

"Preeti Karan Setu Banhal" (A Bridge Built for the Sake of Love)

*[Focusing on the literary works of
Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur
in the Maithili language.]*

Edited by Ashish Anchinhar

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Today, all the blessed lords have
arrived in Janakpur...

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From which city has the seller of
vermilion come to sell vermilion, O,
from which city has the daughter
(maiden) bought the vermilion?...

****Introduction to Gajendra Thakur
and Preeti Thakur****

Like the branch of the Karmi tree,
they spread, like the Puraina (water
hyacinth/plant), they flourished...

****Contributor Introductions****

****Editor Introduction****

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****To the Creator****

**Today, Janakpur is
filled with
auspiciousness as all
the kings have
arrived...**

**First, the verse to
Ganesha was sung, and
the deities were
worshipped...**

Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur are both writers and also a husband-wife. In Maithili, they are one among those who fit the concept of a couple as creators. In literature, Preeti ji's role is seen in creating illustrated stories, children's literature, and working behind the scenes for 'Videha'. But Gajendra ji has many different roles. Gajendra Thakur is the one who brought Maithili to the Internet and established it there; he is working for the development of the language; he is the one who made the Panji accessible to the general reader; he is the one who delivers a magazine in the Tirhuta script along with a total of 11 scripts to the readers; he is the creator of a dictionary, an editor, a researcher, and a litterateur. And above all, he is a person who works silently. In this

book, the articles related to Gajendra Thakur's work have been arranged in this sequence (Internet, Language, Panji, Script, Dictionary, Editing, Research, Literature, and Others). And for all this work, whomever he needed to take work or help from, he did and continues to do so. Two such individuals came forward to help accomplish his work or wishes, with whose assistance the entire history of Maithili literature changed. Gajendra Thakur would bring the ideas, and these two individuals kept striving to find the resources to make those ideas a reality. One is Nagendra Kumar Jha, and the other is Panjekar Vidyanand Jha. Details of how these two worked will also be found in the book. Incidentally, it should also be mentioned that in an article compiled in this book, Dhanakar Thakur ji has given Gajendra Thakur the title of "Good Manager". So I believe that although

this book is directly about Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur, it also evaluates four people from a literary perspective. The article by Siyaram Jha 'Saras' in this book evaluates Gajendra Thakur ji's father, Kripanand Thakur ji, from a social level. Looking at it that way, a total of five people have been evaluated in this book. This book has been divided into three sections. The first is the Kripanand Thakur section, the second is the Preeti Thakur section, and the third is the Gajendra Thakur section. Naturally, the articles included in this book are based on this division. I could not collect any article for the work Gajendra Thakur did for the language. The reason is that in the very Maithili where only those who lead movements or hold protests are considered language activists, no one acknowledges that Gajendra Thakur or any other linguist worked for the language. So,

I have brought up this matter in the preface. When Babu Bhola Lal Das led a movement, it was the need of that era; when Tarakant Jha filed a case against the government at that time and put in all his effort, it was necessary at that time. But in the present time, what is needed is to enroll one's children in schools to study through the Maithili medium, which no one is doing. Everyone educates their children through the English medium; everyone just hopes that Maithili teachers will be recruited. But the government has all the information, so why would they do such a thing? For the development of a language, it is necessary that in the era you are in, what progress other developed languages are making, what have you done to ensure that progress happens in your language as well? This, in my view, is the only criterion. The use of the Internet by

Gajendra Thakur for the Maithili language, and his work on its various tools, is something superior and more effective than any other activity being done on platforms. From this perspective, Gajendra Thakur comes in the line of dedicated fighters for the language like Babu Bhola Lal Das, Prabodhanarayan Singh, Kanchinath Jha 'Kiran', Subhadra Jha, Babu Saheb Chaudhary, Pt. Govind Jha, Jayakant Mishra, Tarakant Jha, Prof. Dr. Ramavatar Yadav, and others like them. It is hopeful that in the future, someone will write about the language-related work done by Gajendra Thakur through the Internet. Articles on some topics could not be included, such as 'Videha and Diversity', 'Videha and New Writers', 'Research Articles Published in Videha', 'Videha's Pro-People Stance', etc., but their indications appear in various

articles. It is hoped that in the future, evaluations of Videha on various topics will be conducted.

Gajendra Thakur, Panjekar Vidyanand Jha, and Nagendra Jha are among the editors of the Panji (two parts) and the dictionary. If due to my oversight, an article mentions only Gajendra ji's name, please read it as the trio of editors. The articles compiled in this book come from different sections of society. Section here does not mean caste. Litterateurs are a separate section, institutions are separate. Readers are a separate section, and those who primarily do technical work are another. Unlike in other books, one does not find articles from a single homogeneous group of litterateurs. Perhaps for this reason, some might find the presentation of this book weak. But in my view, this is

precisely why the ideas presented in this book are found to be completely critical and factual. Another advantage of this is that everyone has focused on the subject they have written about. There is no digression in any article, and along with that, a lot of meaningful information and facts are found that further confirm and strengthen the work of Gajendra Thakur, Preeti Thakur, or Videha. For this reason, I have full faith that this book will also become a historical document for the readers.

For the special issues of Videha, I also approach those people for articles, informing those who are staunch opponents of me, Videha, or Gajendra Thakur. And I have done the same for this book as well. If a few people say that they did not receive information, then my request to them is that they at least check

their WhatsApp, Facebook, or email message boxes (inboxes). I hope the result of this effort of mine will be visible in the special issues of Videha as well as in this book.

In Maithili, the word "editor" has its own distinct swagger (showiness, glamour). In Maithili, an editor is one who can arrange for funds, can get a book printed on good paper with an attractive cover. Whereas these tasks are not the editor's. Funds can be arranged, an attractive cover can be made by a good designer, a proofreader can standardize spellings and call it good language. But where does the aspect of vision and insight come from? Editing is primarily a matter of vision, insight, and critical thinking. When there's no vision, then an attractive cover and uniform spellings are of no use. You can

assess what my vision and insight as an editor are like by reading the preface and seeing the arrangement of the book "Swatantracheta Arvind Thakur: Vyaktitva-Krititva" edited and published by me in 2020. If even a slight expansion of Arvind ji's critical activities is found in the preface of Swatantracheta book, then the world of Maithili criticism will surely evaluate it someday in the future. Incidentally, it is also appropriate to inform that the book named "Swatantracheta Arvind Thakur: Vyaktitva-Krititva" is essentially the revised form of Videha's Arvind Thakur special issue. This special issue was published in Videha issue 189, on 1st November 2015.

A brief description of the work done so far by Gajendra Thakur has been written by various authors. In this

sequence, there is some work that would be good for Mithila-Maithili if Gajendra Thakur does it. Such work is as follows:

1) **A Critical History of the Entire Maithili Literature** - The literary history written in Maithili so far is one-sided. It is one-sided only because there is no discussion, or very little discussion, of the parallel stream that has always flowed in Maithili literature at every point in time. Gajendra ji has an authentic study of both streams of Maithili literature. So I believe that the literary history of Maithili is still incomplete, and Gajendra ji can turn this 'incomplete' history into a "Critical History of the Entire Maithili Literature".

2) **Work Related to Lexicon and

Thesaurus** - Gajendra Thakur has edited a dictionary, so editing the Maithili Lexicon and Thesaurus would be convenient for him.

3) **Comprehensive History of Mithila** - The history of Mithila available so far is divided into fragments. There are many periods where historians become silent. There are many such dynasties and the contemporary condition of the people on which historians maintain silence. With the vision that Gajendra Thakur possesses, he can write the comprehensive history of Mithila.

4) **Updating and Digitizing the Panjis of All Castes of Mithila** - Many Ojadhhs have been digitized by Gajendra Thakur, but much still remains. No work has been done yet

on the Panjis of other castes. Previously, Panjikars used to gather and update the Panjis; now this work is not happening. Currently, in present-day Mithila, Gajendra Thakur is the only one who can do this work.

5) **Special Issue on Literary Corruption** - Videha had once announced in one of its issues that it would publish a "Special Issue on Literary Corruption", but that has not been possible so far. I wish that Gajendra ji writes a separate book on this topic and provides information to the public about how much damage has been caused to Maithili literature by all this.

Videha primarily writes with inflections attached to words, and also has its own guidelines named

"Bhashapak" for the Maithili standard language and the Maithili language editing curriculum, but the authors publishing in it have the freedom to write in whichever form they choose. Videha respects all spellings and forms. So please understand the same rule applies to this book as well. In my preface or other compositions, you will find inflections attached, but different authors and publishers bring their own style. That is not wrong either. However, I believe that keeping inflections attached enhances beauty. Many people write by removing 'ka' from verbs, while some attach it. I have used both forms in this book. Please understand similarly for other grammatical rules. I also want to mention one thing that while typing an article or correcting a typed article, in haste, my own spelling and style creep in. So it is very possible

that two spellings of the same word appear in the same article. If this causes any inconvenience to anyone, please consider it my oversight and forgive me. Despite great care, somewhere or other, conjunct consonants might appear in their original form (like the halant remaining in the initial and middle characters).

This book also includes an old interview conducted by Munnaji, in which questions were asked to Gajendra ji: "How many days will your resolve to stick to one point, despite being far from Maithili journalism or due to the pursuit of truth, even after facing insults, last?" In response, Gajendra Thakur had said, "I can only say that the future will determine this; why should I exaggerate about myself?" For this reason, we have included the old

interview as well, so that readers can see the consistency between his commitment at that time and his current activities and commitment. Along with this, a new interview has also been included. Possibly Preeti Thakur's first and only interview to date has also been included in this.

There is no article by me on Gajendra Thakur ji in this collection, and it has been deliberately omitted. I do have some articles on him, and certainly, by adding more articles to them, I will present a separate book to you all. Anyway, the work that Gajendra Thakur has, and the extent of it, cannot be understood from just one edited book.

The title of this book is taken from 'Barahmasa' (a traditional song about the twelve months). There are

textual variations in the folk verse, so the line I have taken also has another version, but the text given in the book appealed to me more. The three sources I used for determining the text are as follows:

<https://youtu.be/mONclfV0uHk?si=MbV7kmM3NCbfc1iA>

https://youtu.be/GiDjpgTNHY?si=KSZSErHO_f1aEwoJ

<https://durgatutorial.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/Class-9Mithilak-DharoharMithilak-DharoharChapter-3CL9-MITH-DHAROHAR-CH-3.pdf>

****As far as I know, this book is possibly the first of its kind in Maithili in which a husband-wife creative duo has been evaluated together. Incidentally, it is also appropriate to know that based on**

the 'book publication year', Preeti Thakur is a senior creator compared to Gajendra Thakur. Whereas in Maithili, the opposite usually happens. The husband's book is published first and the wife's book later, or much later. Some wives' books are not published at all. Based on the information provided by Siyaram Jha 'Saras', this coincidence occurred after Neerja Renu and Kishornath Jha. It is also appropriate to mention here that Kishornath Jha is primarily a Sanskrit scholar and writer. His books in Sanskrit were published before Neerja ji's. However, Saras ji had mentioned one or two more names like Narendra Jha and Panna Jha, but upon investigation, the husband's publication came first. Whatever the case, such a tendency is rare and the feminist discourse makers of Maithili should take cognizance of this fact. Incidentally, readers should also

know that in the same village as Gajendra Thakur ji, there was also a creative couple, Gopal Jha 'Gopesh' and Prabhavati Jha, much before his time.

If you are reading the PDF of this book and see any word or line underlined in blue or a different color, understand that a link has been provided in it for reference, and clicking on it will open that link. Links have also been provided in some photos. Through this medium, readers can study the references in less time. But this facility is not available in the printed book. For this reason, it is possible that some lines of this book may not seem conventional to the reader. Wherever a link has been provided, there is extra space left between some words of that line. It is requested to read it as a single line. If

I had wanted, I could have given all the links or images in one place, but I think that readers should get more references in one place.

Thanks to Lakshman Jha 'Sagar' who suggested that print magazines should publish special issues on Gajendra Thakur. He had also mentioned the names of one or two magazines. I had said that the work should be good, but no one does it. Later, I compiled the articles on Gajendra and Preeti ji, or related to both of them, that were in the old issues of Videha so far and on the blogs run by Videha (marked as 'taken from Videha's chest'). And I thought, why not compile these articles along with new articles and make a book? And so this book is in your hands. It is very possible that the old articles by various authors might have been compiled in their

books. In such a situation, whatever information I got, I have written the name of that book below that article.

An essential piece of information for the reader is that due to a mistake of mine, in some places in this book, the period mark has been replaced by the English full stop. Now, this mistake has occurred, but readers should consider it my compulsion and accept the full stop as a period. But readers know that the full stop remains in the links.

In this book, I have expressed my thoughts through some lines of Maithili folk songs, the details of which are as follows:

1. आजु जनकपुर मंगल भुप सभ आओल हे... (This

section contains the table of contents).

2. प्रथम गणेश पद गाओल देवता मनाओल हे...
(This section contains my own words, i.e., the editorial).

3. बनहीमे मुँगिया जनमि गेल बनही लतरि गेल हे...
(This section lists the specialties of Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur and the first and important works done by them in Maithili).

4. पीपरक पात अकासहि डोलए शीतल बहए बसात यौ... (This section provides details about Gajendra Thakur ji's father, his family, and social background).

5. पहिल पहर गौरी पूजल... (This section contains a critique of Preeti Thakur's work).

6. तोड़लनि धनुष कठोर हे परिछन चलू सखिया...
(This section contains a critique of Gajendra Thakur's work).

7. कवन नगर के सेनुरिया सेनुर बेचे आयल रे आहे

कवन नगर के कुमारी धिया सेनुर बेसाहल हे...(This section contains a complete introduction of Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur).

8. करमी के लत्ती जकाँ लतरथु पुरैन जकाँ पसरथु हे... (This section contains my final words related to this book).

I am grateful to all the known and unknown lyricists whose lines have been used in this book. It is very possible that the use of these folk songs in places may not be liked by some progressive readers and scholars. Some progressive writers and critics may also say that those whose works are in this book have been reduced to singers. In response to such statements, I have said many times that it is not surprising that writers and critics cut off from their traditions say such things. Let this point also reach such progressive

people: I clearly believe that Maithili's oral literature is far ahead of so-called serious literature. Therefore, serious readers and writers will like the song lines. As far as I can understand, the lines of folk songs that I have placed in the context and places in this book have further highlighted the purpose of the compiled articles. Now this book is in the hands of the readers; they can tell me what they understand. I will respectfully preserve their suggestions for another edition of this book and for other future editing work.

-Ashish Anchinhaar

बनहीमे मुँगिया जनमि गेल बनही लतरि

गेल हे...

Here are the specialties of Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur and some of the works done by them in the Maithili language and literature that are first for Maithili:

1) Preeti Thakur is a full-time children's literature author in Maithili. She creates her own illustrations for her picture books. The imaginary pictures of some heroes separated from the mainstream of Mithila are created by her. Readers can see the pictures of these heroes in her picture books.

2) Preeti Thakur is the first creator of picture books in Maithili. In 2002, she first translated the picture book "Chhot Aur Baigh" and in the year 2008, her original Maithili picture

book "Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha" was published.

3) The first presence on the internet in Maithili was the blog "Bhalsarik Gaachh" run by Gajendra Thakur, which was from the year 2000.

4) Samdiya is the first literary review blog in Maithili, which Gajendra Thakur created in 2004.

5) Gajendra Thakur is the first person to bring the Panji to the public in digital and book form for the common people. He completed the work of digitizing the Panji around 2007. For this work, the two people from whom Gajendra ji received assistance are credited as editors in this work. In 2007 itself, he gave a copy of it to Anshuman Pandey without any conditions, so that Pandey ji could complete his research from the University of Michigan, USA. The research topic

was "Recasting the Brahmin in Medieval Mithila: Origins of Caste Identity among the Maithil Brahmins of North Bihar". This research was published in 2014, and on page 22, Anshuman ji has acknowledged Gajendra Thakur ji's aforementioned work.

Before Gajendra Thakur, the Genealogical Society of Utah (United States) came forward for the preservation of the Panji, but they created an archive for themselves, not for the society. For this, with the help of some local people, they reached the Panjikars and some payment was given to the Panjikars, and it is very possible that there were local guides who might have received funds. The common public cannot use the Panji archive in the Genealogical Society of Utah because the Genealogical Society took it by

paying, and now its digital form is their property, which they use for their research. Now many people are found saying that the Panjikars do not cooperate in giving the Panji, which is perhaps a result of the work of the Genealogical Society. The Panjikars might think that someone will come again and pay. In contrast, Gajendra Thakur, with his willpower and hard work, made a thing of Mithila accessible to the people of Mithila and the entire country at both digital and print levels. The extent of confidentiality of the digital work done by the Genealogical Society can be gauged from the fact that Bhairav Lal Das, who is a good scholar, mentioned in a comment on my Facebook post that even after a lot of searching, he did not get the Genealogical Society's material. The screenshot of the comment is being given at the end. The link to my Facebook post is:

<https://www.facebook.com/anchinhar/posts/pfbid02Sr82dVYSSAYf8JoFZ2ZvjcFY8R6WTPPUfxbuuPoJC9yQv13dAJ3S6PjNUNgQBp6nl>

6) Gajendra Thakur is the first person to make the Dushan Panji public. This is the first attempt to make it public since the beginning of the Panji. For this work, Gajendra Thakur received threats and abuses in his mail.

7) Videha is the first e-magazine of Maithili, which has been around since 2008 and is founded by Gajendra Thakur.
<http://videha.co.in/>

8) Videha magazine is the first Maithili magazine to receive an ISSN (International Standard Serial Number).

9) Videha is the first Maithili magazine that is published in more than one script (Devanagari, Tirhuta,

Braille, Kaithi, Newari, IPA, Brahmi, Kharosthi, Urdu, Tibetan, and Tibetan-Ume). Videha does this work using the technique of Transliteration. A simple question may arise in the reader's mind: are the editor of Videha or the people associated with it knowledgeable in all these scripts? The simple answer is that it is not necessarily mandatory. Since it is based on transliteration technology, it can at least be considered a symbol of interest and self-study. It is very possible that on the strength of this self-study, people associated with Videha become experts.

10) The first digital library of Maithili was started by Videha in the year 2008.

11) Gajendra Thakur is the first Aroozi of Maithili (Aroozi means one who knows the prosody of ghazals and is its pioneer). Gajendra Thakur

is the person who, through the medium of ghazal, reintroduced Vedic meters.

12) Gajendra Thakur is one of the three editors of the first computer-based dictionary of Maithili.

13) The first Maithili book in Braille script is by Gajendra Thakur ji. This book is a novel named "Sahsrabaadhani".

14) The most books in the Tirhuta script are by Gajendra Thakur ji.

15) Gajendra Thakur is the first editor of Maithili who publishes magazine issues in more than one script.

16) The first blog for literary translation on the internet is <http://Madhubani-art.blogspot.com>, created by Gajendra Thakur ji.

17) A blog for children's literature on

the internet came under the name "Nena-Bhutka", which has been around since 2009 and was created by Gajendra Thakur.

18) The first effort for Maithili Wikipedia was made by Gajendra Thakur in 2008, various translation works continued until 2013, and in 2014, Maithili Wikipedia was approved. Wikipedia is a community project in which all work is done for society without payment.

19) Videha is the first aggregator of Maithili, where one finds a list of other internet sites of Maithili.

20) The first effort for Google Translate was made by Gajendra Thakur in 2011, and Google approved it in May 2022. Google Translation is a community project.

21) The first blog focused on Maithili drama is "Videha Maithili Natya Utsav", which has been around since

August 2011 and was created by Gajendra Thakur.

22) Videha: Sadeha: The first Tirhuta (Mithilakshar) blog, the link of which is <http://videha-sadeha.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

23) Videha: Braille: The first Maithili blog in Braille script, the link of which is <http://videha-braille.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

24) Videha Radio: The first podcast site in Maithili, the link of which is <http://videha123radio.wordpress.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

25) Videha Maithili Sign Language - The first Maithili sign language blog, the link of which is <https://maithili-sign-language.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

26) Videha Brahmi - The first Maithili

blog in Brahmi script, the link of which is <https://maithili-brahmi.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

27) Videha Kharosthi - The first Maithili blog in Kharosthi script, the link of which is <https://maithili-kharoshthi.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

28) Videha in Kaithi script - The first Maithili blog in Kaithi script, the link of which is <https://maithili-kaithi.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

29) Videha in Newari script - The first Maithili blog in Newari script, the link of which is <https://maithili-newari.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

30) Videha in IPA script - The first Maithili blog in IPA, the link of which is <https://maithili-ipa.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

31) Videha - The first Maithili blog in Urdu Nastaliq script, the link of which is <https://maithili-urdu.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

32) Videha - The first Maithili blog in Tibetan script, the link of which is <https://maithili-tibetan.blogspot.com/>. Its founder is Gajendra Thakur.

33) The credit for translating the Japanese poetry forms Tanka/Senryu/Haibun into Maithili goes to Gajendra Thakur ji. Before this, only Haiku existed in Maithili. Since 2008, there is also a blog for Maithili Haiku/Tanka/Senryu/Haibun where Haiku have been collected from Videha's Facebook version. This blog can be seen at this address: <http://maithili-haiku.blogspot.com/>

34) "Shruti Publication" is the result

of the combined efforts of Gajendra Thakur (Creative Idea) and Nagendra Kumar Jha (Resource + Technical Approach). Shruti Publication is the first standard publisher of Maithili. A standard publisher means one that publishes books without taking payment, and despite that, the copyright remains with the author. This publication has published more than 100 books so far, which includes my book "Anchinhaar Aakhar" (2011).

This list above is taken from my book titled "Maithili Web Patrakarita ka Itihas". Readers can get detailed information by reading that book. This is not the final list. Many 'first' works may have escaped my notice, which I will include in the future. Also, there are some first things described in various articles inside the book. Incidentally, here I also

want to inform the reader that seeing the work of Videha, the name of a meter (behar) used in Maithili ghazals has been kept as 'Behr-e-Videha'. Its detailed discussion is found in my ghazal collection "Kumari Ichchha". It is also requested that if any reader disagrees with my introduction, the list provided by me, or any fact given in the articles of this book, or if that work was done before the first work mentioned in this book, then they should come with references and I will immediately make corrections in my understanding.



Ashish Anchinhar

8h

गजेन्द्र ठाकुरसँ पहिने पंजीक संरक्षण लेल Genealogical Society of Utah (United States) आगू आएल मुदा ओ समाजक लेल नै अपना लेल आर्काइभ बनेलक। एहि लेल ओ किछु स्थानीय लोकक सहायतासँ पंजीकार धरि पहुँचल आ पंजीकार सभकेँ किछु पाह भेटलनि आ बहुत संभव जे स्थानीय गाइड सभ रहथिन हुनको फंड भेटल होइन।

Genealogical Society of Utah मे जे पंजीक आर्काइभ अछि तकरा साधारण जनता उपयोग नै कऽ सकैए कारण Genealogical Society पाइ दऽ लेने छै आब ओ डिजिटल रूप ओकर संपत्ति छै जकरा ओ अपन रिसर्च लेल उपयोग करैत।

एखन बहुत लोक ई कहैत भेटि जेता जे पंजीकार सभ सहयोग नै करै छथि पंजी देबामे से शायद Genealogical Society केर काजक उपज भऽ सकै छै। पंजीकार सभकेँ होइत हेतनि जे फेर कियो आएत आ पाइ दऽ कऽ जाएत। मुदा एकर विपरीत गजेन्द्र ठाकुर अपन इच्छाशक्ति आ मेहनतसँ मिथिलाक चीज मिथिला लेल आ संपूर्ण देशक जनता लेल डिजिटल आ प्रिंट दूर स्तरपर सुलभ बनेलाह।

21:47

Binayanand Jha and 45 others

Rishi Bashistha

गजेन्द्र ठाकुर जी उत्तरेखनीय आ ऐतिहासिक काज कयलनि अछि। विदेह ई-पत्रिका सेहो मैथिलीक लेल एकटा अमूल्य आ अनवरत चलायवला दीर्घजीवी पत्रिका अछि। एहि पत्रिका आ हुनका द्वारा स्थापित श्रुति प्रकाशनक प्रताप मैथिलीकेँ अनेक महत्वपूर्ण रचनाकार प्राप्त भेलैक। साधुवाद।

7h Like Reply Hide 1

Sanjay Jha

हमरा लग अछि

7h Like Reply Hide 1

Sanjay Jha

लेकिन हम अपन तकलौ त खोजबामे की बुझबा में दिक्कत भेल। केना ताकल जेतै से कने बुझाबी।

7h Like Reply Hide 1

Ashish Anchinhar

Sanjay Jha भूमिकामे...

Shiva Kumar Mishra

मिथिलाक पञ्जीक संरक्षण एक अपूर्व काज थिक। मिथिलाक धरोहरिक संरक्षणकाज कतेक कठिन छैक से एहि क्षेत्रमे काज केनिहारे टा बुझि सकैछ। साधुवाद।

See translation

21:44

Binayanand Jha and 45 others

Pawan Jha

6h Like Reply Hide 1

Nabo Narayan Mishra

बहुमूल्य कार्य हेतु बधाइ

4h Like Reply Hide 1

Awesome WORK

3h Like Reply Hide 1

Bhairab Lal Das

Utah वाला डॉक्यूमेंट्स तकबाक लेल बहुत बोआयल छी श्रीमान। नई के नई भेटल

1h Like Reply Hide 1

Chandeshwar Khan

बहुत सुन्दर काज एहि लेल बहुत बहुत बधाई

1h Like Reply Hide 1

Comment as Ashish Anchinhar

Comment as Ashish Anchinhar

two centuries.

The largest hinderance to a proper study of *pañjī prabandha* and other aspects of brahminical society in north Bihar during the medieval period is access to sources and the paucity of primary sources on this topic. While the *pañjī* records offer a vast amount of detail on Maithil Brahmins, the records themselves are difficult to access. The difficulty is not one of language or script or completeness of content; rather, it is one of privilege. The *pañjīkara*-s whose families have maintained these records for generations are often reluctant to allow others to peruse their records. It is a matter of 'intellectual property' to them. I was fortunate enough to receive a complete digitized set of *pañjī* records from Gajendra Thakur of New Delhi in 2007. I was allowed to browse through transcriptions of records that are in the possession of Hetukar Jha of Patna in 2013. The second limitation is the lack of historical records about the general society, culture, and polity of the Karnata period. Several scholars have complained about this.⁴³ Apart from the genealogical records, there are very few sources directly related to the origins of the records. Although *pañjī prabandha* took place during Karnata rule, the kings of this dynasty left no epigraphic sources, such as copper-plate grants to Brahmins. The absence is quite curious because the *pañjī* records provide ample proof of Brahmin settlements in north Bihar. Equally curious is that there are epigraphical sources from the borderlands of Mithila slightly preceding and during Karnata rule, which show land grants being made to Brahmins in areas of north Bihar. Moreover,

⁴³Sircar, *Studies in the Society and Administration of Ancient and Medieval India*, 140; Chaudhary, "Political History of North Bihar," 281.

****The Peepal Leaf Sways
in the Sky, the Cool
Breeze of the Monsoon
Arrives...****

****Section-1: Kripanand
Thakur****

****Turning the Pages, the
Village's Director:
K.N.T.****

****By Siyaram Jha**

'Saras' **

His name was Kripanand Thakur. I try to understand the meaning – whose grace? Upon whom? Anand – then what kind of joy or joy in what? Immersed in the feeling of joy himself, or immersing others in the unspoken? This biographical essay is an attempt to quell the turmoil of many such questions!

****The Setting and Environment:****

The story is from the sixth and seventh decades, of the last century. The story is from today's Madhubani district, which in those days wasn't a district, but a subdivision, and its condition, to borrow a phrase, was 'a shivering city – Madhubani'. Why shivering? Its story is long, but in short, one year floods, the next year

drought! Then sometimes waterlogging, then sometimes dryness! There, the village, folk traditions, creatures, and plants, as they should be – naked in the summer and shivering in the winter! Covering one part leaves another uncovered, and vice-versa!

Situated across the western bank of the Kamala-Balan rivers in the central area of that district is a village. Its name is Mahath. Why? Because elephants were once used for ploughing here – hence Mahath! This is not an exaggeration. Around 1950-55, there were four elephants, this is an eyewitness account. Talking about the surrounding villages, on the eastern bank of the Kamala are Mahrail-Kanhauli-Jhanjharpur Bazaar-Station etc., and to the west are Kathia-Patti-Raima, Bharat-Bijai, Koilakh, etc. To the

north are Gopalakha-Ramkhetari-Shankarpur and to the south are Mahinathpur-Naruar-Hainthibali, Bhairab-Sthan, Bideshwar-Sthan, Lohna-Kathna, etc.

The lifestyle of this ten-mile region was generally simple and domestic. Yes, due to some good fortune, the prestige of Lohna-Rupauli-Kathna, Bharat and Koilakh was somewhat higher; in our village, there were six-nine, in those villages, nine-thirteen. Here, 'hau-rau-yau' was spoken, there, the advanced 'yau-yau-yau'. Here, bread meant millet, khesari, rice, groundnuts, maize, etc., there, it was pure wheat's delicacy – whether eaten as rice or wheat! The point is that even within this distance, there was a vast difference in lifestyle, food habits, and thoughts.

****Education: Famine of Basic
Facilities:****

The village had a Lower Primary School. Next to the school was a Shiva temple, and in front, the village's lifeline – a big pond. Actually, there were other bigger ponds – Samia-pond, Dakahi pond, but those were outside the village; like they were fenced off after being donated by the zamindars! For middle school studies, one had to go one and a half kilometres away, crossing villages to Kathia School. This was a board middle school (it still exists). Children from five surrounding villages came here for class four, out of which roughly 50% would pass seventh grade and move on, the remaining 50% would get involved in farming, cattle herding, or go straight to Calcutta! High schools were searched for in the seventh decade, two were found – in Bharat and Bhairabsthan. Both were

makeshift huts, built by collecting bamboo, straw, posts, and twigs from villages. The teachers and staff were of a similar standard!

Those who wanted a proper education, who wanted to do something special, would go to Jhanjharpur – Kejriwal High School or Saraswa High School, and if they were even more capable, then Madhubani or Darbhanga!

Despite all this struggle and hardship, around 1960, the village had two M.A.s and a Ph.D. who were professors in Calcutta, one postgraduate, and five or six graduates, all living outside the village during their careers. During Durga Puja, Diwali, Chhath, Holi, and the summer heat, these people would get leave and come to the village, and

then almost every part of the village would be buzzing. Between Diwali, Chhath, and Saraswati Puja to Holi, two plays would be staged by the 'Yuva Natya Kala Parishad'.

So, regarding education, it was an extraordinary problem in those days. 95% of Brahmin families were dependent on farming, household, and livestock. The condition of other castes – some Yadavs, Mallahs, Dhobis, Hajjams, Pathans, Rams, Mandals, Kamars, Sonars, etc. – was even worse! Those whose households were already in trouble, how could the boys of such families even dream of school?

There were about ten to twelve families in the entire village considered well-off; their children would study up to middle or high

school! The question of girls was pointless. Even the daughters of those mentioned ten to twelve families, despite the Lower Primary School in the village, could not become properly literate. It used to be said, 'If they learn to read letters, that's enough!' But even in those extremely difficult circumstances, around 1961-62, two daughters of the village – Urmila and Sondai – somehow passed the entrance exam from Jhanjharpur School (both were sisters of the aforementioned Calcutta professors, so they could demonstrate such exceptional courage).

In such a depressing time, when a boy of extraordinary intelligence and talent from an ordinary middle-income family of Thakurtoli (of the late Jaykalit and Ankalit Thakur) – Kripanand (born 1939) – passed the

entrance examination from Kejriwal High School, Jhanjharpur in 1957 with first division, it was naturally a matter of pride for the village and surprise for the area. It is noteworthy that the track record of that school was renowned at the district level. For many consecutive years before and after, this school used to compete with Watson High School, Madhubani; Zila School, Darbhanga; and M.L. Academy (Saraswati School), Laheriasarai. In these three schools respectively, Thakur Prasad Singh, M.A., Dip.Ed. (Jhanjharpur); Chandranath Mishra (Pokhrauni), M.A., Dip.Ed. (Madhubani); Jhingur Kunwar, M.A., Dip.Ed. (Laheriasarai) were not just renowned scholars but also known as strict administrators, perhaps even infamous. Not only that, in that school at Jhanjharpur, there were strict English scholars like Latti Babu, strict science teachers like

Dukharan Babu and Pitambar Lal Das, and gold medalist teachers for Hindi and Social Sciences like Shyam Babu and Vishnudev Babu. Speaking of Watson (Madhubani), that school was equipped with scholars like Dr. Shyamchandra Jha (Bhawani Pur, Pandaul), postgraduate in Hindi-English; Dr. Devnarayan Jha (Sharhad-Shahpur), M.Com., gold medalist (Commerce); a science-maths teacher (from Ghonghardiha) who was an expert in Physics, Chemistry, and Mathematics; Kula Babu and Madan Babu, both brothers, were top postgraduate scholars in English. And what was the Principal's discipline? He did not let his own son get promoted in the pre-board test exams twice because he couldn't score 30 marks in English with a pen. Such were the President's Award-winning teachers in those days!

And at M.L. Academy (Darbhanga), the administrator-capable principal (President's Awardee) was even stricter, 'Vajradapi Kathorani' – Jhingur Kunwarji from Gangapatti (Laheriasarai). Along with Pt. Shree Chandranath Mishra 'Amar' (Sanskrit-Hindi teacher), teachers for all subjects were similarly one more excellent scholar than the other! So, in the board exams of the then undivided Bihar, these schools used to occupy five, six positions out of the top ten merit list. I am giving this detailed description because I myself was a student of Kejriwal School, Jhanjharpur and Watson School, Madhubani for higher secondary, and Jhingur Kunwarji was a relation by marriage (samdhi) of Mahath. Kripa Babu's constant companion was another equally brilliant student – Rambahadurji, whose hand he had held to take him away to make him

his son-in-law (but against that student's wishes)! As a result, within a few days of the marriage, he untimely passed away. The entire settlement was not just in mourning for days, not months, but for years after this incident or accident, and as a result, within three-four years, the establishment of the only library in Paropatta named after him – 'Shree Rambahadur Sarvajanik Pustakalaya' became possible. Paying tribute to that promising young man, I pause this story here. So, I was saying – in 1957, matriculation, and in 1959, I.Sc. with high marks from R.K. College, Kripanand ji secured admission in M.I.T., Muzaffarpur in Civil Engineering (1959-63) with rank number 1 and became an engineer. I remember, his father's protective shadow was lifted from his head early, but his elder brother, Late Nityanand ji, was not affected by that

blindness or helplessness. He fulfilled his unwavering guardianship.

****The Ripple That Became a Wave:****

After the drummers announced and the worship offerings were distributed throughout the village – Kripanand ji's success and his contribution as an Assistant Engineer with the Bihar Government (1963), the ripple was not limited to the village and society. About a year or so later, from Naruar, the eldest son of the late Bikal Jha (nephew of Mahath), Shree Harekanth Jha (board topper, from that same Kejriwal Vidyalaya) also became an engineer; from Kathia and Mahrail villages, two engineers each (from Kathia, Shree Hariballabh Jha, renowned from DDA Delhi); then in

1965-66, Narayan Jha (Naruar) from our batch's board merit list became an engineer, and in that same period, my two friends, Shree Naresh Jha (now late) and Shree Durganand Jha, obtaining engineering diplomas – I can say this was an era of significant change. Around that time, from Kathna as well, one J.E. (name probably Vedanand Mishra, now late) qualified. One of my classmates – from Mahath – Lakshman ji also became an engineer.

A rapid change also came in other fields of education or knowledge during that period, which can be estimated; for example, around the same year or so, Indrakant ji M.A. Political Science, Sachindra Kumar Jha (Phul Babu) M.A., Ramnarayan Jha, B.Com/M.Com, Pitambar Jha (Bhutkun) doing I.Sc. and joining the Navy, Triptinarayan ji and

Jaynarayan ji's graduate degrees, and Satyanarayan Thakur's B.Sc. prestige, and obtaining a science teacher's job at Bharat College – these are some examples that highlight the awakening of that transitional educational period; which was identifying Mahath, once known for 'stick-wielders, buffalo-keepers, and wrestlers', as a reading, writing, progressing, and well-educated village. On this foundation, in the subsequent generation, we have Krishna Kumar Jha, Central Excise Commissioner, Delhi; Dr. Mohan Jha (M.B.B.S.); and Vijay Kumar Thakur (Chief Engineer, Coal India, Kripa Babu's grace-product); and the pioneer of various e-revolutions in Maithili literature, including today's e-magazine 'Videha', Shree Gajendra Thakur, whose mention is also necessary. That ripple raised in the seventh decade can still be seen touching the

shores up to the blessed Preeti Thakur.

****K.N.T. Among the Village Folk:****

While Kripanand ji was establishing himself on the path of his own and his family's upliftment, during that same period (early seventh decade), as mentioned earlier, the sorrowful incident of Rambahadur ji had also pained and churned the village. It's hard to say how the villages and society in our neighbourhood reacted to such an accidental incident, but how our village society reacted, I can still see before my eyes, but let's pause that story for a bit.

****Helping a Student:****

In 1961, my father, respecting my

wish and stubbornness, got me enrolled, bypassing Bharat and Kathia High School (now situated in Bhairabsthan), into the eighth class at Jhanjharpur-Kejriwal School. The reason behind it was none other than Kripanand ji. That reason became clear to me a year or two later when once during the summer heat, I reached Kripanand ji with an 'Everyday Science' book to study. On the southern bank of the pond, towards the west was the house-courtyard, and on the east side, facing east, was a large verandah. By that time, the respected elders – Sitaram Babu (Principal Assistant, District Board Madhubani) and Pt. Bachcha Thakur, Kuldeep Babu – all had their gatherings there. So the verandah was always full. Many card games were going on. Several chaupars and other games were set up on some cots, but in one corner, towards the north-east, sitting

quietly on a mat spread on a patia, engrossed in some thick English book, was Kripa Babu. By this time, Kripa Babu had become known as K.N.T. among his contemporaries. Seeing me, all the players seemed surprised or curious. Perhaps, 'What's this from another tola...? Why...?' But he was not surprised, because I had requested him the day before while bathing in the pond for help, and he had gladly accepted, saying 'Come'. Anyway, it was another matter that I was known throughout the village among all castes as a singer or a gentleman-honest student, and was respected accordingly.

- "Yes, student. What do you need to study?"

- "Preparation of Oxygen gas in the laboratory' from 'Everyday Science'."

He looked at my book, turned a few pages, and in one sitting taught me three chapters and told me to bring the answers to the questions for all three chapters tomorrow at this time. He repeatedly addressed me as 'student'. The next day, seeing my homework, he expressed happiness and, giving time continuously for two hours, cleared the doubts for almost the entire book. I felt truly blessed! And then he discussed school, the condition of each teacher, and gave me the mantra for studying and written preparation for each subject; he gave me an understanding of expressing English language and social studies seriously, not by rote, but in my own language. Although I used to occasionally take help from Dr. Parshuram ji (English subject), Devnarayan Thakur ji (Commerce-Book Keeping), and Rajendra Jha ji for Economics subjects, later on, up to the

postgraduate level, the first 'guiding star' was indeed Kripanand ji! Yes, for all this help from seniors, my father used to first go around and make arrangements. He had connections in all four tolas and his recommendations were highly respected (except perhaps in his own brother's household, but everywhere else in the village).

****The Library Episode:****

Now, the most important thing from a social perspective! It was around 1960-62 when the decision to float a public library in the name of the late Rambahadur ji was discussed. It's not necessary to re-mention each of the above-mentioned seniors; in short, a kind of interim committee was formed by combining at least two, three, or four people from each tola, first during the Diwali-Chhath

holidays. Kripa Babu was the representative from Thakurtoli. The good thing was that even when he wasn't there, or couldn't come during any holiday, Nityanand Thakur ji would take on the responsibility, and the work wouldn't get delayed.

First, it was decided to seek the consent of Rambahadur ji's family members for this proposal. His relatives – Kamlu Babu, Gauri Babu (Master Saheb), and Radhakant Babu, despite being in mourning, gladly gave their consent! Subsequently, with the relatives' consent, four or five junior members went to the courtyard to obtain the consent of the respected elder sister-in-law and receive the first donation/contribution. The writer of these lines was also among these new recruits. In giving shape to this

plan, Kripanand ji's influential personality acted as the precise key, because he was not just a close neighbour, but a constant companion.

Then, the second priority was site selection. Several places were proposed during discussions – on the northern bank of Lalbachcha's pond in Dakshinbari tola, near the then Primary School, in the plot of Krishnadev ji (Bachchan ji, Mukhiya) near Misr Tola, near the current Durga Sthan, etc. etc.

Consulting Lalbachcha, despite Phul Babu's agreement, did not appeal to most of the village youth, because the forceful interference or encroachment by running a tractor on the football field near the Balli-Pokhar had caused immense distress to the entire village; no one was

ready to forget that so soon. Consensus was on the site near the Primary School. There, about 7 kathas of land were recorded in some old deed in the school's name. To its south, enclosing the Shiva temple, was the edge of the big pond. The ownership of that land was shared equally (eight annas each) between the village Parhak Patidar and Kachahri Tola.

Then, after obtaining consent by letter from Gopesh ji (Bihar Hindi Rashtrabhasha Parishad, Patna) and Ganpati ji (Kolkata) of Kachahri Tola, and the agreement of Rajendra ji, Indra (later Mukhiya), etc. from the village Parhak Patti, this site was finalized. Then began meetings for bamboo, wood, straw, and bricks. People from all four tolas contributed well – money, bamboo, wood, straw, everything. So, instead

of the initially planned temporary hut, a brick-walled bungalow with a verandah on three sides was built.

As far as I remember, in 1962, the library was registered and from the same year, government grants (for book purchase) started coming, and in 1963, a radio set, speaker, etc. were received from the Central Government. Official receipts were printed, and donations in cash kept coming from as far as Kolkata and Patna, with which electricity connection, patia mats, and two wooden almirahs, etc. were arranged. In summary, the success of this entire campaign was achieved by the continuous efforts of Shree Indrakant ji, Satyanarayan Thakur ji, Kripanand ji, Madhuban ji, Krishnadev ji (Bachni Mukhiya), Triptinarayan ji, Krishnadev ji (Master Saheb), and Indra (Mukhiya) for Mahath. So, Indrakant ji was

chosen as the first librarian. Assisted by him (from 1963 to 1970), the operational responsibility was continuously handled by yours truly, Saras ji (who, as a student of C.M. College in 1969-70, had received the title 'Saras' from Suman-Kiran-Madhup ji).

****The Drama Parishad Episode:****

In the sixth decade of the last century, some enthusiastic young and middle-aged artists from Mahath-Mahinathpur (both villages in one panchayat) had come together and run a Nautanki troupe for about 8-9 years. Ramakant ji (passed away 40 years ago) from Dakshinbari tola was somewhat educated. He had a large moustache and a somewhat greyish tuft of hair. He was the leader and played the role of the dacoit Sultana with extraordinary

acting. Among other select artists of the village, Vishveshwar alias Bisai Jha from the same tola was a famous comedian and an extraordinary dholak and nagada player. Similarly, from Misr Toli, there was Raghuvansh ji, who, along with his rustic charm, also had the style and flair for singing film songs. At upanayan ceremonies, weddings, kojagara, or other occasions in the village, this troupe would be booked and get two hundred, three hundred rupees per night, along with meals. In those days, if an artist got a share of 50-60 rupees after meals, it was a big thing. Anyway.

After the Nautanki troupe disbanded, the entire village felt a void. To fill this, a Ramlila troupe was started in Mahinathpur under the leadership of Harshnarayan, and since there were many educated and talented people

in Mahath, the Natya Parishad was initiated (around 1960-61). As mentioned earlier, the success of the public library had united not only the educated but also the uneducated and less educated youth of all tolas, and the grand Saraswati Puja celebration was started in the premises of that Primary School. On this occasion, it was decided to stage plays for two nights (probably in 61-62). One night, the Hindi play 'Sardar Bhagat Singh' was planned, and the next night, the much-discussed Maithili play 'Basat' written by Pt. Govind Jha (recently late).

I remember well that for the roles of Sardar Bhagat, General Dyer, Colonel (or Major) Saunders, Lala Lajpat Rai, Asafaq-ulla, Rajguru, Batukeshwar Dutt, and also Chandrashekhar Azad, there was a lot of competition, with people jostling for the parts. And,

thanks to Gopesh ji and Madhuban ji! Ultimately, the provisional list of main characters they proposed was revised with the active involvement of two senior elders of the time, Shyam Babu (uncle of Indrakant ji) and Lal Babu (Kachahri Tola), who was a respected postmaster.

On the first night, after testing (like an interview) some important English-Hindi dialogues, seeing Madhuban ji's excellent English pronunciation and fluency, and assessing his personality, Kripanand ji was found suitable for both Saunders and Dyer roles, but handling both simultaneously was not possible; considering this, he played the role of Mr. Saunders. Thakur ji was exceptionally successful! He himself had given up on portraying the cruel image of General Dyer. With his French-cut

moustache and beard, a pinkish foundation on his full cheeks, and varnish on top, and an English hat on his head...!

Wherever the dialogues of both Englishmen were longer and the words difficult, one or two Hindi sentences of similar style were cleverly inserted to make it easily comprehensible for the rural audience. How grand and divine the 'graph' of the play's success was, can be gauged from the fact that both the English villain characters were showered with shoes, slippers, and clods of mud from the audience, and comments like 'Kill them, beat these ugly-faced ones to death' were repeatedly hurled. Beyond that, Lal Bhai (Lal Babu, Kachahri Tola) gave four silver medals and Shyam Bhai gave two medals to honour and encourage the artists. And Kripa Babu was number one on both lists. An even more important

achievement was that within a year or year and a half, the Natya Parishad had to stage this play again on some auspicious occasion, and for that, Lal Bhai gave 500 rupees along with other expenses to buy a set of curtains and royal costumes. Those were bought from Darbhanga in due time.

People from nearby villages – Kathia, Patti, Mahinathpur, Bharat-Gopalakha, etc. – would come in large numbers to see the play. Senior elders used to handle discipline and proper seating arrangements for men and women. Sometimes the B.D.O., C.O., and Deputy Inspector (Schools) also came, and sitting on a dozen chairs arranged on the school verandah throughout the night, respected people like Lalbachcha (former MLA, Jhanjharpur Assembly), Lal Babu, Kamla Babu,

Gauri Babu, Shyam Babu, Babuji Jha (Panchayat Mukhiya), Phusiyaha Bachcha (Kathia) used to sit. These people would, on their own, give donations of one or two hundred rupees to the Parishad. This sequence continued as a tradition from 1960-61 to 1980-81, during which Dinesh ji, Naresh ji, Durganand ji, Ravindra, Udaychandra ji, Tarakant, Hiralal, Lakshman ji (Engineer), etc. kept joining one by one. As they say, 'We kept coming, and the caravan kept growing'! Along with Saraswati Puja, the eagerness to see plays spread to all surrounding villages.

****The Library Episode
(Continued):****

Much has been discussed earlier, no need to repeat. But it's important to say that the fortune of that

Rambahadur Public Library (Mahath) kept rising higher and higher from 1961 to 1981. About 1300 books were collected through village support and about 1800 through government grants, totalling over 3100 (filling two almirahs). Before the grants, two rounds of inspection by the S.D.O. and District Education Officer had taken place, and their welcome and hospitality were excellently managed with the cooperation of the entire society. Arrangements for fish and rice, curd, sugar, rasgullas, and five baskets of mangoes were made. Arrangements for tea, refreshments, and meals were handled by Nityanand ji and myself.

This library was not established merely as a tribute to Rambahadur ji, but it was truly a medium of social change, and within about 4-5 years,

many changes started becoming clearly visible. For example, the Primary School was upgraded from 'Lower' to 'Upper' Primary. To understand it this way – my name was enrolled in the fourth class (1957) at Kathia Board Middle School, but my younger brother Ramesh ji (Maithili writer, retired Deputy Collector) was enrolled in the seventh class at Kathia School. Why was that? Most girls of Mahath, whether from other villages or relatives' villages, were almost destined to stop studying after the third class, but now they started studying at least up to the fifth class in the village itself. My own three sisters, Parshuram ji's daughter, Devnarayan ji's daughter, and about ten other girls, studied up to sixth-seventh standards from Kathia School and progressed further.

The application to the Electrical Sub-divisional Engineer for bringing an electricity line to the village was also prepared by sitting in this library by Shree Indrakant ji, Triptinarayan ji, and Lal Babu. Similarly, efforts were made for metalling the District Board road from Madhubani to the western embankment of Kamala (Kachahri Dhadan).

When rounds of knocking at doors were made at the Madhubani Sub-divisional Office and Darbhanga District Headquarters, these works of the Second Five Year Plan were executed during the Third Five Year Plan period (at its beginning), and then many neighbouring villages like Mahinathpur, Kathia, Patti felt jealousy and envy; I have also seen the resentment of those villages, which they would express whenever and wherever they met the then

MLA (from our village).

The library received a big 'Iron-Chest' like radio set from the Government of India (1962 – January-March), and all the village people used to listen to the Hindi-English news from 8 AM and 8 PM to 9 PM. It was my job (as Assistant Librarian) to switch the radio on and off at the scheduled times. The special thing was that this radio did not play without a speaker (it had no in-built speaker). So it was called a community radio. In this situation, the radio's aerial was tied to a thirty-foot bamboo pole in a corner of the library bungalow, and to ensure the sound reached the entire village, that bamboo had to be rotated every half hour; otherwise, the next day, one would hear resentment from some tola (especially during the 1962 India-China war). I can say that even

among 70-75% illiterate farmers or labourers and buffalo-keepers, listening to the news and the 'Choupal' programme from Patna station on the radio had become a pleasant experience.

In this same library room, between 1964 and 1970-72, there were also Gamaiya-Dakdar (who was only an expert compounder) from Bhavanipur village and electrician Aniruddha Babu (also from Bhavanipur), with the village's consent. These two used to cycle around all the neighbouring villages and became quite popular. And through both of them, I became the son-in-law of Bhavanipur (prematurely).

When I left the village (July 1970), for the next 3-4 years, Naresh ji,

Durganand ji, Ravindra, Gauri Jha, Jugeshwar Bhai (my in-laws) managed it with difficulty, but progress stagnated. During this period, the village had become divided into two factions, with the educated and Kolkata-going people on one side, and the former MLA – the village's powerful landlord – along with five to ten sycophants and lathials on the other.

****The Football Episode:****

There was a football team in Mahath, with more than 30 capable players; selected ones, aged 16 to 30-32; educated from matric to postgraduate, and some less educated ones as well.

Kripanand ji and Satyanarayan Thakur were high-quality 'back

position' (both full-back and half-back) players. Narayan Chaudhary, Pitambar (even after joining the Indian Navy, whenever he came), Triptinarayan ji, and Nageshwar ji (my uncle) etc. were good 'centre forwards' (fast runners and could use both left and right feet). Ganpati ji and Krishnadev ji (Dakshinbari tola, later Master Saheb) were good goalies. Bhannu Mandal, Gauri Jha (Pubari tola), Sitambar, Vedanand (all from Pubari tola) were backward in studies but very durable and reliable in sports.

Once, during the summer heat, three 'cup' (trophy) championship matches were arranged. Ghonghardiha vs Mahath, Kharauna vs Mahath, and Raima vs Mahath. In the Raima team, 'Bodo' from Kathia-Patti was there, and from Mahath, Ramchandra Singh from Bharat (Centre Forward) was chosen as

'Bodo'. Kripanand ji had probably joined service (1964-65), so he could only play in two matches. Mahath won those two matches against Kharauna and Raima respectively, but he wasn't there for the third, and the Ghonghardiha team had 21 players instead of 20, and also for that reason, our village lost 3-1. All these matches and the championship were held at the Tibdebal School ground in Jhanjharpur. I have seen with my own eyes that breaching the defence of these two Thakurjis (K.N.T./S.N.T.) was almost impossible for any strong team. Anyway.

This exceptional team's football ground (on the bank of Balli-Pokhar – northern part) was suddenly usurped at gunpoint in Mahath. Hence, the village divided into two factions! Hence, the discrimination reached its peak. 99% of the

educated people of the village, including the Kolkata-goers, got organized under the capable leadership of Prof. Dhaneshwar Jha, Prof. Parshuram Jha, Prof. Rajendra Jha, Prof. Devnarayan Thakur, Lal Babu, Madhuban ji, Indrakant ji, etc., and this group, in retaliation for the insult to Dhaneshwar ji, eventually got the landlord's eldest son (who had reached the football ground brandishing a gun, following his father's arm) imprisoned in a lock-up for a week. This was the power of unity! But that came at a very heavy cost. Football was uprooted from the village! Similarly, the library also started declining!

****Guru-Shishya and the Vow of Service:****

Shriman Bhavanand Jha was an engineer of exceptional insight,

intelligence, and talent. Resident of Dhanga-Haripur, the aura of this B.N. Jha kept growing in the seventh, eighth, and ninth decades (1965-95). Starting as an Assistant Engineer, becoming Chief Engineer (including Engineer-in-Chief) of undivided Bihar, this great man, called 'Bihar's Visvesvaraya', seemed to attract every honour. Who would believe that 50 years later, we had such a sage-like figure who was directly or indirectly associated with projects like Son Command, Koyal-Karo, D.V.C., Tenughat Dam, Barakar Dam, several water supply schemes around Ranchi (dam construction), and was also the visionary behind the blueprint of the Gandhi Setu (Patna) on the Ganges? Who, despite being the initiator, director, and chief supervisor of thousands of such crore-worth schemes, spent his entire life in a modest tiled-roof house (I have seen his permanent

residence in Dhanga many times). Big-time crorepati and billionaire contractors would be left wondering that he wouldn't even offer them a cup of tea or a khilli of paan.

The younger brother of that great soul, Executive Engineer (Shree Suryanand Jha), was also in the same Public Works Department, but he was a completely different person.

..And the principal disciple (in the workplace) of that Guru was our guide, Kripa Babu. It so happened that when the Government of India's approval (1970-71: under the Fifth Five Year Plan) was received for the construction of the world's one of the longest river bridges (approx 5.750 km), the Gandhi Setu, simultaneously, the process of selecting a world-class construction

agency through global tender was underway, and after Gamon India was selected, on the other hand, a search was on not for just capable, but the most capable engineering team for inspecting and testing the work quality. This entire construction work continued from 1972 to 1982, and in May 1982, the then Prime Minister, Shrimati Indira Gandhi, inaugurated it.

So, when the responsibility for the complete supervision of that mega project was handed over to Bhavanand Babu, (I remember – I was also posted in Patna then) he told the then Chief Minister (Dr. Jagannath Mishra) in clear terms, as a condition, that he would form the engineering team for inspection and testing according to his own calculation, and no minister or anyone would interfere in their work

process. And that was accepted as is. This was considered a very big thing (perhaps surprising and strange) at that time, and was exceptionally discussed in the print media.

And we Maithilis are holders of a distinct sense of pride that in the operation, management, inspection, and periodic testing of this world-renowned project, along with the chief Bhavanand Babu, in the role of deputy chief or sarpanch, there was our very own Kripanand ji (although there were many other engineers in the team, but he was the embodiment of capability and honesty! One of a kind! Many people like me used to go to see the construction on holidays.

I want to conclude this essay by presenting the details of a true

incident of this honesty and dedication, which has been imprinted on my mind like a film reel for the past 40 years. Such things, truly, can sometimes be doubted!

(Approximately) one night in 1980-81. Place – The government inspection building complex on the Hajipur side of the (under-construction) Gandhi Setu. Temporary electricity poles with wires strung haphazardly, and small, dim yellow lights flickering in the quarters. The foggy darkness from the Ganges side trying to engulf it! In the silent camp, sitting worried and anxious was a descendant of a non-begging, boon-bearing hand, with papers and files spread all over the bed and table.

At the site, in the middle of the sand mass (on the northern floodplain of the Ganges), far and wide, lay iron and wood, small and big hammers and shovels, and the silhouettes of heavy machines like Tatas, Caterpillars, Hitachis, cranes, looking like the trunks of swaying elephants, and in between, large solidified chunks of cement, iron, and concrete, piled up in heaps.

An expert was hammering and chipping at those solidified chunks, checking the edges and testing the 'temper'. 'Break it from here' – 'Split it from here' – 'Show me by taking the rod out', 'Why is the rod thickness 16 mm?', 'Why isn't the rod Tata brand?', 'Why isn't the sand classic gold sand?', 'Why are the stone chips undersized?' These and fifty such questions were asked to the chief engineer of Gamon India,

and again today, and again tomorrow, and again the day after! Its project director would become more and more troubled. He would hold meetings with his subordinate junior engineers. From the top brass downwards, then further down, then further down... going down to the lowest level, but no correct answer was found. Ultimately, proving substandard or poor-quality construction, more than twenty segments [which are called 'segments' in English] were ordered to be rejected or declared scrap. Following all the procedures, it was to be reported to the state government and also the central government – the very next day.

There was panic in that company, and simultaneously, the (then newly established) Technical Secretariat also trembled, because the selection

of that company had been done through global tender with the participation of Delhi. The second important thing was that the concept of this 'segmentation' was completely novel, the practical knowledge of which most engineers did not have in those days. The third special thing was that the cost of each cast segment was in the lakhs of rupees, so the company stood to lose crores potentially.

Gurudev (B.N. Jha) Saheb was not only aware of the step-by-step process of that report but was also involved in it; having inspected the site himself, he was also convinced of the substandard decision. In those days, the Government of India had a monopoly on the phone, yet phones kept ringing incessantly like bees swarming from a hive for all three days. Hardly had one put the

receiver down when it would ring again... ring again...

In that godforsaken inspection building, there were only two nominal guards sitting outside, lost in their own world. Inside, an orderly was cooking roti, dal, and vegetables for the Saheb, and the Saheb was in his bedroom, sitting at a table and chair, working on reports and returns. A little away from this camp, there was a police post like a showpiece elephant tusk, where sometimes two constables with sticks would be present, and sometimes not even them!

Night had not progressed much by the clock, but in this area far from habitation on the Ganges bank, there was complete silence. Then, a guard near the window on the verandah,

tapping his stick, called out to the officer sitting inside, near that same window – Saheb-Saheb! A jeep has arrived at the gate. Two-three people have got down and are asking to open the gate. They say they want to meet the officer.

Still sitting in his place, the Saheb opened one shutter of the window slightly and told the guard – Who is this at this hour? Tell them to come tomorrow morning – whoever it is... come tomorrow at eight!

But by that time, two hefty, moustached individuals had already swished onto the verandah. And pushing aside the guard as if he were nothing, they pushed the slightly open door of the room and entered. He looked at their faces carefully – one of them looked vaguely familiar, probably a munshi or someone from

the site. The second one was completely unfamiliar... in appearance, a veritable brother of the dacoit Sultana. In his waistband was a 'Chamouti' and tucked in the Chamouti was a country-made pistol. Both had a briefcase each in their hands. They had a grim look on their faces.

- "You people...? What is the matter? Is there any work with me at this hour?"

- "Sir, sir! Don't be worried! The boss has also come, he is sitting in the vehicle. These (pointing to the briefcases in their hands), sir, we have brought something for you!"

- "Okay-okay! What is in these? I had not asked anyone to bring anything!"

- "Sirji! Sirji! In these (indicating with a clap of both hands, probably meaning notes of five hundred and a thousand), this much is here right

now. And whatever you order, will come again tomorrow or the day after – the boss has said..."

-"Hey. Take these and get out of here! Go on, get out!..."

Saying this much, the Saheb started walking towards the phone placed on the table in the other corner of the room, but just then, a third person also entered the room.

-"Sir, Sir! Please listen! Who are you going to call? The one who toils day and night like this, what does he get? Is this job enough to make a living nowadays?"

That third visitor said, as if trying to reason.

-"Listen, listen! I do this job, what I get, how much I get – what is that to you? Come on, take all this and leave from here! How I will manage my living, that is for me to think, don't

you poke your nose into it!"

- "Sir, sir! We have children, family! The family wants happiness and comfort, sir! So the Lakshmi that has come to the house should not be insulted, sir!"

- "Listen, listen Babu! How old are you? And what is your weight?"

- "Sir! I am 58 years old! And weight is... up to 80 kilos...!"

- "And how many children?"

- "Sir, five! Three daughters and two sons! Why, sir! Why are you asking all this?"

- "Look, you probably get a salary of five-ten thousand. And you have a family, parents too, so nine people, right or not?"

- "Yes sir! That is true!"

All three were staring at the Saheb's

face.

- "Yes, then you might have to resort to theft and dacoity. And when you do all this dishonesty and mischief, your children will become bigger scoundrels, goons, and ruffians than you. Understand? You want alcohol and chicken along with your basic necessities. Your weight has become 80 kilos by eating this very ill-gotten food! And your BP and sugar must also be high, have you got them checked?"

- "No, sir! Once I felt dizzy, the doctor told me to get both checked, couldn't get them done!"

- "Enough, enough! This is what you need to understand! I myself am healthy and I want to keep my children healthy in body and mind as well. Everyone is hardworking. They study with focus. There is no illegitimate income at home, no

unnecessary expenses! No fear of theft or dacoity! And this moustached one who roams around with a pistol tucked in, he must have retired as a sepoy or havildar somewhere and is the G.M.'s bodyguard! Isn't it? Your name is Rameshwar Singh and your home is in Bihta, right?"

Hearing his name and address, the one with the pistol immediately bowed his head and left the room. His stature didn't stoop as much as his long, curled, stiff moustache.

- "Yes, so now you people also take this stuff and go tell your boss that this Pandit is not for sale, not even for twenty briefcases. And also tell him that at least for the next decade and a half, death is not destined for me!"

Saying this firmly, he shoed them all out to the stairs on the verandah.

Those two, after stepping down from the verandah, turned back once, looked at him intently, folded their hands, and apologising, quickly got into the stationary car near the gate and vanished – whoosh!

This extraordinary officer was none other than Bhavanand ji and Kripanand Thakur ji, almost the last pillars of our village's or our people's glorious 'Ayachi (non-begging) tradition'. And the resonance of this incident was first heard (in brief) from the mouth of Maithil pride Bhavanand Babu himself at a meeting of the Chetna Samiti, and later from the mouth of Thakur ji himself during his visit to Darbhanga (my housewarming at Laxmisagar Colony in 1989-90).

Then, listening to those things that

came from Thakur ji's mouth (including that prediction about children), and observing today's 'Kurukshetra-victorious Gajendra' of the Maithili literary arena, or 'Panji-manager new administrator Gajendra', or 'e-magazine Videha's founder-editor Gajendra', or 'Gajendra who establishes the neglected and untouched litterateurs of Maithili', I am truly amazed! Along with that, the development and radiance of the daughter-in-law of the clan, Preeti, provides a different kind of happiness and satisfaction. This is indeed the son following the father's dharma! This is an extraordinary proof of the excellent qualities and good conduct inherited from the parents!

Yes, but it is also a point of regret to note that the social respect and honour that these discussed guru-

shishya duo deserved, which they were fully entitled to, they did not receive. We see that ordinary business people, or those who manipulate truth and falsehood, who swap khadi for handleloom and show it off, who become MLAs, MPs, or ministers once or twice, they also manage to get the badge of a Padma award through tricks and arrangements. Whereas, in Darbhanga and Madhubani, not even a road, park, bridge, or square has been named after a titan like Bhavanand Jha who brought a timeless creation like the Gandhi Setu to the ground, and also selflessly served, risking his life. This proves the inertia of the Maithils!

A hundred salutes to the virtuous memory of Kripanand ji, the man of glory who, turning the pages, equipped his village, his district-

surroundings, and the country with strong pillars and supports.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 386,
15 January 2024)

****The First Quarter,**

**Gauri is
Worshipped... ****

****Section-2: Preeti
Thakur****

****Preeti Thakur's Gonu Jha**

and Other Maithili Picture Stories**

****Dr. Shefalika Verma****

In every language, there are some creators, whether women or men, who, due to their extraordinary talent, stand out distinctly from the rest. It is a different matter that the critical class often relegates women's writing to a corner of history's pages. Some fortunate female writers do get some space, but not comprehensively. In writing, there is no man or woman; the subjects a male author writes about, a female author also writes about, sometimes even better. Now, only one expectation remains: to see a powerful female critic who remains just a critic, not defined by being a woman, devoid of prejudice, giving birth to good criticism. They will add

glory to the history of Maithili literature. I know there is no shortage of such scholarly female writers.

Seeing Preeti Thakur's Maithili picture story book on Gonu Jha, I was amazed. Initially, I thought of it as comics for Maithili children, but as I started reading, I became immersed in it. Much substance in a small vessel. It's wonderful how she has condensed the vast world of Maithili folk tales like Shiva's matted hair. Only after reading it does one understand. I had only heard the names of so many stories, and all of them were brought to life in this book. Just as today's society is forgetting Akbar-Birbal, similarly Gonu Jha. Through this book, readers can recognize the ideals of all sections of their society. Best wishes to Preeti ji for such a beautiful book.

I have one request to Preeti ji and Gajendra ji: the big legends about the Kosi river are prevalent in society, please encapsulate them in pictures as well. The mysterious character of the Kosi river, its marriage to Singheshwar Baba, etc., all sorts of tales... Just as women are continuously advancing in every field of society, today's women are contributing invaluable to the development of Maithili and Mithila from their own levels. Immense congratulations, Preeti ji. Countless good wishes.

(From Videha's archives, Videha Maithili Child Festival, Videha Sadeha-9)

*** * Gonu Jha and Other Maithili Picture Stories * ***

*** * Prof. Veena
Thakur * ***

I had the opportunity to read and see "Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha" (2008) composed by Preeti Thakur. 'See' because this book is a picture story, meaning the author has illustrated sixteen stories compiled through the medium of pictures. Among the sixteen stories, the hero of nine stories is Gonu Jha, and the remaining feature Reshma Chudharmal, Naika-Banijara, Bhagata Jyoti Panjiyar, Mahua Ghatwarin, Raja Salhes, Chhechhan Maharaj, and Kalidasa. All characters

represent the culture of Mithila.

Actually, the word 'culture' is extremely broad. In other words, behavior received through tradition can be called culture. It can also be called a synonym for social practice. Qualities like love, sacrifice, kindness, compassion, empathy, etc., are all encompassed within culture. At the same time, if the purpose of art is the exploration of beauty and the experience of aesthetic delight (rasa), then art's connection with folk culture becomes essential. The stories of Gonu Jha are prevalent in every household of Mithila, in people's voices; almost every resident of Mithila must have heard Gonu Jha stories from their elders and later narrated them to their children and friends. Similarly, Naika Banijara, Salhes, Chhechhan Maharaj, Bhagata Jyoti Panjiyar, due

to their valor, bravery, prowess, and noble personalities, were once folk heroes and later began to be worshipped as folk deities. Likewise, Kalidasa has established his important place in Indian culture through his scholarship and erudition. The ideal love story of Mahua Ghatwarin, depicted here as an ideal, has become immortal. Every character and story compiled in the book represents the culture of Mithila.

Culture remains connected to folk life. There is an integral relationship between society and culture because the creation of culture is time-relative, just as good deeds are imitated in society. After some time, they become the nature of society. Over time, this very nature takes the form of culture. Thus, the cycle of deed (kriti), nature (prakriti), and

culture continues. This is the reason why the creation and destruction of culture take time, whereas changes in civilization happen in a shorter period. Every character compiled in the book, representing their respective times, are symbols of Mithila's culture. The artist, author Preeti Thakur ji, has created these picture stories through the medium of lines and colors. Each picture reveals certain symbols. Nothing can be created without reason or spontaneously. Every picture is factual, every line constructs a story. The expression of Mithila's folk life has been achieved through these picture stories. Indeed, folk art portrays the contemporary folk life, just as folk songs, folk dances, folk language, etc., provide knowledge of the society's form at that time.

Culture, like the fragrance of a

flower, is imperceptible but continuously perfumes the atmosphere with its scent. It is an intrinsic quality that can only be experienced. Its place is in the heart; external conduct is merely its result. The medium of expression of this culture is art, such as dance art, music art, painting. Painting is mute, its language being colors and lines. The artist Preeti Thakur ji has not only depicted this culture of Mithila through colors and lines but has doubled the beauty of her artwork by also portraying it through words. Indeed, this effort of hers is entirely praiseworthy.

Art is a product of human culture; the relationship between art and humanity is indivisible. Art was established by humans, and through art, humans have attained self-esteem and self-awareness. Through

art, sweetness and aesthetic sensibility were born in human life, making actions sweet and beautiful. Indeed, the fundamental inspiration of beauty is the origin of art and proof of aesthetic taste. Humans have an imitative tendency. Since ancient times, natural scenes have delighted the human mind, and the desire to recreate these scenes awakened in the mind, and this desire became the motivator for the birth of art. Preeti Thakur ji's self-esteem and self-awareness motivated the creation of these picture stories: self-esteem towards Mithila's culture and self-awareness due to aesthetic sensibility, the result of which was the representation of Mithila's folk heroes from different times through the medium of picture stories.

Due to print media and electronic media, when the entire world has

globalized, Mithila painting, like other art forms, has also seen changes in its traditional form. Change is synonymous with development. The author has certainly brought changes to the traditional form of Mithila painting, but through the medium of folk picture stories, she has succeeded in their meaningfulness and relevance. Because Mithila painting is not just a hobby of value-seeking or soft-hearted artists but is an integral life-philosophy of a tradition-bound society, as well as an inseparable part of Maithil culture's life.

The impact of social change on art and literature is natural, and art and literature are also a reflection of society. Indeed, literature cannot ignore the tendencies and purposes of an era. Art cannot remain detached from life because its

foundation is human life. It is nourished by life, its impact falls on human life, so the artist cannot neglect their responsibility towards life. And this is the reason why the form of art keeps changing. In this age of global competition, Mithila painting is confined to the periphery of creating paintings for Kohbar, Dala, Ashtadal, Aripa, Mandap, Veda, etc. It is necessary to expand the subject matter of Mithila painting. The author's effort is entirely novel. Preeti Thakur ji, moving beyond traditional subject matter, has depicted Mithila's folk tales through the medium of picture stories, creating an entirely new style in Maithili literature. Certainly, the treasure of Maithili literature has been enriched, this new style, new subject matter – in a word, the new style – is entirely praiseworthy.

Time is changeable; one who does not adapt oneself with this changing time gets left out of the stream of development. Therefore, a realistic depiction of time through art is essential, only then can art prove its relevance. In accordance with the needs of the present changing modern society, the author has composed this book; it is not only relevant but also useful for the people.

At the same time, another fact is important. The preservers of Maithili folk literature are the women of Mithila, because folk songs and folk dances reside in their throats, and folk painting lives in their hands. Endowed with sacrifice and austerity, folk art lives through their cultural consciousness, and due to the blessing of their gentle brushes, Mithila painting remains alive,

preserved, and developed.

And the creator of this book, "Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha", is also a woman. This is entirely commendable.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 74, 15 January 2011)

*** * 'Gonu Jha Aan
Maithili
Chitrakatha' and
'Maithili
Chitrakatha' * ***

*** * Dr. Raman Jha * ***

I saw and read Mrs. Preeti Thakur's two illustrated story collections, 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha' and 'Maithili Chitrakatha'. Presenting stories through the medium of pictures is a novel experiment that attracts people, especially children, towards it.

The tradition of telling and listening to tales and fables has been going on

in Mithila since ancient times. Elderly women folk tell various kinds of stories to young children at bedtime, which are entertaining as well as instructive and educational. Among those stories, the famous ones are stories of demons, stories of princes, stories from the Ramayana and Mahabharata, stories of Gonu Jha, etc. After entering high school and college, students themselves read stories, understand them, appreciate their essence, and also narrate them to others at the right time.

The irony with Maithili is that although it is kept and taught as a subject at the college and university level, at the school level, despite government announcements, people neither keep Maithili as a subject nor teach any other subject through the Maithili medium. To such an extent

that even teachers in the schools of Mithilanchal feel inferior while teaching in Maithili. Young men, as soon as they get married, start speaking in Hindi with their wives. If you see some educated and degree-holding people talking among themselves in Maithili, they will definitely speak in Hindi with the children. They do not understand that Maithili language is not difficult. If the child does not acquire proper knowledge of it, it will be difficult to acquire it later. Poet Chand Jha has said that for non-Maithili speakers (people from other regions), Maithili language is as difficult as it is for a baby fish to drink all the water of the ocean:

If a non-native were to learn the
language of Mithila,

It would be like a young fish

drinking the entire ocean's water.

As far as Hindi is concerned, it is the national language. It is a compulsory subject. Its knowledge will naturally be acquired by every person and already is. In such a situation, seeing Mrs. Preeti Thakur's above-mentioned books, my heart was filled with joy. 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha' contains a total of 16 stories, including nine stories related to Gonu Jha, one related to the great poet Kalidasa, and in the remaining six, the prominent and well-known stories of Raja Salhes, Naika Banijara, etc., are depicted through imaginary pictures. In all these stories, some things are expressed through words, and some things the pictures themselves tell. The mental images people had regarding the contexts of these stories seem to have become

manifest here.

The erudite story writer's second collection is 'Maithili Chitrakatha', which describes a total of 10 prominent stories. The arrangement of imaginary pictures in between these stories proves the authenticity of the stories. The important stories collected in this collection are - Raja Salhes, Bodhi Kayastha, Dina Bhadri, Naika Banijara, Vidyapati's Age and Demise, etc.

I have full faith that the above-mentioned two story collections will not only attract children but people from all sections of society will also have the desire to browse through them once. In this direction, Mrs. Thakur's effort is praiseworthy, a courageous step, and a novel experiment. My best wishes are that

the story writer continues to perfume the treasure of Maithili literature with such graceful, simple, and fluent compositions.

(From Videha's archives, Videha Maithili Child Festival, Videha Sadeha-9)

****Editorial Note:**** After being published in Videha, this article was also compiled by Dr. Raman Jha in his book 'Parijat Manjari'.

****Gonu Jha and Other
Maithili Picture**

Stories**

****Shiv Kumar Jha**
'Tillu'**

In a sense, the years 2008-09 can be considered a revolutionary period for the development of Maithili literature. In 2008, a children's literature composition in Maithili was created by the proficient critic of Maithili, Mr. Taranand Viyogi ji; the book's name was 'E Bhetal Ta Ki Bhetal'. This book has been awarded the newly created Bal Sahitya Puraskar by the Sahitya Akademi. If the Akademi had established this award a few years earlier, it's possible that the Maithili position might have remained vacant because in some years, no children's literature was written in Maithili. In 2009, the first play in Maithili by a

female creator was written. The creator is the famous Maithili litterateur Mrs. Vibha Rani, and the play's name is 'Bhag Raau Aan Balchanda'. It's a matter of joy that this play reflects child and female psychology. Although Mrs. Ilarani Singh has also written plays, they are translated, not original. So, Mrs. Vibha Rani can be considered the first female playwright of Maithili literature. However, Mrs. Usha Kiran Khan's 'Bhuskaulwala' was published earlier. The lamp of revolution cannot be lit according to a plan. A direct proof of this is presented by the first picture story in Maithili - 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha' (2008). I had not seen any book on this subject in Maithili before this. This picture story was created by Mrs. Preeti Thakur. Before the writing of this picture story, Preeti ji's name was not prominent in any literature or

painting. Her first composition, and that too on an original subject for Maithili literature. Despite being in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution, we were lost somewhere. Some categories of composition were untouched in Maithili, a language of the premier language group. I was surprised and amazed: how did a woman from our society get focused on this new subject?

In this picture story, reflecting the culture of the entire Mithila, picture stories are presented in 16 segments of folk legends and historical tales. The first nine stories are based on the deeds of Gonu Jha. Gonu Jha is not an unknown name. The place that Birbal got in the Mughal court, in Mithila's wit and intelligence, that place was given to Gonu Jha. Gonu was a court jester, but not one who

only glorified others. He had no parallel in astonishing others with his intellect and cleverness. It is unfortunate that Gonu was Maithili; if he had been from England or any other Western country, he would not have been compared to Birbal, but Birbal would have been compared to him. This misfortune of his has become a fortune for all of us, that people from other regions know us because of great men like Mahakavi Vidyapati, Gonu, and Raja Salhes from this land of Mithila.

The first picture story compiled in this book discusses Gonu Jha's intellectual encounter with Mother Durga. This story cannot be given historical recognition because in history and science, God is only a natural force, not a legal entity. But if seen with the hundred petals of emotion, this story full of questions

will certainly arouse curiosity in children, which can ultimately be considered naturally beneficial for Maithili literature and language. The quality of the pictures is good, the colors are good, the presentation is good, but the picture of the lion looked like a cat. Whether in a royal court or a place of ancestral or religious rites, along with Brahmins, the role of the 'Thakur' (barber) is considered more important than others. In 'Gonu Jha Aan Swargkatha', a Thakur wants to defeat Gonu but fails himself. A nice, witty presentation in a short picture story. Seven other stories related to Gonu Jha are also included. The stories written based on folk legends present photos sympathetic to child psychology because they are written only for children.

The story of Reshma Chuhamal is a

historical story. It's possible that historians of Aryavarta may not acknowledge it, but it is famous in every village of Mithila. Dudhvanshi caste is identified with Yaduvansh, but in this literature, Chuharmal is a Dugdhvanshi Dusadh and the heroine Reshma is a Bhumihar Brahmin. It felt good that the daughter of Purnia and daughter-in-law of Madhubani felt no hesitation in creating the story of Mokamaghat. The viewpoint of trampling love under the caste system of society is broken in this picture story. Manipadma ji's writing on the Naika Banijara story flourished in Maithili in 1973, so people are certainly familiar with this story. At the entrance level, Manipadma ji's this story was given in Maithili. In this book, the simple language and child-friendly illustrations seem good. The illustration of Bhagata Jyoti Panjiyar is also well reflected. Reading the lost

ancient folk tales of Mahua Ghatwarin and Chhechhan Maharaj and seeing their illustrations, the children of the new generation will definitely try to enter the womb of Mithila's culture. The illustration of such a universally discussed subject as Raja Salhes and the depiction of Kalidasa's connection with the traditions of Mithila seemed desirable.

In conclusion: Preeti ji's new experiment, novel thinking, and presentation of multi-dimensional subject matter are commendable. In Maithili literature, 'Gonu Aan Chitrakatha' is a new type of composition, so I consider it appropriate to evaluate it properly.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 74, 15 January 2011)

**** A Look at Preeti Thakur's Both Picture Story Books ****

**** Dharendra
Kumar ****

The first picture story published in Maithili literature was encountered through Umesh ji. Literature becomes complete only when it is written in all genres and the compositions are mature. In my view, Preeti Thakur's compositions in the picture story genre, 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha' and 'Maithili Lokkatha', are successful compositions.

The author is worthy of thanks, for the reason that her attention turned towards Maithili. The second reason is that she has attempted to enrich the picture story genre of Maithili, which is negligible, by giving written form to the stories preserved in people's mouths in Maithili's heritage.

Published in 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha' are: Gonu Jha Aan Maa Durga, Gonu Aan Swarg, Gonu Aan Swarn Chor, Gonu Jha Aan Bilarri, Gonu Jha Ka Duta Barad, Gonu Jha Ka Mahis, Gonu Jha Ki Ashrafi, Gonu Jha Aan Kar Adhikari Ki Darhi, Gonu Jha Ki Maay, Reshma Chuharmal, Naika Banijara, Bhagata Jyoti Panjiyar, Mahua Ghatwarin, Raja Salhes, Chhechhan Maharaj, Raja Salhes Aan Kalidas. And in 'Maithili

Chitrakatha' are: Moti Dai, Raja Salhes, Bodhi-Kayastha, Bahura Godhin Natua Dayal, Amta Gharen, Dina Bhadri, Jhalim Singh, Naika Banijara, Raghuni Marrar, Vidyapati Ki Aayu Avasan.

All stories are associated with the land of Mithila and have been preserved in people's mouths till now. With the change of time, people's tastes and cultural practices also change. Take our country's example. Today, Ayurveda, Unani, Homeopathy, and many other knowledge systems dedicated to knowledge are preserved in books. If they were not preserved in books, the next generation would remain ignorant of these systems. Therefore, by giving book form to the stories prevalent in our Mithila, Preeti Thakur ji has done commendable work. Birbal's stories might have

been forgotten by people, but because they remained in book form, they have remained a means of entertainment for the public mind till today.

Picture stories have their own importance. The impact that remains deprived of external communication is communicated through pictures. In drama, what is not communicated through acting is communicated through color, sound, and light, similarly in picture stories as well. The pictures in the discussed book are cultured.

This work by Preeti ji is commendable for children's literature. A four-year-old child who does not even know letters can also understand the story through the medium of pictures. The lack of

children's literature in our Maithili had not been given any attention by big scholars, especially of this kind. The book is attractive, interesting, and impresses the child's mind. For this, I once again thank Mrs. Preeti Thakur. Along with this, I hope that she will continue to do this kind of work in the future as well.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 74, 15 January 2011)

****Beautiful Picture Stories for Children****

****Durganand Mandal****

Mrs. Preeti Thakur's two picture storybooks (first 'Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha', second 'Maithili Chitrakatha') were published for the first time in Maithili literature by Shruti Publication, New Delhi. It felt like now we Maithils, who were poor, are becoming enriched in every way. Literature has many genres, among which story is one, and within that, picture stories are prominent for children's literature. Through the medium of picture stories, a glimpse

of our forgotten culture is also obtained. Certainly, its lack was felt in Maithili literature for a long time. By placing her picture stories before the Maithil society, Mrs. Preeti Thakur has introduced her immense talent.

It seemed as if we had forgotten ourselves. We had forgotten that time when grandmothers, taking their grandchildren, would sit in the courtyard and narrate the stories of Gonu Jha, which were very entertaining and indicative of Gonu's sharp intellect. Similarly, other stories that Preeti ji has illustrated and placed before us. Among them are Reshma-Chuharmal, Naika Banijara, Jyoti Panjiyar, Mahua Ghatwarin, Raja Salhes, Chhechhan Maharaj, and Kalidasa. Which were once common, now were becoming almost extinct, she reintroduced

them. So people learned who Reshma and Chuharmal were.

Not only that, whereas Heer-Ranjha or Laila-Majnu were on people's lips as examples of the pinnacle of love, she made us see that wasn't the selfless love of Reshma and Chuharmal any less? Where Chuharmal was from the Dhudhvanshi Dusadh caste, on the other hand, Reshma was a daughter of the Bhumihar Brahmin caste. When she saw Chuharmal returning after winning the wrestling match, their meeting happened on the banks of the Ganges, and that's where the love story began. That is, in love, caste and creed have nothing to do with it; love is just love. Love is not done, it happens on its own. Similarly, Naika Banijara is also indicative of the pinnacle of love. Bhagata Jyoti Panjiyar became

worshipped due to his bravery and prowess. Today, along with Dharmaraj, Jyoti Panjiyar is also worshipped. Jyoti Panjiyar, a devotee of Dharmaraj, after twelve years of penance, returned home wandering with a golden body. The mother's womb became blessed. Such a great devotee was born from her womb.

Similarly, Mahua Ghatwarin, to protect her honor, sacrificed her life in the Kaushiki river, keeping her chastity intact. The story of Raja Salhes is famous even in the form of a folk dance. Preeti ji has immortalized it by illustrating it. She gave it the form of a heritage. Along with the story of the somewhat unknown Chhechhan Maharaj, the picture story of Kalidasa and his birth in the Yadava clan, his true identity was revealed. Many must have understood that Kalidasa was a

Karna-Kayastha. Thanks to Preeti ji for that as well.

In Preeti ji's second composition, 'Maithili Chitrakatha', a total of ten stories are described. Among them, Raja Salhes, Bodhi Kayastha, Dina-Bhadri, Naika-Banijara, Vidyapati's Age and Demise are prominent. In this way, after reading both picture storybooks, it felt that these stories gain historical importance. There was almost a complete absence of such compositions. By placing them before all of us, Preeti ji has given them importance as a heritage. These books can be called the first love of children. Especially, children who were accustomed to reading books like 'Nandan', 'Balhans', or others will now benefit from the compositions created by the author. Every picture in the books is factual and purposeful. Through the

medium of picture stories, Preeti ji has given story form to the almost extinct subjects of Mithila and brought them to life. Maithili lovers cannot ignore such compositions. For the coming generations, such compositions will prove not only entertaining but also inspiring. The biggest thing about the books is that each picture has succeeded in presenting a particular style and situation, clarifying the meaning of the written lines. People of almost all castes are depicted in these picture stories. This indicates Preeti ji's inclusive thinking. Progressive ideas are natural. Mithila has always been indicative of liberality, but some people have promoted and continue to promote commercial and casteist thinking in between. I am happy for the author of these picture stories that she has created a distinct place in the development of Maithili literature by taking such a beautiful,

easy, and progressive step.

My best wishes are continuously that if Preeti ji keeps creating such compositions, then certainly Mithila, Maithili, and the people living in Mithila will become completely enriched.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 116,
15 October 2012)

****Maithili Picture Story****

****Shiv Kumar Jha
'Tillu'****

Eight years ago, 'Maithili' was included in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution. Many of us were happy that our language was given legal existence. Silently, we were feeling grateful and sending good wishes to all those people whose efforts made this work

possible. But! There was a pang shaking the inner self: what next? We were not seeing a bright future for our language.

The biggest reason for this anguish was that no revolution seemed in sight in our language and literature. The present generation was moving away from the mother tongue. What to say of the next generation? How many children understand the meaning of words like *olti*, *chinuar*, *than*, *chhaan-pagaha*? If I ask any parent why they don't speak with their children in their own dialect, the answer is that when the child goes to school, they won't understand Hindi and English, so they are being taught from now. The child lacks awareness because children's literature hasn't been written in Maithili. Whatever little exists, how many children

understand its meaning? If I, an adult, don't understand the compositions written in the excellent language of great authors or poets, how will my sons and daughters understand them? In the midst of this, 'Videha-Sadeha' made its entrance in Maithili. With a new form, novel thinking, and a positive outlook. Compositions began to be created on original points. The neglected found new hope. I am discussing with the reader one result of this literary movement - 'Maithili Chitrakatha' - this book was published in 2009 by Shruti Publication, Delhi, courtesy of Videha. The author of this book is Mrs. Preeti Thakur. This is her second composition. The subject is completely new: a children's literature picture story. It cannot be called a 'composition' in the strict sense, because there is no literary creation in it; it discusses folk tales

and legends that have been heard in Mithila for a long time, accompanied by pictures. This kind of folk legend used to be spoken by the mouths of elders in every village, but is now fading away. By writing picture stories on these fading subjects, Preeti ji has done a very good deed. The special and new positive aspect I saw in this book is the selection of subjects and stories. The entire Mithila is encompassed in it. Folk tales from all castes and communities are depicted. The depiction of the washerman community's devotion in the Moti Dai story, and the explanation of the Dhudhvanshi community's feelings in Raja Salhes. Ganga's blessing to Bodhi-Kayastha of the Mithila court seemed delightful. Bahura Godhin and Natua Dalal are folk tales from Begusarai. Earlier, people had the mentality that people of Begusarai are not Maithili speakers. It used to

pain me too because my maternal home is in Begusarai district. After reading this story, the distinction between Tirhutia and Dakhnaha was erased from the heart. There is a neglected caste in our society, the Musahar. Among Musahars, there were two ideal men, Deena and Bhadri. The story of those Deena-Bhadri felt very good. Earlier, I used to think that intellect and material wealth were the big criteria for becoming an ascetic, but now this illusion is gone. In this way, many stories are depicted.

Once, after reading the compositions of respected Jagdish Prasad Mandal and Bechan Thakur ji, I had written that the 'Videha Maithili Sahitya Andolan' washed away the casteist stigma attached to Maithili. If this statement is true, then the role of this book cannot be ignored. This

book is relevant for inspiring the present generation and for awakening affection for Maithili in the next generation. The language editing seemed good. The quality of the pictures is very beautiful and extensive. The use of good paper and the color combination of the pictures also seemed appropriate.

Finally, I thank Preeti ji for using her pen on a subject that was overlooked among us. I express my thanks, hoping that she will continue to do so in the future.

(From Videha's archives, published on Videha's blog 'Maithili Samalochana' on 7 April 2012)

****Folk Deities of Mithila****

****Shiv Kumar Jha
'Tillu'****

The basis for the richness of any literature is considered to be epics, long narrative poems, novels, or post-modern discussions of stories. In this direction, Maithili is still far behind because, in the traditional sense of the complete literary spectrum, this language can be considered lacking. Literary development is possible only when the long-term potential of the language is reflected. The older generation is struggling, and with English being the medium of education for the new generation, a

question mark on Maithili's existence is visibly evident. If we leave aside the village children, the mother tongue of childhood in Maithili families is definitely changing.

The medium of primary education is English and Hindi. In this situation, more than literature, it is necessary to save the language. Maithili can firmly maintain its existence only when the new generation has the pain of maternal and affectionate love. For this, it is necessary to encourage children's literature that touches child psychology. In this direction, though much work has supposedly been done, in the group of modern-generation creators of actual children's literature, a pioneer is Mrs. Preeti Thakur. Her third book, 'Folk Deities of Mithila', was published in 2010 courtesy of Shruti

Publication.

According to T.S. Eliot's 'Tradition and the Individual Talent' (1917), no poet, storyteller, or artist clarifies their full meaning by themselves. Their art can be evaluated only after comparing it with the works of dead poets or artists. Even if this view is considered relevant, Preeti ji is incomparable because before her, this kind of children's prose in a pictorial and rhythmic style had not been written in Maithili. This is literally true because no one had the courage to place a turban on the head of the original pioneer. Along with this, it is also necessary to know where Preeti ji stands after comparison with other language groups.

'Sama-Chakeba' is a festival of Kartik

Purnima prevalent in every village of Mithila, based on traditional legend and mythological stories. By including this story in this book, Preeti ji did not do any new creative work, but inadvertently, she definitely acquainted the new generation with their culture. I used the word 'inadvertently' because this festival is disappearing from many villages; imagining its existence in cities is also impossible. Like elsewhere, migration has also dominated Mithila. It is not necessary that after migration, people can preserve their culture under the influence of Darbhanga. Therefore, discussion of such festivals is necessary for the modern generation. When there is discussion, it is possible that the inspiration to stay connected with this kind of culture may awaken in migrant children. Like Madhushravani or Kojagara, Sama-Chakeba is not a

festival of any particular caste; rather, it represents the entire Mithila.

It is a proven truth that literature enthusiasts may not consider this book a creative story because its stories are not based on new imagination but are replicas of traditional style and narrative. Through this, criticism of the creator is also possible. But it is also necessary to keep in mind that an innocent child does not have any affection for complex literature. A child has more affection for seemingly meaningless lines like 'Aani-Mooni Ham Nai Jaani' than for epic verses. So, it would be appropriate to consider storylines related to folk legends like Chalan Bhadhani Dedh Bitna, Jehan Karni, Chari Batauhi, Bagiya Ka Gaachh, etc., as relevant to child psychology.

The author has already honestly admitted that she gave story form in her own words to what she heard from the mouths of elders in her childhood.

The strong point of this book is the pictorial discussion of the stories. How much effort and time must have gone into preparing pictures for stories like Moti Sayar, Lalbaba Baba, Gareeban Baba, Bihula, Sita and the Parrot, Ayachi Mishra, Pakshadhar Mishra, and Ugna, only the author can tell. But these pictures, in their various silent styles, will definitely converse with the children. From a critical perspective, if seen, this might not be considered much more than comics in other languages and literature. But such a long-sighted critic can do that. Because this is not a computer game, but a pictorial style of child

awakening born from the mind,
created by the author free from the
fear of criticism, only for children.

The color coordination also seemed good. Some pictures at the end are given in black and white, in which children can color themselves. The storylines of this book are traditional, but the style and illustrations are new, so the creator is successful in her objective. A weak point is that whatever story is given with the pictures could have been more detailed. For example, in the picture story from Moti Sayar to Mira Saheb, the storyline changes abruptly, which seemed like a summary. But I hope that children must have liked it.

(From Videha's archives, Issue 102,
15 March 2012)

****The Early
History of Maithili
Picture Story (2002
to 2016)****

****Ashish
Anchinhaar****

Drawing (making pictures) is one of

the oldest arts. Script is also a type of picture, so in Indian tradition, writing is found as an extension of words in every language. Even today, China and Japan have pictographic scripts. Earlier, pictures of various moods were made, and people, seeing that situation, would make their own interpretations. Then, during British rule, when newspapers became prevalent, political-social cartoons began. The Delhi Sketch Book (1850-57) and the Amrita Bazaar Patrika (Bengali language, 1872) are among the early cartoons of India. Newspaper cartoons usually consisted of one or two pictures, depicting the contemporary situation with a few sentences. Later, these cartoons also came to magazines and continued to expand. Later, a story and pictures were combined, and it was named 'Chitrakatha' (Comics).

The early picture stories were translations, which started in the 1950s. Among these were translations of picture stories like The Phantom, Mandrake, Flash Gordon, Rip Kirby. Once again, the Bengali language led in this genre, and picture stories were written by Narayan Debnath in 1960. India's first superhero picture story, 'Bāṭul di Greṭ' by Debnath ji, came in 1965. Around this time, picture stories in other languages also strengthened their roots. 'Amar Chitra Katha' provided strength to this genre in Hindi as well as other languages. The picture stories that the Maithil people know are those in the Hindi language, including ones like 'Hum Bhi Hain'. Picture stories of the Nagraj, Super Commando Dhruv, Doda series, as well as Motu-Patlu, Chacha-Bhatija series, were legends of their time, but in the midst of all this, there were no Maithili picture

stories anywhere.

'Not there' meaning that to my knowledge, no picture stories were published in old magazines, I understood after reading Devashankar Naveen ji's article "A Panoramic View of Maithili Children's Literature". Anyway, if picture stories had been published anywhere in old magazines, there would have been a lot of fuss about being the 'first, first', because Maithils have the greed to be first in tasks, even in those tasks that might have been done long before them. In his article, Devashankar Naveen ji has extensively referenced Daman Kumar Jha's book "Maithili Bal Sahitya", the first researcher of Maithili children's literature, but even in those references, there is no fact about picture stories. This means that even Daman ji did not find

picture stories in old magazines for his research. Well, this information is not final from my side; if anyone has an example of a picture story in an old Maithili magazine, please provide the information with logic. This would be necessary for the accuracy of the history of Maithili picture stories. Devashankar Naveen ji's article is on the literary website named 'Gadyakosh', the link is:

<http://gadyakosh.org/gk/...>

The Millennium Year (2000 AD) was the time when webcomics gained a foothold. Webcomic means picture stories published on the internet (not in print), and this is the time of the "dawn of Maithili picture stories". More intensity came to this dawn with the prevalence of the Creative Commons License. Before knowing about the Creative Commons

License, one should know about Copyright. When any author writes their book or composition, they automatically get its Copyright. With the publication of the book, this Copyright becomes even more effective. Under this Copyright, no part of this composition or book can be given in any other book without the permission of the author or publisher. This Copyright law also punishes those people who steal material from others' books and write it in their own name. Under the current Indian Copyright Act, the rights to publication and royalties remain with the author's successor for 60 years after the author's death, and after 60 years, anyone can reprint it, but the author's name remains the same. For example, now any publisher can reprint Chanda Jha's 'Mithila Bhasha Ramayan', but the author's name on the book will remain Chanda Jha, the editor's

name could be someone else. The Creative Commons License was born in the year 2001, whose main proponents are Lawrence Lessig and Eric Eldred, and its technical advisor is Aaron Swartz. Its first version came on 16 December 2002. The meaning of the Creative Commons License is that if an author has published their composition or book under the Creative Commons License, then their name remains on that composition or book, no tampering is allowed with their creation, but they have no rights over its publication, distribution, and translation. This meant that for the Maithili translation of a book published under the Creative Commons License, and its publication and distribution, the original author's permission is not needed. In some cases, permission for everything is allowed, but commercial permission is not

allowed, and that is written on the book published under this License. Understand similarly for other languages.

In Maithili, picture stories arrived through translation, and after that, original Maithili picture stories were also printed. The first Maithili picture story, which was a translation and was translated by Preeti Thakur, was a product of this Webcomic and Creative Commons License. The book 'Little and big' written by Carole Bloch in 2002, illustrated by Vian Oelofsen, and narrated by Petra Totome, was translated into Maithili by Preeti Thakur in the same year (2002) under the name "Chhot A Baigh" and was posted on the blog named 'Bhalsarik Gaachh'. Later, a second edition of this book was made on Bloom Library in 2022, which can be

seen by visiting bloomlibrary.org.

Similarly, the book 'Look at the animals' written by Jenny Katz in 2003, illustrated by Sandy Campbell, and narrated by Petra Totome, was translated into Maithili by Preeti Thakur in the same year (2003) under the name "Maal-Jaal Aan Janwar Dis Dekhoo" and was also posted on the blog 'Bhalsarik Gaachh'. It is also appropriate to inform the reader that there is another book by another author named 'Look at the animals'. So that the reader does not get confused, I mentioned this. Later, a second edition of this book was made on Bloom Library in 2022, which can be seen by visiting bloomlibrary.org.

Similarly, the book 'My Family' written by Clare Verbeek, Thembani

Dladla, and Zanele Buthelezi in 2007, illustrated by Kathy Arbuckle, colored by Terry Lofgren, and narrated by Helen Sahl, was translated into Maithili by Preeti Thakur in the same year (2007) under the name "Ham Parivaar" and was also posted on the blog 'Bhalsarik Gaachh'. Later, a second edition of this book was made on Bloom Library in 2022, which can be seen by visiting bloomlibrary.org.

And in the year 2008, the first original Maithili picture story "Gonu Jha Aan Maithili Chitrakatha" was published by Shruti Publication, Delhi, whose author is Preeti Thakur. In 2008, the Reserve Bank of India, under its financial education series, had original Hindi picture stories translated into Maithili, the translator being Dr. Ramanand Jha 'Raman'. In Videha's 32nd issue, 15

April 2009, Devanshu Vats's Maithili picture story series began, which later also came in the form of an independent book. In 2009, a total of three Maithili picture stories were published by Shruti Publication:

- 1) Neetu Kumari's "Maithili Chitrakatha"
- 2) Devanshu Vats's "Natasha"
- 3) Preeti Thakur's "Maithili Chitrakatha"

After this, Preeti Thakur's other two picture stories were published:

- 1) Mithila Ke Lokdevta (Children's Literature), (2010)
- 2) Vidyapati Ki Purush Pareeksha

(Children's Literature), (2012)

As far as the publication of picture stories in magazines other than Videha after 2009 is concerned, it comes after 2009, in 2016. In February 2016, a children's magazine named 'Nena Bhutka' started under the editorship of Devanshu Vats, and picture stories were also published in it. It is also appropriate for the reader to know that in the past too, a Maithili magazine named 'Nena Bhutka' has been published, but the 'Nena Bhutka' I am discussing in the context of picture stories, its first issue came in February 2016, whose editor was Devanshu Vats. After 2016, many translations by Preeti Thakur have come, and along with that, many women have become involved in translating picture stories. But I have kept my subject

only up to 2016. The progress made in Maithili picture stories after that, I will present in another article.

Incidentally, in one of his articles, Daman Kumar Jha considered Devanshu Vats's 'Natasha' as the first picture story of Maithili (Maithili Children's Literature in the First Decade of the Century, see Videha Sadeha-11). It is very possible that all these books were published in the same time period, hence Daman ji might have had such a misunderstanding. But from the list provided by me, it is absolutely clear that picture stories existed in Maithili before Devanshu Vats.

****INTERVIEW WITH PREETI
THAKUR, THE FIRST COMIC
BOOK AUTHOR OF
MAITHILI****

**** (By Ashish Anchinhaar via
email)****

****1)** You came to children's literature, specifically the comics genre. Did you read comics in your childhood? If yes, share any memories related to that.**

Answer - Yes, I used to read Nandan, the picture series in Parag, as well as Amar Chitra Katha, etc. They were also available on rent.

****2)** How did you think that there should be comics in Maithili, and what difficulties did you face in the beginning?******

Answer - I used to make drawings since childhood. After the birth of my son in 2000, when he started talking, the thought came to my mind.

****3)** Comics are meant for children, but children are often stopped from reading comics. Why is that? And how does this affect the comics genre?******

Answer - Earlier they used to be stopped, but now children have started playing video games. If a child reads a book, whether it is a print book or on a computer/Kindle, people are happy about it.

****4)** How connected are the children in your family to your comics, or rather, how connected are they to Maithili comics?******

Answer - They definitely read my books. Both my son (Om) and daughter (Aastha) used to read Twinkle as well. Now they have grown up.

****5)** What precautions should a writer, especially a children's literature writer, take when entering

the comics genre? What should their preparation be like? **

Answer - It should be something children like, the pictures, and also the language.

**6) About twenty years ago, there were comics, and today there are 3D cartoons on TV and on YouTube. In such a situation, what is the market and significance of the comics genre? **

Answer - Nowadays, reading itself is considered good, both print and e-books. So the situation is good.

**7) Often, after becoming proficient in some genre, writers go to public

platforms, but you remain absent from platforms. What is the reason for this?*

Answer - It's just a matter of individual nature.

) What is the difference between graphic books (like graphic novels, graphic history, etc.) and comics currently?

Answer - Comics are for children. Graphic novels are read by both children and adults. Comics are like short stories, and graphic novels are like novels.

*) Your husband is also a writer. What are the advantages and

disadvantages of being a couple who are both creators? **

Answer - There are no advantages or disadvantages. We all remain busy in our own work, both of us, son, daughter.

**10) Has it ever happened that you got stuck somewhere in a comic and received help from your husband? If yes, please share it publicly. **

Answer - My husband is useless at making pictures, but he sometimes gives ideas. He helps with lettering/composition.

****She Broke the
Stubborn Bow, Let's
Go, Friends...****

****Section-3****

****Videha Digital
Library: A Boon for
People Fond of
Reading and
Studying****

****Kalpana Jha****

"After me, who will care for these Maithili books? Investing money in Maithili books now seems pointless. Whatever collection I have is enough for my own reading." In the course of conversation, this statement was heard from several people, which was also my own thought, one that I hesitated to express anywhere. People might think I'm very miserly. But the issue is neither about miserliness nor financial hardship.

Yes, miserliness could be one reason, no doubt about that.

Incidentally, among those who make such statements are also some of the wealthiest, most generous people, possessing abundant movable and immovable property. What I mean is that high-profile people, middle-class people, and also those known in society for their generosity, such thoughts cross their minds too. Whether they are ordinary readers, litterateurs, researchers, or people involved in socio-political activities, all kinds of people face this problem. The hobby of building a book collection is a troublesome one. Let's look at the various types of troubles:

1. The first problem is the lack of space to keep books. Most people now live in flats. In such a situation,

how many bookshelves can one keep at home? It's not possible for everyone to have a library-like collection in their home.

2. Whether it's a lack of time or a lack of people. There's a lack of time to take care of the books, to dust and clean them, and also the question, 'who will do it?' This problem is especially more complex in households where the interests of all family members are completely different. Apart from a few exceptions, one rarely finds a family where the husband, wife, sons, and daughters are all equally fond of books. More often than not, the hobbies of the husband and wife are mismatched. Then the book collection can also become a cause of discord.

For example, if the patriarch of a family was fond of collecting books, it becomes a problem for his wife. She doesn't hesitate to complain now and then, "You keep bringing books and piling them up, and I keep dusting them all day, don't I...? Don't I have any other work? No matter how much I polish and dust, the books get covered in dust again in a few days. Books everywhere you look. Books on all the racks, books on the headboard, cartoon-filled books tiredly piled under the bed, heaps of books on top of the almirah. I'm fed up with your love for books. If you have such a passion for accumulating so many books, then hire a servant who can dust the books every ten days. I can't handle this thankless task." Many people are troubled by termites. Meaning, the maintenance of books is not easy.

3. After the above two reasons, comes the matter of choice. Not everyone likes all kinds of books. Many times it happens that people buy a book based on its genre, title, or the author's name, but while reading it halfway, they realize that there's nothing particularly special inside the book. In other words, they understand that it's not "worth it". Then the bought book cannot be exchanged. At such times, it feels like money was wasted. Then it's natural to think, "I'll buy fewer books now, I won't buy any book haphazardly."

4. After all these reasons, comes the matter of price. I see that Maithili books with less than a hundred pages, or just a little over a hundred pages, cost no less than two hundred rupees. Some books are available as exceptions, that's a different matter. In such a situation, Maithil people

definitely get thoughtful. Buying two books for five hundred rupees, or instead, isn't it better to buy two kilos of fish or fifty rasgullas and satisfy the soul? The tongue gets taste and it's also beneficial for the body. Now whether this is called miserliness or the victory of the inner mind over the intellect and the sensory tongue over the gustatory sense depends on interpretation. People will interpret it according to their own thinking.

5. Another major reason is the rapid increase in the number of authors now. Due to this, people get confused. There are more authors and fewer readers in Maithil society. It seems the hobby of writing is outweighing the hobby of reading. In such a situation, it's difficult to decide which book to buy and which not to. However, the arrival of new

authors in the literary world is a matter of happiness. But how much money people should spend on books is also a matter of consideration. Especially people nearing their fifties or sixties, who feel they are moving towards the final stage of life, hesitate to accumulate many books. The reason is that by the time one reaches this age, one's thinking tends to become: the time to pack up is near, so reduce your clutter. Leave behind some useful items for your children after you, that can provide them financial support. Leave behind something valuable for the next generation, something that has meaning and utility for everyone. Nowadays, even if children read, it's English literature; in such a situation, the utility of Maithili books for children seems almost nil (this is bitter, but it's the truth). In such circumstances, if a treasure trove of books becomes

available without spending a single penny, doesn't it seem like a blessing? For me, the Videha site is truly like a blessing. No need to spend money, and just browse for books on your preferred subject or genre on the Videha site. There's no need to even bother filling your mobile storage by downloading them. If you wish, you can store them too. Keep increasing your digital book collection, without any cost. Opening the Videha site and browsing for books does take some time, certainly. If it's stored in your file, you can take out a book and start reading whenever you feel like it, anywhere, anytime. Meaning, whether traveling or at bedtime when you feel sleep is teasing you too much, just visit the Videha library, always available on your mobile or laptop, pick a book, and start reading. What convenience, isn't it! As far as I know, over 1500

books and magazines have been made available on the Videha site so far.

From poetry collections, story collections, novels, criticism, reviews, humor, satire, drama to infant, child, and adolescent literature – what isn't there on the Videha site? Along with literature, PDF files and photos of Mithila painting/modern painting, flora and fauna of Mithila, life in Mithila, etc., are also available. "Videha Archive" is such a unique library where both entertaining and informative material is found. A special attraction of this library is also the clear photos of the original pages of the Panji.

If you need material for research in this library, that's also available,

whether for UPSC preparation or any other kind of competitive exam preparation, there's a plethora of colorful books available for academic material. In addition to books, there are also 377 issues of Videha e-magazine (published so far), which is published in six scripts including Devanagari, Tirhuta, Kaithi, Newari, Braille, and IPA. The Videha magazine, available on the Videha site in both digital and print forms, has carved a niche for itself as a special magazine. Where other magazines publish special issues focused on a creator after their death, the Videha magazine breaks this tradition by publishing special issues on living creators, making this magazine special. Not only this, apart from creators, Videha has also published special issues on institutions. In addition, important issues like the Ghazal Special Issue, Haiku Special Issue, Bihani-Katha

Special Issue, Children's Literature Special Issue, Drama Special Issue, Review Special Issue, Women's Special Issue, Translation Special Issue, Children's Ghazal Special Issue, Bhakti Ghazal Special Issue, Ghazal Criticism-Review Special Issue, Maithili Web Journalism Special Issue, Art Discussion Special Issue, Videha Samman Special Issue have been published, which are always available for readers on the Videha site. The speciality of the special issues focused on creators is that all those on whom special issues have been published so far deserved them. It was a very good decision by the Videha team. Almost all the special issues focused on creators have now come out as print-on-demand books. Readers can buy and preserve them.

On the Videha site, besides Videha,

some issues of other magazines are also available. For example, numerous magazines like Purvottar Maithili, Maithili Kavita Quarterly, Kaushiki, Desil Bayana, Mithila Darshan, Sankalp, Antika, Bharati Mandan, Sandhan, Dhuwa-Dhaja, Aangan, Gamghar, Aanjal, Ghar-Bahar, Society Today are found on the Videha site. On the Videha site, along with Maithili, a collection of English books is also available. For example, three books by Radhakrishna Chaudhary ji:

1. MITHILA IN THE AGE OF VIDYAPATI
2. A SURVEY OF MAITHILI LITERATURE
3. THE POLITICAL AND CULTURAL HERITAGE OF MITHILA

The above books would be useful for the present young generation and also for the generations to come. Isn't it necessary for the present youth and future generations to understand and comprehend the age-old traditional, cultural characteristics, and historical heritage of our Mithila? If reading Maithili seems difficult, then such English books will help those children understand the history of Mithila.

Jayakant Mishra ji's 'A History of Maithili Literature' and 'Introduction to the Folk Literature of Mithila', Upendra Thakur ji's 'HISTORY OF MITHILA' and 'STUDIES IN JAINISM AND BUDDHISM IN MITHILA' are among such important books. Another very important book is 'AN INTRODUCTION TO THE MAITHILI

LANGUAGE OF NORTH BIHAR' by linguist George Grierson. It is in two parts, the first - Grammar, the second - Chrestomathy & Vocabulary. Both books are obviously useful for researchers, and also prove extremely useful for curious readers. In addition, some other important books written in English are available. On www.videha.co.in, not only books but also Tirhuta, Newari, and Kaithi fonts are available for download.

Not only that, through audio-video media, an ocean of informative as well as entertaining material is also found on the Videha site. Along with storytelling, songs-music, and cinema, under Videha e-Learning, 23 very good lectures by Shri Gajendra Thakur ji for UPSC preparation are available. From which the youth can benefit. Even those who are not

preparing can listen; in my opinion, it's beneficial for everyone's knowledge enrichment. Videos in Maithili Sign Language are also available on the Videha site. That all this kind of work has been done under the Maithili language, many people probably don't even know. I myself was amazed to see such diverse material on the Videha site.

As soon as news of a book fair in one's city is received, book lovers get excited, as it is organized for a limited time. Sometimes due to lack of time or circumstances not favoring within that limited period, people cannot go to the book fair, and then they feel very sorry. But the Videha book fair is organized in every corner of the world 24x7x365 days, where the option to select books without any cost is always in front of the reader.

If there is any kind of curiosity related to Maithili language and literature, related to the history of Mithila, related to Maithili grammar, script, dictionary, then undoubtedly the books available in the "Videha Archive" will be helpful. Books like Charyapada, Dak Vachan, Vidyapati Padavali, Varna Ratnakar, Maithili Dhurt Samagam, Vyadi Bhakti Tarangini, which are like old heritage, are also available.

Finding a useful book like 'Dak Vachan' on the Videha site delighted me, in which couplets giving instructions for daily activities are written in a very simple, easy language. It contains sections on household duties, farming, travel, vegetation, various topics, and yearly predictions. Many couplets from

'Dak Vachan' must have been heard by everyone from the mouths of elders. For example – "Wear clothes for three days on Budh, Brihaspati, Shukra days." Books that are no longer available in print anywhere, such old books are preserved like a heritage on the Videha site. That is a big thing.

Similarly, on the Videha site, as an important heritage, pictures of great men and modern historical figures related to Mithila-Maithili have been compiled and preserved. At the same time, under 'Mithila Painting - Modern Art-Photos', pictures of extinct objects, from animals, trees associated with Maithil society to wooden carts, bamboo ladders, bridges made of wooden planks, have also been compiled. Children born, brought up, and raised in cities can at least see pictures of the above-

mentioned objects. So this kind of picture compilation is an important task.

The Videha team is undoubtedly worthy of praise for making such good use of the internet. The proper use of the internet, or 'Antarjal'. One must understand that this word 'Antarjal' is also an invention of the Videha team. Similarly, using the word 'Videha' for the digital form of a book or magazine seems to be the Videha team's idea. And calling its print version 'Sadeha'. The digital magazine is "Videha" and its print is "Sadeha-Videha"; in this way, presenting an old word in a new form makes the "Videha" team very special. The editor of Videha, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji, is not only the creator of the Maithili dictionary but also a creator of words. The way the 'Videha' team is dedicated with

heart, mind, and wealth to the Maithili language, however much praise is heaped on them, it would be less.

One flaw that I noticed on the Videha site needs correction. If some books are not opening while downloading (if they are unavailable), then their names should be removed from the list. So that many readers' time isn't wasted. For example – Dr. Govind Jha's 'Kalyanee Kosh'.

The second problem is that in the PDF of some books, the page numbering is very haphazard. Not being in order causes inconvenience to the reader. For example, one I remember now is the PDF of 'Society Today'. Such a good magazine, full of quality articles, with topics that compel you to read. Articles in all

three languages – Hindi, English, and Maithili – one after the other. But when I started reading, the pages were not in order. Certainly, whatever facilities have been made available for the reader are commendable, but paying attention to errors is also necessary, isn't it?

The third thing, not exactly a problem, but a suggestion from me to the Videha team: if the books could be listed in alphabetical order by book name or author's name, it would be more convenient for the reader to select books.

May the Videha site keep blossoming and flourishing with time. May readers and writers continue to benefit from it for a long time to come.

****The Founder of
Maithili Digital
Journalism: Gajendra
Thakur****

****Kirtinath Jha****

Creative writers or researchers in the scientific and artistic fields face two types of obstacles in publishing their works: money and acceptance. Due to financial constraints, many creative works could not be published before independence. The creators themselves could not arrange the funds. As a result, the work was either lost or decayed. The second problem was and is of

acceptance: many have had to hear, 'What nonsense are you writing!' Even if it was due to quality, it was rejected because of predetermined standards.

Digital publication, in various ways, came as a solution to both these problems. The facility to write and publish on digital media proved to be an unprecedented boon for creators in terms of 'freedom of expression'. However, the satisfaction of seeing and reading a printed book or magazine in one's own hands did not make digital publishing popular in the field of regional languages and literature. Nevertheless, even before the unprecedented revolution of Android mobile phones and social media began, Gajendra Thakur appeared in Maithili with the fortnightly e-magazine 'Videha'. This was entirely new and the first in

Maithili. Even today, apart from 'Videha', I am not aware of any other e-magazine in Maithili.

According to the information available on the website of the fortnightly e-magazine 'Videha' (<http://videha.co.in/>), 'Videha' has completed sixteen years. But even more important than that is that throughout its entire publication period, 'Videha' has been published uninterrupted; for more than ten years, 'Videha' has been continuously arriving in my mailbox as well. Thus, apart from the glory of being the first digital fortnightly in Maithili, 'Videha' is unique in the history of Maithili journalism in many senses.

In my opinion, 'Videha' started like a magazine for proletariat writers.

From the beginning, 'Videha' was a platform for the works of those writers who felt themselves marginalized somewhere, who could not get their writings published in mainstream newspapers and magazines, or whose works were not published in mainstream magazines. As far as I know, this was the core identity of 'Videha'. Initially, in terms of quality and diversity of articles, 'Videha' certainly had its shortcomings, but expecting a newly born magazine to be perfect in every way is inconsistent. Moreover, this endeavour was a new experiment in Maithili journalism. Therefore, I consider Gajendra Thakur ji, the editor of the fortnightly 'Videha', to be the founder of Maithili digital journalism. Over time, the situation changed. Gradually, mainstream writers also started contributing to 'Videha'. Nevertheless, even now there is a lack of diversity in the

writings. Whether this is due to editorial policy or lack of cooperation from writers is difficult to say. But this point is not worth considering here.

Videha is free. This is the third characteristic of this magazine. The way the operator and editorial board have kept this endeavour running continuously for so many days is not only commendable but also astonishing. This is the biggest achievement of its editor, Gajendra Thakur, and his team.

But the list of achievements of the 'Videha' digital platform does not end here. Over time, 'Videha' has progressed in various directions. All these progresses of 'Videha' are known to those who occasionally visit the <http://videha.co.in/>

webpage to explore the diverse content. The details of the main literary material available on this website are as follows:

- 1) All old issues of Videha e-magazine
- 2) Maithili audio-video collection
- 3) Maithili infant, child, and adolescent literature
- 4) Student-useful material for those taking Maithili as an optional subject in the Union Public Service Commission examination

The material compiled on the 'Videha' digital platform for candidates opting for Maithili as an optional subject in the UPSC exam is a great help for the competitors. This is also an achievement of this

platform. Because the availability of books in Maithili is a major problem; even if one wishes to buy, books are not available. In such a situation, the facility to download free material is a boon. I myself have downloaded many books from the 'Videha' webpage. The editorial board of 'Videha' is worthy of congratulations for this.

One more thing: from 2015 till now, special issues focused on many Maithili scholars – Arvind Thakur, Jagdish Chandra Thakur 'Anil', Ramlochan Thakur, Rajanandan Lal Das, Kedarnath Chaudhary, Premlata Mishra, Sharadindu Chaudhary, Ashok, and Rambharos Kapri 'Bhramar' – have been published in the fortnightly 'Videha'. Print versions of some of these special issues are also available. All this is important.

However, the above list is not the complete content available on the <http://videha.co.in/> platform, nor is it the complete list of achievements of Shri Gajendra Thakur. Information about the available content is available on the webpage itself.

In summary, I am happy to say that the long journey of 'Videha' and the labour of Gajendra Thakur are commendable. I wish Shri Gajendra Thakur and 'Videha' continued progressive success.

****The Internet Man of Maithili: Gajendra Thakur****

****Lal Dev Kamat****

From electronic media, the use of energy and equipment for content is faster compared to print media. A large part of new media is spread as electronic media. Simple electronic and digital electronic are two types. Electronic media can be in any structure. Companion audit indicates the work done between presented composition and screening of subsidy applications. This process requests the creators to fulfill the approved guidelines of their control. And important research reduces inappropriate references, acceptable understanding, and personal

approach scattering. News media is that element of mass communication through which the general public focuses on news and public relations. This includes print media and radio-television, which have recently settled, except the internet. Global Media Journal, International Sociology era, Mass Communication Society will continue to progress. The first presence of Maithili on the internet was by Gajendra Thakur ji (on Yahoo Cities) with the e-magazine named 'Bhalsarik Gaachh' in 2000 AD. After the Yahoo Cities account was created, Mr. Thakur ji made a blog with this name in 2004. Its name was changed to Videha in January 2008. Then, since last 2004, it got an ISSN. What is said about the start of Maithili Wikipedia from 2014 is completely misleading. Ashish Anchinhaar, the author of the history of Maithili web journalism, has clarified this fact. Just as evidence

from various historians regarding the history of Mithila is found in fragments, opinions regarding Maithili Wikipedia also differ. Before October 2014, by September, despite fewer Maithili translations, the Maithili page reached the Wikimedia announcement stage through the successful efforts of Gajendra ji and Rajesh Ranjan ji. When a proposal came to Gajendra ji to become an admin, he had to consider his time and, consulting with Rajesh ji, agreed on the name Biplav Anand. It was his greatness that the Wikipedia team caught hold of the active Biplav Anand ji. And in October 2014, Maithili Wikipedia went live. The emails related to becoming a Wikipedia admin are available for readers to see in Videha issue 351. Regarding Unicode, Google Translate, and his involvement in various Community Projects, the related emails have been made public by

Gajendra Thakur ji. After being rejected in January 2008, Gajendra Thakur requested again and expected cooperation from his team to complete the translation work. This appeal was published in Videha issue 3, 1 February.

It is a matter of great astonishment that when someone starts a task, they develop the mentality that they were the first to start this work. Those who cannot control the greed to be first and boast, they must provide proof. But modern historians keep exposing such tendencies of Maithils from time to time. In that sequence, now it must be said that the history of Maithili Wikipedia is also like this. The same Biplav Anand, whom Gajendra Thakur and Rajesh Ranjan made the administrator of Wikipedia by mutual consent, that very Biplav

Anand and some people from Nepal are saying that Maithili Wikipedia started in 2014. If approval is considered the start, then it is even more necessary that the work done before approval should be made public. That is absolutely necessary. How can anyone efface the names of Gajendra ji and Rajesh Ranjan ji? Gajendra Thakur is the first editor of the Maithili e-magazine Videha, who regularly publishes issues of the magazine in more than one script, e.g., Braille, Brahmi, Kharosthi, Kaithi, Newari, IPA, Urdu, Tibetan, Tirhuta (Mithilakshar), and Devanagari.

Gajendra ji has many achievements, a detailed description of which is not possible in this short article.

****Gajendra Thakur's
Contribution to Panji
Literature****

****Binayanand Jha****

Gajendra Thakur's contribution to the language, literature, and cultural field of Mithila is significant. His

contribution in the field of Panji is also commendable. As is well known, the collection of genealogies (Utedh) of Maithil Brahmins and Maithil Karna Kayasthas began during the time of King Harisingh Dev. According to the present author, this compilation likely occurred between 1309 AD and 1324 AD. During this time, the compilers went to various villages and listed the names of contemporary individuals according to their gotra, and also attempted to list the names of ancestors up to seven or eight generations prior from the existing household heads. Therefore, for an individual up to seven or eight generations earlier, a separate identity based on their residential village name was created under the associated gotra, and that village was called their 'Mul' (root). That earliest known individual was called the 'Beej Purush' (seed ancestor) of that Mul. The villages to

which his progeny migrated and settled from the time of the Beej Purush up to the compilation period were called the branches (Mulgram) of that Mul. The original texts of the Panji are not available in the present time. The two oldest compilations available in the twentieth century were written around the same time (first half of the eighteenth century). One was written by Mangrauni's Panjekar Purushottam Jha (1719 AD) and is known as 'Purushottam Panji'. The second, known as 'Devānand Panji', is famous by the name of Kakraur's Panjekar Chhoti Jha. All subsequent Panji compilations are based on the above two. Among these, the Purushottam Panji was available in the Raj Library, Darbhanga, until the mid-twentieth century. The Devanand Panji is said to be still preserved by his descendant, the late Modanand Jha, Panjekar of Shivnagar (Purnia), in his

family.

This important Devanand Panji was published by Gajendra Thakur along with two other scholars, Nagendra Kumar Jha and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha, in 2009 AD under the title "Genome Mapping (450 AD to 2009 AD) – Mithila Ka Panji Prabandh". It is clear that this would also include the compilations done by his descendants after the Devanand Panji.

This is a thick volume, in a single binding, large format. In describing the genealogy, each page has two columns; the left column is in Tirhuta and the right column is its Devanagari transliteration. Before the genealogical description of the ancient Panji, Upati (Shrotriya lineage) and Nagaram (non-

Shrotriya lineage) classes, there is a detailed introduction related to the Panji. This introduction is first in Devanagari script and then in Tirhuta, both in the Maithili language.

Despite such an important publication, the general public is generally deprived of benefiting from it. The names of various Muls are described in the book in the same order as they appear in the Panji text, which is not comprehensible for the average reader or researcher.

Therefore, it is not possible for someone working on a particular Mul, its specific branch, or later specific villages, or any other curious reader, to find that portion. If the genealogical names of each lineage (Mul) were described in separate chapters or headings (according to

Mul), in order of branches and subsequent villages, the book would be very useful for both the general public and researchers. Nevertheless, it is a unique, important, and extensive (with detailed genealogy) work of its kind. After this, under the editorship of Yognath Jha, a book on the genealogy of Maithil Brahmins was published in three parts titled "Panji Prabandh". However, due to the editor not having a background in Panji, the said book is erroneous and misleading. Thus, 'Genome Mapping' is the only important publication on genealogy. The present author has noticed some factual errors in Genome Mapping, which have historical significance. Two of these are discussed in detail below.

The name of the member of the Mandar Mul contemporary to the

Beej Purush of each Mul is "Narasimha". But in this lineage, names from 18-20 generations prior to 'Narasimha' are also compiled in Panji books. So, the earliest known person of this lineage was 'Trinayan Bhatt', who resided in Mandala (present-day Madhya Pradesh). Thus, the name of this Mul became Mandala, which later came to be called Mandar and in colloquial speech became Madray (Mandalay = Mandaray = Madray). The names from Trinayan Bhatt up to Narasimha are available in two other books before Genome Mapping – one is the present author's "Mithila Ki Saraswat Sushma"¹ and the other is Pt. Govind Jha's "Atitalok"². There are differences in names and their numbers in these three. The three lists are presented below:

	Sr. No.		Mithila Ki Saraswat
--	---------	--	---------------------

Sushma (p-40) | Atitalok (p-51) |
Genome Mapping (p-1.11) |

| :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- |

| 1 | Trinayan Bhatt | Trinayan
Bhatt | Trinayan Bhatt |

| 2 | Aadi Bhatt | Aadi Bhatt | Arya
Bhatt |

| 3 | Vijaya Bhatt | Udaya Bhatt |
Udaya Bhatt |

| 4 | Trilocal Bhatt | Vijaya Bhatt |
Vijaya Bhatt |

| 5 | Dhurjati Mishra | Trilocal
Bhatt | Sulocal Bhatt (Sunayan
Bhatt) |

| 6 | Dharmajati Mishra | Sulocal
Bhatt | --Bhatt (handwritten as
Dhurjati) |

| 7 | Dharajati Mishra | Dhurjati
Bhatt | Dharmajati Mishra |

| 8 | Brahmajati Mishra |
Dharmajati Bhatt | Dharajati Mishra
|

| 9 | Sripujati | Chandrajati Bhatt |
Brahmajati Mishra |

| 10 | Vishnujati Mishra | Ajaya
Singh | Tripurajati Mishra |

| 11 | Ajaya Singh | Vijaya Singh |
Vighujati Mishra |

| 12 | Vijaya Singh | Paharaj Singh |
Ajaya Singh |

| 13 | Paharaj Singh | Parashuram |
Vijaya Singh |

| 14 | Parashuram Singh |
Aadivarah | Paharaj (handwritten) |

| 15 | Aadivarah Singh | Varah |
Parashuram (handwritten) |

| 16 | Varah Singh | Duryodhana
Singh | Aadivarah |

| 17 | Duryodhana Singh |
Narasimha | Mahovaraha |

| 18 | Narasimha | ----- |
Duryodhana Singh |

| 19 | ----- | ----- | Narasimha |

Here, the present author's list, i.e., the first list, has eighteen names, Govind Jha's list has seventeen names, and Genome Mapping has nineteen names. For the author, this list was sent by Panjekar Modanand Jha of Shivnagar, Purnia (father of Vidyanand Jha, one of the three compilers of Genome Mapping) through a letter dated 7 July 1988 AD. The name Uday Bhatt is not in the author's list but is in the other two lists. It is very possible that due to old age, Panjekar Modanand Jha missed writing this name while preparing the list for the author. Therefore, considering this point, if the name

Uday Bhatt is added at the third position in the first list, then the order and number of names in the first and third lists become identical. This should be so because both lists originated from the same source, written by father and son at different times. In Genome Mapping, due to Vidyanand Jha being unable to read some names, those places were left blank in the publication, and after the book was published, those names were added in the blank spaces or even where there was no blank space (as Vidyanand Jha told the present author). Corrections were made by hand in the relevant chapter and page (1.11) of the book, but in the introduction (p. 0.15), those names could not be added while listing the members from Trinayan Bhatt to Narasimha. Hence, only seventeen generations' names are mentioned there. Although on the same page of the introduction, it

is said that there are twelve generations from Narasimha to Trinayan. So, the number twelve is either erroneous or a printing mistake.

As mentioned above, if Uday Bhatt is added at the third position in the first list, the order and number of names become similar to the third list; however, some names still do not match. It can be said that this variation might be the result of one of the two list-makers misreading the original text.

According to the author, at the tenth position in the first list, the name Vishnujati is written as Vighujati (at the eleventh position) in Genome Mapping. In Genome Mapping, possibly 'Vidhujati' was misprinted as 'Vighujati' due to typographical

negligence.³ Anyway, in the original Devanand Panji, the name was probably Vishnujati or Vidhujati.

The name at the fourth position in the above list is Trilocan, for which the name in Genome Mapping (at the fifth position) is Sulocan (Sunayan). Generally, it seems here that one of the two list-makers provided a wrong reading. But the problem becomes serious when in Pt. Govind Jha's list both names appear, i.e., Trilocan and his son Sulocan. If this is taken as authentic, then it can be said that Modanand Jha might have missed writing Sulocan and Vidyanand Jha might have missed writing Trilocan. Also, in Pt. Govind Jha's list, there is a name Chandrajati (serial no. 9) which is not in the other two lists. In Pt. Govind Jha's list, the names Dharajati, Brahmajati, and Sripujati (Tripurajati) are

absent, which are present in the other two lists. Thus, it can be said that the source of Pt. Govind Jha's list might have been different from the Devanand Panji. He himself belongs to the Mandar lineage, so this list might have been traditionally preserved in his family.

According to the present author, the name Sripujati (serial no. 9) in the first list is the same as Tripurajati (serial no. 10) in the third list. One of the two list-makers has misread it. Although Pt. Govind Jha's list can be called erroneous and incomplete in light of the other two lists, some points need consideration. For example, both names Trilogan and Sulogan are present there. The other two lists give one name each from these. It is very likely that the makers of the first and third lists made an error in writing or reading one

name, causing the other to be omitted. The name Chandrajati was either omitted in the original Devanand Panji or is not found in these two lists due to the carelessness of the two list-makers. Thus, in the context of the above discussion, if a comparative study of the three lists is done and a new list is prepared, there would be 21 names from Trinayan to Narasimha. Researchers on the Mandar lineage will determine how reliable the following list is:

Sr. No.	Name
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:	:
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1	Trinayan Bhatt
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2	Aadi Bhatt (Aryabhatt is a wrong reading) ⁴
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3	Udaya Bhatt
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| 4 | Vijaya Bhatt |

| 5 | Trilocan Bhatt |

| 6 | Sucalocan Bhatt (Sunayan
Bhatt?) |

| 7 | Dhurjati Mishra |

| 8 | Dharmajati Mishra |

| 9 | Chandrajati Mishra (serial
order doubtful) |

| 10 | Dharajati Mishra |

| 11 | Brahmajati Mishra |

| 12 | Sripujati / Tripurajati (both
are same person) |

| 13 | Vishnujati / Vidhujati (same
person, variant reading) |

| 14 | Ajaya Singh |

| 15 | Vijaya Singh |

| 16 | Paharaj Singh |

| 17 | Parashuram Singh |

| 18 | Aadivarah Singh |

| 19 | Varah Singh |

| 20 | Duryodhana Singh |

| 21 | Narasimha |

In every source, Duryodhana Singh has three sons – Sodhar, Jayasimha, and Narasimha, but details of only Narasimha's progeny branch are found.

After the fall of the Karnata dynasty in Mithila, Rajpandit Kameshwar Thakur of the Khuaraade Jagatpur Mul became king. After gaining the kingdom, based on the residence of an ancestor of this lineage, Oen Thakur, in the village "Oini", a separate Mul "Oinwar Oini" was

named.

In Upendra Thakur's 'History of Mithila', the names of Kameshwar Thakur's brothers are: Kameshwar, Harshan (Harishan), Tripur, Tivari, Salakhan (Salakshan), and Gauda.⁵ In Genome Mapping (p. 1.138), the names of Kameshwar's brothers are as follows: Kameshwar, Rameshwar, Harishwar, Tripure, Tevari, Salakhan, and Godhi. The name Harshan is not in Genome Mapping. In the introduction to the editor of the 'Parvanirnaya' text, Kusheshwar Sharma (Kumar), it is said that he comes in the twelfth generation from Harshan Thakur, the third brother of Rajpandit Kameshwar.⁶ There is also a text written by this Kusheshwar Sharma (Kumar) called "Kumar Vanshawali", which contains a family tree prepared by two then-famous Panjikars of Saurath (Madhubani),

Lutan Jha and Bisuni Mishra, starting from Oen Thakur.⁷ According to this, the names of Kameshwar's various brothers were – Kameshwar Thakur, Rameshwar Thakur, Harshan Thakur, Tripur Thakur, Tevari Thakur, and Gauda Thakur.

In Genome Mapping, the name Harshan is not there, and also in the names of Salakhan's descendants, some are called Raja Maharaja and surnames like Singh and Kumar are found, most of whose members are shown in the progeny branch of Harshan in the Kumar Vanshavali. In Genome Mapping, among the two sons of Salakhan, Shivai and Bhattgonae, the three sons of Shivai are mentioned – Kumar Prabhakar, Shrikar, and Sudhakar. According to Kumar Vanshavali, the sons of Harshan were Shivai and Gonan. The

names of the sons of Shivai from his first wife were Kumar Prabhakar, Kumar Shrikar, Kumar Sudhakar, and Ravidatta.

Upendra Thakur mentions the names of Kameshwar's brothers based on Parameshwar Jha's 'Mithilatattva Vimarsha'.⁸ Therefore, the name Harshan is found in the list of Mithilatattva Vimarsha and the Kumar Vanshawali. If we proceed assuming that the name Harshan was omitted in Genome Mapping due to printing carelessness, then the progeny of Salakhan would not match with the progeny of Harshan, whereas in Kumar Vanshawali, there is no existence of any person named Salakhan. Thus, this seems to be a subject for research.

References:

1) Binyanand Jha, Mithila Ki Saraswat Sushma, Delhi (2007 AD), p. 40

2) Pt. Govind Jha, Atitalok, Akhiyasal Publication, Lalganj, Madhubani, Patna, 2005 AD, p. 51

3) For Yognath Jha 'Sindhu' edited Panji Prabandh, Part-1 (Ankit Prakashan, Darbhanga, 2010 AD, p. 242), the genealogy (Utedh) was provided by Vidyanand Jha. In that book, the name is Vidhujati. Therefore, the misprint 'Vighujati' in Genome Mapping can be considered a printing error.

4) Trinayan's son is universally written as Aadi Bhatt. In Yognath Jha's Panji Prabandh Part-1, whose genealogy was provided by Vidyanand, the name is also Aadi Bhatt. Hence, it can be said that the name "Aryabhata" in Genome Mapping is a wrong reading.

5) Upendra Thakur, History of Mithila, Mithila Research Institute, Darbhanga (1956 AD), p. 294

6) Kusheshwar Sharma (ed.), Parvanirnaya, Delhi, 1985, p. 141

7) Kusheshwar Sharma, Kumar Vanshawali, p. 5

8) Parameshwar Jha, Mithilatattva Vimarsha, Maithili Akademi Publication, Patna, Second Edition, 2013 AD, p. 89. After listing the above 6 names, it is said "Somewhere after Kameshwar, a seventh son, Rameshwar, is written." Thus, as Harshan is called the third brother in Parvanirnaya and Kumar Vanshawali, it is also confirmed by Parameshwar Jha's writing. However, Parameshwar Jha and Kumar Vanshawali mention Harshan, but this name is not in Genome Mapping. Similarly, Parameshwar Jha and Genome Mapping mention

the name Salakhan, but it is not in Kumar Vanshawali. In Genome Mapping, the name at the third position is Harishwar. Possibly, in Devanand Panji, the name was Harishwar for Harshan (Harishan, or Harishen). His actual name in his tradition might be Harishwar, and in other Panjekar traditions, the actual name (or known name) might be Harshan or Harishen. Where Parameshwar Jha and Kumar Vanshawali give the last name as Gauda, Genome Mapping gives its variant as Godhi.

In Yognath Jha 'Sindhu' edited Panji Prabandh, Part-2 (Ankit Prakashan, Darbhanga, 2012 AD, p. 371), the following names are given – Kameshwar, Rajeshwar, Harishwar, Tripure, Tevari, Satlakh, and Godhi. Since Vidyanand Jha of Genome Mapping provided this compilation for Yognath Jha, it can be said that in this book (Panji Prabandh, Part-2),

Rajeshwar for Rameshwar and
Satlakh for Salakhan might be
printing errors or editorial errors.

****Editorial Note:**** In references 3,
4, and 8, Binyanand ji states that "for
Yognath Jha 'Sindhu' edited Panji
Prabandh, Parts 1 and 2, the
genealogy (Utedh) was provided by
Vidyanand Jha." But the fact is that
Yognath Jha ji used Vidyanand ji's
material. When the final proof of
Genome Mapping had come,
Panjekar Vidyanand ji was requested
by Yognath Jha to provide him with
the original part details, which he
could keep for his personal work.
Vidyanand ji gave him a printed
copy (the original one) of Genome
Mapping. But Yognath Jha ji
published that part of Genome
Mapping in his own name with some
modifications. When Vidyanand Jha
came to know of this, he told

Yognath Jha what needed to be said about this act of his, and simultaneously, in the foreword of the second part of Genome Mapping, "Genealogical Mapping (450 AD to 2009 AD) – Mithila Ka Panji Prabandh - Part-2 (Editors – Gajendra Thakur, Nagendra Kumar Jha, and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha)", published in 2012, the three editors mentioned Yognath Jha's wrongful act in writing. Binyanand ji can contact Panjekar Vidyanand ji, and readers can read the second part of Genome Mapping. What Yognath Jha ji did is a matter of copyright infringement, wherein he published a book edited by someone else under his own name.

****What is Panji
Prabandh? ****

****Jagdish Chandra Thakur**

'Anil'**

We have all seen that when a marriage is fixed somewhere, after taking the introduction of both the bride and groom's sides, people go to Saurath to the Panjekar's *ot* (enclosure/designated spot). The Panjekar, after checking their records, gives a paper which is called a *Siddhant*. This Siddhant is essentially an acceptance or permission letter stating that the boy with certain details can marry the girl with certain details, and both these details are recorded by the Panjekar in the relevant records.

Due to changing times, its utility is gradually decreasing, but knowing about our ancestors – where they

came from, where their marital relations were, what the marriage system was, what its scientific aspects were, what its weak points were, and many other things – is very interesting and enlightening. Knowing this is not easy either, but the satisfying thing is that this information has been available from the ledgers or Panjis that the Panjikars possess.

We all did not know when this Panji system came into existence in Mithila, when and how and by whom modifications or revisions were made in it, what all it contains, whether it contains details of all Maithils or only some communities. All this information was compiled and made available in the fortnightly internet magazine of Maithili by its editor, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji, who completed the difficult task of

providing information about Mithila's Panji system in two thick volumes many years ago. Fortunately, the book is available for everyone to download in the Videha archive. I am reading the book, but many pages still remain to be read. Whatever has been learned from this book so far, I am sharing. Earlier, everyone used to keep their own records of their ancestors and marital relations.

****Beginning:****

During the early medieval period, for the purity of castes among the Brahmin, Kayastha, and Kshatriya classes, the system of Panji Prabandh was initiated during the time of the Karnata dynasty king, Maharaja Harisingh Dev of Mithila. Gunakar Jha was appointed for Maithil Brahmins, Shankar Dutt for Karna

Kayasthas, and Vijay Dutt for Kshatriyas. The Panji Prabandh of that time had a scientific basis and was purely a record of genealogical identity. Brahmins, Kayasthas, and Kshatriyas were all equally included in their respective Panjis.

****Change:****

During the time of Maharaja Madhav Singh, Shakha Panji began, and divisions like Shrotriya etc. occurred. Gradually, considerations of high and low status emerged, leading to social evils born from them. Due to the influence of time, the Panji system ended among Kshatriyas. Now it exists only among Maithil Brahmins and Karna Kayasthas. In Gajendra Thakur ji's book, explanations of terms like Panji, Panjekar, Gotra, Mul, Utedh, and many others are given:

****Panji - Panjikaar:**** The book of records is called Panji, and the one who keeps this book is called Panjikaar. There are seven types of Panji:

1. Mool Panji
2. Shakha Panji
3. Gotra Panji
4. Patra Panji
5. Dushan Panji
6. Utedh Panji
7. Asvajanya Patra Panji

Gotra Panji contains all gotras and their ancient origins. Patra Panji mentions the original village

(Mulgram); this has been in practice for about 500 years. Dushan Panji contains mentions of blemishes or degradations that occurred in the lineage. This was a written document of marriage with other castes, especially Dalits and Muslims, or remarriage after the husband's death.

****Brahmins and Maithil Brahmins:****

The division of Brahmins in India first occurred based on the Vedas, such as Samvedi, Yajurvedi, etc. Later, with the advent of the Puranic age, the Brahmin society of India was divided into ten different classes based on different regions:

1. Utkal
2. Kanyakubja
3. Gauda
4. Maithil
5. Saraswat
6. Karnata
7. Gurjar
8. Tailang (Telugu)
9. Dravid
10. Maharashtriya

Maithil Brahmins are primarily followers of two Vedas:

1. Followers of the Madhyandina branch of the Yajurveda, called "Vajasaneyi".
2. Followers of the Kauthuma branch

of the Samaveda, called "Chhandoga".

There are some differences in the rituals and procedures for various sacraments like Upanayana (sacred thread ceremony), marriage, etc., between these two types of Brahmins.

****Mul:****

At the time of the Panji Prabandh, the place where a person resided was called his village for his future descendants. The name of the most ancient dwelling place of one's ancestors, as recorded by the record-keeper, became that person's *Mul*. Information about Brahmins from 167 Muls is found in Mithila, all of which are mentioned in the book.

****Gotra:****

In Maithil Brahmin society, Gotra indicates lineage. All gotras are patrilineal, meaning each gotra is named after the earliest known great person of that lineage. There are twenty gotras among Maithil Brahmins, with the majority of people belonging mainly to the following seven gotras:

1. Shandilya
2. Vatsa
3. Kashyap
4. Savarna
5. Parashar
6. Bharadwaj
7. Katyayan

The remaining thirteen gotras are as follows:

1. Garga
2. Kaushik
3. Alambukaksha
4. Krishnatraya
5. Gautam
6. Maudgalya
7. Vashishtha
8. Kaundinya
9. Upamanyu
10. Kapil
11. Vishnuvridhhi
12. Tandi
13. Jatukarna

Among Karna-Kayasthas, there is one gotra, 'Kashyap'.

****Gotra-Mul:****

Each gotra has many Muls; some Muls are found in more than one gotra.

****Script:****

The Panji was written on palm leaves / birch bark in the Mithila script, Tirhuta. Due to the lack of knowledge of this script, support for the preservation of these books was decreasing, so transcribing the Panji written in Tirhuta and transliterating it into Devanagari was necessary.

This difficult task was accomplished by Shri Gajendra Thakur ji. Thakur ji

writes: 'While transcribing and transliterating the ancient Panji in 2000 AD, it was realized how high Mithila's sense of history was. Despite being impoverished, despite the crooked gaze of the then rulers, the educational condition of Mithila, the capacity for religious-exegetical discussion, the talent for literary composition, the proficiency in art and skill, the cultural diversity – all were evident.

In no other society in the world has the genealogy of people spread over such a vast geographical area been recorded so comprehensively for over 1500 years, in the way the people of Mithila, even in poverty, kept collecting records of their identity, preserving details of their ancestors' education, so-called blemishes and relationships, and chronological records of migration

and non-migration – this is truly amazing.'

How modern Maithil society will receive this kind of knowledge, tradition, and culture will require patience to see, but in today's era of globalization, Gajendra Thakur ji's herculean effort to place all this on the world stage is extraordinary, unparalleled, and invaluable.

****Dushan Panji: Gajendra
Thakur's Universal
Contribution to Maithili
Culture****

****Dr. Kailash Kumar
Mishra****

Gajendra Thakur remains continuously engaged for Maithili literature and culture. He keeps himself away from any kind of cultural-literary politics. He has an authentic and serious book titled "Dushan Panji", which Gajendra ji edited with the cooperation of an expert Panjkar. This can be called not just a book but a project; it can essentially be considered an effort to present research, the search for researchers, and achievements before everyone with honesty. While reading the book, many kinds of thoughts kept coming. This book seemed very good at places and very technical at many others. To understand the facts, however, reading the entire book is necessary.

Before that, understanding Mithila and Maithili is essential. Mithila has been a confluence of folk and classical traditions. Written tradition or the folklore of the specific scholarly tradition is found in Mithila as much as it is rare to find elsewhere. Many legends and anecdotes are associated with Kalidasa, Mandan Mishra, Kumaril Bhatta, Mahesh Thakur, Vidyapati, Ayachi Mishra, and many others. Even now, folklore continues to be created about scholars. Many things that are not written down, people preserve in various ways in their memory. The tendency of the people has always been to reach the depth of the truth. As one studies Maithili folk and knowledge traditions, this becomes clearer. One such tradition has been the Panji Prabandh, which when started included Brahmin, Karna Kayastha, and Kshatriya societies, but in the present time, it

has survived only among Brahmins and Karna Kayasthas. Much boasting has been done about this tradition. One group compares it to genome mapping, while another group considers it the most authentic source of the world's most scientific and systematic preservation of genealogy. In the present time, although this tradition is limited to Maithil Brahmins and Karna Kayasthas, its comparative and scientific research can reveal many profound things. How to correct the Panji, what its form should be in the present time, and solutions to various curiosities are possible through research on many Panji books and manuscripts. I think this tradition, which operates on scientific principles, should be researched further. Avoiding ultra-puritan ideologies, the tendency of a so-called group based on caste or community, and the activism of

greatness, the analysis of facts should be done with the discrimination of milk and water. In this process, it is possible that the available Panji, which is now sufficiently available in digital format, will present itself with very meaningful evidence. It is also possible that in the future, people from other societies may also accept this intangible heritage of record management and make it more acceptable and authentic. Over time, improvement in this may be possible.

In no other society in the world has the genealogy of people spread over such a vast geographical area been recorded so comprehensively for over 1500 years, in the way the people of Mithila, even in poverty, kept collecting records of their identity, preserving details of their

ancestors' education, so-called blemishes and relationships, and chronological records of migration and non-migration – this is truly amazing.

In this direction, one format, whose manuscript is available, is called Dushan Panji. As is clear from the name, it contains evidence of the faults or blemishes of ancestors in various genealogies. It mentions the degradation that occurred in the lineage. Its discussion becomes possible much later, so that the concerned lineage could survive its ill effects.

From reading this book, it became known that there are seven types of Panji:

1. Mool (Root/Main)

2. Shakha (Branch)

3. Gotra: Gotra Panji contains all gotras and their ancient origins. The main thing is that marriage cannot take place within the same gotra. There are 20 gotras found among Maithil Brahmins: Shandilya, Vatsa, Savarna, Kashyap, Parashar, Bharadwaj, Katyayan, Garga, Kaushik, Alambukaksha, Krishnatreya, Gautam, Maudgalya, Vashishtha, Kaundinya, Upamanyu, Kapil, Vishnuvridhi, Tandi, and Jatukarna. In Maithil Brahmin society, Gotra is indicative of lineage. All gotras are patrilineal – meaning each gotra is named after the earliest known great person of that lineage, i.e., the Beej Purush.

4. Patra: Patra Panji has been in practice for about 500 years. In this, mention of the original village (Mulgram) began.

5. Dushan

6. Utedh: From Utedh Panji, knowledge of the termination of sapinda (same lineage) relations is obtained – mention of six ancestors is found. Utedh was the introduction of seven ancestors, for which the introduction of these thirty-two families was necessary – the father and mother's paternal grandfather and paternal grandmother, and maternal grandfather and maternal grandmother's paternal grandfather and paternal grandmother, and mother and maternal grandmother's father. And from these thirty-two ancestors, the person eligible for marriage should be the seventh in descent. In this sequence, the division into Shrotriya, Yogya, and Panjibaddha categories occurred. Those who were not Panjibaddha became Jaebar. In Utedh, Shrotriyas married after renouncing five

generations on the mother's side and seven generations on the father's side. Panjibaddha people, also called descendants, married after renouncing five generations on the mother's side and six generations on the father's side. Currently, according to Dharmashastra, there is a single system for Shrotriya-Yogya-Panjibaddha and so-called Jaebar, nothing different.

7. Asvajanyapatra: It is said in the Smritis that those with whom one does not have the right to marry are called Svajana. The offspring obtained from marriage with Svajana were considered Chandalas. Asvajanyapatra means a certificate given by the Panjekar that the groom and bride are not Svajana. Their marriage can take place. Every marriage is finalized only when the Panjekar, after checking the rights, writes that a particular girl and a particular boy are not 'Svajana'. This

letter was called 'Asvajana Patra' or 'Siddhanta Patra'. Even today, before marriage, it is considered necessary to check the rights of the boy and girl and obtain a Siddhanta Patra. In Panji-Prabandh, this became the foremost rule that marriage without a Siddhanta is considered unscriptural. The giver of the 'Asvajana Patra' was called Panjekar. The compiled record in which every new birth and marriage began to be added became the Panji. Those whose names appeared in the Panji became Panjibaddha.

While reading the book, many mysteries keep unfolding. They keep unfolding. I always wondered:

a) Is the Panji only a document of good things? If there was any wrong or inferior thing or fact, why is there

no mention of it?

b) Why are women's names not mentioned in the Panji?

c) Why is it not discussed among castes other than Brahmin, Kshatriya, Karna Kayastha?

d) What is the script of the Panji?

Gajendra Thakur's scholarly endeavour and research answered many questions.

a) It became known that if any ancestor ever did a wrong marriage with a wrong place/caste, i.e., a faulty marriage, a Panji book was written on that as well, named Dushan Panji. Dushan means second marriage or faulty marriage.

b) The Rasadh-Arariya Panji is the

only Panji book (known and available) where women's names are mentioned in the Panji.

c) All the books of the Panji are written/are being written in the Mithila script, Tirhuta. And understand, the lifeblood of the Tirhuta script is the Panji Prabandh. Comparing Mithila's Panji with any pilgrimage site like Gaya, Simaria Ghat, Babadham, Amarkantak, etc., has no justification, because the data at pilgrimage sites is mostly only hereditary details of the patrons and priests (Pandas). It contains only name, gotra, village, Mul, father's name, date of visit, etc., no other information. The style of writing information or the register is also not universal. In Mithila, it has a uniform pattern, a separate script for writing (Tirhuta script), and at least 10 types of information about the boy or girl's side are available.

Information up to the name, gotra, Mul, and Beej Purush of the girl's maternal grandmother's father is available. The boy's side's seven generations are certainly there. The surprising thing is that all this information is contained in one line. Information about the education, titles, and honours of a particular individual is available. All this information is authentic to a great extent.

The meaning is that through deep exploration of the Panji, answers to all questions keep appearing. It's just that one should have a research mindset and keep reading the book. Since the authentic transliteration of the book is in Devanagari, it acts like a life-giving herb for ignorant readers like us. For those who are knowledgeable about the manuscript genre or discipline, who have

knowledge of many scripts and languages, the folios of the original manuscript are attached. They can also shed light on the errors of transliteration, their analysis, etc. Meaningful dialogue can happen with many scholars on this book. Seminars and workshops can be organized. The biggest thing is that the entire book is available for free on Videha's website. This work is an intangible heritage of knowledge wealth. We people should take cognizance of this. People from outside Mithila and India, students, scholars, software engineers, professionals, scientists, linguists are taking cognizance, but there is no concern among us! This needs serious thought.

Now let's talk about Dushan Panji. Regarding the book, Gajendra Babu tells us that Gotra Panji contains

details of Gotra and Mul, Patra Panji contains knowledge of offspring, and Dushan Panji contains knowledge of defects that occurred in the lineage. Among the ancient books, knowledge related to educational titles prevalent from 450 AD to the present is available. This means that even before Maharaja Harisinghdev, the people of Mithila used to keep accounts of their Panji, but there was no royal legislation or system for it. However, after Harisinghdev, it gained the status of a state record.

I again focus on Dushan Panji. There are some people who are very afraid of Dushan Panji, its discussion, and research. Their fear is that discussing it would mean initiating the decline of the very high status of a class in the prevalent public belief and caste. The hidden secrets might come out. Citing a manuscript of Dushan Panji,

the scholar writes that it contained written documents of Brahmins' marriages with other castes, especially Dalits and Muslims, or remarriage after the husband's death. "Gangesha's birth 5 years after his father's death and then his marriage to a Charmanrini (woman of the cobbler caste) is described here. This is the same Gangesha, the father of Navya-Nyaya. Anand's marriage to a Charmanrini is also noteworthy."

Whether Brahmins eat Shrotriya or so-called Jaibari, there are no special privileges or special bonds for anyone. The people of Mithila, adorned with the term Jaibar, have been considered liberal and humble since ancient times compared to other civilizations and cultures of India. There has been no permanent place for any kind of religious

fundamentalism here. The scope for reform has always been kept open. If ever in any era a storm of casteism arose here, the sentiment of hatred did not find a place here. The biggest events of their respective eras become timeless and are forgotten, the proof of which is Mithila's Panji appendix – Dushan Panji. Events that shake an era disappear from society and mind after a short while.

Marriage of Kanham, son of Devasharma from Pali Mul, marriage of Damu, son of Govind from Budhwal Mul, marriage of Chakrapani, son of Shrinath from Sarisab Mul, marriage of Umapati, son of Bhim from Darihara Mul, marriage of Harinath, son of Shrihari from Sodarpur Mul, marriage of Krishnudev, son of Vasudev from Hariam Mul, marriage of Madhukar from Panichobh Mul – in unknown

lineages and castes. Marriage of Kishai, son of Kamalnayan, grandson of Bhavanath from Sarisab Mul – with the daughter of Gangadhar, son of Chamru from Valiyas. Chamru's own marriage was with an unknown girl. Meaning there was no trace of Kishai's mother-in-law's lineage. The descendants of this Kishai are spread in many villages of Mithila. But today, society has appropriately forgotten that fact. There are many instances of this type – for example, the marriage of the daughter of Bhim, granddaughter of Madhav from Budhwal Mul, due to which many families are affected. Jagannath, son of Ramnath from Satlakha, had a maternal uncle Udharan, son of Ratanu from Ghusaut; Ram, son of Horai from Pali, had a maternal uncle Radhav, son of Veni from Sakradhi Mul; Chandi, son of Pakhu from Sodarpur Mul, had a maternal uncle; Harikar, son of Dinkar from

Alay Mul, had a maternal uncle; Vidu, son of Shripoti from Tilay Mul, had a maternal uncle, etc. These were from the Devdasi tradition, considered unknown, but their descendants are respected in society today. Such examples are abundant in the Panji, which, being timeless now, do not adversely affect any lineage, but rather guide what decision should be taken in such situations. In this context, it seems necessary to say this.

According to Manu and Yajnavalkya, the right to marry belongs to that girl who is: 1. Not of the same gotra, 2. Not of the same pravar, 3. Not a sapinda on the mother's side, 4. Not a sapinda on the father's side, 5. Not a descendant of the paternal grandfather or maternal grandfather, 6. Not a descendant of the Kathamama (mother's sister's

husband?).

Inspired by King Harisinghdev (born 1294 AD, ascended throne 1307 AD) of the Karnata dynasty of Mithila, the Pandits of Mithila decided in Shake 1248 corresponding to 1326 AD to initiate the current form of Panji Prabandh for the Brahmin, Karna Kayastha, and Kshatriya classes. Gunakar Jha was appointed for Brahmins, Shankardutt for Karna Kayasthas, and Vijaydutt for Kshatriyas to execute this work.

Again, in the current form, some intellectuals got an order from Mithilesh Maharaja Madhav Singh in 1760 AD and got the Panjikars to create branch books (Shakha Pustak). After that, in the Panji (sometimes described as Shake 1600 i.e., 1678 AD, actually around 1800

AD after Madhav Singh), a new Brahmin sub-caste named Shrotriya originated in Mithila.

The Panji Prabandh was created in the pre-medieval period for the purpose of caste purity of the Brahmin, Kayastha, and Kshatriya classes. To ascertain the caste purity of a Brahmin, knowing the Utedh was necessary. Utedh was the introduction of seven ancestors, for which the introduction of these thirty-two families was necessary – the father and mother's paternal grandfather and paternal grandmother, and maternal grandfather and maternal grandmother's paternal grandfather and paternal grandmother, and mother and maternal grandmother's father. And from these thirty-two ancestors, the person eligible for marriage should be the seventh in

descent. In this sequence, the division into Shrotriya, Yogya, and Panjibaddha categories occurred. Those who were not Panjibaddha became Jaebar. In Utedh, Shrotriyas married after renouncing five generations on the mother's side and seven generations on the father's side. Panjibaddha people, also called descendants, married after renouncing five generations on the mother's side and six generations on the father's side. Currently, according to Dharmashastra, there is a single system for Shrotriya-Yogya-Panjibaddha and so-called Jaebar, nothing different.

These were divided into 20 types of Gotras, 167 types of Muls, and many types of Mulgrams. Again, based on rituals, two vertical divisions of Samvedi and Shukla Yajurvedi Brahmins remained as Chhandogya

and Vajasaneyi Brahmins respectively. Out of 20 Gotras and 167 Mulgrams, 34 main Muls were determined. From these 167 Muls as well, they spread to various regions and sub-villages. In the later period, the Khanam branch of the Phanandah Mul came to be counted among the so-called high lineages as the 35th Mul.

The main 35 (34 + Khanam branch of Phanandah Mul) Muls are also divided into three categories.

Ayanat Shreshtha (Superior) – First category includes 1. Khadaurai, 2. Khauarai, 3. Budhwarai, 4. Madarai, 5. Dariharai, 6. Ghusautai, 7. Tisautai, 8. Karamhai, 9. Naraunai, 10. Bhabhaniyamai, 11. Hariammai, 12. Sarisabai, 13. Sodarpuriye.

Second category includes 1. Gangoliwar, 2. Pawauliwar, 3.

Kujauliwar, 4. Alewar, 5. Bahidwar, 6. Sakadiwar, 7. Paliwar, 8. Bisiwar, 9. Phanewar, 10. Uchitwar, 11. Pandulwar, 12. Kataiwar, 13. Tilaiwar.

Madhyam Mul (Middle) – 1. Dighwe, 2. Belaunchai, 3. Ekahare, 4. Panchobhe, 5. Valiyase, 6. Jajiwal, 7. Takwal, 8. Pandue.

Pravar: Among Maithil Brahmins, there are two types of Pravar families – Tripravar and Panchaprar. The gotra whose three ancestors composed hymns of the Rigveda is called Tripravar, and the gotra whose five ancestors composed hymns of the Rigveda is called Panchaprar.

Thus, according to Gotra, the Pravars are as follows:

Tripravar – 1. Shandilya, 2. Kashyap,

3. Parashar, 4. Bharadwaj, 5. Katyayan, 6. Kaushik, 7. Alambukaksha, 8. Krishnatreya, 9. Gautam, 10. Maudgalya, 11. Vashishtha, 12. Kaundinya, 13. Upamanyu, 14. Kapil, 15. Vishnuvridhi, 16. Tandi.

Panchaprar – 1. Vatsa, 2. Savarna, 3. Garga.

Detailed description of Pravar is as follows:

1. Shandilya – Shandilya, Asita, Adevala. 2. Vatsa – Orva, Chyavana, Bhargava, Jamadagnya, Aplavan. 3. Savarna – Orva, Chyavana, Bhargava, Jamadagnya, Aplavan. 4. Kashyap – Kashyap, Avatsara, Dhruva. 5. Parashar – Shakti, Vashishtha, Parashar. 6. Bharadwaj – Bharadwaj, Angirasa, Barhaspatya. 7. Katyayan – Katyayan, Vishnu, Angirasa. 8. Garga – Gargya, Ghrita,

Vaishampayana, Kaushika,
Mandavya, Atharvan. 9. Kaushik –
Kaushik, Atri, Jamadagni. 10.
Alambukaksha – Garga, Gautam,
Vashishtha. 11. Krishnatreya –
Krishnatreya, Aplavan, Saraswat. 12.
Gautam – Angira, Vashishtha,
Barhaspat. 13. Maudgalya –
Maudgalya, Angirasa, Barhaspatya.
14. Vashishtha – Vashishtha, Atri,
Sankriti. 15. Kaundinya – Astika,
Kaushik, Kaundinya. 16. Upamanyu –
Upamanyu, Angirasa, Barhaspatya.
17. Kapil – Shatatap, Kaundilya,
Kapil. 18. Vishnuvridhi –
Vishnuvridhi, Kaurapuchha,
Trasadasyu. 19. Tandi – Tandi,
Sankhya, Angirasa. 20. Jatukarna –
Jatukarna, Angirasa, Bharadwaj.

Among these, the ancestors of
Savarna and Vatsa are the same,
hence despite being two different
Gotras, marriages do not take place

between them. The vertical divisions of the Vedic era, Chhandogya and Vajasaneyi, remained with this, and the Yajnopavit mantras/marriage rituals of both are different. Then, to give three Pravars or five Pravars in the Yajnopavit, the above list is used.

The Brahmins of India were first divided into various classes based on the Vedas. For example, they were called Samvedi, Yajurvedi, etc. But under the influence of time, Brahmins living in different regions became influenced by different cultures. The main reasons for being influenced by regional culture were the specific climate of a particular region, the specific language of a particular region, different food and attire of different regions, and the inconvenience of travel to go from one region to another. As a result, the Brahmin community of a

particular region became influenced by the customs, thoughts, food habits, attire, emotions, language, and civilization-culture of that particular region.

Due to the above reasons, with the advent of the Puranic age, the Brahmin society of India became divided into various classes based on different regions. According to ancient consensus, the entire Brahmin society of India was divided into ten classes. These ten classes of Brahmins are: Utkal, Kanyakubja, Gauda, Maithil, Saraswat, Karnata, Gurjar, Tailang (Telugu), Dravid, and Maharashtriya. Broadly, the first five are called Pancha Gauda and the latter five are called Pancha Dravida. This demarcation was made: north of the Vindhyachal mountains are Pancha Gauda and south of the Vindhyachal mountains are Pancha

Dravida.

Maithil Brahmins: The Maithil Brahmins of the Pancha Gauda class, due to living in Mithila for generations, became influenced by the specific culture of Mithila, hence in the Puranic age, they became famous as Maithil Brahmins.

Maithil Brahmins are primarily followers of only two Vedas: one group is the followers of the Madhyandina branch of the Yajurveda; the second follows the Kauthuma branch of the Samaveda. The followers of the Madhyandina branch of Yajurveda are called "Vajasaneyi", similarly, the followers of the Kauthuma branch of Samaveda are called Chhandogya. There are some gross differences in their sacraments. Chhandogyas have four sacraments in Upanayana –

Namakarana, Chudakarana, Upanayana, and Samavartana, but Vajasaneyis have these four sacraments: Chudakarana, Upanayana, Vedarambha, and Samavartana. Similarly, Chhandogya marriage is mainly completed in two parts, pre-marriage and post-marriage. Post-marriage is done after sunset by seeing the star Arundhati. But there is no such division in Vajasaneyi marriage. It can happen anytime in the same sequence, day or night.

The right to marry which girl – the rules for marrying her, the offspring obtained, for the Aryan caste, the marriage rules were first codified in various Smritis. According to Manu and Yajnavalkya, the right to marry belongs to that girl who is: 1. Not of the same gotra, 2. Not of the same pravar, 3. Not a sapinda on the

mother's side, 4. Not a sapinda on the father's side, 5. Not a descendant of the paternal grandfather or maternal grandfather, 6. Not a descendant of the Kathamama.

For the execution of this marital right, at least from the time of Manu and Yajnavalkya, people certainly kept their own 'yavato parichay' (detailed introduction) themselves, but in later ages, this tendency became almost extinct. It is said in the Smritis that those with whom one does not have the right to marry are called Svajana. The offspring obtained from marriage with Svajana were considered Chandalas. They were considered excluded from the dignity of Aryan-hood. Therefore, the first step of marriage must have been the decision of right. People from the groom's side and the bride's side would sit together and

decide based on their own introductions whether the marriage of a particular boy with a particular girl should happen or not. But due to the decline of the tendency to keep introductions, to decide the right, capable and faithful individuals of each family started writing and keeping their 'yavato parichay' (mention of 32 origins). Before the seventh century, the mention of this written genealogical introduction 'Samuh Lekhya' first appears in 'Tantra Varttika' composed by the eminent scholar Kumaril Bhatta, which is a prose 'Varttika' on the commentary by Shabara on the Jaimini Sutras of the Mimamsa philosophy. Tantra Varttika is a philosophical text in which, by describing the true facts, the purity of caste is proved, based on which religion can be expounded. Kumaril Bhatta said that "Great high-born people protect their caste with great

special effort. Therefore, Kshatriyas and Brahmins, so as not to forget the tradition of their fathers and grandfathers, started the 'Samuh Lekhya'. They, seeing merits and demerits in each family, become inclined to establish relationships accordingly."

But by the end of the thirteenth century, even the Pandits had stopped keeping 'Samuh Lekhya', let alone common people. As a result, Pandit Harinath Upadhyaya, the author of a work on Dharmashastra like 'Smritisara', married his own paternal uncle's granddaughter due to lack of introduction, which was not his right among Svajana. Consequently, by the third decade of the fourteenth century, the need was felt to place these genealogical introductions under the authority of specific Pandits who could decide the

right at the time of marriage. Inspired by the then ruler of Mithila, King Harisinghdev, the Pandits of Mithila decided in Shaka 1248 corresponding to 1226 AD that "keeping introductions should not be left to the people themselves, but rather they should be compiled and entrusted to specific Pandits, and a separate royal department should be created, so that Pandits appointed by royal order would keep those compiled introductions. Every marriage would be finalized only when the appointed Pandit (Panjikar), after checking the rights, would write that a particular girl and a particular boy are not 'Svajana'. That is, according to scriptural rules, the boy has the marital right to the girl. This letter was called 'Asvajana Patra' or 'Siddhanta Patra'. Even today, before marriage, it is considered necessary to check the rights of the boy and girl and obtain

a Siddhanta Patra. In Panji-Prabandh, this became the foremost rule that marriage without a Siddhanta is considered unscriptural. This Pandit appointed by royal order, who gave the 'Asvajana Patra', was called Panjikar. The compiled record in which every new birth and marriage began to be added became the Panji. Those whose names appeared in the Panji became Panjibaddha.

According to the joint decision of Maharaja Harisinghdev and the then Pandits, by appointing record-keepers, the complete introductions of all Maithil Brahmins were compiled. The record-keepers would go around and ask the head of each family for their introduction and write it down. Generally, people knew introductions up to six ancestors. Some knew much more

than this. Some only had knowledge of two or three ancestors. As much as they knew, their information about their ancestors' place of residence, gotra, pravar, and their Veda and branch would be written down and collected. From this collection, the introductions of various branches of the same family settled in different villages were brought together. In this way, complete introductions of various families according to Gotra were obtained. At the time of this compilation, the Beej Purush and the original village (Mulgram) were considered most important. Because this was the most useful formula for genealogical introduction. The genealogical introductions of different individuals of the same family living in different villages would have been compiled based on this original village. For this reason, mention of the original village (Mulgram) is mandatory in the Panji.

At the time of the Panji-Prabandh, the place where a person resided became the village for his future descendants, and the name of the most ancient dwelling place of one's ancestors, as recorded by the record-keeper, became that person's Mul. Thus, the earliest known ancestor of each family was called the Beej Purush of that family. An example can be seen as proof of this. A great family of Kashyap Gotra, whose seventy-four branches are prevalent in Mithila, was, based on compiled introductions, originally proved to be residents of Mandar village. But long before the Panji-Prabandh, its two branches had clearly been established. One of Mangrauni village and the other of Garh-gram. Hence, in the Panji, from the beginning, the epithets Garh and Mangrauni were added along with Mandar. But based on available introductions, both were proven to

be two branches of the same family. Therefore, the Mul of both families was the same, and the Beej Purush was also the same.

In "Amarakosha", three meanings are given for Gotra – mountain, lineage, and name. In "Vachaspatya" Kosha, eleven meanings are given for Gotra – mountain, name, knowledge, forest, field, Kshatra, group, wealth, path, increase, and lineage of sages. In ancient Sanskrit literature, the word Gotra is often used for lineage or father's name. In the Chhandogya Upanishad (4/4), when the life teacher asks Satyakama about his Gotra, his intention is regarding Satyakama's family or father's name. But in the Rigveda, Gotra is mentioned four times for cloud or mountain, and twice for a group of animals or a community or protector of animals.

Ultimately, the use of the word Gotra in the sense of lineage or family is a later usage. The use of Gotra in the sense of lineage or family first occurs in the Chhandogya Upanishad. In Maithil Brahmin society, Gotra is indicative of lineage.

All Gotras of Maithil Brahmins are patrilineal. In total, there are 20 Gotras among Maithil Brahmins. Seven Gotras are well-organized, well-known, and in majority. These seven Gotras are: 1. Shandilya, 2. Vatsa, 3. Kashyap, 4. Savarna, 5. Parashar, 6. Bharadwaj, 7. Katyayan.

Each Gotra has many Muls. Introductions of Brahmins from 167 Muls are found in Mithila. Some Muls are such that they are found in more than one Gotra. 'Brahmapura' is one such Mul. Brahmins of this Mul are found in Shandilya, Vatsa,

Kashyap, Alambukaksha, Gautam,
and Garga Gotras.

Pravar – Mention of Pravar is found in the Vedic era in the Ishtis named Darsha and Purnamasa. These Ishtis are the basis for all other types of Yajnas. Therefore, the recitation of Pravar occurs in them. The purpose of this recitation is at the moment when after reciting the Samedheni riks, which kindle the Yajna fire, the Adhvaryu offers Aajya (ghee) into that fire. Its implied meaning is that Pravar is a prayer to kindle the fire in the Yajna. Later, Pravar was also called 'Arsheya' – meaning related to the Rishi (Rigveda 9/97/51). The well-known ancestors of Rishi Shonak are called Pravar among Maithil Brahmins, meaning the composers of the hymns of the Rigveda are the Pravars. Among Maithil Brahmins, there are two

types of Pravar families – Tripravar and Panchaprar. The gotra whose three ancestors composed hymns of the Rigveda is called Tripravar, and the gotra whose five ancestors composed hymns of the Rigveda is called Panchaprar.

Gotra and Mul:

1. Shandilya – Dirghosh (Dighwe),
 Sarisab, Mahua, Parvapalli
 (Pawauli), Khandabala, Gangoli,
 Yamusham, Karian, Mohari, Sajhual,
 Madar, Pandoli, Jajiwal, Dahibhat,
 Tilay, Mahab, Simmual,
 Singhashram, Sodarpur, Kadiya,
 Allari, Hoiyar, Talhanpur, Parisara,
 Parasra, Virnam, Uttampur,
 Kodariya, Chhatiman, Barewa,
 Machheal, Gangaur, Bhaur,
 Budhaura, Brahmapura, Koair,
 Kerhiwar, Ganguaal, Ghosiyam,
 Chhatauni, Bhiguwal, Nanauti,

Tapanpur.

2. Vatsa – Palli (Pali), Hariamb,
Tisuri, Raudh, Takwal, Ghusaut,
Jajiwal, Pahaddi, Jallaki (Jalai),
Bhandwal, Koaiyar, Kerhiwar,
Nanor, Dadar, Karamha, Budhwal,
Madar, Lahi, Sauni, Sakauna,
Phanandah, Mohari, Banthwal,
Tisaut, Baruali, Pandrauli, Baheradi,
Baraiwa, Alay, Bhandarisamay,
Babhaniyam, Uchati, Tapanpur,
Bithual, Narwal, Chitrapalli,
Jarhatiya, Ratwal, Brahmapura,
Sarauni.

3. Kashyap – Oini, Khauwal,
Sankaradhi, Jagati, Darihara,
Mandar, Valiyas, Pachaut, Katai,
Satlakha, Pandua, Malich, Merandi,
Bhaduval, Pakaliya, Budhwal,
Pibhuyi, Mauri, Bhutahari, Chhadan,
Visphi, Thariya, Dosti, Bhareha,
Kusumbal, Narwal, Lagurdah.

4. Savarna – Sondpur, Panichobh,

Bareba, Nandor, Merandi.

5. Parashar – Naraun, Surgan,
Sakuri, Suiri, Sammual, Pihwal,
Nadam, Maheshari, Sakarahon,
Soini, Tilay, Bareba.

6. Bharadwaj – Ekahara,
Vilvapanchak (Belaunch), Deyam,
Kaligam, Bhutahari, Godhar,
Godhuli.

7. Katyayan – Kujauli, Nanauti,
Jallaki, Vatikam.

8. Alambukaksha – Basam, Katai,
Brahmapura.

9. Garga – Basaha, Basam,
Brahmapura, Suraaur, Budhaur,
Uraur.

10. Kaushik – Nikhuti.

11. Krishnatreya – Lohana, Busavan,
Podauni.

12. Maudgalya – Ratwal, Malich,

Dirghosh, Kapinjal, Jallaki.

13. Gautam – Brahmapura,
Untimpur, Koaiyar.

14. Vashishtha – Kothua.

15. Kaundilya – Ekahara, Paraun.

16. Jatukarna – Devahar.

17. Tandi – Katai.

18. Vishnuvridhhi – Busavan.

19. Upamanyu.

20. Kapil.

Shrotriya Brahmins are arranged in eight categories, and Yogya and Vanshaj in fifteen categories. There are 185 Panjis, of which 32 Panjis are Shrotriya and 153 Panjis are Yogya and Vanshaj.

In Varna Ratnakara, out of 72 Rajput

clans, 64 are described, in which Baes and Pamar are repeated. Elsewhere, 36 Rajput clans are described. Twenty names are discussed earlier. In Vidyapati's *Likhanavali*, which was probably written during his stay in Nepal, Chandela and Chauhan are described. There were two branches of Gahanvar or Gandhavariya Rajputs of Mithila in Mithila, Bhith Bhagwanpur and Panchmahala (Saharsa, Purnia). Gandhavariya, Pamar, Vishevar, Kanchiwal, Chauhan etc. are among the important Rajputs of Mithila. But Gandhavariya is among the important ones in Mithila and even now they are found from Madhubani to Saharsa-Purnia.

The following are approximately 62 clans described in Varna Ratnakara's Rajput clan description.

Somavansha, Suryavansha, Doda,
Chausi, Chola, Sen, Pal, Yadav,
Pamar, Nand, Nikumbh,
Pushpabhuti, Shringar, Araham,
Gupajharjhar, Suruki, Shikhar,
Bayekwar, Ganhwar, Surawar,
Meda, Mahar, Vata, Kula,
Kachhawah, Vayesh, Karamba,
Heyana, Chhewark, Chhuriyij,
Bhond, Bhim, Vinha, Pundiryan,
Chauhan, Chhind, Chhikor,
Chandela, Chanuki, Kanchiwal,
Ranchakant, Mundaut, Bikaut,
Gulhaut, Changel, Chhahela, Bhati,
Manadatta, Singhavirabhahma,
Khati, Raghuvansh, Panihar,
Surabhanch, Gumat, Gandhar,
Vardhan, Vahhom, Vishishth, Gutiya,
Bhadra, Khurasam, Vahattari etc.
Even now in the Gangetic diara,
'Banaut' (exchange of girls in
marriage) happens between Rajputs
and Yadavs, and there is much
closeness between the two.
Nowadays, the Panji is extinct among

Rajputs, but to avoid that, they also practice 'Bari' (for marriage), like marrying by leaving the village of the father's maternal side.

The description of those living in the mountains and those living in the plains is also in Varna Ratnakara. Janaka Raja's 'Virud' seems to be made from 'Jan' (tribe).

Earlier, everyone used to keep their own records of their ancestors and marital relations. Harisinghdev ji started an institution for this purpose. Gunakar Jha was appointed for Maithil Brahmins, Shankardutt for Karna Kayasthas, and Vijaydutt for Kshatriyas for this purpose initially. Harasinghdev's Panji had a scientific basis and was purely a record of genealogical identity. All Brahmins, Kayasthas, and Kshatriyas

were equally included in their respective caste Panjis. But during the time of Maharaja Madhav Singh, the branch Panji (Shakha Panji) began, and divisions like Shrotriya etc. started, along with considerations of high and low status based on hierarchy, leading to social evils.

Among Karna Kayasthas, there is one gotra, Kashyap. The Utedh is done only according to the Mul; they are called middle-class householders.

Gotra can generally be known from the Mul. There are some exceptions too. For example: Brahmapura Mul, Kashyap/Gautam/Vatsa/Vashishtha. (7 types)

Karamha – Shandilya (Gaul branch)/
all others are Vatsa Gotri. Marriage is

possible between both Karamhas.

Shrotriya people are also called Pubari Par (eastern side) and the rest Pachbari Par (western side). The Panji of Shrotriyas is divided into Chaupala (categories). Shrotriya Panji is called Laukita. There are a total of 8 Chaupal categories. There are 32 Panjis. Panji and Pani are descending. Over time, due to marital relations with lower families, the higher categories cease to exist. The first and second categories have ceased for this reason.

The remaining Brahmins are called Pachbari Par. There are 15 categories in this. There are 153 Panjis. They are addressed by name, like Narpati Jha Panji, etc. In the Pachbari Par, Panjis above the current Mahadev Jha have become almost unavailable.

Due to the influence of time, the Panji became extinct among Kshatriyas, and therefore they leave the entire village, so that there is no hindrance in the Siddhanta.

Utedh – Before writing the Siddhanta, the rights of the groom and bride's sides are examined. 5-10 years before the girl's marriage, the girl's father gets a 'rights garland' (Adhikar Mala) prepared from the Panjekar, which contains a list of potential and available grooms. The Panjekar prepares the Utedh for this. The full introduction (Yavato Parichay) of 6 ancestors from the paternal line and 5 ancestors from the maternal line of both the groom and bride's sides is given. Yavato Parichay means the Utedh of 32 Muls, which is useful in checking

rights. Any girl or boy is in the sixth position from 16 individuals in the maternal or paternal ancestral line. If any of these 16 individuals falls within the sixth position on the groom's paternal side, then there is no marital right between that girl and boy. If that 16th or any individual falls on the maternal side (of the groom), then the right exists. But in this, it also has to be seen that the groom and girl are not of the same Gotra and same Pravara. It also has to be seen that the girl is not a descendant of the brother of the groom's stepmother.

The Darbhanga ruler Madhav Singh ordered the creation of branch books (Shakha Pranayan Pustak). Before this, the original Panjis were made uniformly. Now, separate branch Panjis (Shakha Panji) started being made for the original (Soti), eligible

(Jog), and Panjibaddha.

Gotra Panji contains all gotras and their ancient origins. Patra Panji has been in practice for about 500 years. In this, mention of the original village (Mulgram) began.

Dushan Panji contains mentions of the degradation that occurred in the lineage. Its discussion becomes possible much later, so that the concerned lineage could survive its ill effects.

Utedh Panji provides knowledge of the termination of sapinda relations – mention of six ancestors is found. Only in the Rasadh-Arariya Panji are women's names mentioned in the Panji.

****Marital Right Decision:****

Rule 1. Any girl or boy is in the sixth position from their 16 ancestors (combining paternal and maternal lines) – these are called Chhathi (the sixth ones).

This Chhathi is determined as follows:

1. The girl's (aged great-great-grandfather's) great-great-grandfather's paternal grandfather – First Chhathi
2. The girl's (aged paternal grandfather's father-in-law) great-great-grandfather's maternal grandfather – Second Chhathi
3. The girl's paternal grandfather's maternal grandfather's father – Third Chhathi
4. The girl's paternal grandfather's

maternal grandfather's father-in-law
– Fourth Chhathi

5. The girl's paternal grandmother's
great-great-grandfather – Fifth
Chhathi

6. The girl's father's maternal
grandfather's maternal grandfather
– Sixth Chhathi

7. The girl's paternal grandmother's
great-maternal grandfather –
Seventh Chhathi

8. The girl's paternal grandmother's
maternal-maternal grandfather –
Eighth Chhathi

9. The girl's maternal grandfather's
great-great-grandfather – Ninth
Chhathi

10. The girl's great-maternal
grandfather's maternal grandfather
– Tenth Chhathi

11. The girl's maternal grandfather's

great-maternal grandfather –
Eleventh Chhathi

12. The girl's maternal grandfather's
maternal-maternal grandfather –
Twelfth Chhathi

13. The girl's maternal
grandmother's great-great-
grandfather – Thirteenth Chhathi

14. The girl's maternal
grandmother's paternal maternal
grandfather – Fourteenth Chhathi

15. The girl's maternal
grandmother's great-maternal
grandfather – Fifteenth Chhathi

16. The girl's maternal
grandmother's maternal maternal
grandfather – Sixteenth Chhathi

All the above Chhathis have equal
importance. If any of these Chhathis
appears on the groom's paternal

side, then there is no marital right between that groom and girl. If that Chhathi appears in the groom's maternal line, then the right exists. The above rule applies equally to the groom and the girl. Just as it is said for the groom, "मातृतः पंचमी त्यक्त्वा पितृतः सप्तमी भजेत्" (renouncing the fifth from the mother's side, he should marry the seventh from the father's side), similarly it is said for the girl, "असपिण्डा च या मातुः – असपिण्डा च या पितुः सा प्रशस्ता द्विजातीनां दार कर्मणि मैथुने" (a girl who is not a sapinda on the mother's side and not a sapinda on the father's side is praised for marriage and conjugal rites for the twice-born).

Rule 2. The groom and girl must not have the same Gotra.

Rule 3. The groom and girl must not have the same Pravar.

Rule 4. The girl must not be a descendant of the brother of the

groom's stepmother.

(Quoting Manusmriti and other Sanskrit verses, meaning explained in the text.)

Here it is also observed that all these scientific perspectives remain intact only when the evils of child marriage and polygamy do not intervene. Then sometimes, on one hand, father-in-law and son-in-law become related, and on the other hand, brothers-in-law (Sadhu) become related. And here the Panjikar becomes helpless because, according to the rules, such irregular marriages become scripturally sanctioned.

****Specialty of Shakha Panji:****
Shakha Panji is an unprecedented book. Such a book is not found in any country, sect, or class in the world.

Although it is a book of a specific class, this kind of book can be initiated for any sect or class. Mithila is unique in that a web of introductions has been created here for over 1000 years. For example, the complete introduction of Kavi Kokil Vidyapati Thakur, from the mention of his ancestors 7 generations prior to the present descendants of Vidyapati, including all details (education, titles, specialties, change of profession, maternal lineage) is found. Such introductions are found not only for Vidyapati but for all Maithil Brahmins. Based on this kind of information, the period of various scholar Brahmins can also be determined.

Now that complete introductions have been compiled in the Panji books for many generations, why is there branch recitation (Shakha

Vachan) only for the three categories like Shrotriya etc., and not for the so-called Jaibar (even though introductions are available)? What does it mean? There have been many stages in the form of compiling lineage introductions, first from the Smritis, later (in Kumaril Bhatta's time as Samuh Lekhya). Again in the current form (by Panjikars) during the time of Mithilesh Maharaja Madhav Singh (1760 AD), some pleasure-seeking people, through their flattery, got the branch books (Shakha Pustak) created by the Panjikars on the king's orders. For the sake of practice, parrot-like repetition began. Initially, there was only the main root book, which was sufficient for determining marital rights. The format of Utedh proves this fact, and the words of Dharmashastra confirm it. When the concept of a Panjikaar did not exist, Dharmashastra scholars used to

determine, based on the lineage introduction provided by the person concerned, whether they had the right or not. Did they think differently from the Utedh format? Were they acting against religion?

Therefore, Panjikars should abandon the idea of oppressing society with the burden of their ignorance and follow the words of the sages with all their might, not their own made-up formulas. Every girl or boy is in the sixth position from certain individuals; all those Chhathis have equal authority, only the direction is given to look – paternal line or maternal line. No Chhathi has special privileges from the words of scripture. Then what is the meaning of saying that if the girl belongs to a certain Mulgram, and that is also the Mul and Mulgram of the groom's maternal grandfather, then maternal

sapindya ceases in the eighth generation (after the seventh generation)? This is a completely mistaken notion. There is no verse in Dharmashastra to support this. If there is, then refute the written opinion with evidence (not with talk). The provision given by the revered M.M.P. Mahesh Thakur, "संप्रमी त्यजेत... भजेत..", society gladly accepted, so it is valid. Finally, there is also the issue that the persons associated with Panji work are appointed to protect the religion of society. Whatever honorarium or remuneration they receive, they should accept it as a gift (Prasad), not that for going from one place to another for five similar tasks, they should take travel expenses from all five people, and without receiving money in advance, they should not check the rights. This is gross immorality. Panjikars are protectors of culture, not greedy businessmen.

It is the duty of the Panjekar to prepare disciples in time for future generations – earning money should not be the goal. If they are not careful, then in time society should be informed of this situation, and society will prepare new individuals to carry out the responsibility. As soon as the concerned person is absent, the need for a new Panjekar arises. Who will think about that?

Thus, if this were not in the script prevalent among the majority of people, how would the world become acquainted with Mithila's uniqueness? From the 10th century AD until the time of India's independence, there was no means of transportation in Mithila. Despite being skilled in the art of writing, due to the lack of writing materials, palm leaves were used instead of paper, which were not easily

available. Yet, the Maithil society, to protect its literature, somehow procured palm leaves, dried them in the shade, cut and trimmed leaves of about 1.5 to 2 spans (haath) in size. They made a circular hole about 1.5 angul within the left part of the leaf, passed a thin string or thick cotton thread through it, and tied a knot. This book would consist of 500-600 leaves, with wooden covers on both sides, and the book would be tied with a knot in the string. It was difficult to bind. Books were made in the Brahmapatri style. Every guru would tell his disciple – the book speaks. They used wild herbs for ink and a reed pen (Khaddahi) for writing. "Protect from water, protect from oil, protect from tight binding" – this very formula was also taught to Panjik students. Despite facing these difficulties, the people associated with Panji work, in a deprived society, without worrying

about their dependents, enduring sun, rain, and the monsoon, traveling from village to village, collected the desired details. Again, coming to the village from time to time, they would edit it – this work continued for hundreds of years. They received cooperation and respect from society, but they never received any kind of royal patronage. They performed the editing work flawlessly. Unlike today's government employees, who, sitting at home enjoying salary and facilities, fill in something or other in the identity column of citizenship certificates, the information compiled by Panjikars has been fulfilling multifaceted purposes of society – such as determining sapindata for periods of impurity (Ashouch), for marital consent, knowledge of ancestors' names for offering funeral balls (Pindadaan), checking rights for marriage,

educational and geographical knowledge of the lineage, etc., etc. Keeping all the above books in view, the work of transliteration was completed continuously for 7 years. Determining the numbers in the Panji book is very important; the branch book (Shakha Pustak) is based on numbers. If this work gets messed up, understand that the situation would be like being washed away in a stream. The link with the ancient Panji would be broken. Therefore, so that the transcription (Ankan) would not be incorrect, the writing work was done with concentration.

Mention of events like: the king adding the title 'Taskar' to the name of Panjikars for beating them when they married off a girl dedicated to the king to someone else to protect their Panji; the birth of the logician

Gangesha Upadhyaya 5 years after his father's death; the marriage of Mahesh Thakur's sister to the prince of Cooch Behar; the mention of the title Kavisheshwar along with Jyotirishwar (before his manuscript was obtained from the Nepal library); besides this, details of many Dhaka poets and poets named Sekhar; details of marriages with Muslims and cobblers and the lack of any prejudice in society towards the offspring from them – all these are described in the Panji. Details of Aryabhatta – (27) (34/08) Mahipati: Mangrauni Mandair sai Pitambar sut Damu dau Mandr sai Beeji Trinayanabhatta: E suto Aryabhatta: E suto Udayabhatta: E suto Vijayabhatta E suto Sulocanabhat (Sunayanabhatta) E suto Bhatta E suto Dharmajatimishra E suto Dharajati Mishra E suto Brahmajari Mishra E suto Tripurajati Mishra E suto Vighujati Mishra E suto

Ajayasingha: E suto Vijaysingha: E
 suto Aadivarah: E suto Mahovarah: E
 suto Duryodhana Singh: E suto
 Sodhara Jayasingharkacharyastras
 Mahastra Vidya Parangata
 Mahamahopadhyaya: Narasimha:.

584 (A). Chaitanya Mahaprabhu:
 Ramapati Upadhyaya of Karamha
 Tarauni Mul. He went to Bengal,
 Chaitanya Mahaprabhu was his
 disciple. Gangesha Upadhyaya –
 Chhadan Chhadan, Udayanacharya –
 Nanaotivar Nanaoti (Karian,
 Samastipur), Mahesh Thakur's
 maternal side Rud Jha in Kashyap
 Gotri Sakradhi Mul. Ramapati
 Upadhyaya (famous Vishnupuri,
 Paramanandpuri) of Vatsa Gotri
 Karamha Mul, Tarauni village, guru
 of Chaitanya. In the time of Ballal
 Sen, Halayudha and Lakshmanasen-
 Udyotkara. M.M. Trinayan Bhatta
 (approx. 400 AD), the Beeji of
 Mandar Mul, is 12 generations
 before M.M. Halayudha of

Singhashram Mul (page 18). Halayudha and Narasimha were contemporaries. 12 generations before Narasimha (Mandar Mul) is Trinayan Bhatta.

Maithil Panji suggests that there were two different Vidyapatis: The Adikavi Vidyapati of Maithili was probably contemporary to Jyotirishwar (approx. 1275-1350), who is mentioned in Jyotirishwar's work. He was possibly the son of Shri Mahesh Thakur of the Barber caste of Bisphi village. In the parallel tradition of Bidapat Nach, dance-drama of Vidyapati lyrics (predating Jyotirishwar) is performed. The second is Mahakavi Vidyapati Thakur (1350-1435). He was Vishayavar, Bisphi-Kashyap (courtier of King Shivasimha) and a Sanskrit and Avahatta writer. Timeless compositions in large numbers

including Kirtilata, Kirtipataka, Purush Pareeksha, Goraksha Vijaya, Likhanavali, etc. He is different from the Adikavi Vidyapati of Maithili (pre-Jyotirishwar).

In my opinion, this is not a matter of dispute but a subject for research. Work should definitely be done on this. It needs to be viewed rising above caste and class sentiments.

****Some Official and Social Terminology Available in Panji-Prabandh:****

Details of some official and social terminology available in Panji-Prabandh were compiled after exploring JPG images of 11,000 Panji palm leaves. It is necessary to include some of them here:

Sandhivigrahika,
Dharmadhyarakshaka,
Chaturvedadhyavayi, Yajnika,
Parnagarika, Varttika, Mahamattaka,
Bhandavagarika,
Sthadanantabharika,
Rajavallabharajavallibha,
Sthanantarika, Raula, Khanatari,
Kapani, Phulahara, Sandhi
Vigrahika, Purohita, Kula
Kshetroparyaka, Avasthika,
Kantakoddharakaraka, Jyotishvid,
Padankita, Pandita Raj Padankita,
Upaya Karaka, Ekantarika, from
Mandar – Vaidika Vishvanambhara,
from Sihauri Mandar – Purandra
suta Vaidika Gonu Jha, Narabali.
from Ghanashyam suta Vaidika
Ganapati Mishra, from Khauwal –
Kamala suta M. Gunakara Vaidika
Pitamvara, from Sihauli Mandamar –
Vaidika Vishvambhara suta M.
Kulapati M. Chaturbhuja, from
Darihara – Raghunatha suta M.
Madhava Vaidika Vireshvara, from

Darihara – M. Madhava suta Vaidika
 Bhagiratha, from Darihara –
 Kirtinatha suta Vaidika Dhananatha,
 from Darihara – Rama suta Vaidika
 Bhagiratha, from Sakradhi – Nakatu
 suta Vaidika Chandarakta, from
 Mandar – Vai. Acchapati suta Vaidika
 Jivapati, from Sodarpur – Vaidika
 Hori, from Darihara – Rama ddau.
 Vibhakara sutau Vaidika
 Vishvasambhara, from Sakradhi –
 Harishvara ddau. Vaidika
 Vishvambhara, from Mandor –
 Vaidika Vishvambhalara, Kamala
 suto Krishnadeva Maho Gunakarau
 (109/04) Vaidika (109/04)
 Pitamvara:, from Mandar – Bhairava
 ddau. Vaidika Vidhupra, Vaidika
 Yudanatha:, Vaidika Vireshvara,
 Vaidika Bhagiratha, Vaidika
 Vishnatha, Vaidika Ghananatha,
 Vaidika Chandra Datta, from
 Darihara – Vaidika Jivanatha,
 Vaidika Acchadapati, Vaidika
 Baladeva, from Darihara – Vaidika

Jivanatha dauhitra dau, Vaidika
Kalaghara, from Darihara – Rama
suta Vaidika Bhagiratha dau, Vaidika
Raja Maho Gosai, Vaidika Mukundi,
Bechu suto Vaiyakarana
Dharanighara Vaidika
Vanakhandidakau, Vaidika
Nityanandai, Vaidika Soni, Vaidika
Badrinatha, Vaidika Vidhu, from
Hariam – Muktinatha ddau. Vaidika
Tulanandaka, Vaidika Chandra Datta
Premadatta, from Sodarpur –
Chitradhara ddau. Vaidika
Dhananatha, Vaidika
Amodayanatha, Vaidika Hemaganda,
Vaidika Ganapati Vaidika
Kulapatiko, Vaidika Gunapati suta
Ankhi Vaidika Kalaghara, Aparā
Vaidika Kulamani, Vaidika Adinatha,
Vaidika Kulapati, Jyo., Vaiyakarana
Bhairavadatta, Vaiyakarana
Amritanatha Buddhinatha
Devanatha, Vaiyakarana Rama:,
Vaiyakarana Radhanatha,
Vaiyakarana Parameshvara, from

Sarisab – Jhotaha ddau. Vaiyakarana
 Nandipati, Vaiyakarana
 Gaurishankara, Vaiyakarana Rajje,,
 from Khandabala – Bhagiratha ddau.
 Maha Vaiyakarana Dinabandhup
 suta Vaiya. Jivanatha, Vaiyakarana
 Matinatha, from Sakuripali –
 Vaiyakarana Shridatta suta Vai.
 Manabharana dau, Vaiyakarana
 Rupanatha, Vaiyakarana Matinatha:,
 Kavi Hemannatha suta Vaiyakarana
 Mahinatha, Vaiyakarana Ramanatha
 Umanatha:, Vaiyakarana Khushihala,
 Vaiyakarana Bhavanidatta
 Devidatta, Vaiyakarana Hemannatha
 dau, Vaiyakarana Harinatha:,
 Vaiyakarana Riddhi, Chhakkanana
 Vaiyakarana, Maho Chandaishvara
 suto Vaiyakarana (276/07)
 Shivashvarara:, from Khauwal –
 Vaiyakarana Modanatha dau,
 Vaiyakarana (201/04) Modanatha,
 Vaiyakarana Gopala:, Vaiyakarana
 Meghanadau, Vaiyakarana Chanlala:,
 Vaiyakarana Ishvaridatta suto,

Vaiyakarana Harshanatha dau,
Vaiyakarana (04/06) Brajagopala
Jayagopala Vaiyakarana
Pradhyapaka (Calcutta University
Maithili Dept.).

****Conclusion:****

The meaning is that Gajendra ji's work is historical and a Herculean effort to preserve the knowledge tradition. This should be called not a book but a grand project. This project is a living proof of how one person can make an impossible task possible with his dedication and firm resolve. In my opinion, no kind of criticism or review can be written on this work, at least I am not qualified to write a review of it. So what can be done on this? Future work can be done on this. Based on this, the Tirhuta script can be widely

promoted and propagated; Maithili can get a place in UNESCO's list of rare intangible languages. While working on it, the weak aspects can be improved. Women can be given their proper place. Keeping the language of the Panji as Tirhuta, respecting the three-language formula, it can be converted into Devanagari and Roman scripts through Unicode. It should also be remembered that the Panji is a social system; seeking excessive scientificity in it can question its authenticity. By making it timely, people of other castes and communities of Mithila can also accept it.

****Editorial Note:**** Readers can see the original quotes given in this article by visiting the link to "Dushan Panji" edited by Gajendra Thakur and reading it:

https://ia601402.us.archive.org/31/items/maithili_202209/Gajendra_Thakur_Dooshan_Panji_The_Black_Book.pdf

****Panji of Mithila and Shri Gajendra Thakur's Efforts towards its Preservation****

****By Bhavanath Jha****

There is widespread misconception among the general public about what the Panji of Mithila is. People other than Brahmins, Kshatriyas, and Kayasthas had no connection with the Panji, so they never discussed it. The Gandhavar Kshatriyas of Mithila had preserved their own Panji, which is a pure genealogy, so they had no concern with the

broader Panji under discussion. The remaining communities were the Brahmins and Kayasthas, who did have their Panjis and had an interest in their application. They applied it as much as possible in marital relations, thereby preserving the limits prescribed by Dharmashastra. In Brahmin society, due to the availability of comprehensive Panjis for the Srotريا group and a particular insistence on tradition, they used it effectively to finalize marital alliances. Other Brahmin groups, under specific circumstances, gradually moved away from it.

In such a situation, when socialist thinkers of Mithila and a group of literature enthusiasts leaned towards progressive writing, opposition to bourgeois values, tradition, and Brahminism became vocal, along

with opposition to the Mithila Panji. In an attempt to create a void, the knowledge traditions of Mithila, preserved in Sanskrit, Prakrit, and other languages, were also opposed, and along with this, the Panji suffered. The irony was that no one had any interest in finding out what the Panji actually was.

Since society was unaware of the original form of the Panji, a certain class opposed it by giving it names like Harisinghdevi System, Panji System, etc. They opposed the faith in its tradition. It was claimed that this Panji was inertia, that it fostered high-low distinctions, was a cause of restrictions in marriage, was a social shackle, fostered elitism, and so on – many such allegations were floated. But no one stated what the Panji actually was.

The Panji suffered damage from this movement. In the name of progressivism, many people turned away from it and stopped visiting the Panjikars. The Panjikars, who used to dedicate their valuable time to updating it, saw their income decline and they too became disinterested. Their family members took up other professions, and the process of updating stopped. The Saurath Sabha was ruined. Another reason for its decline was the end of the patronage of the Darbhanga Raj. Only the Panjikars of the Srotriya class remained ready to update it.

Naturally, due to decreased usage, the Panji manuscripts ended up stored in bundles and were also destroyed due to indifference. I have seen the vast collection of Panjekar

Keertinath Jha of Koilkhand being destroyed.

In such circumstances, if someone has come forward and done concrete work for the preservation of the Panji, it is Gajendra Thakur. Through the magazine 'Videha', he got the Panji of the renowned 19th-century Panjekar Modanand Jha of Purnia scanned, transcribed, and made it public. A glimpse of what the Panji is was revealed. Gajendra Thakur ji published three massive volumes related to the Panji, in which the transcription of the Panji was published in both Tirhuta and Devanagari scripts:

1. Genome Mapping (450 AD to 2009 AD) – Mithila's Panji Prabandha (Year 2009)

2. Genealogical Mapping (450 AD to 2009 AD) – Mithila's Panji Prabandha - Part-2 (Year 2012)
3. Dushan Panji (Year 2023)

In addition to these three volumes, he also made digital copies of the manuscripts available for public use on the Videha website. If I may use a slightly miraculous analogy here, it can be said that just as Hanuman ji brought the entire Sanjeevani mountain, he similarly made available to society whatever he found for further research. Among his PDFs of manuscripts, there are many documents that had no direct connection with the Panji, but since the renowned Panjikaar had kept them in his volumes, he got them scanned page by page and made the material available for researchers. This includes materials like the

inscriptions of the Basaithi temple, lists of scholars from Mithila who were proficient in mantra and yantra, etc., all written in Modanand Jha's own hand. This tradition existed everywhere in India. Most of the ancient manuscripts we receive follow this tradition. The scribes used to write:

*Yādrśaṃ pustakaṃ dr̥ṣṭaṃ tādrśaṃ
likhitaṃ mayā |

Yadi śuddhamaśuddhaṃ vā mama
doṣo na diyatām || *

Meaning: I have written as I found the manuscript. Whether it is correct or incorrect, the fault is not mine. This is the ideal form of preservation I understand. Whatever he found, in whatever condition, Gajendra Thakur made it available to society.

Thus, through the Genome Mapping volumes, a part of the Panji has been preserved, and many doors for future research have been opened. Now that the actual sample of the Panji is before us, it has become clear that the Panji is merely a record of names and villages, which does not in any way present high-low distinctions or restrictions. The misconception spread by socialists that the Panji determines where marital alliances should be made is entirely opposite; in fact, the Panji is applied to determine where marital alliances should **not** be made. Things like Shreni, Panji (in the sense of categories within a community) are not the Panji; they are entirely different things. The Panji is merely a record providing 10-12 pieces of information, not a system or management.

Today, if anyone wishes to read it, they can easily understand that the Mithila Panji is a written form of a high-quality identity, which has many purposes. The use of the term 'Panji-system' is the biggest misconception. No kind of 'system' is the subject of the Panji; that is the subject of Dharmashastra. There are separate texts like Vachaspati's "Sambandha-Vichara" based on this system, written considering the Panji as the basis. In the Bihar Research Society, Patna, there is a fragmented and untitled manuscript (Bundle No. 37, Manuscript No. 91) consisting of only 9 folios, which contains names of individuals and declares relationships between two families as proper or improper using the words 'Kṣemyaḥ' and 'Akṣemyaḥ'. It is possible that more texts of this kind were written. Publication of this text is necessary.

In the 16th century, Raghudev says, "Pañji-prabandhaḥ kṛtaḥ". The meaning of the word 'Prabandha' is a text compiled systematically, but interpreting 'Prabandha' in the sense of 'management' – the English 'management' – is also a misconception. This confusion has spread due to misunderstanding the meaning of the word Prabandha and the mentality of the word Vyavastha. A third misconception has also spread: that the Panji determines limits in marriage, i.e., it permits marriages within certain families. Whereas the reality is that the Panji merely provides a decision on blood relations, indicating in which families a particular groom's marriage cannot take place. The Panji determines the limits of one's own kin (swajan). Under no circumstances would a Maithil wish to hear criticism for accepting

marital relations like brother-sister, uncle-niece, maternal uncle-niece, etc. The author of these lines has often experienced that sometimes a relationship with a person is not consciously remembered, but upon checking, it turns out to be a very close relation. Therefore, it is advisable to conduct marital matters only after the Panjekar has determined that the families are not related (aswajan). In this way, the noble tradition of the Panji suffered great harm due to many misconceptions surrounding it. The credit for breaking these misconceptions and presenting the Mithila Panji in its true form should be given to Gajendra ji.

However, looking at the overall picture, the Panji compiled by him is a negligible part of the entire Panji of Mithila. Also, its upper limit can be

considered up to 1900 AD. I find this in the sources I am connected with. My great-grandfather's name appears here, but it has not been updated since. My opinion in this context is: it would be inappropriate to discuss what does not exist; discussion should be about what exists. And I have already said that Gajendra ji, like Hanuman, has uprooted and brought the Sanjeevani mountain. Now our task is to make it as useful as possible and to search for further material.

Nevertheless, the preservation of whatever part of the authentic Panji Gajendra Thakur ji has done remains significant. Currently, anyone who is making efforts in this direction or planning to do so should first see this, take an example, and proceed further.

Finally, there are some suggestions: the Panji contains many roots (mula) and branches (shakha). All of them should be divided under headings and subheadings, page numbers should be given, and a scientific Table of Contents should be prepared. In many places, the names of branches are embedded within the Panji text; they need to be clarified. The main reason for the incomprehensibility of the thick volumes is the lack of proper formatting. The font size for headings, subheadings, and text has not been managed well. Having the text in Mithilakshar in a single column has made the volumes even more cumbersome. I don't know why A4 size was chosen for creating the PDF files; the document size could have been maintained. If that had been done, the blank spaces on

each folio would have remained, making it easier for people like me to read the original Mithilakshar manuscript. Writing numbers by hand on the palm-leaf pages also creates much confusion. It was necessary to arrange the palm leaves in proper sequential order before scanning, which wasn't done, so a coherent manuscript of any material is not available. The current PDF of the manuscript is so large that looking for the original manuscript within it seems nearly impossible. I spent a whole day trying to locate the original manuscript but couldn't find it.

Anyway, now that everything is available in digital form, everything is possible again. The volumes can be prepared again. It is said that the cutting of pure gold jewelry should not be questioned. That's true;

Gajendra Thakur ji has excavated gold and given it to society. For that, he deserves endless thanks!

**** Courtesy-Murti
Shri Gajendra
Babu ****

**** By Bhimnath
Jha ****

The initiator of my acquaintance with Shri Gajendra Thakur ji was Nachiketa ji. He told me on the

phone that Gajendra Thakur had published his new play 'No Entry: Ma Pravis' (2008). You can get it from him. I don't remember whether he gave me Gajendra Babu's contact number or gave him my number. But within ten days, ten copies arrived by registered parcel. The accompanying letter said that these should reach the hands of discerning readers. To be honest, the presentation of the book didn't attract me. However, I thanked him for providing it and asked how the payment should be sent? He said – I won't take payment, give them like that.

This is how our acquaintance grew. He said that he had once come to my place. But I don't recall, or perhaps he couldn't meet me. Gradually, I understood that he was 'Ganesha' in writing books and 'Vishwakarma' in

publishing them. Parcels started arriving thick and fast. I am a 'slow' reader, he is a 'fast' writer. I couldn't keep up. The books were of various types and genres. Some were quite thick – five hundred pages, seven hundred pages. 'Kurukshetram Antarmank', 'Genome Mapping'. And many issues of the 'Videha' magazine, plus compilations of them. A special attraction of that magazine was a large album of pictures of Maithili writers. A Maithili-English Dictionary. Some books by other authors too, like Shri Jagdish Prasad Mandal ji, but most were self-written. Two or three illustrated children's story collections written by his wife, Shrimati Preeti Thakur, also printed and published.

Among these, I must specially mention two works. First, I will name the novel 'Sahasrabadhani' in

Braille script. A very thick book. Everyone knows that the Braille script was invented for those visually impaired brothers and sisters who are divyaang. A school for them runs at the local 'Poor Home'. When I passed by that way, I would see them regularly, but I had no comment on their study-teaching style. Gajendra Babu had understood this by visiting that school. So he sent me two copies of 'Sahasrabadhani' prepared in that script – one for that school, one for me.

I took the book to the school. The Headmaster and all the teachers were astonished to learn that a book in Braille script was now available in Maithili too, considering it a matter of great fortune. They said this event was beyond my imagination. Moreover, it wasn't an ordinary book – a novel with over two

hundred pages. Who is this noble soul? I told them whatever I knew about Gajendra Babu's personality and work. They said they wouldn't accept the book like that. They would hold a meeting at school the next day, invite officials and office bearers of the institution, and receive it in that ceremony. This is not only a new gift for us but also a special event for Maithili literature. So it happened. The next morning, a formal ceremony was organized, and this work for Maithili literature was highly praised, and Gajendra Babu was also commended for it.

I presented the second copy to the Maithili Department of Lalit Narayan Mithila University, where I had previously worked, so that future students and researchers could see this book (in fact, a tome) in this script and feel proud.

The second book is 'Genome Mapping'. This volume on Panji Prabandha is printed in hardbound. The entire volume is printed in parallel in Devanagari and Mithilakshar scripts. The Mithilakshar is also in typeset form. It has been transcribed and printed from original palm-leaf manuscripts dating from 450 AD to 2009 AD. In this context, I feel like mentioning an interesting point. While Gajendra Babu was preparing this work, one night around 9:00-9:30 PM, the phone rang persistently. He said – Right now, the pages of your lineage are being turned. Saying this, he read out the lineage from top to bottom in a flowing manner. He asked if it was correct or not. There was no question of it being incorrect. Then he said – Now write down the names of the next generation. I wrote down the names of both my sons. After that, I

asked him – Did you find women's names anywhere? He said – No, I haven't, but why do you ask? I said – I have three daughters. Then he said – Write down all their names. So what if they are not there? They should be there. We are starting from here. I wrote down the names of all three daughters. When he sent the printed copy, I saw my five children's names printed in both Devanagari and Mithilakshar scripts. I don't know what he did in others' lineages, but in my children's lineage, all three daughters' names are also there. How necessary it was for women's names to be in the Panji – today's sociologists know this. The credit for starting this goes to Shri Gajendra Thakur ji, and future researching sociologists will surely highlight this fact someday. I will always remain grateful to him for this.

I also had the good fortune to visit his Delhi residence once and partake of a wonderful meal. The incident is like this. I had to go to Delhi for some work for five-six days. Revered Amresh Pathak ji, friend Devendra Jha ji, good friend Prem Shankar Singh ji, and one or two other companions (I don't remember their names) were also there. We were all staying in the same hotel. I didn't know that Prem Shankar ji was his friend. He called him and gave him the hotel's address, and he came to meet us the next evening. While talking with him, he also found out about me and my companions. He immediately came to my room. I was startled, taken aback. He invited all of us for dinner the next night. We went to his place by two cars. There was an extraordinarily lavish meal. I saw all the rooms filled with books. Everyone received gifts of thick

bundles of books. He had already sent me some. All of us were overwhelmed by the graciousness of his ideal family.

After that, he came to Kabilpur (Laheriasarai) for the 'Sagar Rati Deep Jarae' program, along with many new books, and also got them released there. We met there and sat together for a long time. Since then, my eyes have been deprived of his physical presence, but hearing praise of his renown from many mouths, both my ears are continuously satisfied.

Editor's Note – Besides the Poor Home in Darbhanga, the All India Confederation of the Blind has also kept the novel 'Sahasrabadhani' for sale.

****Gajendra Thakur:
Preserver of Mithila's
Heritage****

****By Dr. Shiv Kumar
Mishra****

Mithila's cultural heritage is world-famous, but there is a complete lack of its preservers. One hears praise of its rich traditions everywhere, but it is unfortunate for Mithila that mere discussion of preservation meets

with disinterest. The result of this indifference towards its rich traditions and heritage is that countless heritages have been and are being destroyed. In such a situation, there are some personalities in Maithil society who have taken up the task of preserving their traditions and cultural assets as a mission in their lives. Among them, the work that Gajendra Thakur has done and is doing is no ordinary task. Evaluating his work requires special study and hard work. Nevertheless, based on my experience, this article attempts to present some thoughts regarding the efforts being made by Gajendra Thakur for the preservation of Mithila's heritage and its scripts.

Mithila's rare heritage is the Panji-Prabandha. Its scripts are Tirhuta and Kaithi. The work Gajendra

Thakur has done for the preservation of the rare Panji is commendable. In a society where the tendency is to hide away the assets of one's ancestors, and also to let them rot away in hiding, bringing out the rare manuscripts, scanning them, and publishing them after composing them in the Tirhuta script is an extraordinary feat. For publishing the unique work titled Genome Mapping, all those who helped him, including Panjiar Vidyanand Jha, are worthy of reverence. Whenever any effort is made towards preserving the Panji, the first obstacle is that complete cooperation from the Panjiars is not forthcoming. There is some truth in this misconception, but Gajendra ji solved this problem and took help from Vidyanand Jha Panjiar – for that, he deserves congratulations.

For the preservation of Mithila's manuscripts and Panjis, the internationally reputed institution, the Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH), New Delhi, had a plan in 2021 to spend 15 lakh rupees. Experts were sent from Lucknow for this, but the owners of those manuscripts and Panjis were determined to keep their assets hidden away. Among these, the custodians of both governmental and social heritages were determined to destroy them. After much persuasion and requests, the officials of the government institutions agreed. Only two Panjiars, Prof. Jayanand Mishra (Nanour, Madhubani) and Sanjeev Prabhakar (Darbhanga), got some of their Panji volumes preserved. Programs were organized in Saurath, Darbhanga, and Lalganj to create awareness for the preservation of manuscripts and Panjis, yet no one budged an inch. Some even mocked

the preservation work. Those who continue their work despite such social obstinacy are certainly worthy of reverence.

Gajendra Thakur says that the Panjis of Brahmins are written in both Tirhuta and Kaithi scripts. Naturally, for publishing the Panji, he had to compose in both Tirhuta and Kaithi, and therefore had to learn both scripts. These two scripts have become extinct in Maithil society. There is no provision for teaching them in universities. The script that was once included in the curriculum gradually disappeared. However, some institutions are definitely making efforts to restore them. Through this campaign, many individuals have learned the Tirhuta script.

Evidence of the Tirhuta script in Mithila is found from nearly 1500 years ago. This script was used in the ancient Nalanda and Vikramshila universities, as evidenced by film negatives of manuscripts from that time. Mahapandit Rahul Sankrityayan brought photos of some such manuscripts written on palm leaves from Tibet. These volumes were preserved in Tibetan monasteries. In the 7th-8th centuries, scholars of Nalanda Mahavihara had taken these volumes to Tibet for propagating Buddhism. From 1929 to 1938, Rahul ji brought photos of this invaluable asset from Tibet, got film negatives and glass negatives made, and they were kept in the Bihar and Orissa Research Society, Patna. Some of these volumes were published by the present-day Bihar Research Society, Patna, and the Kashi Prasad Jaiswal Research Institute, Patna. The process for publishing the remaining

volumes is underway by the Central Institute of Higher Tibetan Studies, Sarnath. A memorandum of understanding has been signed between the Vice-Chancellor of that institute and the author of this article for this work.

The inscriptions found during the Vikramshila excavation are also in the Tirhuta script. Their time can be considered the 9th-10th centuries. Additionally, as many statue inscriptions as there are in Bihar and Jharkhand, whether on Buddhist images or those related to Sanatan Dharma, all bear Tirhuta inscriptions. The most statue inscriptions have been found in Lakhisarai. Besides this, inscriptions engraved in the Tirhuta script are found in all museums of Bihar. Apart from Jyotirishwar's Varnaratnakara and various works of Vidyapati,

works of other scholars are also in the Tirhuta script. Many manuscripts are preserved in the National Archives of Nepal. There are manuscripts of approximately 5,500 texts at Kameshwar Singh Darbhanga Sanskrit University, and about 12,500 texts at the Mithila Research Institute, Darbhanga. Most of these are in Tirhuta. Besides Tirhuta, manuscripts in Kaithi, Newari, Bengali, and other scripts are also preserved. But there is a complete lack of readers for these assets.

Discussing the Tirhuta script, many Maithil scholars, before anyone else, declare the Darbhanga Maharaja Lakshmishwar Singh as an opponent of Tirhuta and a patron of Devanagari. But about fifty years before Lakshmishwar Singh's birth, Mr. Francis Buchanan, in his

Bhagalpur Report, states that the Pandits of Mithila use Devanagari texts. He also discusses inscriptions in the Tirhuta script. In this situation, choosing the easier path, the use of Devanagari here has been prevalent for two hundred years.

Gajendra Thakur is also preserving the Kaithi script, just like Tirhuta. At a time when there is a complete lack of Kaithi readers, Thakur ji has done a great service by bringing the Panjis in Kaithi script before everyone. By using Kaithi along with Tirhuta in his magazine, he proves that these two scripts are unique heritages of Mithila.

Evidence of the Kaithi script in Mithila is found from the 9th-10th centuries onwards. Along with Tirhuta inscriptions, a Kaithi

inscription was also found at the Kamaladitya Sthan located at Andharatharhi in Madhubani district. The Vishnu image inscription in Tirhuta, engraved by Shridhar Das, is still placed in the temple. Another inscription was found a few years ago, inscribed on the pedestal of the Buddhist goddess Tara. It bears a Buddhist mantra, which Buddhists used to recite on the occasion of consecrating the image. This Kaithi script inscription was buried in the soil during the construction of a new temple; it was inscribed with "Magardhaj Yogi 700". At the famous archaeological site of Shrinagar village in Ghailarh block of Madhepura district, there is also an inscription bearing "Magardhaj Yogi 100". Its time can also be considered the 9th-10th centuries. Apart from this, outside Mithila, this inscription has also been found in the Baidyanath temple in

Kaimur district. The term "Magardhaj Yogi" inscribed in Kaithi script has been used in many places like Bhagalpur in Uttar Pradesh, Chittorgarh in Rajasthan, Cuttack in Odisha, Kelod, Markand and Churil in Maharashtra, Potenar, Bhoramdev, Kankali, Devarganv and Pali in Chhattisgarh, and Khajuraho, Bilhari, Hindoria, Narsinghpur, Mandhata, Amarkantak, Chandrehe and Narayanpur in Madhya Pradesh. In the famous Maithili text Varnaratnakara, during the description of the eighty-four Siddhas, the word "Magardhaj" is mentioned. Later, land records began to be written in this script. According to renowned linguist Dr. Subhadra Jha, those who did not know Sanskrit and Tirhuta used Kaithi. Manuscripts in this script are collected in many places, including the Chandradhari Museum, Darbhanga, and the Ramchandra

Shahi Museum, Muzaffarpur.

Meanwhile, Tilka Manjhi Bhagalpur University has started a six-month certificate course for training in Kaithi and Tirhuta. Besides Bhagalpur, programs for training in Tirhuta and Kaithi scripts have been organized many times in Darbhanga and Patna over the last ten years. The Central Institute of Indian Languages, Mysore, the Maithili Sahitya Sansthan, Patna, INTACH, and the Bhagalpur Museum have played a major role in this work. Thousands of people have received training in both scripts through these programs.

In addition to Tirhuta and Kaithi scripts, Gajendra Thakur ji is also preserving the Newari script. The largest repository of Newari script

manuscripts is in Nepal. Many Maithili texts are written in the Newari script. Internationally renowned linguist Prof. Ramawatar Yadav has edited many Newari script texts. Newari script manuscripts are also preserved in other parts of the country and world, including Mithila. There is also a lack of readers for this script. But Gajendra Thakur ji continues to work through this script. He also uses it in his magazines. So naturally, his major contribution lies in the preservation of this script as well. Gajendra Thakur ji is primarily a heritage activist who is always engaged in the work of preserving and promoting Mithila's heritage. Besides the Tirhuta, Kaithi, and Newari scripts of Mithila, he is also always enterprising in preserving Devanagari, Braille, Nastaliq (the Urdu script), and others. The many texts uploaded through his website

are of particular benefit to researchers of Mithila's script, language, literature, history, and culture. It is my wish that Gajendra Thakur ji lives a long and healthy life and continues to preserve such heritages.

****On Gajendra Thakur's
Maithili-English, English-
Maithili, and English-Maithili
Computer Dictionaries****

****By Uday Narayan Singh**
'Nachiketa' **

When Samuel Johnson's 'A Dictionary of the English Language' (1755) was published, only then did English scholars and students truly receive a reliable and refined lexicon in their own language. Most earlier English attempts lacked seriousness. Robert Cawdrey's 1604 lexicon, named 'A Table Alphabeticall', and several other works and their imitations were not up to the standard consonant with the tradition of lexicography in the rest of Europe. However, earlier bilingual lexicons, which included foreign French, Italian, or Latin words with English definitions, were better than these, and Richard Mulcaster's 1592 glossary can be cited as an example. These were still not equivalent to Arabic lexicons compiled between

the 8th and 14th centuries, especially those created for general use, like 'Lisan al-Arab' (13th century).

English, as we see it today, is a relatively recent phenomenon in the global history of language, possibly only slightly older than Maithili. This is because when the oldest available Maithili text was being written by Jyotirishwar, English was still in its infancy. The oldest lexicons in the West were created in the Akkadian Empire, containing Sumerian-Akkadian word lists (found in Ebla, modern Syria), dating to around 2300 BCE. But the most ancient Greek lexicon, by Apollonius the Sophist (1st century CE), lists Homeric word definitions and meanings, providing an example. The 2nd millennium BCE Ur-ra-hu-bullu word list is another example of early lexicography, comparable to the

Chinese tradition of the 3rd century. Early Japanese attempts like the 682 CE Nihon Shoki glossary of Chinese characters and the oldest extant Japanese lexicon, the Tenrei Bansho Meigi (835 CE), were also significant efforts. In India, the preservation of Vedic literature was the greatest catalyst for grammatical and lexicographical composition. In the Paninian and other grammatical traditions of Sanskrit, it was a common and fundamental task to break Vedic sentences into words and words into roots and suffixes. In this process, lexical structure and phonetic-structural principles also developed alongside the phonological system. It is believed that Yaska wrote a commentary named Nirukta on the Nighantu (700 BCE), which is the oldest known work today, and this tradition continued into the Pali tradition. He arranged all lexical material

according to synonyms and homonyms. The most popular work in classical Sanskrit is Amarasimha's Amarakosha (6th century CE). The Catalogus Catalogorum lists at least 40 commentaries on the Amarakosha alone, showing its importance and popularity in ancient India. Other lexicons of this type, composed more or less based on the Amarakosha, include (reference Malhar Kulkarni – TDIL website):

1. Namamalika by Bhoja (11th c.), 2. Siddhashabdanrava by Sahajakirti (17th c.), 3. Sharadiyakhyanamamala by Harshakirti (17th c.), 4. Paryayashabdaratna by Dhananjaya Bhatta, 5. Kosha Kalpataru, 6. Nanartharatnamala – Irugapa Dandanayaka (14th c.), 7. Nanarthamanjari by Raghava, 8. Dharanikosha by Dharanidasa (12th c.), 9. Shivakosha by Shivadatta Mishra, 10. Ekarthanamamala-

Dvyaksharanamamala by Saubhari,
11. Paramanandiyanamamala by
Makarandadasa.

The first modern-era Sanskrit lexicon applying Western principles was the Sanskrit-English Dictionary compiled by Professor H.H. Wilson and published in 1813 CE. Two Indian lexicons followed: Pt. Raja Radhakanta Dev's Shabdakalpadruma and Pt. Tarakanta Vachaspati's Vachaspatyam.

In my view, lexicography, the science or art of dictionary compiling, i.e., writing and editing dictionaries for various purposes, is as important as theoretical lexicography. The word 'lexicography' as a term came into use around 1680 CE, while the word 'dictionary' came into use in the

English language in 1526 CE, as per the Merriam-Webster Dictionary. We are told that a dictionary should include:

1. A reference source in print or electronic form containing words arranged alphabetically, including their form, pronunciation, function, etymology, meaning, and syntax, and ideally illustrative usage.
2. A reference book containing an alphabetical list of words and names important to a particular subject, along with discussion of their meanings and applications.
3. A reference book giving equivalent words in another language for words in one language.
4. A computationally processed list (data lexicon or lexical database) that can be used as a reference for information retrieval or word processing.

The application of this extraordinary and time-consuming art necessarily includes the following tasks:

- * Determining the user and their needs.
- * Determining the number of lexical items based on general vocabulary and deciding on a defined limited scope.
- * Deciding on the presentation of definitions and descriptions.
- * Determining the information transmission and conceptual framework concerning the dictionary.
- * Determining various parts of the dictionary and selecting the appropriate structure for data collection and display (e.g., cover structure, categorization,

classification, transmission, and cross-referencing).

- * Selecting headwords and added words – for creating technical terms.

- * Identifying synonyms and collocations.

- * Indicating pronunciation using the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) and Bloch & Trager symbols.

- * Incorporating elegant and region/dialect-specific forms.

- * Selecting synonymous terms for the target language in multilingual dictionaries.

- * Providing entry points and other facilities for users in both print and electronic dictionaries.

The Gangetic plains of Bihar and the Himalayan foothill Terai region of

Nepal together constitute the linguistic and cultural region of Maithili and Mithila, discussed long ago in 1908 CE by George Abraham Grierson, although he primarily focused on the Mithila region within India. This region has undergone many changes and boundary redeterminations. In the early 20th century, Grierson considered the Maithili language area to encompass the entire districts of Darbhanga and Bhagalpur. Additionally, he identified Maithili as the language spoken by the majority in Muzaffarpur, Munger, Purnia, and the Santhal Parganas. But today, parts of these have become part of Jharkhand state.

It would also be appropriate to mention here that in the process of state recognition, only 5 out of 17 districts (namely Bhagalpur, Purnia,

Saharsa, Darbhanga, and Muzaffarpur) have been commonly designated as the Maithili-speaking area of Bihar. Paul Brass (1974), in his extensive study of the Maithili movement in *Language, Religion, and Politics in North India*, treated it as a generally defined geographical region. In the 1980s, after the division of Bihar into 31 districts, in a project report (titled 'The Maithili Language Movement in North Bihar: A Sociolinguistic Investigation') jointly prepared by myself, N. Rajaram, and Pradeep Kumar Bose, we concluded that out of 31, these 10 districts should be considered the Maithili-speaking area: Bhagalpur, Katihar, Purnia, Saharsa, Madhubani, Darbhanga, Samastipur, Sitamarhi, Muzaffarpur, and Vaishali. This change in geographical boundaries has resulted from natural changes (the Kosi river has changed its course seven times in 200

years) and district reorganization.

It would be a major challenge for anyone attempting to create a monumental lexicon of Maithili, as Gajendra Thakur has done. This situation is further complicated because Maithili's vocabulary is partially or largely influenced by possibly 12 other languages spoken in this cultural region. A description of these nearly 12 other languages is also noteworthy. Maithili's neighbors include Bhojpuri and Magahi, and Hindi is superposed over all, spoken by people of all three language groups. But Bihar is a multilingual state, and Nepali and Bengali speakers can also be seen here in abundance. Furthermore, since Maithili speakers are also numerous in the Jharkhand region, it's important to understand that Oraon, Mundari, Ho, Birhor, Dhangar,

Santhali, and numerically fewer speakers of Austric language groups also reside among them. Although many Muslims in the Mithila region claim Maithili as their mother tongue, many also declare themselves Urdu speakers. Among all these languages, only four have received constitutional recognition – Hindi, Urdu, Bengali, and Nepali (Santhali was added later). In my view, Maithili syntax has been influenced from various angles, including by the Austric language group. But at the lexical level, adaptation has occurred from limited sources like Urdu, Hindi, Bhojpuri, and Magahi. The lexicon assimilates indigenous vocabulary along with foreign (deshaj) terms. This is because, in my opinion, at most 25-30% of speakers are monolingual in Maithili. The rest are also proficient in other languages. Maithili speakers residing on the

western border of Bihar also speak Bhojpuri, and those in Patna-Ranchi-Gaya-Munger areas know Magahi, in addition to Hindi. But a very small percentage, less than 3-5%, are Maithils who can also speak English effectively. However, the influx of English words into Maithili is as extensive as in any other modern Indian language (MIL).

****Many might express this doubt: how many people would actually benefit from an effort like Gajendra ji's?*** Although the official statistics of Maithili speakers have not remained stable, a detailed description of this fact is necessary. The population figures are not realistic, for example, the 2001 CE population figure: (1,21,79,122). There is certainly reason to distrust this. When we see the population figures taken at ten-year intervals

concerning the number of Maithili speakers, there is a great deal of variation. This is clear from the comparison of the increase and decrease in population figures at ten-year intervals since 1891:

1901-11: +3.12%; 1911-21: -0.77%;
1921-31: +7.68%; 1931-41: +9.13%;
1941-51: census not conducted; 1951-61: +22.35%; 1961-71: +20.89%; 1971-81: +24.19%

Logically, the number of Maithili speakers has actually increased steadily. Some indication can be given based on my estimate, which reaches approximately 4 crore. In 1891, Grierson (1908) estimated the number of Maithili speakers to be 92,89,376. In contrast, the 1961 census figure gives it as 49,82,615. Certainly, the 1961 census figure is not realistic. However, Grierson's (1909) population estimate, based on his survey conducted in 1891 CE, is

not accepted by everyone. At the beginning of the present century, Maithili was spoken in the following areas:-

(i) the entire districts of Darbhanga and Bhagalpur; (ii) 6/7 parts of Muzaffarpur; (iii) 1/2 part of Munger; (iv) 2/3 parts of Purnia; (v) 4/5 parts of the Santhal Parganas, whose inhabitants are described as Hindi speakers in the census figures.

In 1816 CE, the linguistic area towards the north was permanently annexed into Nepal by the Nepalese monarchy. To arrive at the number of language speakers, an additional 14% of Nepal's population must be added. Paul Brass (1974:64-6) makes calculations (population year 1901 CE) based on various documents available since 1885 CE and arrives at a figure of 1,65,65,477. This

calculation is based on Grierson's estimate and the population growth in Bihar over the subsequent 8 decades. Based on the 1981 census figures, adding the number of Maithils spread outside the Mithila region, and considering the population of 10 districts (out of 31), my colleagues and I reached a figure of 2,29,72,807 in the mid-1980s (Singh, Rajaram & Bose 1985). In my view, considering decadal population growth, this number has reached up to 4 crore, and therefore, many people would benefit from this monumental lexicographical effort. It is generally believed that Maithili is spoken by the Brahmins of the Mithila region. This was an earlier misconception spread to prove it as a dialect of Hindi, mainly with the aim of increasing the official numbers of Hindi speakers. But looking at the caste structure of North Bihar, the population figures related to Maithili

tell a true story. The relatively higher numbers of Maithili that appeared in census reports can only be explained by the fact that although in many areas of Maithili-speaking districts, up to 46.84% Muslims and up to 31.06% Hindus reside, the support that came for Maithili would not have been possible without a large number of them declaring Maithili as their mother tongue.

A survey of language use in Mithila can show that although the use of the language in formal domains has decreased, it is also true that its literary productivity and achievements are coming to the fore much better at the all-India level today compared to what it was 20 years ago. Madhubani painting or Mithila art has now become renowned throughout India and has reached the global market. Only if

the new generation of Maithili speakers decides to move away from their cultural and linguistic identity would it face any danger. In my view, not receiving constitutional recognition indirectly proved to be a boon for Maithili because it strengthened literary and cultural activities. It had already left behind many constitutionally recognized languages, like Manipuri, Konkani, Nepali, and even Sindhi. And now that it is in the Eighth Schedule, it should receive all the official and other types of protection it is entitled to. It should also receive support from its users, who are now taking advantage of modern tools such as online magazines, e-lexicons, convenient mobile dictionaries, and automated question-answer systems, etc. At that level, the Maithili-English, English-Maithili, and English-Maithili Computer Dictionaries, available in both online and print versions,

constitute an important contribution by the compiler. Gajendra Thakur, Nagendra Kumar Jha, and Panjikar Vidyanand Jha are especially worthy of praise by the Maithili-speaking community and translators/scholars of other languages. It is true that Maithili lexicography developed very late, long after the efforts of M.M. Dinabandhu Jha, and now significant works have come before us, such as the Kalyani Kosha by Pt. Govinda Jha or the Brihat Maithili Shabdkosh by Jayakant Mishra, the Mithila Shabda Kalpadruma by Matinath Mishra 'Matang', or Alice Davis's Basic Colloquial Maithili: A Maithili-Nepali-English Vocabulary. The Concise Maithili Dictionary and the Bilingual Maithili Dictionary conceived by the Maithili Academy are still awaited. The Longman-CIIL Basic English-English-Maithili dictionary, conceived by the National Translation Mission (see

www.ntm.org.in) and based on corpora, would also be an interesting product. But after all is said and done, the importance of this work will be realized over time.

(From Videha's repository, published on the WordPress version of Videha on July 19, 2009)

****Shri Gajendra Thakur:
In My View****

****By Pranav Kumar
Jha****

In the contemporary Maithili literary and publishing world, where stage-managed shows and mutual admiration clubs predominate. As

soon as someone writes something, they are filled with eagerness to hear applause and get busy arranging stage-shows and in the desire to obtain awards and positions connected to Maithili literature. In that context, Gajendra Thakur can be called a name in the Maithili literary and publishing world who, even after doing work running into hundreds of thousands of pages in the field of Maithili literature, history writing, translation, and publishing, shows not a trace of the aforementioned tendency. People who follow the Maithili literary scene never see Shri Gajendra Thakur on platforms organizing literary events, etc. At least, I have not seen him. So, to tell the truth, although I have been acquainted with Gajendra Thakur ji through Videha since 2008, even today my acquaintance with Gajendra Thakur ji is limited only to his literary and

publishing work; apart from that, I do not know much else about him. In today's social media age, when all kinds of people are engaged in a race to influence and disseminate their personality, activities, and work through social media, Gajendra ji is silently engaged in the service of Maithili literature without expecting any return. In this regard, it is no exaggeration to say that he is the 'Videha' (one without a body) of the contemporary Maithili literary world, engaged in the service of Maithili literature without showing his physical self.

Around the year 2007-08, when I was a student and my interest in the field of Maithili literature was newly developing, the availability of Maithili books and magazines was not easy at that time. In Delhi's libraries, finding such books and

magazines was unimaginable. Some books would appear at the stalls of NBT, Sahitya Akademi, etc., at book fairs. Around that time, while searching in my computer lab, I came across a digital Maithili e-journal called "Videha" (<http://www.videha.co.in/>). At that time, when India was in the initial phase of entering the digital age and the internet world, seeing this, I felt a great sense of wonder mixed with happiness that since 2008, such a Maithili e-journal was being published, which even had an ISSN number (ISSN 2229-547X). The ISSN number is a number issued by a body of the United Nations to provide international identification to newspapers, magazines, and journals published in print and digital media. Those times were not like today. Registering a domain and continuously publishing a journal on a server at that time must certainly

have been a big task. At that time, access to computers and the internet was not so widespread, but whenever I got the chance, I would download and take the e-copy of Videha to read. Later, I learned that this journal was edited by someone named Gajendra Thakur ji. I used to think that this person must be some big name in the contemporary Maithili literary world, but I had not seen him on any other platform (at that time, my acquaintance with the contemporary Maithili literary world was very limited). Today, in the sixteenth year of "Videha", 374 issues have been published so far. Publishing any digital journal continuously for such a long time (that too in Maithili, without any advertisements) can be considered a great achievement. In fact, even today, whatever acquaintance I have with Gajendra Thakur ji is through Videha. Apart from his literary and

publishing work, even today I do not know anything particularly else about him, and it is possible that many readers like me might be in the same situation.

But despite staying away from glamour, fanfare, and gossip, he has done so much in the field of Maithili literary history and publishing that it cannot be ignored or forgotten. It would not be an exaggeration to say that the work he has done through writing, translation, and publishing is such that even if an ordinary reader like me keeps reading it for a lifetime, it may not be finished. Through Videha, he has also made available digitally many famous and forgotten books of numerous Maithili writers for ordinary readers. The work of bringing books/articles/poems/ghazals, etc., of many writers like Shefalika

Verma, Jagdish Chandra Mandal, Ashish Anchinhaar, Sharadindu Chaudhary, Arvind Thakur, Kalikant Jha "Buch", Kailash Kumar Mishra, Gangesh Gunjan, Dr. Shashidhar Kumar, Jagdish Chandra Thakur Anil, etc., to ordinary readers like me, and the work of taking interest in that, was done by Videha, for which credit can be given to Gajendra Thakur ji. Not only this, through Videha, a platform was also provided for hundreds of established and non-established, full-time and part-time writers to publish their work. In my opinion, this scheme under the editorship of Shri Gajendra Thakur ji has been very successful in connecting newcomers with Maithili literature and planting the seed of creativity in them. Today, there are many established writers who started their writing activities through Videha and have now made a place for themselves in the Maithili

literary world. Seeing this scheme of Videha and the articles, stories, poems, etc., of various kinds of writers published in its new issues, I also got inspiration, and it happened that I should also write something in Maithili. Before this, I used to write a little in Hindi and English as a hobby, but I had no inclination to write in Maithili. I had never formally studied Maithili either. My hand was completely unsteady in grammar and spelling, yet inspired by Videha, I wrote my first story in Maithili, "Teshar Pran". It was published in the January 2015 issue. This gave me a lot of satisfaction and inspiration, after which I occasionally started writing stories, poems, and articles in Maithili. Many of them have been published from time to time in issues of Videha. Certainly, even if it is a modest contribution, the credit for giving birth to the creativity within me to write in Maithili also goes to

the Videha team and Gajendra Thakur.

His pioneering role in providing academic material for Maithili literature through Videha can also be seen. I remember when I was searching for question papers, etc., of Maithili for the BPSC, this material was first available to me through Videha. Later, the compilation of study material for BPSC/UPSC/UGC, etc., examinations was also done by Shri Gajendra Thakur through Videha and made available to the general public. I don't have any data or examples, but I hope that this material certainly benefited some of those preparing. In the field of translation, the creation of Maithili-English dictionaries, and the translation of materials from English, Hindi, and other Indian language literature have also been

done by Gajendra Thakur, for which there is a long list. All this is available in the repository of "Videha" (www.videha.co.in).

An unforgettable work done by him on Maithili history and tradition is making the Maithili marriage Panjis public under the name Genome Mapping. He has transcribed into Devanagari more than ten thousand inscriptions written on palm leaves and birch bark in the Tirhuta script of the Maithili language. These Panjis are genetic records of the Maithil Brahmin community of the Mithila region, and in them, more than a hundred inter-caste marriages are also described in written form. Written evidence of personalities considered mythical until now has become available for the first time in this, and by making it available in Devanagari, he has completed a good

effort to reach a vast audience. Contribution to the development of Tirhuta and Kaithi Unicode for the internet, development of internet and computer terminology in the Maithili language, role in the establishment of Maithili Wikipedia, contribution to Google Maithili Translate, and the vast compilation and publication of dictionaries, etc., are some of Gajendra ji's achievements that are milestones in the history and digitization of Maithili literature.

In Videha's repository, there are also books and other materials for children and grandchildren. That is, efforts are made to provide material to generate interest in Maithili in the new generation. Shri Ashish Anchinhaar's children's ghazals, Dr. Shashidhar Kumar's children's poems connected to nature and

science are very entertaining and informative. Through Videha, Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur ji made an effort to teach children English from Maithili or Maithili from English through illustrated Maithili translations of some English fairy stories. I read some stories – the translations are very good. I think this experiment can be more useful for children. Most children usually make the journey from Maithili to English or English to Maithili through the medium of Hindi; books like these can be helpful for young children in villages to learn English directly from Maithili, and for children growing up abroad or in English-speaking societies to learn Maithili directly from English.

What more shall I write? Whatever information and experience I have about Gajendra Thakur is through

Videha, and I am sharing that with
the readers.

****Mithila Mihir and
Videha Web
Magazine****

****By Lakshman Jha
'Sagar'****

Undoubtedly, Mithila Mihir has carved a distinct place for itself in the history of Maithili journalism. There is no dispute about this. Whatever great literary figures Maithili literature had (from the sixth to the ninth decade) are the contribution of Mithila Mihir. In this field, from Acharya Ramanath Jha, Umanath Jha, Tantranath Jha,

Ishanath Jha, Harimohan Jha, Kiran ji, Madhup ji, Suman ji, Amar ji, Ramdev Jha, Govind Jha to RCS Prasad Singh, Radhakrishna Chaudhary, Manipadma ji, Lalit, Rajkamal, Mayanand Mishra, onwards to Prabhas Kumar Chaudhary, Keertinarayan Mishra, Jeevakant, Mohan Bhardwaj, Rajmohan Jha, Dhumketu, Dr. Dharendra, Gangesh Gunjan, Markandey Pravasi, Gaurikant Chaudhary Kant, Gopesh ji, Subhash Chandra Yadav, Mahaprakash, Sukant Som, and after them Vibhuti Anand, Kedar Kanan, Pradeep Bihari, Ashok, Shailendra Anand, Raj, Ramesh, Narayan ji etc., are all products of Mithila Mihir.

Mihir had its own standard writing style which contemporary Maithili literary figures adopted, except for Ramanath Jha and Dr. Subhadra Jha.

Mihir was a weekly magazine sustained by the Darbhanga Raj, so it did not print society's grievances. Mihir's annual story issues, Phagua issues, and other special issues were very popular among readers and earned fame. Mihir's chief editor was Sudhanshu Kumar Chaudhary. Associate editing work was done by Upendra Thakur Mohan, Hansraj, Bhimnath Jha, Sharadindu Chaudhary, etc. Mihir had blacklisted certain struggling writers (like Ramlochan Thakur, Narendra, Agnipushpa, Kunal, etc.). It would not print their work. Mihir was printed as a weekly and later as a daily newspaper. To encourage women's writing, it printed a column called *Strigan Samaj*. To promote children's literature, there was a wide column called *Nena Bhutaka Chaupari*. It also printed summarized news about Maithili activities. It published reader's

reactions. I can say that it was a golden period for the creation of Maithili literature.

In the present time, Videha magazine, which can also be called a web portal or e-magazine, is entirely a personal endeavor, but its scope is as wide as Mithila Mihir's. Videha also has its own set of rules and methods. Its way of working is unique. First and foremost, the notable thing is that Videha is punctual. Consistency is its destiny. Arranging content in such a short time, editing it on time, and uploading it on its web portal for its readers is no small feat. Videha contains literature from almost all genres. A long time ago, Videha used to come out in print form as well (sadeha). The beginning of *Bihani Katha* (Morning Story) perhaps started, but the real development

happened with Videha. The proclamation that Ghazal has its own grammar came from Videha.

Videha accepts the spelling of all writers, which is why writers of every ideology and every capability have entry into it. And just as Mithila Mihir created a vast class of writers and readers, similarly Videha also has its own class of writers and readers.

Videha has a unique project of bringing out issues focused on living writers, thereby providing them with a proper evaluation. The Videha team also does the important work of uploading the complete literary works of some writers onto Google. I can say, and with complete conviction, that in the coming time, people's attraction and interest in

Videha will only increase further.

Videha's editor foresaw 25 years ago that the paperless age was coming. People would become so busy that they wouldn't be able to find time to look at books, magazines, and newspapers. A severe crisis of communication would arise in society. But before this lack of communication could set in, Videha, through the medium of the internet, became a digital bridge for the Maithil society in India and abroad. The Videha magazine did not let any communication void arise in the literary society, and appearing regularly every fortnight, for the past 25 years, people sitting at home have been gaining information and knowledge on subjects like literature, science, games, commerce, etc., on their laptops and smartphones, and that too free of cost. In today's time,

when the whole world is being influenced and benefited by the communication revolution, the intellectual society of our Mithila is not deprived, and the entire credit for that goes to all the team members of Videha. And that's as it should be.

The editor of Videha is Shri Gajendra Thakur.

His village is Mehath, near Jhanjharpur, a village whose soil has the capacity to give birth to one brilliant Maithil son after another. This village is home to the late Gopalji Jha 'Gopesh' and his wife, the late Prabhavati Jha. Shri Sitaram Jha 'Saras' and Shri Ramesh (both brothers) are from this village. Playwright Shri Anand Kumar Jha and Ayushman Abhinav Anand (father and son) are also from this

village. The first Dalit autobiographer in Maithili, Sandeep Kumar Safi, is also from this village. All these literary figures are famous and renowned in their respective fields through their writing.

Shri Gajendra Thakur ji, distinct from all of them, has created a rare and innovative world for Maithili literature. A world that no poet could imagine in their poetry. No story writer, novelist, or playwright could weave into their narrative craft. Could not create a suitable space for their protagonist's performance. Could not express their thoughts before society through any other genre of Maithili literature. Thakur ji built such a world.

If he had wished, he could have earned more name and fame in

Maithili literature on the strength of his own literary works. He would have been honored with many awards and accolades. He would have garnered much praise. But, Thakur ji never had that hunger, nor will he in the future. His concern from the very beginning was to do something concrete for his mother tongue Maithili, something that the contemporary society and literary figures were not aware of. He was the first Maithil youth to come forward from the national capital, Delhi, to digitize the Maithili language. Through this medium, starting from the first decade of this century, he created a website named the fortnightly e-magazine Videha <http://videha.co.in/> and began running it, which continues to be published uninterrupted even now. That too in 11 scripts. And Maithili stands equal to other languages of the world. Any Maithili lover

residing in any corner of the world can see their Maithili magazine simply by turning on the internet on their smartphone and pressing the given link with their finger. Thakur ji is providing this facility to all of us for free. Earlier, the Videha magazine used to come in print form (sadeha) too, and that too without any prior notice. Thicker than the Ramayana, without any payment.

He is a senior officer in some Government of India undertaking in Delhi. He finds time from his busy life and remains prompt and alert for the service of Maithili. I have no hesitation or doubt in saying that among the few important personalities who have done immense service for Maithili from their homes, Gajendra ji is also one such son of Mithila. Dozens of his books on various issues and genres

are published and praised. This includes books in English as well as Maithili.

He is a washed-clean person. His thinking is transparent. He neither does any shady work himself nor expects it from others. He has hated the system and process of the Sahitya Akademi awards for a long time, not just recently. See his resilience: he started giving a parallel literary award of his own. I don't know of any others, but that award was given to Ramlochan Thakur ji (now late). Gajendra Thakur ji created a platform for neglected writers. He identified them. Writers whose works were not published by the main Maithili magazines, their works started getting published in Videha. I say with complete fearlessness and awareness that today, Shri Jagdish Prasad Mandal ji,

who is a reputed literary figure in Maithili literature, is a gift of Videha.

Along with this, I would like to add some more names like Shri Rabindra Narayan Mishra, Umesh Mandal, Laldev Kamat, Pradeep Pushpa, Rajeev Ranjan Mishra, Abhilash Thakur, Manoj Karn, Ashish Anchinhaar, etc. Gajendra ji had a plan to bring out special issues focused on neglected writers, and that too during the writer's lifetime. Videha has published special issues on Arvind Thakur (which later came out as a book named 'Svatantracheta' and was well-received), Jagdish Chandra Thakur 'Anil' special issue, Ramlochan Thakur special issue, Rajanandan Lal Das special issue, Sharadindu Chaudhary special issue, story writer Ashok special issue, and Ramabharos Kapri 'Bhramar' special issue, etc.,

and all are uploaded on Videha. Not only this, Gajendra ji searched for the works of the old Maithili novelist and story writer Sushil ji and wrote *Nit Naval Sushil*.

I have not met Gajendra Thakur ji, but there was a time, between 2008 and 2012. During that time, we used to talk a lot on the phone. There used to be an exchange of ideas. I had sent him my first poetry collection *Uchari Baisu Kaua*, which was published from Guwahati in 2010. He called and said, "I speak the truth, I haven't seen a book like this in the last five-six years." It felt very good to hear that. Once, he sent me a bundle of books by post, which included his own books and two or three books by Shrimati Preeti Thakur ji. I liked one of Preeti Thakur ji's children's books very much. I thought on the phone that

this book of Preeti ji deserved a children's award. It should have been included in children's courses. It's a very useful book. But, Gajendra ji told me to drop that topic and talk about something else. Such a selfless servant of Maithili is truly an invaluable gem of Mithila.

I salute such a devotee and soldier of our Mithila and pray to Mother Amba to keep him immortal! The first Maithil youth who, 24 years ago, called the Internet 'Antarjal' and realized that such a dawn of the Government of India would come that we would be forced to live in Digital India. And the fact that this facility became available to everyone in literature so easily, for that, everyone should give their blessings and good wishes to this son of Mithila.

****Special Issues in
Maithili Magazines
(Special Reference-
Person Centric Special
Issues)****

****By Shivshankar
Srinivas****

Just as reading and understanding a creation is enjoyable, understanding a creator is also enjoyable. After we see and understand a creation, the feeling we have for that creation may not necessarily be the feeling others would have for the same creation. Roughly, even understanding one aspect, everyone forms feelings according to their own intellect. Sometimes it happens that we are unable to read and understand a creation, but upon reading an analysis from another perspective, we become delighted. In this sequence, if the analysis of various aspects of a creator's works or their life is available in one place, it becomes important in many ways. In this context, a felicitation volume or an evaluation volume can be useful, but it is not always easy or simple. The reason is that impartiality is not often seen in felicitation or evaluation volumes.

There can be exceptions, but even those are not found in felicitation volumes.

For this, a magazine is most suitable. A magazine focused on the life and literature of a single creator has a higher chance of being impartial. Behind the publication of a felicitation volume, personal devotion and the efforts of the felicitators themselves are often visible, but magazine special issues are mostly free from these things. In the Maithili language, many magazines have come out as Phagua special issues, with Mithila Mihir being a pioneer. Special issues on other specific festivals have not been seen, like in Bengali, Odia, Assamese, and other languages, where many special issues are published on the occasion of Sharadiya Navratri. Similar things are not seen in

Maithili (an exception is the *Karnamrita* magazine published from Kolkata, which used to publish its Sharadiya special issue every year). In this context, in Sarairan, Madana, village Madhubani district, Saraswati Puja committees also publish not special issues but souvenirs. Other institutions also publish souvenirs.

I don't have precise knowledge of when and which magazine focused on a literary figure was published, however, I will mention what I know. In 1968 CE, the magazine 'Aakhar' published from Calcutta came out as a special issue on Rajkamal Chaudhary after his death (19 June 1967). Its editors were Shri Keertinarayan Mishra and Shri Virendra Mallick. In 1993-94, the magazine 'Dhaar' was published in three separate issues focused on

Mantreshwar Jha, Mahaprakash, and Upendra Doshi. After that, the magazine was not published. The special feature of this magazine was that it was focused on these three living writers. During Dr. Dharendra's lifetime, in 1994, the magazine 'Sankalp' edited by Kedar Kanan published a Dharendra special issue. After the death of Prabhas Kumar Chaudhary (22 February 1998), the magazine 'Sandhan' edited by story writer Ashok was published the same year as a special issue on him. In the same year (1998), 'Pravasi' edited by Shri Akhilesh Jha was published from Allahabad. In 1999 CE, the Bharati-Mandan magazine edited by Kedar Kanan published a special issue focused on Yatri ji. After that, focused on living writers, in July-September 2001 CE, an issue of the magazine 'Antika' focused on Rajmohan Jha came out, which also

included an interview taken with Rajmohan Jha. Including Rajmohan Jha ji, there are seven special issues published in 'Antika' magazine, the list of which is as follows:

- 1) Yatri Prasang (April-June 2000 CE)
- 2) Dhumketu Prasang (July-September 2000)
- 3) Kulanand Mishra Prasang (April-June 2001)
- 4) Rajmohan Jha Prasang (July-September 2001)
- 5) Rajkamal Prasang (October 2001-March 2002)
- 6) Kiran Prasang (January-March 2007)
- 7) Harimohan Jha Prasang (July-September 2008)

In the *Karnamrita* magazine published from Kolkata under the editorship of Rajanandan Lal Das, special issues on Kiran, Babu Saheb, Pitambar Pathak, and later on Prabodh were published. But the aforementioned special issues of Karnamrita were printed after the death of the concerned person. Apart from these, other special issues may have also been published.

In terms of such person-centric special issues, the work being done by Videha magazine since 2015 is noteworthy. Noteworthy also because this magazine's special issues are focused on living writers. If a living writer sees and reads an evaluation of themselves in a magazine during their lifetime, that is greater for them than any award.

Firstly, that particular issue of the magazine is focused on their own work and life, and secondly, understanding what they have done and how it was, they can joyfully further broaden their path; such life enthusiasm is easily obtained. Therefore, I have always felt that if a special issue on a living writer is published, the likelihood of benefit to literature from that writer increases. Although after the announcement of a special issue by Videha, two or three writers have also passed away, Videha's primary objective is to publish issues focused on living writers. The special issues published so far by this magazine are as follows:

- 1) Arvind Thakur Special Issue, 01 November 2015, Issue 189
- 2) Jagdish Chandra Thakur Anil

Special Issue, 01 December 2015,
Issue 191

3) Ramlochan Thakur Special Issue,
01 April 2021, Issue 319

4) Rajanandan Lal Das Special Issue,
01 November 2021, Issue 333

5) Rabindranath Thakur Special
Issue, 15 June 2022, Issue 348

6) Kedarnath Chaudhary Special
Issue, 15 August 2022, Issue 352

7) Premlata Mishra 'Prem' Special
Issue, 01 November 2022, Issue 357

8) Sharadindu Chaudhary Special
Issue, 15 November 2022, Issue 358

9) Ashok Special Issue, 01 May 2023,
Issue 369

10) Ramabharos Kapri 'Bhramar'
Special Issue, 15 May 2023, Issue 370

11) Lakshman Jha Sagar Special

Issue (15 November 2023, Issue 382)

In addition to the list given above, Videha has published a total of 19 more special issues on various other subjects, including a Madhup special issue, a web journalism special issue, an institution special issue, etc. Also, the Ashok special issue in this list refers to the story writer Ashok special issue. This kind of work by Videha magazine is coordinated by ghazal writer Ashish Anchinhaar and edited by the magazine's editor, Gajendra Thakur. I hope that Videha magazine will continue to do this kind of work in the future.

Besides Videha, the magazine 'Navarambh' brought out a Somdev special issue in November 2019 CE under the guest editorship of story writer Ashok. After Somdev's death,

'Anjur' published from Nepal under the editorship of Ramabharos Kapri 'Bhramar' also brought out a Somdev special issue (December 2022-January 2023). The magazines I have mentioned while writing this article are only based on my current knowledge; there must certainly be more special issues beyond these, which researching scholars might mention.

Editorial Note – The original title of the presented article was 'Patrika Visheshank' (Magazine Special Issue). In my attempt to fulfill my fantasy, I changed this title. Hopefully, Srinivas ji will forgive me for this, and it might also provide some convenience to the reader in understanding. The presented article discussed the special issues on living writers published by Videha, but I could not find any article regarding

special issues published on institutions. For the information of readers, Videha had published a special issue on the Mithila Students' Union (MSU) on 01 June 2023, Issue 371. For the selection of subjects for Videha's living person special issue or institution special issue series, roughly some fixed points are followed:

- 1) About five-six months in advance, Videha informs its readers to give suggestions.
- 2) From the suggestions received, Videha selects only living writers. Institutions must also be currently active.
- 3) Among all living Maithil workers, music workers, literary figures-editors, and theatre workers-directors, the consistency between their writing/work and conduct is

observed. Six names are selected where there is the most consistency (least gap) between the writer's work and conduct.

4) Once the six names are selected, a comparison is made regarding what these six Maithil workers, music workers, literary figures-editors, theatre workers-directors, or institutions have received from society in return for their creative work or social work.

5) Those three Maithil workers, music workers, literary figures-editors, theatre workers-directors, or institutions who seem to have received the least are kept for the next stage.

6) Among these three selected living Maithil workers, music workers, literary figures-editors, theatre workers-directors, or institutions, a mutual comparison is made of their

work, objectives, etc., and,

7) Finally, Videha chooses the name and announces it at the end of the year, and tries to publish this special issue at the scheduled time. This means that the notification asking readers for suggestions concludes by April-May every year.

A question may arise: with the above rules, is a fully deserving living writer ultimately selected in time? The answer is no. Videha's readers, Videha's writers, and Videha itself – all three have their own limitations. But along with these limitations, we all have to give our best as per our capacity and create such a path for Maithili that the literature of the coming 500-600 years can find inspiration from Videha's trail. With this thought, Videha is also focusing its attention on those living writers

who are deserving but for some reason, a special issue of Videha could not be published on them. This is called Videha's "Nit Naval Series". The main points of this new idea are as follows:

1) Videha's editor, Gajendra Thakur, will write a focused critique on a particular living writer or artist, considering all available literature by that writer. The language of this book will be either Maithili or English. The first form of this book will be as an e-book, and an effort will be made to bring out a print version as well, which will depend on circumstances.

2) The selection of the writer or artist will be made by the editor according to his own interest or the interest of the Videha team.

3) Selection of such writers or artists

is possible whose every available book has been made public in PDF format through Videha. For artists, YouTube and other sites will also be acceptable.

4) Work on the selected writer or artist for this project will proceed according to the editor's time. Therefore, specifying a timeline is not possible.

The list of books published so far in the Nit Naval Series is as follows:

1) Rajdeo Mandal-Maithili Writer
(This has also been published in print form)

2) Nit Naval Subhash Chandra Yadav
(This has also been published in print form, and is also available as print-on-demand)

<https://store.pothi.com/book/गजेन्द्र-ठाकुर-नित-नवल-सुभाष-चन्द्र-यादव/>

Additionally, in the current issues of Videha, "Nit Naval Sushil" and "Nit Naval Dinesh Mishra" are also being published serially, and the book form of both will be available soon.

****Shri Gajendra Thakur
ji's Invaluable
Contribution for Maithili:
Videha e-Journal****

****Rabindra Narayan
Mishra****

When we all were children, then Mithila Mihir was very much in circulation. Along with the weekly newspaper, Mithila Mihir used to reach village to village. In this weekly magazine, which was full of various types of material, the inclusion of new and old, all kinds of creators used to happen. Their compositions used to get published. As a result, at that time, many writers developed through the courtesy of Mithila Mihir. Later, when Mithila Mihir closed down, then a big emptiness came. No such magazine could be published in Maithili. Whatever did get published, that got closed after a few days. The Videha e-journal has very successfully filled that void.

Shri Gajendra Thakur ji's vision was

always to encourage the new, new writers of Maithili. This is the reason that through the medium of Videha e-journal, many new writers/creators got a platform in Maithili, from which they can publish their compositions very easily. In writing this, I have no hesitation that today-tomorrow, in Maithili, there is no other such magazine available where, with such ease, twice a month, a creator can see their composition getting published. Not only that, without any expense, this magazine regularly reaches thousands of readers twice a month. There is no purpose in describing the specialities of Videha magazine because the thousands of readers/writers associated with it are fully aware of all this. Nevertheless, contextually, this much then must be said that through the medium of this magazine, hundreds of new writers have been created

and are being created.

For the last fourteen years, I have been in contact with Videha e-journal. In the year 2009, after the demise of respected Jayakant Babu, I had written a memoir about him. I had sent that handwritten memoir to Videha. In response to that, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji had sent me the Uninagari software, so that I could type that handwritten memoir with it and send it. I could not do that, but that Uninagari software proved very useful. Later, when Dr. Umesh Mandal ji was typing all my compositions and giving them book form, then in between, I used to take the help of this software to correct them. Initially, my five books were typed/published with Umesh ji's help. After that, my practice of typing in Uninagari became so good that later, I went on to write twenty-two

books myself directly on the laptop. In this, the Uninagari sent by Thakur ji had a great contribution. In the fact that I am able to publish books so quickly today-tomorrow, this software has a great contribution. After typing in Uninagari directly on the laptop, a lot of time, labor, and expense are saved, and the publication of the book with good quality becomes possible.

I myself have benefited greatly from Videha e-journal. For the last many years, my many compositions have been getting published in it. My autobiography, 'Bhor se Sanjh Dhari', travel episodes ('Swarg Etehi Achhi'), many stories have all been getting published in it. The serial publication of my novels, 'Namastasyai', 'Lajkotar', 'Matribhumi', 'Maharaj' kept happening in Videha for many years.

Even in the present, the serial re-publication of my novel, 'Badali Rahal Achhi Sab Kichhu', is happening in Videha. It is not that this is happening only to me. Many creators continue to get such facilities in Videha and have been getting them, among which the name of respected Jagdish Prasad Mandal ji can be taken prominently. Even now, the serial publication of his novel is happening serially in Videha.

Meanwhile, for many days, many special issues of Videha have been brought out, in which serious discussions have happened on the contribution of the litterateurs associated with Mithila and Maithili. By bringing out special issues on many such creators who could not get proper respect/prizes, Videha has done wonderful work.

As the editor of Videha, Shri Gajendra Thakur's contribution is invaluable. He has been performing his editorial duty with extreme impartiality and fearlessness. To remain continuously and regularly engaged in this work, year after year, without any expectation, is no trivial matter. Thousands of Maithili-speaking people residing in the country and abroad are benefiting from this magazine. For this, however much praise is done of the invaluable contribution of Shri Gajendra Thakur ji and his associates, it becomes less.

In the archive of Videha magazine, PDF files of books by many creators are available. From this, Maithili readers can study rare Maithili texts without any expense and

inconvenience. For researchers and students preparing for competitive examinations, this is doing the work of a huge library. The most important thing then is that by doing this work, Maithili books can remain safe for ages to come.

For this invaluable contribution to Maithili, however much praise is done of Shri Gajendra Thakur ji, it becomes less. I hope that in due course, more and more creators and social workers will keep getting associated with this magazine and contribute their own efforts to make it even more useful. In the literary field, his important contribution is there. Pages upon pages would be filled with the list of books written by him. There is no genre of literature in which he has not written. Recently, his collection of short, long, and very long Maithili

stories, 'Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal', has been published. All the stories included in it are wonderful. Reading them gives a lot of inspiration. A lot of information is obtained. Definitely, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji has done wonderful work for the sake of Maithili literature and language. By continuously publishing this magazine in Maithili, he has greatly benefited the writers and readers of Maithili. Our duty is to adequately honor such a learned, diligent, and Maithili lover, so that he remains engaged in the service of Maithili with even more enthusiasm.

****Videha and Gajendra****

****Dhanakar Thakur****

Gajendra Thakur is not Videha, nor was or is Videha Gajendra. For Mithila, Videha became a bodiless, paperless e-journal, "Videha", of which, since 2008 AD, continuously fortnightly (published on every month's 1st and 15th English date), 377 issues have been published. Bringing out so many fortnightly issues according to time is no joke.

In a recent issue, Gajendra Thakur's editorial was on a Mandal ji's first prose novel, whose plot was written completely in the editorial, which did not seem right to me. Its meaning being the writer's or editor's fault is not the matter, because I myself have already created a tradition by writing reviews of the poetry of Saraswat and Vishnukant Mishra. Let it be understood whether it is my prejudice or lack of time, because I never read Videha properly, nor did I ever attempt to understand Gajendra Thakur. Even though he is a good government officer, why he is so immersed in Maithili, also establishing a parallel prize to the established Maithili Sahitya Akademi prize, standing against the establishment until today, which is not completely wrong either, because for that class whose language is Maithili and who are considered like untouchables by the

majority, or who, considering themselves untouchable, speak Maithili but consider themselves isolated, Gajendra's thoughtfulness is praiseworthy.

Through his continuous effort, at least one such person also got the main prize, otherwise, in that, the role of an activist of the International Maithili Parishad was also good. A parallel prize never seemed right to me. It would have been good if he had only remained with Videha. People forget with how much difficulty Maithili reached there. It is not possible for the prize to always get to the deserving only, when the well has been adulterated. Gajendra is a good manager who has a good team, whether it is Umesh Mandal or unknown-like youths, who are so agitated that instead of healthy criticism of a particular person or

small group, they also abuse it like a big, widespread, and Vamsefi movement, but because of that, the positive contribution of the Gajendra-group, which takes the form of Videha, towards Maithili does not become less, and this is not limited only to the magazine Videha; in its archive, much is available which, for a hasty person like me, will be very useful sometime. Like I was seeing that Kolkata's Kishorikant Mishra's photo was found, although it was the worst of all in the entire gallery, nevertheless, his son did not send it in the evening; I had put it in Maithili Sandesh.

I express gratitude for the fact that my one photo was somehow collected in the gallery and I was also declared Mithilaratna, but I reiterate the advice I had once given to them all: it should be arranged according

to the person's date of birth or period. That has not been done properly until now, it seemed to me. Until a literary presentation becomes scientific, it does not take on a wide and accurate form, and science is an orderliness, like rhythm, meter, if one can see, and this seeing itself is realization of truth, and when one reaches that level, then whether Vidyapati was a Brahmin or a barber, it would go beyond the greater sky of Gajendra's genealogy, because the reason that Vidyapati wrote many Sanskrit texts and also wrote ordinary songs and, remaining in the throat, can attain immortality, seeing this with the lens of caste is merely prejudice or foolishness.

In between, bringing out many person-centered issues is okay, otherwise, there also, the parallelness in the mind is not that

objectionable, because a writer is a writer, but in this, the propriety of discussing one particular organization is not there if a list of discussions on many contemporary organizations is not given, which demands impartiality in publication. Otherwise, roughly, I am also an admirer of many, many works of Videha and Gajendra, then with the advice of 'excess everywhere avoid', my good wishes.

****Editorial Note:**** We have written on why criticism and disagreement are considered an insult in the Maithili mainstream. That issue 383 of Videha, dated 1 December 2023, was published under the title "Are Taranand Viyogi doing inauthentic criticism and writing history?" Readers can read it. Like other articles, this article also is being published as it is.

****Maithili Literature's
Seeker-Worshipper
Shri Gajendra
Thakur****

****Dr. Yoganand Jha****

Shri Gajendra Thakur is an unparalleled worshipper of Maithili. By the grace of his creative and contemplative talent, the continuous protection and enrichment of various genres of Maithili is being

compiled. Through dictionary creation, operation of the e-journal Videha, new and novel experiments via Shruti publication, and along with the creation of the next generation of Maithili, by creating a unique archive of Maithili, he is dedicated to establishing Maithili at the global level. "Kurukshetram Antarmanak" is his garden of various genres, in which are compiled together his essays, articles, criticism, the novel 'Sahastrabadhanee', modern poetry, stories-tales, drama, two epics, and abundant children's literature and folklore. Dr. Uday Narayan Singh 'Nachiketa' has called this book a new experiment and a modern epic, in which abundant textual material is available. From the viewpoint of guiding modern Maithili writing, this book of his is of high quality. His efforts in preserving the Maithili script and arousing curiosity towards

their mother tongue in children through the medium of picture-stories are directive. His epic 'Tvanchahanch', based on the Mahabharata story and composed through the medium of free verse, is also captivating, in which, depicting the contemporary context, an aphorism is expressed in these words:

"You and I, we all fight among ourselves

Is still spread this epidemic

Attachment to caste-religion, family-son

As long as talent remains, crushed, alas

You and I, where Dhritarashtra does stubbornness

Duryodhana starts, how little is

Yudhishthira's fault?"

Nevertheless, whatever essays of his based on exploration-research are woven into the discussed book, they are indicative of his expanded vision and original thinking in the direction of protection-enrichment of Maithili, such as: 'Khissa Shit-Basant', interpretation of the meaning of ancient Maithili words, agricultural-fishery terminology, Vidyapati's Videsiya, forgotten poet: Pt. Ram Ji Chaudhary, Mithila's search, etc. The saying is famous: "A word, properly known, well-used, becomes wish-fulfilling in heaven and in the world."

Actually, for any language, the word is its unit. The more words there are in a language, that language is considered that much more rich or

wealthy. But the word stock is continuously changeable. This change keeps happening in its form and also in meaning. Over time, after the usage of many words is excluded, they gradually come into a state of extinction. Naturally, many words used in ancient literature become incapable of interpreting their meaning. Therefore, it is necessary that based on context, the meaning of such words be interpreted and they be revived. Otherwise, one would have to wash one's hands of such ancient words. Shri Thakur ji, by interpreting the meaning of many words from ancient literature, has made a praiseworthy attempt to revive those words of Maithili, which can be called his laudable attempt in the direction of preserving the Maithili language. The same situation is of folklore, which, due to gradual scientific progress and other reasons, being excluded from use,

gradually comes into a state of extinction, because this literature generally remains alive in the people's throats and has been transmitted from throat to throat generation after generation. But now, due to lack of public interest, this wealth of Maithili has come into a state of extinction. Therefore, to protect this invaluable wealth of Maithili literature from becoming time-devoured, it is necessary to transcribe them all. But field visits and the exploration of the knowers are difficult tasks. By attempting to extract the story of Shit-Basant from the folk throat and transcribe it, Shri Thakur ji has provided direction for the preservation of this literary wealth.

Similarly, that part of any language-literature which, although not transcribed by the creator, remains

alive in manuscripts, and its publication does not happen, or if it was published somewhere in very ancient times, then over time it can become unavailable, whose preservation is possible through its re-publication. Therefore, scholars, by exploring manuscripts, try to provide it with the form of living literature through its publication-re-publication and become capable of preserving that wealth of their language. By being endeavouring in the direction of preserving the Gitavali of Pt. Ramji Chaudhary, a distinguished devotional poet of the modern period, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji has provided direction for the preservation of this category of literature as well. Such types of efforts made in the direction of preservation-enrichment of Maithili language and literature had started from the beginning of the nineteenth century. The credit for this goes to

European and Bengali scholars. For the study of the form of the Maithili language, some European scholars, such as Colebrooke, Campbell, Fallon, Beams, etc., went on collecting its words, idioms, proverbs, etc. Dr. Grierson made laudable efforts in this direction. He composed a Grammar in Maithili, published Maithili Chrestomathy, compiled twenty-one Vaishnava songs, Dinabhadri's and Newar's songs, Salhesh Gatha, etc., and by publishing Umapati's Parijatharan, Manbodh's Krishnajanm, etc., established the linguistic capability and antiquity of Maithili. Dr. Nagendranath Gupta, Dr. Har Prasad Shastri, Dr. Suniti Kumar Chatterji, Dr. Biman Bihari Majumdar, etc., did work of various explorations and compilations related to Maithili, as a result of which the exploration of works like Vidyapati's Padavali, Varnaratnakar, etc., could happen.

The medieval period-promoter scholar of Mithila, Chanda Jha, roamed all over Mithila and collected Vidyapati's Padavali. By him, exploration of Mahesh Thakur's songs, the names of forty-seven Maithili poets, Sahebram Das's Padavali was done, and Govind Das's compositions were compiled. Along with this, he presented the introduction of Lochana's Ragatarangini. Jadunath Jha 'Yadubar' and Munshi Raghunandan Das also presented the introduction of many Maithili poets. In the later period, Dr. Jayakant Mishra got many Nepali Maithili dramas published and presented a scholarly study of Maithili folklore. Dr. Ramdev Jha also, along with the exploration of Hargaouri marriage and many other dramas and dance-dramas, got the dramas of poet Jeevan Jha re-published and made them accessible to the people. By

getting the Padavali of Pt. Ramji Chaudhary published along with his introduction, Shri Gajendra Thakur ji has done such important work in the direction of literature preservation. Similarly, his attempt to establish Vidyapati's Videsiya on the basis of his songs is extremely original and thought-provoking, and in 'Mithila's Search', an introduction to many historical and archaeological sites of Mithila has been presented.

The essay "Forgotten Poet Pt. Ramji Chaudhary" is, in fact, one of the most significant contributions of Shri Gajendra Thakur ji in the direction of exploration-research. Accordingly, this poet was a resident of Rudrapur village under Andharathadhi police station, and his period of presence was 1878-1952 AD. He was a devotional poet and, according to the tradition of Mithila, was a

worshipper of the five deities. One book of his was published. On the basis of all that, by bringing his forty-five songs onto the path of publication-re-publication, Thakur ji, while making the existence of this Maithili poet alive, has not only paved the way for the enjoyment of his compositions, but by preserving this invaluable wealth of Maithili, has presented his earnestness and exploratory nature towards the enrichment of Maithili literature. In the songs of Ramji Chaudhary ji, generally, the following of surrender devotion has been done. He used to compose songs related to Ganapati, Shiva, Vishnu, Goddess Sita, Ram, Krishna, etc. All the songs are in the form of hymns and devotional songs, in which, along with the name, form, weapons, attire, etc., of the concerned deity, a description of the devotee's humility, helplessness, and surrender is there. The language of

the songs follows Mithila music. In one condolence song, describing the sentiment of the time of departure of life from its earthly abode, it has been said:

"The day of departure has approached for me, O friend, gather all the society.

I will come again to this world, to the rule of the distant land of in-laws.

Day and night, remaining lost, with the company of friends, I did not do any of my own work.

Suddenly the mind has become restless, understanding my state, how will I do my work?

Who will go with me? Some message, some provision, the distant land has a long path.

Not a single debt or loan is received;

in the path, there are kusha grass
and thorns.

Now be gracious to me, forgive all
remaining faults.

Ramji, what will I gain by regretting
now, how will I go to the distant
land?"

Describing Vrindavan, the poet,
presenting its image and beauty, has
said:

"See Vrindavan on all four sides.

See Kalindi Lake, Vanshivat, the
groves and lanes at every place,

In Seva Kunj, have darshan of the
deity, dance once.

On the bank of Yamuna, the ghat is
charming; the traveler stays at many
places.

See the bent of the Kadam tree,
wearing a saree at many places.

Ramji, roam and see all places of
Vaikuntha and Vrindavan,

Seeing the beauty with the
Rasmandal, stay a few more days."

In the maximum number, he has
composed Maheshwani. In these, the
subject of Shiva's marriage is
predominant. In one song, the
description of surrender to Shiva is
of this form:

"My life also passed in vain.

Never did I pluck a bilva leaf, never
did I plant a flower.

Akshata, incense, lamp, anointing, I
never worshipped Shankar.

Doing, doing so many desires in my mind, days and nights passed.

Never did meditation, with mind becoming calm, never did I say Bam-Bam.

Under the sway of son, wife, etc., objects, the mind never got rest.

Doing, doing worry, days passed, now the body has become withered.

Ramji says, renouncing all hope, serve Shiva, the unique one.

Without Shiva, no one else removes the unbearable suffering; certainly do this in your mind."

In one Chaitavar song, a description of the episode of the Sundarakanda of the Ramayana has been made:

"Has come to search for Sita, ho
Rama, in the wind-son.

Forbidding, forbidding, all demons
are tired, who would not fight in
sleep?

Destroying the garden, the angered
Lord of Lanka, the cloud-rider, says
in speech:

Do not kill, O son, binding bring him;
Ramji understands the reason, ho
Rama."

In this way, by exploring this
traditional poet of modern Maithili
literature, Pt. Ramji Chaudhary, the
affection that Shri Thakur ji has
shown towards research-criticism in
the field of Maithili literature will
remain an inexhaustible source of
inspiration for those interested in
research. If research students,
inspired and influenced by him,

become imbued with the sentiment of preservation towards the perishing wealth of Maithili, then not only the word wealth and folklore of Maithili, but the entire wealth can survive becoming time-bound and can be assimilated into the mainstream. Otherwise, Shri Thakur ji, through the archive, is engaged in the digitalization of all available literature, which is his most significant contribution in the worship of Maithili.

****Gajendra Thakur's
Kurukshetram
Antarmanak****

****Uday Narayan Singh**

"Nachiketa" **

In Gajendra Thakur's seven parts divided Kurukshetram Antarmanak, together, on the most difficult subjects, well-considered analysis is found, and the puzzle of the novel's complex story is also found solved, and along with that, love poetry and nature songs are also there. The seven parts are of this type:

Part-1. Research-Essay-Criticism,
Part-2. Novel-Sahasrabadhane, Part-
3. Poetry Collection-Sahasrabdi Ka
Chaupadpar, Part-4. Story-Tale
Collection-Galpa Guccha, Part-5.
Drama-Sankarshan, Part-6. Epic-1.
Tvanchahanch, and 2. Asanjati Man,
Part-7. Children's Group / Youth
World.

The most important thing is that for the male and female readers of all subjects, here something or other will definitely be found. When asked why such a structure, then from whatever he said, it seemed that he is trying to make his place somewhere between Hindi's Tar-Saptak and Tamil's Kurukshetram. The difference is only this that in Hindi and Tamil, many people together have been compiled in one volume, and here, it is not compositions of various genres by many writers, but his own compositions have been made available in the book.

Many lines, fully, get engraved and printed in the readers' minds, like that –

"The wall of crumbling emotions

The pillar of weakness standing

The granary of aspirations is full

Standing as a symbol."

Or, take this below-mentioned line:

"Hearing the scene of the void

On nature's canvas

The picture of the wailing ocean

The words of the characters in the
painting of the dark hollow

Who does not see this picture of
mine in the dark..."

The influence of many cultures, not
only of Mithila but of India, can be
seen in his stories and poems. From

this, the landscape of Maithili active compositions increases further, and new-new pictures, sounds, and plots come to the fore. Which Mandakini is the poet in search of, who says-

"Mandakini, which in the middle of the sky

I saw today upon the earth..."

The impression of his vast travels seems to appear well in the compositions. And one more thing is clear – the lexicographer Gajendra Thakur and the creator Gajendra Thakur are different persons, different even in personality... where in lexicography, the shadow of the person related to editorship and technology is found, but at the moment of creation, all that disappears.

He has also kept many of the texts from this on the internet, keeping in mind the increasing readers of Maithili, like Videha-Sadeha is there at <http://videha.co.in/archive.htm>, and in both Devanagari and Tirhuta scripts. For those who are lovers of Mithilakshar, for them all, this remains a rare gift.

In many compositions, he not only gives vague stories but also adds political commentary. In that, he has no hesitation. Otherwise, if you see, there were many great warriors of Kurukshetra - each brave warrior was a famous expert in their own field and genre - someone in commanding many Akshauhini armies, then someone in archery, etc. etc. They all knew what the difference between religion and

irreligion is, but still, all of them, as if, had become helpless in the face of the imminent catastrophe. Even in today's context, in the story and in the interpretation, a glimpse of such a situation is seen. This is what I would call the specialty of this meta-text. Otherwise, why would he write-

"Seeing the countrymen knock them down

Awake in the mantra-tantra
equipped afternoons, the dream
humming with tune

Becomes the fastest runner, the most
agile wrestler of the arena

Suppressing the master's voice, his
solitude breaks it

The sleep of the night painted with
soot,

The breaking-growing-breaking

sleep and the continuity of the dream..."

If we see this meta-text as an experiment, then it is fine, and if we see it as the essence of the Saptarshimandal or as a modern epic divided into seven cantos, then it would also be fine. However you read, the material in it is abundant, fully; some things seem of a very high standard, and some things are not that pleasing. But readers will definitely welcome this book, and the new writer class will also get a new direction.

(From Videha Archive, published on Videha's WordPress version on 9 June 2009)

****Gajendra Thakur and His Novel****

****Ashok****

Gajendra Thakur, with his entire energy, talent, and resources, has been continuously endeavouring for the development of Mithila's culture, language, and literature. In his thought and writing, the vision of increasing the prestige of Maithil society is seen. To preserve the ancient heritages with modern

technical resources, he has been ready from the very beginning. Gajendra Thakur has contributed in various genres like essays-articles-criticism, poetry, tales, epic, children's poetry, etc. In addition to editing the magazine, he has done various works like contributing to the development of Tirhuta Unicode for the internet and developing internet and computer terminology in the Maithili language. According to Ashish Anchinhaar's 'History of Maithili Web Journalism', 'The first presence of Maithili on the Internet is Bhalsarik Gaachh', which was from the year 2000 and whose operator was Gajendra Thakur. Samdiya is the first literary blog of Maithili, which Gajendra Thakur created in 2004. Videha is the first e-magazine of Maithili, which has been there from the year 2008 till now, and whose founder is Gajendra Thakur. The first digital library of

Maithili was started by Videha in the year 2008. In addition to this, many other works, like the first blog for translation on the internet, the 'Nena-Bhutka' blog for children's literature, the first attempt for Wikipedia, the first attempt for Google Translate, etc., are such works that are achievements of Gajendra Thakur. Various works of this type have been very important for Mithila and Maithili. No other person like Gajendra Thakur is visible to me who has done so many different types of work.

Two novels of Gajendra Thakur are published. 'Sahasrabadhane' was published in 2009 AD and 'Sahasrashirsha' in 2010 AD. In the novel 'Sahasrabadhane', the story of two generations of government servants and a father and son, struggling with the corruption

pervasive in the country's government system, is told. In this sequence, light has been shed on many internal work-systems of the government machinery. Otherwise, this novel encompasses the time of three or four generations. The details of that time have all come. The novel is mainly based on the life of Arunee, working in the Vigilance Department, and the experiences and incidents related to departmental work, but in this, the story of his father Nand, who is a government engineer and was working in the construction of the Ganga Bridge, also comes. Both father and son are honest. The father's death happened in an accident. After his government tour, Arunee also has an accident, but he survives. It comes at the end of the novel that this accident was not an accident but was made to happen. This novel very minutely exposes the

corrupt conduct going on inside the government system.

The second novel, 'Sahasrashirsha', is like a continuously ongoing story. This novel acquaints one with the activities of the country's independence movement and the politics after independence. This novel is divided into thirty-four waves. Mainly, from the village Garh Narikel and the shelter of Mamatod and Mukhdev, it brings a wide socio-cultural landscape to the fore. The narrative style has a specialty in this. There is a description of the hamlets of various castes. How castes were formed is also told through stories. In this novel, there is information of various types. There is information about the Kabir monastery, and also the names of mangoes, all types of paddy are written. Due to the various types of information, the novel has

become instructive. There are many folk songs in it, many folk tales. There is the story of Gonu Jha. In the village, clothes are taken on rent from the washerman. In Garh Narikel, there is a story for everything. This is not just a story; it is a social history. From the perspective of transcribing oral histories, this novel holds its own distinct feature. In Garh Narikel, the types of trees-plants, fruits, grains, and vegetables are more numerous than the human species. It comes at the end of the novel that Garh Narikel is the first novel of a trilogy. Encompassing songs, tales, movements, stories, and history within itself, this novel has become a collectible novel.

****Sahastrabadhane e: In My View (Some Comments)****

****Arvind Thakur****

[1]

"Sahastrabadhane" basically tells the story of the gradual development (evolution) of four generations of a family.

Jhingur Thakur is a traditional farmer by profession, but he understands the importance of education, and that is modern education. The irrelevance of Sanskrit education in the current era is in his cognizance, and therefore, renouncing the attachment to

traditional Sanskrit education, he arranges modern education for his son Kalit. As a good result of his decision, Kalit gets appointed to the post of Revenue Officer of the Darbhanga Raj and, in his work field, changes the corrupt methods of all the previous revenue officers. Kalit's son Nand studies engineering and gets appointed to the post of Engineering Assistant in the Irrigation Department of the Bihar Government. Nand also has an aversion to corruption, and in the form of various losses, he pays its price. Ultimately, losing to circumstances, he goes to the refuge of magic-mysticism and rituals. Nand's son Arunee has seen the result of his father, but while following his honesty, he struggles with adverse circumstances and ultimately becomes victorious.

With the well-structured combination of many episodes along

with this main story, this novel has been composed.

[2]

In the dedication of "Kurukshetram Antarmanak", the creator writes -

(I had seen the father taking the truth in balanced-state

Then I had understood that

Sacrifice had not been made

This is the path for those who live

Dedicated to all the dear and unpleasant memories of the father)

The seed-form of the novel "Sahastrabadhanee" is present in the above words of the dedication.

[3]

The structure of "Sahastrabadhane" is influenced by idealism. Instead of turning away from struggle like his father and adopting the escapist path of going towards mysticism and the rituals of worship, the protagonist, maintaining patience in adverse circumstances and retaliating when an opportunity comes, ultimately becomes victorious.

"To remain honest, not to lose in adverse circumstances, to struggle" – this is the core message of this novel.

[4]

The weaving of the novel is very fine. The novelist is not in any kind of hurry. He weaves the warp and weft of the novel's story with great

thoroughness and patience. At the structural level, there is an abundance of description, narrative, and details in the novel. Generally, this abundance puts the core theme of any novel in the background, deviates the story-flow, and makes the plot cumbersome. But the novelist's competence is such that in this novel, all those negative aspects are secondary, and everything seems very natural, spontaneous, and reasonable, and from these, there is no interruption in its interest and readability.

"Arunee had an obsession like keeping his old things in mind. In which AD what happened, from which AD what all happened, how could that be remembered. ----- After many days, one day Nand got hold of Arunee's diary, in which Arunee had given a description like a historian of the sequence of events from his

memory." (2-18)

Like his protagonist Arunee, the novelist's memory is very sharp, and this sharpness of memory is in the background of the fine descriptions and details of this novel. In human memory, many desired-undesired elements, sequences of events, remain accumulated, and the creator, from that accumulated heap, chooses only the things he needs and uses them in his various compositions. In

"Sahastrabadhanee", there are such memories as well, apparently for which there is no need for the presentation of this novel. But this exercise has been accepted as a necessary part of realist literature-creation. Presenting a detailed description of every thing around the subject matter, mentioning contemporary events and customs in detail, discussing even negligible people connected with the subject

matter by a very thin thread, presenting letters, documents, deeds, and other things considered authentic to create an atmosphere of truthfulness of the event, etc., Acharya Hazari Prasad Dwivedi has included these in the skill of a realist writer. Brecht also advocates this thing that writers should take the basis of every medium, whether it be new or old, whether it has been used or not, whether it is far from art or from any other source, if it provides assistance in conveying reality.

[5]

Here, one must also keep in mind this helplessness of any creator that after starting to write, maintaining complete control over the events of the story and the activities of the characters becomes difficult even for

famous and skilled storytellers, and has always been so. It is at this point that the artistry and good structure of the creator's presentation become important, that how digestible, comprehensible, natural, and coherent he is able to make all this. This competence of Gajendra Thakur is praiseworthy that he incorporates all the desired-undesired details so well into the thread of his story, merges them, so that the ordinary reader has no scope for anything to jar anywhere. It is very clear that no relevant or irrelevant event or description breaks the coherence of this novel. Here, the novelist appears to follow the saying of the predecessor novelist Premchand – 'We consider the novel only as a picture of human life. Shedding light on humans and revealing their mystery is the core element of the novel.' Along with enriching 'Sahastrabadhanee' with the subtlest

details of life, Gajendra Thakur has remained more credible in his presentation. In the language, craft, style, and plot of the novel, there is no artificiality or pretentiousness anywhere.

[6]

In literary criticism, just like in various other fields of life, an era of specialisation has set in. In this, the trend of categorising novels based on their content has increased. Keeping those various categories in mind, if we consider 'Sahastrabadhane', we can place it in the mixed category of autobiographical plus memoir-type novels. Taking the help of this mixed style, sometimes as a diary, then as a travelogue, and then moving into various genres like history, etc., 'Sahastrabadhane' achieves its

completeness.

Generally, it is believed that the novel or fiction is a personal or subjective genre, and memoirs are seen and considered as a form of objective genre. By including the memoir genre in 'Sahastrabadhane', Gajendra Thakur has made a rare and successful experiment that makes it interesting with the combined power of subjective and objective, and expanding its scope, taking the story from the individual to the higher step towards the collective, brings it to a stand. In the Maithili novel, this is almost the first experiment of its kind. This experiment, parallel to the introspective character, pure aestheticist jargon, and traditional expressionist expression of Maithili novel literature, provides an extroverted character by establishing and invoking progressiveness standing on the firm

wall of life.

[7]

In 'Sahastrabadhane', there is a natural coordination of past and present, tradition and modernity. The content of the novel keeps demanding this natural coordination, and the novelist, taking cognisance of this demand, has followed it. Thinkers like Acharya Hazari Prasad Dwivedi insist on considering "the continuous effort to keep removing the obstacles of both, on one side the forward-moving knowledge and on the other side the conduct-tradition connected with traditional ideals" as the true essence of realism. That effort has been successfully made in this novel.

There are two specific and modern

concepts towards the past and tradition. According to the first notion, which is based on the gradual development of perfection, the past is only the background of the present, which creates the necessary condition for the arrival of the present. According to the second notion, which is connected with the principle of the gradual unfolding of time, the past only nourishes the specific tendencies of the present within its womb.

The story of four generations in 'Sahastrabadhanee' confirms the first notion of past and tradition, which is based on the belief in gradual perfection.

[8]

In Maithili, this notion has been

created and given prejudicially that in Maithili literature, only that much area and the discussion or context of the inhabitants of that area (and within that, a specific class) should be there, which are Maithili language speakers. In this insistence of seeing society with a particular eye, there are many flaws. Firstly, Maithili does not have any unanimous, universally accepted form; there is no consensus even on its naming; secondly, its much-proclaimed, much-expanded geographical area is also disputed. That's that!

Whatever the language, its literature cannot be bound in chains and made a prisoner within the narrow boundaries of any caste or region. 'Sahastrabadhanee' not only clearly challenges this narrow pettiness but definitely negates it. Its characters, while belonging to Madhubani district (the story's thread indicates

this), travel to Patna, Delhi, and Calcutta. The novel tells the joys and sorrows of the specific Maithili-speaking region, but while crossing this geographical boundary, it is also aware of corruption and other various problems of Indian society. Although its language is Maithili, this novel tells the saga of Indian society and advocates this thing that in the context of literature, our intellectual and academic domain for discussing values, concepts, standards, etc., should be global.

From this perspective, Gajendra Thakur becomes the spokesperson of that progressive generation which rejects the predetermined, pre-prevalent, one-sided Maithil standards of storytelling, character, language, and subject, and creates a new influential writerly path for all this. Through the medium of this novel of his, he also insists on reading the composition in its

entirety (complete text) and rejects that academic method which, considering the character, subject, or language of any story or novel as separate components of the structure of the story or novel, has made them worthy of being read piecemeal and criticised.

For the evaluation, analysis, or criticism of 'Sahastrabadhane', the "established Eastern method" of criticism is not sufficient.

[9]

Maithil society has been a society stagnant with fanatical stability on the ossified priestly establishments in the depths of the past and has carefully avoided curiosity, innovation, and any kind of modernity. It is natural that in such a

stagnant society, there is no place for inquisitiveness. If somewhere a question-like thing appears, it would also appear that that question is for the convenience of some previously present/established answer or for renewal. It is natural that the majority of Maithili's literature is the origin of such convenience and renewal.

Gajendra Thakur, with his writing, stirs the stagnant water of the Maithili status quo. He and his writing both appear to be overflowing with inquisitiveness. His researcher personality sees the Vidyapati of folk songs and the courtier Vidyapati as two separate individuals, then his novelist self is also ready to do a post-mortem of the conscience and intellect of the establishment and system. His protagonist Arunee, while roaming the Patna zoo, can ask that "We had come to roam the zoo. Why is

'Botanical Garden' and 'Biological Garden' written here?" (2-31)

In the novel, fingers have been placed on many such questions that have kept agitating the folk society deeply, kept distressing it, and which, in the name of spirituality and religion, have been forced to sleep again and again by giving the dose of ritualistic unconsciousness. The answers to all questions are not in this novel either, but the awakened state of those questions in a renewed form or in the context of the present is not less important or beneficial.

The protagonist also wants to know the intimate mystery of life and death, and for that, he questions himself – 'Father's father and his progenitor, who? If God is the ancestor of all, then who is his ancestor?' (2-31) or 'Sometimes I also feel that could some of this be a

sequence of events from a previous life?' (2-18)

The displays of linguistic corruption that remain present on public places or things generally not only distort the meaning but also provide the bad education of wrong usage by confusing new learners. The protagonist Arunee has an inquisitive gaze on the confusion that 'Caution Children' written on the school rickshaw creates regarding its meaning, and on not getting a proper solution, he expresses his dissatisfaction. (2-20)

[10]

On governance-power, it is not the vast society but a capable-rich, minimal part of it that has control. It is the misfortune of our democratic

system that here, the consent of the capable class or caste is considered the majority. This so-called majority determines our values, conduct-thought, and laws, and it is the same that decides its dissolution. As a result of all this, corruption has become almost omnipresent, and the misfortune is that under the influence of the minority ruling class, the majority public does not consider any event related to corruption as an event of value-disintegration.

'Sahastrabadhanee' tells the story of this misfortune, of how in the excess of corruption spread across various departments (here, Irrigation and Vigilance), any gentleman and honest person gets crushed, and many times, the honest person himself is trapped conspiratorially by accusing him of dishonesty. From the discussion of the Ganga Bridge, it

can be estimated that in the novelist's view, the time was around 1982 AD. The decade before and after this AD was the decade of the most corruption in Bihar. In all the Kosi, Ganga, Gandak projects, the dance of loot was going on, and from contractors and engineers to the leaders of the ruling party, becoming unrestrained, bathed naked in this Ganga of corruption.

The decisive elements of the novel are corruption and the honesty that becomes its victim, but the depiction of these elements has been done only like a chutney and seems like a little touch. The natural expectation of the reader is that the episode related to this should come in some detail. Along with the readers' perspective, the need for this detail was also there from a social viewpoint. In the context of any society, the landscape of a progressive future takes shape from a deep evaluation of present

difficulties. In the midst of dreaming of a good future, we all must take serious cognisance of the present reality and circumstances. It is noteworthy that identifying the faults, marking them, and remaining effortful to correct them all is the first necessary step for any civilized society. In 'Sahastrabadhane', there was scope to cover the horror of corruption well. This is the weakness of this novel that in place of the terrible pervasiveness of corruption and its deadly impact on public life, it has remained, as if, just a matter of personal and family loss.

[11]

In this novel, one distortion of the governance system has come in a very thin voice, come in such a way that the attention of the ordinary

reader often does not go there, and it causes vibration. Kalit, as a Revenue Officer of the Darbhanga Raj, corrects departmental corruption and is successful. That is, in the monarchy period, an officer could remain honest, active against corruption, and safe. In contrast, Nand, as an engineer of the Bihar Government, pays the price of his honesty in the form of personal loss. That is, democracy fails to provide security to honest people. This is the reality, and it is terrifying!

[12]

Through the medium of 'Sahastrabadhanee', Gajendra Thakur comes forward as a novelist (seeing that the presented composition is his first novelistic work) who is equipped with the

strength of his study and experience, self-reliant, and fitted with modern thinking, and who has no need for any traditional crutch for his expression.

Just as the hero of this novel, Arunee, after the accident, stops walking with a stick (crutch or support) and, gradually increasing his strength, catches his natural gait, similarly, the novelist, completely free from the old writerly rut, standing on his own feet, taking the risk of seeing the world with his own eyes and understanding and expressing it with his conscience and intellect, appears aware of his power and capability. The self-reliance with direct observation of his reality and its self-confident expression is with the rare writers of Maithili, and Gajendra Thakur registers his presence in that rare line.

[13]

Although stories and novels are different mediums of expression from many perspectives, they are connected by an internal relationship. The size of one is small, the other is large. But patience and craftsmanship are desired in both. In front of the creator, in the form of the acquisition of experience, study, and observation, a massive mountain lies ahead. Writing a story is like making a small niche or window in this mountain or carving a small figure, whereas novel writing is the work of carving a cave or dome in this mountain. In both, a balanced use of one's acquired tools is desired. In 'Sahastrabadhanee', although Gajendra Thakur's craftsmanship does not come into the excellent category, his craft skill is certainly praiseworthy. He has not

only carved a cave and a dome out of the mountain but has also done admirable carving work in it.

[14]

Regarding the story, some European scholars also have the notion that in the entire world, the story originated from India itself. In contrast, the situation of the novel is opposite. Its nature has been considered non-Indian. In other words, the novel is a foreign genre. Many novelists have contributed to the Indianization of this genre, and now its form has taken on pure local ground. With this novel, Gajendra Thakur, I understand, is creating a separate path. The content of his novel is purely Indian, but on the style of its presentation, a foreign/non-Indian influence appears. It is possible that

scholarly critics may not agree with this understanding of mine, but I have had the opportunity to read both 'Sahastrabadhanee' in its Maithili form and 'The Comet' in its English form, and after reading both, I get this conclusion. Going one step further and saying, compared to its Maithili read, its English reading seemed more enjoyable and effective to me.

[15]

The famous storyteller Maupassant's expectation was – 'Readers want, from the artist, that he laughs and cries. He sings, jumps, and hops. He makes us laugh and cry. He makes us intoxicated. He resonates from the depths of his inner self. Then, whether it does not seem as if I have made some mistake somewhere.'

The artist Gajendra Thakur obtains sufficient marks to pass the above expectation of Maupassant. Whether the state of being mistaken comes or not, at various turns of this novelistic work, along with the actions of laughing, crying, singing, jumping, hopping, etc., the reader also, becoming a participant, moves along with those same sentiments. What more success can any work achieve than this?

[16]

Sometimes, this question kept arising in my mind: Have we all (the creator community), due to our egotism, our literary sectionalism or partisanship, or our demonstration of art-skill, etc., chosen our readers, or have we negated the need for readers for our compositions?

The disinterest of readers in Maithili is no hidden talk. But whether the readers have rejected us all or not, have we ourselves, by arranging to become reader-alienated through our writing and writerly activities, not driven away the remaining, counted, selected readers as well?

Gajendra Thakur seems aware in this matter. Understanding the importance of the necessity of readers for a composition, he makes every possible effort to ensure the presence of readability in his composition.

Excessive logic and dryness overwhelm literature, just like life. Unnecessary display takes life and literature towards artificiality. Gajendra Thakur has kept 'Sahastrabadhanee' safe from such excesses.

[17]

Some critics may have the sight of 'Nostalgia' in this novel. At places, I also had it. But it must be accepted that without being nostalgic towards one's roots or in the absence of intense involvement with one's livelihood, composing a novel with such content is not possible. Excess of nostalgia definitely becomes a negative aspect of any composition. But as it was said earlier, Gajendra Thakur carefully avoids any kind of excess. This skill of his is also worth highlighting, that due to his internal writerly discipline and impartial self-editing, he saves it from unnecessary expansion by making each thread of this novelistic work its natural assimilation.

[18]

From a theoretical perspective, in the Brechtian concept, there are three important characteristics of the modern novel – Polyphonic, Dialogism, and Carnivalization. In translation, we can call them multi-voicedness, dialogue-orientation, and festivalization. In its content and its presentation, 'Sahastrabadhanee' qualifies, more or less purely, on the touchstone of these three concepts.

[19]

The use of the term 'Sahastrabadhanee' for a comet or a tailed star seems to be purely Maithili preference. I have not seen or heard the use of this word by any other group. (This could also be my ignorance or limited knowledge). If I

had not read the English text of this novel, 'The Comet', I would not have understood that this term is used for a comet or a tailed star.

The genuine and literal meaning of 'Sahastrabadhanee' is – one thousand brooms or sweepers! Why the originator or creator or user of this word or term considered a comet to be like a thousand brooms is a matter of research and investigation. But this thing is very clear that this naming was not done as a result of any reverence; it seems to be an outcome of mockery. If that were not the case, then Bholanath Jha, resident of Koilkha and composer of 'Agurban', would have kept his pen name as 'Sahastrabadhanee' instead of "Dhumketu" (Comet).

In the narrative of the novel, the use of this term has been at two important places. First, while taking

the dead body of the protagonist's father Nand to the village – 'On the way, a fragment of light broke and fell, not Sahastrabadhaneer, but its lesser form, Chhadani (broom).' Second, at the end of the novel – 'Several operations happened, and while coming out of anesthesia, Arunee felt that the dreadlock-wearing Sahastrabadhaneer was shaking him and throwing him into this world. Arunee conquered death.'

The episode of the appearance, after the death of the protagonist's father, of the symbolic planet of one thousand brooms (Sahastrabadhaneer) in its lesser form, which the novelist calls 'Chhadani' (broom), and the episode/use, while coming out of the unconsciousness of anesthesia, of this same symbolic planet of one thousand brooms, which also has dreadlocks, shaking the protagonist and throwing him again into the

world, amazes and astonishes.

One episode is 'death's victory', and the second episode is called 'victory over death'.

What is its implied meaning?

Whenever, wherever, and with whatever sentiment the first use of the word 'Sahastrabadhane' was made, there is no doubt in this matter that in this novel, its use has been done respectfully.

Has the novelist made any mistake in choosing the symbol of 'Sahastrabadhane', or am I mistaken in understanding its symbolic meaning !!!

**** A Letter for
Kurukshetram
Antarmanak (A Review
in Epistolary Style) ****

**** Rajdeo Mandal ****

Dear Friend,

I got the good opportunity to read your lengthy book "Kurukshetram Antarmanak". By collecting many literary works (novel, poetry, story-tale collection, drama, epic, children's drama, children's story,

children's poetry, essay-article criticism, etc.) in one book, you have made such a garland for the readers, in which it seems that flowers of various colours are strung in one place. And the community of readers can obtain any taste of literature from this lengthy book. Certainly, this effort of yours is new for literature, and also evidence of industriousness....

I am not any big critic, so I am incapable of the responsible task of doing criticism. Nevertheless, after reading your book, I consider it a kind of duty to inform you of the thoughts that arise in my mind. So, I am sending some of my thoughts.

Friend, firstly, I have no hesitation in saying that the literary movement work you are doing for Maithili

literature is not only historical for literature, but Maithili lovers and Mithila residents will also never forget this good work of yours.

****Children's Story****

You have collected in a new form the small and big stories spread across Mithilanchal. With this effort of yours, the stories that were becoming extinct have come alive again. I had heard the 'Bagiya's tree' story from my grandmother's mouth during childhood. Today, I got the opportunity to read it again. Reading stories like Raja Salhes, Mahua Ghatwarin, Naika-Banijara, Jat-Jatin, etc., it seems that many deep, factual things of historical importance have come to light. While progressing with speed, the hints of all things have come, and the condition and direction of that ancient time are

naturally reflected. In the picture you have presented while describing the activities of social life, love-hate, union-separation, progress-decline, enmity-friendship, peace-unrest, bravery-cowardice, foolishness-wisdom of that particular era have all been expressed in different forms. While reading, it seems that we have entered another world. If we compare that time with the present time, then it becomes clear how fast development is happening. And writing on these old life stories is no ordinary talk. The balance you have maintained on the subjects is suitable for the time and circumstances.

****Sankarshan-Drama- Apala Atreyi-Daanvir Dadhichi****

In both these children's dramas, Apala Atreyi and Daanvir Dadhichi,

you have expressed the story in a somewhat new form. That is according to the characters. There is flow in the dialogue, and there is use of short, short sentences, which create an effect in the dramatic quality. Like one dialogue of Daanvir Dadhichi: "Dadhichi- Indra. Near Kurukshetra, there is a reservoir whose name is Sharyana. You go there. There, a horse's head is kept..... From that, make various types of weapons." Children's drama is also useful for increasing the knowledge of children. The drama Sankarshan introduces one to a new character, who understands the cheating of village people well. He considers this same defect as talent. He does not think at all about the consequence of the defect. That same person, when he goes to a metropolis like Delhi, gets cheated himself on the way. While buying shoes at the Red Fort, he comes to know how

backward he is in the art of cheating; as an example, one dialogue: "Gonar- You have been cheated. Your name is being heard in the community. Sankarshan- Friend, what to say?..... These people of the Red Fort's thief market mix the intellect of many great-great scholars in the dustbin."

Through short, small dialogues, saying satire, laughter, and serious things in a natural way is a specialty of your writing. The size of the drama is short, which is indicative of newness. And the attempt to encompass the many things spread in Mithila is certainly praiseworthy. Directions for staging have been given in a good manner. The drama is full of readability as well as dramatic quality. And Sankarshan is full of attraction.

Collection)** \- I read the stories that are collected in Galpa Guccha. While reading, I remembered some words from the Encyclopedia Britannica – story is an independent genre. In this, along with brevity, it should be highly organized and have a complete story form. Otherwise, life is a story, and story is life. And life is continuously attaining newness. While reading Galpa Guccha, it seems necessary to say about those stories or lines that influenced me the most. The right to call something good or bad is with the readers.

Nava Samanta- Now the feudal era is no more. But the feudal tendency is still alive. Yes, it has undergone a change in form. And it is visible in society today in different forms. In this story, a new form of a new feudal is being observed.

****Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan-****

Through the medium of the story, a feeling of indifference towards educating the daughters and sons of Dalits and the poor has been expressed; they sell the books given free by the government in bulk. A line from the story: "And from Dusadhtoli, Chamartoli, and Dhobiyatoli, all the books were gathered and taken away."

****Thether Manukkh****- From this story, it becomes clear that the complete degradation of humans has happened. So much so that humans, having descended lower than birds, small birds, insects, and moths, have become thether (completely crushed/hollow).

****Stri-Beti****- In this, the depiction of the insignificance of women in society and, along with that, the changing social condition and circumstance has been done.

****Biah Aaur Goralgai****- The ever-changing color of humans, moment by moment, like a chameleon... and the person greedy for dowry, showing behavior like a contented person, becomes ashamed themselves. In what forms the dowry-greedy person is hidden in society today, and what deceitful tricks they are playing, is understood from this story. Good depiction has been done.

****Pratibha****- Cunningness and talent are two different things. An effort has been made to see which of the two is more important for

achievement.

****Mithila's Industry****- Some talk of certain stories keeps the readers resonated for a long time. The message that is being loaded on a donkey in this story will remain in the readers' memory for many days.

****Rakatal Chhalhun Kohabar Lay****- A poignant analysis of the forming and breaking relationships between men and women, and the deceit and tricks that fool oneself and cause others to be fooled, has been done through this story.

****Ham Nahi Jaeb Videsh****- How much pain-suffering and laughter-joy is filled in a person's heart. Its complete excavation is not even

possible; nevertheless, the storyteller will definitely make an effort. In this story, the story of Dwijendra's mental anguish has been completely revealed. One line: "What concern was bigger than mother, O son? That you say, 'I have kept no concern with anyone'."

****Rag Baidehi Bheravi****- In this story, light has been shed on the life of an artist. A detailed description is found of how an ordinary village singer, struggling with joy-sorrow, success and failure, attained greatness.

****Badhi Bhukh Aaur Pravas****- This story is full of humor and satire. Despite being of small size, this story has encompassed many things. Hunger, and the waves of the mind arising due to hunger, and because

of that, where and where a person migrates to, and how at that place too, frost falls on hope. Reading this line, humor automatically arises. "Government, I have come by train, but which vehicle did you come by that you are seated here before me?"- Vaidik ji says, joining hands to the spirit.

****Nutan Media****- How modern media is functioning, that has been revealed.

****Jati-Pati****- After reading this story, a line comes to mind: "Seemingly small, the sting of caste and sub-caste appears."

****Bahupatni Biah Aaur Hijda****- In this story, a description has been

given of the rot that is being created in society by having more than one wife, and in what forms its perversion emerges. Some lines: "... we do not accept the nephews, that's why God did not give children."

****Banveer****- In this story, the psychoanalysis of Banveer has been done well. It becomes clear from the story how much immense pain Banveer, cut off from the group, struggles and passes each moment of life. How much pathos is hidden in this statement of Banveer: "Mother, father! I understand that my marriage and donation will not happen. But somehow, I fill my stomach in the village. Somehow, I manage to survive. People keep saying that your mother-father sold you. Is that right?".... Tears welled up.

****Anukampa ki Naukari****- People get a job when their father dies. He got it when his brother died. This is the essence of the story.

****Mrityudanda****- Through the story, it has been shown how the girl Arya gets the death sentence, who had no fault. Punishment to the innocent. That too, death sentence. Such is the society of this place. Which is even accepted with ease. The story seems like a mirror of today's society.

In this way, after reading the stories of Galpa Guccha, it is understood that the real form of present-day problems has been revealed. Short, short scenes and segments have come forward in a poetic form. The

plot has the fragrance of Mithila's soil and water. Some stories are extremely short, nevertheless, the purpose has been expressed, which encompasses the reality of the entire country.

****Sahasrabadhanee (Novel)**** \- Since ancient times, along with curiosity about the subject of Sahastrabadhanee, it has been speculated about. Speculative interpretation and criticism have kept happening. By science in a different way, and by literature and spirituality in different ways. The character in your novel says in this regard: "Falling corpses, their families all crying. These kept appearing in dreams, taking the form of Sahasrabadhanee. There is some cursed soul like me, that Sahasrabadhanee, who, leaving their struggle half-done, must have died,

and now wanders in the universe. Now see, the three children's exam results kept coming first every day, now what has happened to them. This result is of the struggle I left in the middle." Nand choked up and started crying.

If we start to assimilate this line seriously, then not just the name, but the essence and purpose of the novel are also revealed. The character of Nand, and the form of the struggle done by him, and his mental psychology become clear. The language style of the novel is of a new type. It has started in a descriptive style. An example of pictorial quality in the language: "One day I saw Kalit that he was going forward, leaning on his elbows. Upon going out of the courtyard, wherever he saw bricks and stones, he would lift his elbows and move forward only on his hands and feet."

With the use of some words like this, attraction has come into the language. Like Thamh-Thomh (supporting/hesitating), Kanab-Kheejab (crying-annoyance), Kaaj-Udyam (work-enterprise), Jaan-Pahachaan (knowledge-acquaintance), Budh-Purana (old-ancient), Ghumab-Phirab (wander-roam), Toka-Toki (objection-objection), Sangi-Sathi (companion-friend), Jhadja-Jhanti (quarrel-quarrel), Tantra-Mantra (mysticism-magic), Padhai-Likhai (study-writing), etc. The language of the novel is suitable for Maithili readers; it is described in a natural way, just as people speak.

Through the medium of characters like Jhingur Babu, Nand and Nand's brother, nephew, son, Naval, Arunee and his mother-father, sister, Kalit and his wife, Shashank, Manindra, Bhabhi, Shobha Babu, Buchia, etc.,

along with the plot, the development of character has happened, in which there is naturalness along with originality. With a new perspective, the development of all the characters has happened with ease, which is suitable for the novel. Descriptions of Mithila's rivers - Kamala, Kosi, Balan, etc., have been done. Along with this, from the descriptions of the villages and houses of this place - Jhajharpur, Mehath, Gadhia, Naruar, Kachhwi, etc., the fragrance of Mithila's soil and water has naturally come into the story. There is brevity and naturalness in the dialogues. As an example, some excerpts can be seen.

Arunee, after eating two-three morsels, got up. His friend Karan asked, "Don't know. Feeling anxious."

"Have to go for training tomorrow, right? Due to that."

"Don't know."

Meanwhile, a voice came from inside. Everyone ran.

The dialogue is suitable for life and the characters.

"What happened, son?" - Mother asked.

"Nothing. Seeing this colony, something came to mind."

"Don't see this Papiyaha colony."

The novel is enriched not only with psychoanalysis but also with philosophy.

"The earth is vast, and time is limitless, infinite. Therefore, there is a belief that if not today, then tomorrow, someone will definitely make my effort meaningful."

This sentence, which spreads hope, keeps arising in the mind repeatedly.

To conduct life, the essence of life is necessary. That same essence is Hope. If there is no hope, no aspiration in life, then life is meaningless.

"Arunee felt that the dreadlock-wearing Sahastrabadhaneer was shaking him and throwing him into this world."

Saying something, why, this question arises in the mind. This very question forces the reader to think again and again - many things. And from one question, many questions are born, which take the reader into a different world.

Regarding human tendencies, this line can be seen: "It is human tendencies, to compare and find equality, how many people spend their lives in criticism and analysis of similarity and difference. Even between Arunee and Nand,

similarity can be seen effortlessly."

Superficially, humans are of different tendencies. But if explored deeply in essence, at some level, almost all humans are similar. In the end, that same essence keeps emanating. But seeing oneself with that much calmness and seriousness is not an easy thing. Despite the small size of the novel, the complete development of the plot has happened. Language suitable for the story has been used in a balanced manner. Expression of new things has been done with a new perspective. It is full of originality.

For the progress of Maithili literature in the present, there is a need for a person like you, who, being dedicated, balances Maithili, and along with that, themselves definitely progresses and gives others the opportunity to move forward. From this perspective, your

effort is indescribable.

One line was remembered:

"On a Maithili servant like you

Is the hope of us all

Will fill the treasury of Maithili

There is complete faith."

****Sahasrabdi Ka Chaupadpar****

Seated on the Chaupad of the millennium, you are showing the game of life. Doing deep exploration, you are composing each picture one by one and are immersed in that enthusiasm.

"At the sight of the shore of the boundless ocean

The heart became filled with enthusiasm...."

Presenting the picture of the sun, the
poet of your inner self says:

"The sun's rays had spread

Dissipated so many mysteries

The haze of darkness has become
fragile

But what is this....."

In the collection, the opportunity to
read some Haiku was found. For a
change of taste....

With the fragrance of Mithilanchal,
your poetry has been perfuming the
hearts of us all:

"I am picking my mind, the paddy
field

Jhilli Kachaudi

Rolling the sheaves of cut paddy

Bought with that spread shish's paan

Lal Jhadhi

Whose name is Lal Chhadi and

The Saten House game...."

Living in exile, remember the village home. In this line, a description of that anguish of separation is found. With a new rhythm:

"Don't know if I will return

Or here, dying and wasting away,

Will be consumed....."

In this poignancy, a clear vision is becoming visible.

"There is no delay in beating with a stick

No less sorrow on becoming a calf

But you are worshipable....."

The problems generated by the flood, and encompassing them in short,

small lines, the effort to fill an ocean
in a pot is being perceived in this
line:

"At places, the embankment was cut

Above, a quilt was falling

All the paddy and rice, the inner
granaries

Broke and fell, became the prey of
water..."

The poems are filled with new, new
images:

"Like Sahasrabadhanee, gigantic

The tangle of events

Breath swelled

I got up hurriedly...."

Not hurriedly, but rather you got up
consciously. With new, new pictures
and sounds, with a new vision. Don't
know how far you will go. Where

your destination is.

"In the churning of the universe

Let something come out....

Wait for the path of the path.....

The journey has become long now...."

****Research-Essay-Criticism****

In the beginning, there is 'Khisra Shit-Basant', based on field work. This folk tale is poignant, and also filled with education and preaching. What the character of a stepmother is like, and what it should be like, has become clear. You have revived this story, which is being forgotten by society, in which a poignant description of mother-father, son, and stepmother has been done. In the present time, the Shit-Basant dance is delighting the public psyche in village after village of Bihar.

The second is 'Mayanand Mishra's Pratham Shail Putri Cha, Mantraputra, Purohit and Stridhan', which is based on Vedic-era history. Taking both history and literature as a basis for its criticism, you have presented it well.

After that are Kedarnath Chaudhary ji's two novels, 'Chameli Rani' and 'Mahur'. These are novels respected by readers. You have reviewed them well. You have said that: "The new review is based on a detailed description of the work."

No Entry: 'Ma Pravesh' is a drama by Nachiketa ji. You have made an attempt to critique it in some new way.

Through Kavisheshwar Jyotirishwar Shabdavali, Vidyapati Shabdavali, Kavi Chaturbhuj Shabdavali, and Badrinath Jha Shabdavali, a detailed description of the Maithili word treasury has been given.

The opportunity to read Maithili Haiku and Kshanika's Siddhant was found.

The flood of Mithila, which becomes a disaster for the local residents, a description of this problem and government efforts has been done well.

The attempt to bring the compositions of the forgotten poet Pt. Ramji Chaudhary before the readers. Actually, this is your unforgettable

work.

Vidyapati's Videsiya - Pia Desantar - some new facts have come to light in this.

In the review of the story collection 'Banait-Bigadait' by Subhash Chandra Yadav, a meaningful effort has been made by you. This statement that "He gives form to life through the medium of story. Adorning the story with both craft and content, he makes the story meaningful." You have reviewed this story collection in detail.

Maithili on the Internet - in this, new and knowledge-enhancing facts have been served for the readers. In today's time, its knowledge and experience have become very necessary.

Society and Culture in Lorik's Gatha - in this Gatha, you have revealed the society and culture and political aspects of that time.

Mithila's Search - you kept doing it, village to village. Along with this, by acquainting the readers with the places, you did a commendable job.

Tvanchahanch and Asanjati Man (Song Composition) - in the song composition, an extremely broad depiction of life has been expressed in the form of sublime human experience.

In the beginning, you have written:

"This India scripture

In which the song of victory

Then when did the local people

become

Actionless, narrow....."

In the end, you have done it with this line:

"This offering of the Asanjati Man

You have given, O Buddha

O Buddha- O Buddha."

Otherwise, now epics are being written less. But all genres of literature should remain alive. An attempt has been made by you to carry this tradition forward. You have made an attempt to decorate a mythological story, based on religious preaching, as a plot in some new way. The use of Tatsam vocabulary has been done for expression. Otherwise, bringing such words suitable to the characters was necessary. Saying the title felt

somewhat difficult. Nevertheless, the composition is worthy of respect.

****Children's Poetry**** - In this, along with preaching, there should be the capacity to delight the mind, which maintains curiosity. Showing new, new charming scenes, you have attempted to acquaint the children with a new world. Like:

"You do the hard work

Give me the fruit....."

Second line:

"Think about the buffalo, what did the buffalo do so much? Time has not changed, this village of mine has not changed."

Certainly, by composing so many children's poems, you have made a commendable effort to fill the treasury of children's literature.

In the end, this is a new experiment of collecting all literary genres in one place. There is purity of grammar and language. For the book, I would say this: you have made such a flower garden, adorned with different types of flowers, entering which, the reader, as they aspire, will obtain that form and fragrance, and becoming delighted like me, will say: "Thank you."

(From Videha Archive, published on the blog 'Maithili Samalochna' operated by Videha on 7 April 2012)

****Kurukshetram**
Antarmanak**

****Shiv Kumar Jha 'Tillu'****

Some people have this tendency that they keep making new, new types of experiments in their ongoing lives. Due to these new experiments, the dawn of a new class is seen in the world. Experimentalism cannot be born from an individual's wish; it is the result of natural talent. In Maithili literature, there is no lack of experimentalist sons of Saraswati, but in the present time, mother Mithila has activated one such experimentalist son of Mithila in her lap, who is attempting to change the condition of contemporary Maithili. That revolutionary and supporter of the balanced thought stream, that person is unknown to none - the editor of Maithili literature's first internet fortnightly magazine,

Videha - Shri Gajendra Thakur. It may be that some people would have been trying to connect Maithili literature with the internet, but giving it a concrete form and reaching up to 371 issues, the work was done by Gajendra ji. By binding new, new genres of literature and the ignored class of society in the embrace of Maithili, bringing communism and socialism to the soil of Maithili, he washed away the inappropriate stigma attached to the foreheads of us all. The work that has been done in 371 issues, where and where it was done before, can be known after doing self-observation. To cover the rotten, naked, and indifferent class of society on the mental screen of his narrative, not everyone can muster the courage. He did not do such work only to show off; in the compositions of the creators of that neglected class, the dynamism and sense of empathy in

the subject matter is not less than anyone else. The other facet of the work of the experimentalist Gajendra ji is the self-realization of emotions filled with the seven-colored gulal of the rainbow, emerging from the stream of his writing - "Kurukshetram Antarmanak".

What should this book be called? A novel, stories, children's literature, criticism, essays, or poetry? He has churned the abundant juice of all genres of literature and made a concoction, where it is impossible to say where the waters of Ganga, Kosi, Yamuna, or Hooghly are?

Seeing the title, I was startled. Is this the arena of the Mahabharata! But if you think from your heart, every human's heart has two forms, but

the inner mind always speaks the truth; there is no place for falsehood there.

Kurukshetra was indeed a battlefield, but there, a war was fought for the victory of truth. There, the play of destruction was enacted for the establishment of religion. Gajendra ji are directing us all to see the Kurukshetra within our own inner souls.

Which untruth of Maithili literature should be renounced? Why has the sweet narrative come to such a state? The creation of a new path happens with a new perspective. I understand that in this book, priority has been given to the perspective for the amalgamation of literature. Writing an article on such unique literature is not easy for me - but I am daring to

do it -

"Letter after letter is becoming exhausted

The purpose is not revealed through words

All the mind's things remained in the mind

Always bathed with a handful."

This book, divided into seven parts, can be called a message for the entire family.

****Research-Essay-Criticism:**** The beginning of this part is done with the story 'Seet-Basant', based on a folk tale. In post-medieval history, how many stories like Alha-Udal and

Shit-Basant were prevalent, whose staging in poetic form is happening in village after village of Bihar in the present time. While depicting the subject matter of a royal family, has the author attempted to question the love of a stepmother? From the beginning to the end of the story, a poignant experience is felt. At the end of the story, the stepmother got the shadow of that son whom she had defeated.

Shri Mayanand Mishra is considered a refined litterateur of all genres of Maithili literature. By presenting a balanced article on the four main pillars of his historical understanding, Pratham Shailputri Cha, Mantraputra, Purohit, and Stridhan, Gajendra ji is challenging the perspective of the essays written previously. Based on the history of the Rigvedic era, Mantraputra is

considered Mayanand ji's major work. Maya ji received the Sahitya Akademi award for this book. Mantraputra is influenced by Western history. Along with Mantraputra, in Purohit as well, a glimpse of Western culture is seen. Gajendra ji has verbatim proven his criticism, but did not raise any question mark on Maya Babu's world of composition. The form of criticism should be like this. With the critic remaining free from prejudice, the dignity of the literary work is not violated.

The review by Gajendra ji on Kedarnath Chaudhary ji's two novels, 'Chameli Rani' and 'Mahur', can be considered completely true. The sales of many works in Maithili literature could not happen as much in the entire Maithil society, but that much sale of 'Chameli Rani'

happened only in Janakpur. From this, the reverence of readers towards this literature can be seen. 'Mahur' was a revolutionary novel for Maithili literature. A comparison of a character from this novel with a character from Arvind Adiga's work demonstrates the author's linguistic richness.

Through the courtesy of Videha-Sadeha, a drama by Nachiketa ji, 'No Entry Ma Pravesh', has been published. For the writing of this drama, Nachiketa ji was given the Kirti Narayan Mishra Samman. By doing a logical analysis of the drama's four waves, Gajendra ji attempted to change the form of criticism. In this drama, at places, logic and modernity have negated the objectivity of the subject matter.

In the chapter before writing the composition, Gajendra ji attempted to pay special attention to language editing in Maithili literature. In his own literature, full attention is not being paid to linguistic errors.

Through Kavisheshwar Jyotirishwar Shabdavali, Vidyapati Shabdavali, Rasamay Kavi Chaturbhuj Shabdavali, and Badrinath Shabdavali, a detailed description of the timeless word structure and word treasury of Mithila-Maithili has been given. This will certainly help in language editing. There are many such words, about which even the big, big scholars of literature might not have known before. Certainly, this chapter will be useful for readers as well as for litterateurs and those competitors of civil services who, taking Maithili as a main subject, are trying to participate in

the competition. The critic is discussing a new poetic genre among us all - Haiku. On this genre, compositions were already being written in Maithili before, but this genre was known by the name 'Kshanika'. Gajendra ji has done the real depiction of this poetic form, created by Japanese literature, in Maithili literature.

Whether called a disaster or a devastation for Mithila, hearing the word 'Flood', all the people uprooted from the interiors of Kosi, Kamala, Balan, Gandaki, Bagmati, and Kareha start to tremble. The condition of this problem, the speed and direction of government efforts, along with the author's perspective on the means of survival, are well understood.

If at any place and in any other

place, we people come to know that they are Maithil, the people's perspective becomes clear - we all are fish-eaters. The reason is that the life of those living on the riverbanks is like that of aquatic creatures. Most individuals consume aquatic life. Therefore, we all are understood to be lovers of fish and makhana, and in reality, we all are lovers of fish. In most Maithil Brahmin families, the consumption of fish is mandatory from marriage to shraddha. In other castes, it is not mandatory, but most people of that class too are lovers of fish. Paying attention to the consumption-pattern of these people, the author has written the 'Krishi Matsya Shabdavali'. In this, an analysis of all types of fish, their size, color, and form has been done. The author's views on the vivid system of a pair of oxen for agricultural work, each plow, etc., can be considered good. Hearing the various names of

Karail, Taruj, and Kheera, village life comes to mind.

The best subject of this part, which shook my inner mind, is the fluent and detailed presentation on the world of compositions of the forgotten poet, Pandit Ramji Chaudhary. There was some complexity with the language of us all, that there are so many such creators in this world who have departed, bundling their compositions with themselves. The reason is that the compilation of the works of some creators among these could not happen, or even if done, it did not reach the readers. Who should be blamed for this, the creator or the then-protectors of our language? In this crowd, the name of Ramji Chaudhary is also there. In compositions written on ragas in Maithili literature, Ramji Babu's

compositions are also there. The songs emerging from his pen, in the form of the devotional Raag Vinay Vihag, Maheshwani, Thumri, Tirhuta, Dhrupad, Chaiti, and Samdaun, are invaluable. By bringing to light the compositions extremely useful for the present generation in classical style Maithili singing, Gajendra ji has done a great service to Mithila, Maithili, and the Maithils. The strength to accept the truth exists only in a few people. Gajendra ji is a person standing in the line of those people. Quantitatively, Maithili literature is considered ahead of Bhojpuri, but from a quality perspective, Bhojpuri is much more refined. The epochal man of Bhojpuri literature, Bhikhari Thakur, got a separate identity for this language through his poignant Bidesiya. The main reason for the lack of Bidesiya in the Maithili language was indifference towards

migration. If it was ever written, it was given the form of an epic. Bidesiya poetry, and written by Vidyapati? I too had not believed. Vidyapati is mainly considered an erotic poet. Otherwise, his compositions are also connected with the sentiment of devotion. After reading the book Kurukshetram Antarmanak, a new thought came to mind. What is called Bidesiya in Bhojpuri literature is actually present in Maithili - Pia-Deshantar.

In Vidyapati's Nepal Padavali, compositions of this type are collected, but they were never glorified in this form. The reason is clear: the dramatic form of Pia-Deshantar is performed among the backward castes of Mithila. Therefore, the forward-thinking people consider it appropriate to stay away from it. How can Maithili's

condition and direction get a new impetus from this? Maithili is a folk language; efforts should be made to promote folk culture. The straightforward perspective of Gajendra ji should be reflected. "Know here, friend, the beloved's pain" – it is a description of erotic-separation pain, but it is Pia-Deshantar.

Gajendra ji's review of Shri Subhash Chandra Yadav ji's story collection 'Banait-Bigadait' is unparalleled. In the introduction, I had read his story 'Kathak Banala Lok'. Seeing the pathos of Badariya, the hero of 'Kathak Banala Lok', even a stone could melt. Actually, Subhash ji is the Phanishwar Nath Renu of Maithili literature. In the era of glorification, his stories are put in the curriculum only to show off. How long will regional compositions be kept covered in the path of ridicule? One day, the cover will surely open, and

the truth will have to be faced. Folk-oriented litterateurs, whether it be Dhumketu, Kumar Pawan, Kamla Chaudhary, Subhash Chandra Yadav, Jagdish Prasad Mandal, or any other, their compositions should not be neglected. Seeing the reviews of Subhash ji's stories 'Kaniya-Putra', 'Banait-Bigadait', and 'Drishti', the incessant conflict of the condition of the times becomes present. I am indebted that Gajendra Babu wrote a review on this book.

The use of the internet for the internet, felt good. I could not understand Gajendra ji's exposition and rules regarding the technique of making a website. I read it three times, but it flew over my head like the June heat of Bihar. New, new children will understand it. The memory power of children of the technical age is greater, so for them all, I left this chapter.

Lorik's Gatha is based on the culture of the neglected class of society. In the introduction and recognition of the brave original man Lorik of Saharsa-Supaul, a vision of mythological Maithil culture is seen.

In Mithila's Search, from places in Nepal like Janakpur, Sugga Dhanusha, to many northern Maithil villages in Madhubani district, and in the south, Jayamangalagarh (Begusaraj) has been discussed. In the east, from many places in Purnia and Kishanganj, to in the west, the temple of mother Durga at Chamunda (Muzaffarpur) has been discussed.

The description of some places in Mithila was not found in this list,

like: Sati Sthan (village-Shasan, block-Hasanpur, district-Samastipur) and Udayanacharya's birthplace (village-Kariyan, district-Samastipur). The author cannot be blamed for this, because Mithila's Search has been taken from Videha, in which Gajendra ji has invited that if anyone has information about any famous place that is not included in this, then please send the information along with its photograph. Some more places may have been missed; enlightened readers can work on this subject.

****Sahasrabadhaneer Novel:****

Sahastrabadhaneer is a celestial body, whose sight is considered inauspicious in the Aryan religious view, but the novelist, assimilating this inauspicious body, made it Savitri. Savitri, with her chastity and strong determination, had snatched

Satyavan's life from Yama. The perspective of this novel is not like that, but in the protagonist Arunee's victory over death, the invocation of Sahastrabadhanees inspiration has been done. On the main page of Kurukshetram Antarmanak, a picture of Sahastrabadhanees has been given. From this, it is proven that in the creator's view, among all seven parts of the entire book, this novel has special importance. Upon studying Sahastrabadhanees, a description from the latter half of the nineteenth century up to the present time has been given.

To consider the description of the story of a family spanning one hundred and fifteen years as a fictional story would definitely be considered an ax blow to the creator's feelings. Actually, this story is the story of the creator's lineage. If

it is considered Gajendra Babu's autobiography, then possibly it would not be an exaggeration. The original man of the novel, Jhingur Babu, is a farmer. In whose house, in the year of the establishment of the Indian National Congress, 1885 AD, a child took birth - Kalit. The commencement of this novel has been done from Kalit's childhood. In that time of Kalit, the arrangement for teaching English was made in Darbhanga by a Bengali teacher. From this, a feeling of two types is perceived. First, that Jhingur Babu was a prosperous person. In that time, education in Avahattha was also given in counted and selected families; the story of English was very rare. Second, that Bengali people were ahead of us all in terms of education. A Bengali person as an English teacher, how backward were we that in our cultural capital, Darbhanga, no Maithil English

teacher was found for Jhingur Babu.

The discussion of the assembly trees of Saurath and Sasaula is done repeatedly, but in this book, the perspective of connecting the story with the assembly tree of the village Pratapur, on the banks of the now-extinct assembly river Balan, is different but well understood. In Kalit's marriage, in the groom's wedding party, the old wedding guests going in a cart and the young people going on foot seems strange to the present generation, but it is necessary to acquaint children with our ancient culture. The story after Kalit's death started revolving around the periphery of his younger son Nand. Nand's transparent thinking, talking directly with his wife, not addressing in the third person. In Mithila, in conversations between groom-bride, mother-in-

law-daughter-in-law, brother-in-law, addressing in the third person is mandatory. Against this type of system, Nand ji centered his new thinking. The relationship between groom and bride, naturally, is just a compromise, but in the world's system, this is the most sacred and unique relationship. If one person is left out in the lifelong conduct, the anguish in the other..... unspeakable anguish. Therefore, there should be direct address in this relationship. My view is not that we should defeat our culture, but the necessity of change, like the motion of time, seems imperative even in culture and system.

Aryavarta is considered the land of emergence of pristine philosophies like Nyaya, Karma, Mimamsa. In this part, providing distinction to the land of Mithila with a new

philosophy is the dignity of relationship in the image of honesty and compassion. Nand Babu was an engineer. If he had been somewhat lax in his duty, his family could have been drenched in the flood of materialism. But not doing so, he continuously bound his work to tangible truth. It is natural that in the age of materialism, the relevance of honesty becomes very little. The analysis of the family's condition after his untimely death seemed poignant. The effect of his good deeds was this that the children, especially Arunee, could not become very prosperous materially, but they became human beings in the shelter of their father's shade. Through the speed of actions, one can obtain the enjoyment of kingdoms, but for becoming a human, natural values are more important. Therefore, it has been said: "The son increases in the father's religion." Sometimes, the

offspring of a low-thinking person becomes a human child; in this, physical values and the play of nature are involved. In the story of this novel, centered on Arunee's firm belief, the continuously flowing Ganga stream seemed gurgling and cool. If the story is assimilated, it cannot be considered fictional in any sense. I cannot clearly consider it an autobiography, because the novelist has not evoked it in any form. It may be a sketch of the society's surroundings, but in my opinion, this is not fiction; it is based on true events.

I also saw one shortcoming in the novel. At places, the use of English letters has been done, like: Anesthesia, Opinion, Impression, etc. In place of these all words, the use of our own words could have been done, but it was not done. I

understand that we only assimilate those words from other languages in place of which there is a lack of words in our own language.

****Sahasrabdi Ka Chaupadpar:**** The third part of Kurukshetram Antarmanak is in the form of a poetry collection, whose title has been given as 'Sahasrabdi Ka Chaupadpar'. In the inclusion of only forty-three poems, along with erotic, separation Haiku, thought-based poetry, there is also one flag song. Like the sky color of the rainbow, in the first poem 'Shamil Bajak Dundabhi Vadak', under the cover of momentary nature, a sense of tone and scale is felt, but after observing the inner meaning, the situation is completely different. In the instrumental culture of Rajasthan, in the centrality of the relevance of a spectator instrument, the poet's

feeling seemed unclear. It is natural, 'where the sun does not reach, the poet went there'. The poet himself is a Dundabhi player, so how can there be a clear vision? I had read one poem in Hindi literature: 'Goraiyo ki Majlis me Koyal hai Mujrim'. Possibly, the silent viewpoint of society's path-guide has been made the central point of the poem. Even a person with a multi-faceted personality, feeling pressure in the motion of life, suppresses their sensitivity somewhere and acts like a Dundabhi player. Some people, to satisfy others, change their ideology externally. Whether it is the tendency of gratification or some kind of compulsion, we should not, under the pretext of adjusting to circumstances, bury our balanced thoughts in the soil. If society considers this a prejudice, then one should analyze one's own side, but one should not give silent support to

nonsensical ranting.

On the invisible wall of the mind's colors, the vision of the subject matter of circumstantial inequalities is beyond expectation. In the poems titled 'Mandakini...' and 'Pakka Jathi', in the silent attack on dissolved humanity between nature and the condition of society, the poet's natural but invisible thinking is like an unsolved puzzle for an ordinary critic like me. People do not want to remember that day of their ancient history, from which one experiences immense pain. The events of the Treta Yuga have been pushed back to the Kali Yuga. Sita ji's marriage happened on Agahan Shukla Paksha Panchami; the result is before us. Then why did priest Shatanand ji have the marriage of the aunt from Kharadak performed on that same date? It may be that in

her fate, household happiness like Sita ji was not written, but the stigma was attached to the date of 'Wedding Panchami'. In this poem, the poet's perspective is to support widow marriage, but the upper-caste Maithils are not accepting it. Taking our old baggage, how long will we remain engrossed in the fantasy of building a bridge over the estuary? The new subject that was understood in this poetry collection is 'Barah Ta Haiku'. For the Gidar's Niraith, Rakash Than, Shahi's Maus, and Bidh, word after word resonates.

Finding a meaningful interpretation of Haiku is extremely difficult, but I understand that if such Haiku are written, then all the children who speak Maithili with their mother, family, and relatives will definitely understand them.

In Mithila's flag song, a meaningful movement of action has been requested from the motherland. Like the prayer of the Gayatri Pariwar, 'Vah Shakti Hame Do Dayanidhi', is sung. His perspective of giving mother veneration in the poetry collection may be suitable in the compositional sequence, but in my opinion, if it had been given on the first page of Kurukshetram Antarmanak as veneration, it would have been more beautiful.

In 'Badka Sadak Chhah Lan Bala', a sequential description of Mithila's development has been given.

After observing the entire poetry collection, no poem seemed startling. In the poem titled 'Putra Prapti', there is a discussion about the cheating tricks of a priest from our community in Ludhiana. Due to such

cheating, people often view a 'Bihari' person with suspicion at eight places. But my request to Gajendra ji is that permission for the translation of this poem into Punjabi should not be given, otherwise many Maithils who pretend to be gentlemen will return to their villages, and the conspiracy in our society will increase further.

****Galpa Guccha:**** By including 23 stories-short stories, it has been given the name Galpa Guccha. In this section of sixty-four pages, reflecting all the forms of time and season, the storyteller has attempted to write in the comprehensive genre of literature. In the story 'Sar Samaj', the silent presentation of economics seemed good, but the lack of artistic style was felt. In the story reflecting 'Gharak Marammati', if there had been some flow of juice, the story could have been even better. In

'Ham Nahi Jaeb Videsh', opposition to escapism has been done; the image is good, but in the analysis, the harmony of ornamentation was not found. A story with such poignant subject matter should be of that type which creates a tremor in the heart. 'Rag Bhairevi' is short but touches culture. Time, place displacement, and life on a crutch can be considered average.

No literature can be considered complete until the language and literature related to the last person of society are connected to it. After reading the story "Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan", the explanation of the reason for the failure of government schemes towards Dalit, backward, etc., classes in Maithili literature seems real. There is no morsel of food in the stomach, and books are available for free; questioning such a

state of education is natural. The storyteller with a communist mindset wants to clarify through the pretext of the story that the division among the poor based on caste is the impure form of our society. Short purposeful poems have been given the name Kshanika or Haiku, but what should the short story be called? In a short story, the analysis of imagery is very complex, but the presentation of the caste stigma attached to the existence of the Maithili language in "Jativadi Marathi" is commendable. The subject matter of Thether Manukkh, Bahupatni Vivah and Hijda, Stri-Beti Biah and Goralgai, Pratibha, Anukampa ki Naukari, all seemed short-small but meaningful. Just as the author Khushwant Singh, discussed in Hindi literature's newspapers and magazines, writes many things in just two lines, exactly like that, reading these all short

stories was understood.

The short story 'Jati-Pati' then seemed completely naked. The inferiority of caste in an I.P.S. probationary officer of the Dom caste can deeply pain any close person. Along with the social imagery of Mrityudanda and Banveer, the stories related to feudalism and media, if considered as touching upon a new stream for Maithili literature, are not unmatched, but there is no harm. Now the question arises: which genre should Galpa-Guccha be considered? It has been the misfortune of our language that more than the subject matter of the story, special attention is given to linguistics, image analysis, and the artistry of word structure. Most deans of literature do not want to pay attention to one thing: whether

the message of a balanced life goes to the landscape of society from the composition or not. Along with caste, it is essential to rise above the pretense of gratification; otherwise, a question mark will arise on the existence of Maithili. Maithili has been most affected within the periphery of regionalization. Along with sister languages, due to the influence of Western culture, the Maithili language has flickered. To implant a new flame in this language, one must work by rising above the situation of class struggle. Instead of the handful, if, along with Maithil Brahmins and Karn Kayasthas, an attempt is made to reach the majority covered but the guardian class of the folk language, then in the condition of Maithili, not four but eight moons will shine.

The analysis of the style of the

storyteller of these all stories, whatever it may be, its decision should be left to the readers, but the purpose of the composition is clear. Gajendra ji, through the medium of this story collection, definitely wants to implant a new balanced light, protecting his culture in society, where Dom, Chamar, Brahmin, Rajput, Muslim, and Kayastha are not the only ones, but Mithila is discussed within the periphery of the sky of the word "Maithil". It is unfortunate that in reviewing Maithili books, criticism and rejoinder are considered the main image, whereas in other languages, attention is paid to the psychology and perspective of the creator.

In the author's story collection "Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal", almost all the stories of Galpa-Guccha have come in an expanded

form, and all the points of criticism have ended there. In 'Some instructions or suggestions for readers' of "Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal", Gajendra Thakur writes:

"Some stories of this book ("Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal") are the expanded form of my stories published/e-published before the year 2023; all the stories of this book are being declared the authentic version of those stories (if anyone wants to compile, mention, or translate any of these stories in any collection, this applies to them)."

****Drama- Sankarshan:**** A drama of only 16 pages; hearing it seems somewhat inappropriate, but if read with absorption, it becomes clear how and why only some storytellers like Shri Chandradhar Sharma Guleri ji in Hindi literature have been

assimilated?

The presence of a special emotion is natural in any drama where an actor like Sankarshan is present. The actor has no quality, but Gajendra ji made him the main hero. This is the true form of society's rotting condition: on one side, the cowherd of Mahis, and on the other side, the sycophant of the Collector. Touching the social image of Mithila, the short drama Sankarshan has the form of a street play. "Ho Gonar! How to apply water to it. If the skin of the feet rots, then new ones will come. But if this rots, then where will it come from?" The meaning of saying this is: for a person who considers something like leather shoes more important than the body, what is the purpose of life's empathy in that person?

Economics is more important than religious policy. Worthy of contemplating the changing form of time, possibly this was the very purpose of this drama. For staging, it cannot be considered suitable in any sense, because the curtain rises and the drama ends in half an hour. But Sankarshan, which centers on the drama troupe of life, certainly seemed worthy of contemplation. In all dramas, there is an inclusion of humor and eroticism in some form or another, but here, why the lack? Reading this drama, which touches the psychology of society, one line from a poem by some poet came to mind:

"I keep wiping the drip-drip of four with my finger."

Gajendra ji's effort seemed small but imitable.

****Tvanchahanch and Asanjati Man:**** As becomes clear from the name, both poems have been written reflecting historical events. The analysis of Aryan culture within the periphery of religion and the field of action seemed good. Regarding this epic, only this much can be said that an attempt has been made to keep the tradition alive through the poetry writing of Surendra Jha Suman, Vaidyanath Mallik Vidhu, and Markandey Pravasi ji.

****Children's Group and Youth World:**** We all are proud that the Maithili language is considered the most mellifluous language among the language group of the entire Aryan family. Literary thought, seeing the count of readers, is also not less than anyone. But one aspect that remained the weakest is the poverty of children's literature in

Maithili language and literature. For the sake of saying, many writers or poets show continuous eloquence in connecting themselves to children's literature, but if a complete count of children's literature compositions is done, then only a few litterateurs like Jeevakant ji are there whose pens remained active in this direction. Whereas if children's literature is not refined, then in the near future, the form of the mother tongue may dissolve. In this direction, one should be grateful for Gajendra ji's effort. Among all seven parts of Kurukshetram Antarmanak, the best part is the children's group. On the youth world, he wrote with his heart, not with his hand. In this part, two children's dramas, twenty-five children's stories, alphabet education, and over one hundred children's poems have been given. The language of the compositions, written centering all images, is

extremely simple. Children need such compositions. If children's literature is written in Tatsam, what is its purpose? The poems can be considered very good -

"Today holiday

Tomorrow holiday

Will wander, roam, and go to the village....."

For children's understanding, the restlessness of the mind is more useful than ornamentation, so it is not appropriate to see this section in a critical form.

****Conclusion:**** In this book divided into seven parts, an attempt has been made to taste the comprehensive essence of literature. But what is its biggest negative form? What should

it be considered? It may be that by touching all streams, Gajendra ji wants to center a new metaphorical stream in Maithili literature.

In one book, along with essays, criticism, a novel, stories, a poetry collection, an epic, and children's literature, it has made the book huge. It may be that along with the critics, some readers may not like it, but I consider it appropriate to welcome this type of experiment. Otherwise, for the convenience of readers, it has also been published separately. Language editing also seemed good; verbal and grammatical errors are extremely minimal.

(From Videha Archive, published on the blog 'Maithili Samalochna' operated by Videha on 7 April 2012)

****Maithili Children's Poetry Stream****

****Professor Premshankar
Singh****

In the present decade, in the Maithili children's poetry stream, a multi-genre talented young poet has made a strong signature, and he is Gajendra Thakur (1971), who, despite being an expatriate, inspired by affection for his mother tongue, registered his presence in this field, whose over a hundred children's poems, etc., are collected in "Kurukshetram Antarmanak" (2009). This reveals the subject-diversity of all the collected poems, etc. The poet has analyzed, with extreme subtlety and in a unique

manner, the psychological analysis of the child's mind, its various curiosities, happiness, pain, sorrow, natural beauty, childlike restlessness, rain, cold-rain, sports, the pain of child laborers, the activities of Kindergarten school, happiness on getting a holiday, unhappiness on studying, and hesitation in going to school, etc., etc. The infant gets more affection from the paternal grandfather and maternal grandfather, due to which he is more aspiring to stay with them, because he does not get pampering and affection from other members in the family environment due to lack of time. He gets appropriate answers to his various curiosities there, due to which he continuously prefers to stay near them.

The child's mind is so sensitive that

seeing the social environment, he becomes self-aware of richness and poverty. The poet has depicted its real condition in the following lines, as follows:

"Flesh and flesh are like a skeleton

Bones have come out

If rice and paddy are not available

Then why was gruel not given

And master, do not ask about wheat

Its price has increased

That big era has gone

Don't play talk while playing"

(Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p.
7.137)

The poet has expressed the emotion
of the child's happiness when he gets
a holiday from going to school; just
look at its direction:

"Today holiday

Tomorrow holiday

Will wander, roam, and go to the
village

Meet with grandfather,
grandmother, maternal uncle,
maternal aunt

All the birds and small birds

The rain quilt has come

Clouds have fled in all directions

Black clouds, white clouds

Clouds have spread

Birds and small birds have come"

(Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p. 7.85)

When a child sees an elephant for the first time, he becomes astonished and suddenly delighted; he suddenly exclaims, "the elephant's ears like winnows" (Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p. 7.84) and "a pipe attached to the elephant's mouth" (Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p. 7.71).

The pain of child laborers also comes to the fore, like:

"Winter has come again

The bones are cracking

Bihari!!

It seems dawn has broken

From the dew, the morning has

started again

Without preparation"

(Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p. 7.90)

As far as the question of language use is concerned, in this, the young poet has introduced his liberal tendency. As a result of globalization, the much-prevalent light words, etc., of different languages are being used abundantly in Maithili; how the child assimilates them and learns international languages, some examples of that are available here and there in these poems, etc. The child tries to imitate such and such words in his stammering speech, as a result of which his knowledge of language expands effortlessly; some examples of that are found in this, as follows:

"The train vehicle on the riverbank

Came to the station, left in the news

The train ran, ran all night

The trees slept, the trees became
morning"

(Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p. 7.63)

In the ultra-modern environment,
the child has become excessively
attached to sports, so much so that
he has completely forgotten his
ancestral games and has become
attracted to Western sports. The poet
has analyzed this restlessness of the
child in this way:

"Grandfather, what should I do first

Bowling or batting?

If I bowl, I will get tired

If I bat, I will get hit?

The first day you slipped

Listen to this, son

Leaving and abandoning batting and
bowling

First do fielding, little hands"

(Kurukshetram Antarmanak, p.
7.121)

His poetic language is extremely expanded and wide, which he has used. Despite living in a metropolitan environment, he has used the most rustic of rustic words in Maithili with great skill, such as: Gaachh-Paat (trees-leaves), Bhore-Sakaal (early morning), Jhahraau (shed), Hiyaau (hearten), Phusiye (rotten), Lukkhee (worthless), Khikheer (rice-gruel), Peechal (slippery), Sunn (hear), Dhahana-it (collapse), Jhalphal

(flicker), Soop (winnow), Iyaar (friend), Chaalee (plow), Chhaagar (goad), Burabak (foolish), Khagataa (paddy-land), Jalkhai (marsh), Bon (downpour), Ghatak (literate), Garipadhua (downpour), Thalathal (soaking), Auntab (turn), Masausi (mother's sister), Purkha (ancestor), Adhakhijoo (half-done), Kopar (elbow), Satakaa (slip), Khaujhaa-i (anger), Lajkotor (window), Muhachuru (face), Kathook (sometime), Diyaabaatee (lamp-flame), Ghata-kaitee (householder), Jharakali (jolt), Dhamagijjar (huge), Chorukkaa (stealthily), etc., etc.

Seeing the dynamism of the young poet, it seems that in the future, his poetic power will develop even more, because he, like a flower bud, along with Maithili children's poetry, has also created poetry in sufficient quantity for adults, which is

luminous.

(From Videha Archive, Videha 70th issue, 15 November 2010)

****Story Penetrating to
the Layer of Social
Inequality****

****Abha Jha****

I know Gajendra Thakur ji as the chief editor of Videha magazine. Occasionally, some exchange of messages related to literary writing has definitely happened, but in the course of purposeful message-sending, it is not possible to know any person. For literary acquaintance, that is not very

necessary. Today in my hand is a story-collection of his that, along with the uniqueness of its name, also encompasses diversity in its size and form; that collection is 'Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal'. First, a pleasure-seeking bee, leaving the flower, what did it go to do on the difficult, hard mountain? And second, having gone there, why did it sleep? Many questions of this type definitely create many curiosities in the mind of a simple reader like me, and for the quelling of that curiosity, only the study of the book is the way! In the course of study, in the long story section, reaching and reaching 'Shabdashastram', an introduction is made to the source song of the title in a lyrical form, and one steps closer to understanding the significance of words.

This diversity of Gajendra Thakur's writing is not only in this book but is seen in his entire writing. Along with

writing ghazals, criticism, novels, poetry collections, story-bundles (long and short story collections), dramas, songs, essays, children's dramas, stories, poems, history, biographies, etc., the discussion of notable work on Devanagari, Tirhuta, and Braille scripts definitely proves that his talent is multifaceted, his vision wide, his nature innovative, and his style multi-colored! Nowadays, many e-magazines are emerging, but Videha is Maithili's famous and first fortnightly e-magazine, which has been continuously and uninterruptedly published under Gajendra Thakur ji's editorship for many years till now. The author's novel thinking and his diverse cultural views can inspire creativity and various innovations. Various regional studies, awareness of contemporary needs, and the thought of the criterion of propriety

and impropriety form the basis for the creation of standard literature. After reading this collection of Gajendra Thakur, one gets an introduction to his study of ancient oriental literature, acquaintance with global literature, subtle observation of Maithil society and tradition, unbiased analysis of merits and demerits, and the psychological analysis of any particular event. In this book, there is a collection of three types of stories: long stories, short stories, and very long stories. Here, the purpose of giving all three types of stories in one place could possibly be that the author also had in mind the clarification of the pride that exists over short stories and very long stories; this can be guessed. But Gajendra Thakur has not accepted the challenge that the supporters of the very long story pose to its limits.

In addition to this, some stories are also in English, which have been self-translated by the author. First of all, I consider some short stories, which, rooting themselves in the social fabric, perform surgery on the entrenched selfishness, greed for others' wealth, and the natural tendency to oppress the weak, and move forward. For a helpless woman, how difficult it is to use her own property as she wishes; at every step, to grab her property, people, donning the guise of good people and claiming to be relatives, hover like vultures over flesh, and any method, persuasion, bribery, or punishment, succeeds. Here, there is a story matching Premchand's famous story 'Panch Parameshwar', called 'Siddh Mahavir', but Premchand ends the story by awakening the consciousness of conscience along with responsibility, and Gajendra Thakur has placed the naked form of

human nature's selfishness in front. No sense of guilt, no shame, just the naked form of selfishness! But the author, doing psychological analysis, goes on - seeing such behavior of people, in reaction, the listless elder sister's disenchantment towards her parental home, her faith in Hanuman ends!

In the story 'Navi Mumbai', a description of Mithila's natural social system has been done naturally. The natural desire to connect with one another, natural and simple laughter and jest, naturally gives the fragrance of Mithila's soil. But the main subject is the horror of the Corona period, the anxiety of family members, the medical incompetence of the entire world, and, dominating over that, mutual distrust and man-made deprivation! The story, giving a

memory of that terrible period, gives goosebumps.

In the story 'New Delhi', the pain of migration and the unbearable condition of that pain can be seen in this line: 'A family forms again, and after thirty years, I will see its result. Till then, this cold shiver, settled in the bones, much colder than the shiver of this rainy season. All will remain in this Delhi, to fight with Delhi, to make it New Delhi. And to make India a superpower, in the hope of its progress, for the next Gulf, one has to sacrifice this much...' And inside Delhi, there are many Delhis, Lutyens' Delhi as well as slum clusters. Otherwise, this wall of inequality, why only in Delhi, stands in the entire country, from which the tendency to turn a blind eye has been there for the power establishment as well as for the

comfort-seekers. Even now, amidst the 'G20 Meet', do you not find any skeleton-like child begging at a red light, wiping car windows, performing a circus between iron rods, or selling roses, or homeless people spending the night on the footpath? So, will the fate of all of them change after the foreign guests leave? In the story, although the main subject is the tendency of people to perform and get performed rituals, indifferent like a machine, towards the dark future of a young widow and an orphaned infant child, along with that, the naked reality beneath the false glitter and glamour is also visible.

'Taskar' is a story of the abduction of a girl dedicated to the king due to a love affair, in which not only the groom's but also the groom's father's consent is obtained. But this consent

is not through this: that the groom's father was of a very progressive ideology or was trapped in affection for his son! The sole purpose was to protect his lineage, to protect the priestly class! Here, this story goes on, opposing wave after wave that status-quoist thinking that is easily accepted in society, which remains unmoved seeing and hearing the marriage of a thirteen-year-old girl with an aged groom.

'Sangharsh' is the story of a widow who has woven the support of life in the form of her only son. But she tirelessly struggles against the departmental conspiracy to prove her son's murder a suicide. People call her crazy, but she has the stubbornness to install her son's statue at the gate of the government colony. During this struggle, she does not widen it only for herself, but indirectly shows the path of hope to

every person who loses and gives up in the vicious cycle of the justice system.

'Letterbox me Aayal Chitthi' is the story of those youth who, trapped in the web of drugs and terrorism, forgetting the definition of good or bad, crossing the border of moral and immoral, have created such a network where losing or winning has no meaning; what matters is the elimination of all kinds of thorns and obstacles coming in the way of their self-made world of equality, whether the innocent becomes its victim or not! In this web, whether people got trapped voluntarily or to protect their own people, this question is in its place, but the extremist step of dissatisfied people has created a terrible puzzle, this is an unambiguous truth!

A story analyzing caste and the caste system is 'Doma, Budhan and..'. Superficially, it seems that this is the story of change happening in the life of a lower-caste person who, through education and hard work, achieves a high post, and also marries a Brahmin's daughter, but still, an unsatisfied hunger for self-respect remains inside him. In this story, the author, giving proof of his logical intellect and deep study, goes on justifying quotes from the Vedic period, the Upanishadic period, and the Ramayana period according to his own calculation, goes on giving the essence of the debate between Gargi and Yajnavalkya, and ends the story considering the words given by Barbarik's guru in the Mahabharata as the root of social harmony. Although the level of this thought-based story is very high and the

presentation is distinct, yet, like a dense cloud of thoughts, the lightning of interest has been covered.

'Atamahatya' is the story of depression taking birth in the minds of today's and tomorrow's children, for which there is a lack of timely treatment. But even today, you and I, with the speed with which we treat physical ailments, are not that aware of mental illness.

The story 'Gandharv Letterbam' starts with this sentence: 'Giving respect to others became his thought, giving respect to his feelings. And from that, respect is obtained for that person and for the sky determined and created by that person for himself...'

Yes, even today, there is a lack of change in social thinking towards 'special people (the disabled)'. We all are somewhat intolerant in accepting people with a physical condition different from ours. Singing or begging for the blind, seeing the future of dwarfs in circuses, closing all doors of education and progress for transgenders, we have accepted as if natural.

Here, giving an example of change, the author takes Letterbam from the livelihood imposed by society, brings him into the world of his capabilities, makes him a successful singer, and makes his life meaningful. This should be the duty of a litterateur: to instill in the readers' minds the conception of an ideal society and its possibility, and to lay the foundation for social change indirectly. The author has been successful in that purpose.

In this collection, there are nine thoughts and nine stories, in which village-home, well-wishers-friends are there, along with that, there is a big platform for thought, where you can see the conflict between tradition and modernity, can get an introduction to the inner struggle of Dalits and the ideological narrowness of the so-called elite, can break your slumber from the long story of injustice happening around you, can awaken human values like empathy towards people with special abilities, and can understand the root cause of increasing discontent and extremism in society and remove that problem as much as possible.

Based on the theme of 'Letterbox me Aayal Chitthi' is the long story

'Madhubani Module', and in it, the hero's name is Mutalife, who makes his own laws for system change. Here, more than terrorist activities, it is an unfortunate narrative analysis of its cause, the brainwashing happening through social media, and the ill-will born towards an entire community as a result of one incident.

In the collection, some typical words come repeatedly: Peer Baccha (children of the in-laws' place), Mahisbar Brahmanak Gaam (village of Mahisbar Brahmins), Garh Narikel, Dushan Panji, etc.

In addition to this, there are two long stories titled 'Shabdashastram' and 'Mahisbar Brahmanak Gaam', in which there are stories of love, social acceptance, and the verbal effect of

bodiless love prevalent in the public mind. In them, with discussions of knowledge and ignorance, logic and analysis, dualism and non-dualism, the story becomes heavy and seems to be filling up, and in between, the inclusion of songs seems to attempt to bring freshness. In the story 'Shabdashastram', there is a song whose first line became the title of the book. The English translations of these both stories are also included in the book, and proof of their popularity is their publication in various newspapers and magazines and their display at international film festivals.

In the third part of the story, there are 36 very long stories, in which contemporary subjects like women's discourse, caste and sub-caste, advocacy-message, yellow journalism, the different scales of

ideology and region, hunger and migration, neo-feudalism, environmental discourse, the consumerism that has penetrated the education system, etc., have been successfully raised, and a solid plot has been given to the readers for thought.

The fourth part is in the form of an appendix, in which the author himself has given English translations of his own two short stories and two long stories. The purpose of the translation into English was undoubtedly in the author's mind that the expanse of Maithili stories should not remain limited only to Maithili-speaking readers, but should also get global acquaintance and fame. And that has also been displayed at international film festivals.

In short, just this much: this story collection is a cocktail of many forms, colors, sizes, and flavors, is based on diverse emotional landscapes, and has brought a big canvas for thought. Yes, the depth of thought, logical sharpness, presentation of classical and folk prevalent quotes, and careful alertness towards the conclusion definitely obstruct the natural, smooth flow of the story here and there, but for the clarity of communication of the subject, the author often takes this risk. For a story that penetrates to the layer of social inequality, commendation and hearty congratulations to the author.

****Litterateur Gajendra Thakur: Personality and Work****

****Acharya Ramanand Mandal****

The pioneer of the parallel Maithili literature movement, litterateur Gajendra Thakur, was a rare litterateur. He was a research-oriented litterateur. In his literature, the revelation of truth happens. There are two streams in Maithili literature. The first is the mainstream. In that, there is the literature of brahmanical and new brahmanical litterateurs. Brahmanical means the litterateurs of the Maithil Brahmins and Karn Kayasthas, and in new brahmanical,

there is the literature of non-Brahmins and non-Karn Kayasthas. The second is the parallel stream. In that, purely Solhakhan/Rar, meaning constitutionally SC/OBC's Maithili literature is there, which is deprived and neglected. That is not considered and kept in the mainstream Maithili literature. This has been continuing since ancient times. For example, Adikavi Vidyapati Nayee, who existed before Kavisheshwar Jyotirishwar. He had composed the Padavali, and his Vidyapat Naach was famous in that time. Whose discussion poet Jyotirishwar had done in his composition Varnaratnakar. But in today's time, people are unaware of Adikavi Vidyapati Nayee. He was hidden or neglected in the history of Maithili literature. But the discussed litterateur Gajendra Thakur, through his Maithili Videha e-magazine, made people aware of Adikavi

Vidyapati Nayee. He discussed his personality and work in his literature - 'Nit Navla' by Subhash Chandra Yadav. The picture of Adikavi Vidyapati Nayee was made by Panak Lal Mandal, who was honored with the Videha Samman.

Maithili litterateur and activist Gajendra Thakur, today, through the parallel Maithili literature movement, is encouraging the litterateurs of the Dalit and neglected classes. In his literature, he is giving respect in literature to the person of the oppressed-crushed society. But in brahmanical literature, the honor-enhancement of the dominationist and the honor-destruction of the caste or person of the oppressed-crushed society is done. For instance, litterateur Gajendra Thakur is writing a book on litterateur Rajdeo Mandal - 'Rajdeo Mandal - Maithili

Writer', and is writing a biography of Jagdish Prasad Mandal. In Maithili criticism-science, he gives the epithet of Maithili's first folk-poet to poet Ramdev Prasad Mandal Jharudar. He tells his poetry collection 'Ambara' to be the best Maithili poetry collection of the 21st century. The research-oriented litterateur Gajendra Thakur, in his literature, discusses the litterateurs of the parallel stream, which are rare in mainstream literature. Like: Sandeep Kumar Safi, Umesh Paswan, Bechan Thakur, Kapileshwar Raut, Umesh Mandal, Ramvilas Sahu, Rajdeo Mandal, Nandvilas Ray, Jagdish Prasad Mandal, Durganand Mandal, Acharya Ramanand Mandal, Lalan Kumar Kamat, Narayan Yadav, Munni Kamat, Shiv Kumar Prasad, Dhirandra Kumar, Ramdev Prasad Mandal Jharudar, Subhash Chandra Yadav and Kishan Karigar, etc.

Storyteller and novelist Gajendra Thakur is a Maithili writer dictionary creator and a knower of Videha (Mithila) history. He transcribed the inscriptions written on 1100 (eleven hundred) palm leaves - Basaha leaves, written in the Tirhuta script of the Maithili language, into the Devanagari script. He is the genealogical writer of the Panjis of all the Maithil Brahmin communities of the Mithila region. And in these, approximately 100 inter-caste marriages are also described in written form. The written evidence of personalities considered mythological until today became available for the first time.

Gajendra Thakur is the radiant family lamp of father Kripanand Thakur and mother Lakshmi Thakur.

His birth happened on 30 March 1971. His native village is Mehath, under Madhubani district. Presently, Gajendra Thakur is also the editor of Videha e-magazine. Through the magazine's Videha e-Learning medium, he presents material for the Union Public Service Commission / Bihar Public Service Commission exams for Maithili (compulsory and optional) and other optional subjects and general knowledge (English medium), along with for NTA-UGC-NET Maithili, which benefits competitive students. Approximately a thousand books are stored in the Videha archive, which readers or students can read or can download the PDF. Under Videha Samman, Parallel Sahitya Akademi, Parallel Lalit Kala Akademi, and Parallel Sangeet-Natak Akademi honors and awards are given, from which persons of the parallel stream get encouraged to do better in their field.

Litterateur Gajendra Thakur is an epochal man of the Maithili literature world. His personality and work are an example.

****Editorial Note:**** Ramanandji has divided brahmanical on the basis of caste, whereas Videha only talks about mindset. For Videha, neither all Brahmins are brahmanical, nor are all Dalits objects of sympathy. In the criticism of Gajendra Thakur, Ramanand Jha 'Raman' is brahmanical, and Taranand Viyogi is new brahmanical, whereas Ramanand Jha 'Raman' belongs to the Brahmin caste, and Taranand Viyogi belongs to a non-Brahmin-non-Kayastha caste.

****Maithili's True
Servant: Mr. Gajendra
Thakur Ji****

****Ajit Kumar Jha****

Writing something about Mr. Gajendra Thakur Ji is beyond my capability. The question arising is natural that then why am I writing? After all, what is the compulsion that I am daring to write something about him? The question is proper, and its brief answer is this: if due to lack of knowledge, errors related to language and grammar are found, it is my request that the enlightened readers refine them and read. I am sharing my mind's talk based on my

experience of being connected with Mithila Maithili magazines for the last fifteen years. Besides 'Mithila Darshan', 'Karnamrit', and 'Bharati Mandan', the responsibility of distributing some other short-term magazines in Muzaffarpur city was given to me. Being a working person, I would somehow take a day off and go out with great enthusiasm to donate labor for mother Maithili, but what to say of the anguish that used to be in my mind while returning home? According to the population of Maithili speakers in this city, a very limited number of Maithili magazines used to come to me for distribution, but the worry remained that the magazine had ever been completely distributed. Well, in an unfamiliar city, I got acquainted with many people and had many experiences, some sweet and some bitter. This experience of mine got a place in an issue of 'Mithila

Darshan', whose title was - 'Sakhi Ki Poochhasi Anubhav Mor?' Some people had read it and had also encouraged me. Undoubtedly, I got energy from this; I am saying this without any hesitation. You all must be thinking where I have come, taking my story, and sat down? My intention is not to tell my story; my intention is to express my heartfelt feelings towards Mr. Gajendra Thakur Ji.

Rustic speech does not seem sweet to us all, but a distant drum seems very beautiful. We all are very indifferent towards our mother tongue, which is indicative of our inferiority complex. As much language as you can learn, that is best, but not by sacrificing your mother tongue. There is no lack of writers and poets in Maithili, but worrying about the reader class is natural. The reasons for this are not

one but many. How many copies of a book are printed? Its easy availability is also a matter of concern. Its distribution system, from village home to city, is almost found collapsed. In such a situation, it is impossible for a reader settled abroad and interested in Maithili literature to get the book in hand. Everyone's interest also cannot be the same. Someone likes stories, then someone likes poetry? Someone has interest in reading beautiful articles, then someone has attachment towards drama. According to interest, the availability of books for the reader class, if you ask the truth, is not here. At particular times, a book of some genre is imposed upon the readers, for which they have no attachment at all; why would that not happen even in Mangani? To tell the truth, how many places are libraries vibrant, and at how many places are Maithili books available in

the library? You can count their number on fingers. Leave the question of book availability and ask whether its preservation can happen easily? Although old people all want to read books, even those of the print medium. They all have that habit formed, so what to do? After a certain time, books are not found anywhere in the market. Change is the law of nature. Science is progressing very fast. New inventions are happening daily, and it is necessary to move with the times. If you do not walk in step with the times, then that same situation will happen that your mother tongue will become extinct.

The Ambani brothers' slogan was - 'Kar Lo Duniya Mutthi Mein' (Hold the world in your fist). Their dream was realized to a great extent. I do not have to go into any political

discussion, so there is no purpose in doing a postmortem of this slogan. With positive thinking, if I say something, I will say this: now almost every Indian has the world in their hand. The meaning is that with just one click, all the information of the world becomes available, yes, through the medium of the internet. Whatever you wish for is present in a moment. If the development of science is used for positive work, then the forms and colors of the world would change. There was a time when there were handwritten books, and then came the era of print media, and if you ask the truth, there is still a craze for it even now, but for people of the old times. Now, all work is done through e-medium. After the Corona period, its further expansion was seen, and all work started being done through e-medium. In every curse, something-or-other blessing is definitely hidden.

From poetry gatherings to symposiums on various subjects also happened through e-medium. If you understand Corona in a way, it brought this revolution, but no revolution is possible overnight. If you go to its root, then undoubtedly the invisible hard work of many people would appear.

One such person is Mr. Gajendra Thakur Ji, who is continuously engaged with life and soul for the preservation and enrichment of his mother tongue Maithili. Matching pace with the times, he did the important work of establishing our Maithili on the internet. He has been successfully operating the Maithili e-magazine Videha for about sixteen years. Maithili's first free digital library is on Videha, and about 1500 books are available on it. This number is very low; the reason is

that many creators or their family members, in the cycle of royalty, do not want to keep their books before readers through this medium. This causes loss to them and also to Maithili literature. If your aim is to reach your composition to readers of every class, then you have to adopt the e-medium. The problem in this is regarding royalty. For this, I am not blaming anyone. Then, royalty cannot be obtained on Videha. You must have heard the name of 'Kindle'. Many books are available on it, but readers have to pay some fee for it. Maithili books are possibly not available on 'Kindle'. Those who are not uploading their books on the internet due to royalty should also create a system like 'Kindle' for Maithili books. From this, the development of Maithili literature and an increase in the number of the reader class would definitely happen. Someone has to come

forward to operate such a system.

I say honestly that I understood only this much about Mr. Gajendra Thakur Ji, but recently Mr. Ashish Anchinhaar Ji sent his book - "Maithili Web Journalism Ka Itihaas" (History of Maithili Web Journalism), and after reading that, the contribution of Mr. Gajendra Thakur Ji in the service of mother Maithili is understood to be unimaginable. One big problem of ours is that we all cannot tolerate anyone's praise. Whoever has done some unprecedented work, we all are proficient in finding faults in it. Well, those who create history, no obstacle can distract them, and therefore his achievements get inscribed in golden letters on the pages of history. In the year 2000, he started his journey from 'Bhalsarik Gaachh' and after that, achieving one after another, he

kept going. In 2008, Maithili's first e-magazine also with International Standard Serial Number (ISSN), Maithili's first digital library also free, in 2009, in the field of children's literature, 'Nena Bhutka Blog', in 2014, Maithili Wikipedia's approval, in 2011, Google Translation, in Tirhuta (Mithilakshar) 'Videha Sadeha Blog', Maithili's first blog in Braille script 'Videha Braille', Maithili's first podcast site 'Videha Radio', for the first time any Maithili magazine in more than one script, Videha, including Maithili's first book in Braille script, they have been continuously doing numerous excellent works. All his works, one more precious than the other, like priceless gems, are adorning his crown. Now, they have many plans, and without getting tired, they are engaged day and night in the service of mother Maithili and will remain

engaged. After all, how could I abandon the fortune of expressing my heartfelt feelings towards him for his Bhagirath-like efforts for the preservation and enrichment of mother Maithili?

****Editorial Note:**** In the initial time, books were given by Videha on Kindle, which included the books of Jagdish Prasad Mandal and Rajdeo Mandal Ji. But after that, Videha did not give other books on Kindle because of lack of time. Occasionally, some book is still given even now. Contextually, readers should also have this information that for giving books on Kindle, there are only a few languages in India, in which Maithili is not there. Hindi is on Kindle; whether Videha initially gave books, or if anyone gives books on Kindle, they give it by calling it the Hindi language. Assume that when Kindle

realizes that this is not the Hindi language, it removes it. This is also one reason why Videha did not continuously give books on Kindle.

****Gajendra Thakur, Giving a
New Dimension to Maithili
Web Journalism****

****Mukesh Dutt****

It was a matter of 2010; my father had gone to some Maithil people in Delhi to distribute Karnamrit and Mithilangan magazines (because Karnamrit magazine used to come to us for distribution in Delhi, and father himself used to look after the distribution system of Mithilangan magazine). In this sequence, he met Gajendra Thakur ji for the first time, and while returning, he brought some books as gifts for me from his side. Among them, along with some books by Preeti Thakur, Jagdish Prasad Mandal, and Gajendra ji himself, there were some books of Videha; after that, this sequence continued. From these books, I got information about other genres of Maithili literature, grammar, and Maithili web journalism. Thanks to Mr. Gajendra Thakur ji.

Gajendra ji's birth happened in Bhagalpur, Bihar, on 30 March 1971, in the house of Kripanand Thakur and Lakshmi Thakur. Otherwise, their native village is Mehath, near Jhajharpur. MBA from Finance, C.I.C., C.L.D., Kovida. A polyglot, Thakur ji's field of work and work is so extensive that it cannot be completed in one article, and I will not be able to do it. Mainly, he is a historian, ghazal writer, playwright, educationist, and along with being the chief editor of Videha (the first Maithili international fortnightly e-magazine), he is the operator and guide of numerous websites. The work done by him on Mithila's Panji management, genome mapping (450 AD to 2009 AD), proved to be a milestone, whose discussion continues everywhere. He has done special work on Panji management, such as:

1. Panji (original Mithilakshar palm leaf)
2. Dushan Panji
3. Modanand Jha Branch Panji
4. Mandar-Mare Kashyap-ancient
5. Ancient Panji (laminated)
6. Utedh Panji
7. Panichobe Birpur
8. Darbhanga Raj orders Utedh etc.
9. Chhoti Jha book directory
10. Letter Panji
11. Mulgram Panji
12. Mulgram Pargana Hisabe Panji
13. Mul Panji -2
14. Mul Panji -3
15. Mul Panji -4

16. Mul Panji -5

17. Mul Panji -6

18. Mul Panji -7

Here, among the works of Thakur ji, who has blessed Mithila-Maithili with so much work, the work I want to especially mention is his contribution to the development of Tirhuta and Kaithi Unicode, the development of internet and computer terminology in the Maithili language, the establishment of Maithili Wikipedia, and the vast compilation and publication of the lexicon from contribution to Google Maithili Translate. Along with this, through him, within just a decade, about 400 new writers and established writers came forward. Otherwise, the readers' community can read his detailed introduction on Wikipedia.

The internet came to India on 15 August 1995, and the presence of the Maithili language on the internet is considered to have happened in 2000 AD. About 5 years later, the internet revolution came in Maithili, the credit for which goes to 'Gajendra Thakur' ji. Gajendra Thakur ji had made many Maithili sites on Yahoo Geocities; this was the first presence of Maithili on the internet. After Yahoo Geocities closed, in 2004, a blog was created by Thakur ji from the same name, and in January 2009, it was connected with Videha, where until now all the issues of Videha are published. His contribution (through Videha) in the digitization of Maithili can be seen, on the basis of which he can be called the father and nurturer of Maithili web journalism. The work done by him on web journalism can be fully known from Ashish Anchinhaar ji's newly published book 'Maithili Web Journalism Ka

Itihaas' (History of Maithili Web Journalism).

****Discussion of Shruti
Publication, which brought Panji
Management Publication, and
Nagendra Kumar Jha****

****Ashish Anchinhaar****

As I have informed before, the result of the combined effort of Gajendra Thakur (Creative Idea) and

Nagendra Kumar Jha (Resource+Technical Approach) is "Shruti Publication". Shruti Publication is the first standard publisher of Maithili. Standard publisher means one who publishes books without taking money, and despite that, the copyright remains with the author. In one or two books, due to carelessness, the copyright got printed as "Shruti Publication". Such authors contacted Gajendra Thakur for their copyright and got it published under their own name through common publication.

Why Shruti Publication? Previously, three types of publication were active in Maithili:

- 1) The author gets his book printed with his own money and gives some name as the publisher. Copyright is considered as the author's.

2) The author gets his book printed with his own money, the publisher is someone else. Copyright is considered as the author's.

3) The author is given some money in exchange for the book, but the copyright remains with the publisher.

In these three types of publication methods, the wealthy ones remained ahead. Those with more influence, money, and connections, their books were abundantly available in the market. But for those who have neither money nor influence, how would their book get printed? And with this thought, Shruti Publication started, which prints books without taking money and the copyright remains with the author.

History of Shruti Publication - The first book from Shruti Publication

was published in 2008, which was the drama "No Entry: Ma Pravesch" written by Dr. Uday Narayan Singh Nachiketa.

Publications of Shruti Publication - Till now, a total of more than 100 books have been printed by Shruti Publication. Among them, many books were the author's first book. Some books are also in the English language, which are mostly related to the history of Mithila and Maithili literary history. Translations of Maithili books into Tirhuta script and Braille script have also been published by Shruti Publication. In addition, Videha-Sadeha has also been published in ten volumes. In this sequence, we will first discuss Panji management. The total expenditure in the publication of both parts of Panji management was 11-12 lakhs (between 2009 and 2012).

The price of its first volume was kept at 5000 and the second volume at 12500. A total of two hundred copies each were printed, and 150-150 copies were given to Panjekar Vidyanand Jha ji, which he could sell himself, and he did sell them. Out of the remaining 50-50 copies, some were given to 25-30 prestigious libraries in India, and the rest remain with Gajendra Thakur ji.

In addition, in other books, the total expenditure was about 17,000 copies of books. Meaning, if we exclude the bulky books, then there were other books worth about 16-17 lakh rupees. Roughly, books worth 30 lakh rupees were published by Shruti Publication, and that was given by Nagendra Kumar Jha. The list of books will be found at the end of this article.

Now you all might be wondering how much return Nagendra Kumar Jha got from this, so I leave that to you all. Given the market of Maithili books, as much return as a standard publisher (not printer) can show to the public with evidence, that much return can be considered for Shruti Publication.

Yes, one return can be considered: that the books of Dalit writers, of poor writers, which were not there in Maithili, came into Maithili, and they came in such a way that a separate world of Maithili was created. I have said before and am saying here too: my first book was also published by this "Shruti Publication" in 2011. You all can see from the list which authors' first books were published by this

publication. One more return can be considered: that only Shruti Publication could break the publication and authorial block of Subhash Chandra Yadav. Subhash Chandra Yadav ji's first book 'Ghradekhia' was published in 1983 AD by Maithili Academy, Patna, and after that, directly his second book 'Banait-Bigadait' was published in 2009 AD, meaning after 26-27 years. Did Subhash ji not write compositions in these 26-27 years, or was anyone in Maithili eager to support Subhash ji? Whatever it was, after this second book, Subhash Chandra ji's literary activity increased so much that it is before you all.

The complete list of Shruti Publication (Links have not been given intentionally in the books listed in this list, with the hope that

the reader will make some effort and go to Videha's site and search for and read the books)-

01. No Entry: Ma Pravesh (Drama), Author-Dr. Uday Narayan Singh Nachiketa, Publication Year- 2008, Price-75, ISBN NO.978-81-907729-0-7 (hardbound), ISBN NO.978-81-907729-1-4 (paperback)

(As per the manner in which the book details are given above, the reader should consider the same for the other books given below. In some, some details may not be available to the reader).

02. Gonu Jha Aaur Aan Maithili Chitra-Katha- Preeti Thakur 2008 100 ISBN NO.978-81-907729-9-0

03. Kurukshetram Antarmanak
(Novel, Stories, Poetry etc.) Gajendra
Thakur 2009 100 ISBN NO.978-81-
907729-7-6

04. Genome Mapping (Mithila's Panji
- Prabandh) Part-1- Gajendra Thakur,
Nagendra Kumar Jha and Panjekar
Vidyanand Jha 2009 5000 ISBN
NO.978-81-907729-6-9

05. Natasha (Comics) Devanshu Vats
2009 150 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-04-4

06. Banait-Bigadait (Story Collection)
Subhash Chandra Yadav 2009 100
ISBN NO.978-81-907729-8-3

07. Gamak Jinegi (Story Collection)
Jagdish Prasad Mandal 2009 200
ISBN NO.978-81-907729-4-5

08. Maulail Gaachhak Phool (Novel)
Jagdish Prasad Mandal 2009 250
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-02-0

09. Jinegik Jeet (Novel) Jagdish

Prasad Mandal 2009 250 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-10-5

10. Utthan-Patan (Novel) Jagdish
Prasad Mandal 2009 250 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-11-2

11. Mithilak Beti (Drama) Jagdish
Prasad Mandal 2009 160 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-03-7

12. Bhag Rau Aaur Balchanda
(Drama) Vibha Rani 2009 100 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-01-3

13. Ham Puchhai Chhi (Poetry
Collection) Vineet Utpal 2009 160
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-05-1

14. Maithili Chitrakatha - Preeti
Thakur 2009 100 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-13-6

15. Maithili Bhasha Sahitya: 20th
Century (Criticism) Prem Shankar
Singh - 2009 400 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-12-9

16. Maithili Chitrakatha - Neetu Kumari 2009 100 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-14-3

17. Baangak Bangauda (Children's Poetry Collection) Gajendra Thakur 2009 50 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-61-7

18. Maithili-English Dictionary Vol.-1, Nagendra Kumar Jha and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha 2009 500 ISBN NO.978-81-907729-2-1

19. Maithili-English Dictionary Vol.-2, Nagendra Kumar Jha and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha 2009 500 ISBN NO.978-81-907729-2-1

20. Videha: Sadeha: 1 (Devanagari) (Selected from issues 1 to 25 of Videha e-magazine) Ed. Gajendra Thakur 2009 100 ISBN NO.978-81-907729-5-2 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

21. Videha: Sadeha: 1 (Tirhuta) (Selected from issues 1 to 25 of Videha e-magazine) Ed. Gajendra

Thakur 2009 200 ISBN NO.978-81-907729-5-2 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

22. Tvanchahanch and Asanjati Man
(Song-Composition) Gajendra Thakur
2009 50 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-20-4

23. Sahastrabadhanee (Novel)
Gajendra Thakur 2009 50 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-16-7

24. Sahasrabdi Ka Chaupadpar
(Poetry Collection) Gajendra Thakur
2009 50 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-17-4

25. Galpaguccha (Story Collection)
Gajendra Thakur 2009 50 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-18-1

26. Sankarshan (Drama) Gajendra
Thakur 2009 50 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-19-8

27. Prabandh- Nibandh-Samalochna-
Gajendra Thakur 2009 50 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-15-0

28. Balmandli/ Kishor-Jagat

(Children's Drama – Stories - Poetry)-
Gajendra Thakur 2009 50 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-21-1

29. Videha Katha 2009-10 (Story
Collection)[Videha:Sadeha;4]
(Selected from issues 26 to 50 of
Videha e-magazine) Ed. Gajendra
Thakur 2010 100 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-07-5 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

30. Videha Padya 2009-10 (Poetry
Collection)[Videha:Sadeha:3]
(Selected from issues 26 to 50 of
Videha e-magazine) Ed. Gajendra
Thakur 2010 100 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-08-2 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

31. Videha Prabandh-Samalochna
2009-10 (Essay
Collection)[Videha:Sadeha:2]
(Selected from issues 26 to 50 of
Videha e-magazine) -Ed. Gajendra
Thakur 2010 100 ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-09-9 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

32. Aksharamushtika (Children's

Story - Fairy Tale Collection)

Gajendra Thakur 2010 50 ISBN

NO.978-93-80538-60-0

33. Bajanta-Bujhanta (Very Long

Story Collection)-Jagdish Prasad

Mandal, 2010 100 ISBN NO.978-93-

80538-89-1

34. Taregan (Children's Inspirational

Very Long Story Collection)-Jagdish

Prasad Mandal 2010 100 ISBN

NO.978-93-80538-25-9

35. Jeevan-Sangharsh (Novel)-Jagdish

Prasad Mandal 2010 100 ISBN

NO.978-93-80538-27-3

36. Jeevan-Maran (Novel)-Jagdish

Prasad Mandal 2010 100 ISBN

NO.978-93-80538-26-6

37. Mithilak Sanskaar/Vidhi-

Vyavhaar Geet Aaur Geetnaad -(Song

Compilation) Umesh Mandal ISBN

NO.978-93-80538-34-1

38. Prabandh- Nibandh-Samalochna
Part Two (Kurukshetram
Antarmanak-2)- Gajendra Thakur
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-54-9

39. Sahasrashirsha (Novel) Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-29-7

40. Sahasrajit (Poetry Collection)
Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-59-4

41. Shabdashastram (Story-Tale
Collection) Gajendra Thakur ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-52-5

42. Ulkamukh (Drama) Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-50-1

43. Jalodip (Children's Drama)
Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-53-2

44. Narashansi (Song-Composition)
Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-58-7

45. Purush-Pariksha (Maithili Picture

Story) Preeti Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-49-5

46. Mithilak Lokdevta - Preeti Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-24-2

47. Mithilak Itihas - Professor Radhakrishna Chaudhary ISBN NO.978-93-80538-28-0

48. Ambara (Poetry Collection)- Rajdeo Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-30-3

49. Nishtuki (Poetry Collection)- Umesh Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-37-2

50. Betik Apaman Aaur Chhinardevi (Drama)- Bechan Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-35-8

51. Anchinhaar Aakhar (Maithili Ghazal Collection)- Ashish Anchinhaar ISBN NO.978-93-80538-48-8

52. Kalanidhi (Poetry Collection)-

Kalikant Jha Buch ISBN NO.978-93-80538-31-0

53. Samay Sakshi Thik (Very Long Story Collection)- Anmol Jha ISBN NO.978-93-80538-47-1

54. Panchvati (One-Act Compilation) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-41-9

55. Ardhangini..Sarojani.. Subhadra.. Bhaik Saneh Ityadi (Short Story Collection) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-42-6

56. Compromise (Drama) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-44-0

57. Jhameliya Viyah (Drama) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-45-7

58. Indradhanushi Akas (Poetry Collection) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-46-4

59. Dhaangi Baat Banebaak Daam
Agoobaar Pene Chhan (Ghazal
Collection)- Gajendra Thakur ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-51-8

60. Kshanaprabha (Poetry
Collection)- Shiv Kumar Jha "Tillu"
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-32-7

61. Anshu (Criticism)- Shiv Kumar
Jha "Tillu" ISBN NO.978-93-80538-33-
4

62. Rathak Chakka Ulati Chalai Baat
(Poetry Collection)- Ramvilas Sahu
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-69-3

63. Varnit Ras (Poetry Collection)-
Umesh Paswan ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-71-6

64. Hamara Binu Jagat Sunna Chhai
(Song and Jharu Collection)- Ramdev
Prasad Mandal Jharudar ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-70-9

65. Shambhudas (Three Long Stories:

Maituggar, Shambhudas and
Phansi)- Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-74-7

66. Geetanjali (Song Collection)-
Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-
93-80538-72-3

67. Raati-Din (Poetry Collection)-
Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-
93-80538-73-0

68. Pratik (Very Long Story
Collection)- Munnaji ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-75-4

69. Maajh Aanganme Katialael Chhi
(Ghazal Collection)- Munnaji ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-76-1

70. Ham Puchhai Chhi (Interviews)-
Munnaji ISBN NO.978-93-80538-77-8

71. Videha Kosh Maithili-English
Dictionary- Gajendra Thakur ISBN
NO. 978-93-80538-22-8

72. Genealogical Mapping (Mithila's

Panji-Prabandh)- Part-2- Gajendra Thakur, Nagendra Kumar Jha and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha ISBN NO. 978-93-80538-62-4

73. Jagdish Prasad Mandal (Biography)- Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO. 978-93-80538-68-6

74. Hamar Tol (Novel) - Rajdeo Mandal ISBN NO. 978-93-80538-78-5

75. Satbhainya Pokhari (Short Story Collection) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal ISBN NO.978-93-80538-80-8

76. Videha Sadeha-5 (Maithili Very Long Story) (Selected from issues 51 to 100 of Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-63-1 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

77. Videha Sadeha-6 (Maithili Short Story) (Selected from issues 51 to 100 of Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-64-8 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

78. Videha Sadeha-7 (Maithili Poetry)
(Selected from issues 51 to 100 of
Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-65-5
ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

79. Videha Sadeha-8 (Videha Natya
Utsav - Maithili Parallel Theatre)
(Selected from issues 51 to 100 of
Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-66-2
ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

80. Videha Sadeha-9 (Videha Shishu
Utsav - Infant, Child and Adolescent
Literature) (Selected from issues 51
to 100 of Videha e-magazine) - Ed.
Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-67-9 ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

81. Videha Sadeha-10 (Maithili Essay,
Article and Criticism) (Selected from
issues 51 to 100 of Videha e-
magazine) - Ed. Gajendra Thakur
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-79-2 ISSN
2229-547X VIDEHA

82. Rehearsal (Drama) Ravi Bhushan Pathak 2012 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-43-3

83. Nav Anshu (Ghazal-Hazal, Rubai Compilation) Amit Mishra 2012 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-82-2

84. Monak Baat (Ghazal-Hazal-Children's Ghazal-Rubai-Kata Compilation) Chandan Kumar Jha 2012 ISBN NO.978-93-80538-81-5

85. Ganga Bridge (Drama) - Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-92-1

86. Bap Bhel Pitti Aaur Adhikar - Bechan Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-91-4

87. Videha Sadeha-11 (Selected compositions from issues 101 to 110 of Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-86-0
ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

88. Kiyo Boojhi Nai Sakal Hamara

(Ghazal, Rubai and Kata
Compilation) Om Prakash 2012 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-87-7

89. Teen Jeth Egaraham Magh (Song
Collection) - Jagdish Prasad Mandal
ISBN NO.978-93-80538-88-4

90. Videha Sadeha-12 (Selected
compositions from issues 111 to 115
of Videha e-magazine) - Ed. Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-90-7
ISSN 2229-547X VIDEHA

91. Sahastrabadhanee (Novel)
Gajendra Thakur 2009 100 ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-00-6 (First Maithili
Braille Book)

92. Panji Tadpatra Gajendra Thakur
2009 1000 Appendix of Genome
Mapping (Mithila's Panji -
Management) Part-1 ISBN NO.978-81-
907729-6-9 and Genealogical
Mapping (Mithila's Panji-Prabandh)-
Part-2 ISBN NO. 978-93-80538-62-4

93. Khali Kamra (Story Collection) -
Prasanna Kumar Acharya ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-40-2

94. Unmukt (Poetry Collection) -
Santosh Kumar Jha ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-85-3

ENGLISH TITLES

95. VIDEHA DICTIONARY English-
Maithili Dictionary-2012- Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-23-5

96. Learn Mithilakshar - Gajendra
Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-80538-55-6

97. Learn Braille through
Mithilakshar - Gajendra Thakur ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-56-3

98. Learn International Phonetic
Script through Mithilakshar -
Gajendra Thakur ISBN NO.978-93-
80538-57-0

99. A Survey of Maithili Literature-
Radhakrishna Chaudhary ISBN
NO.978-93-80538-36-5

100. English-Maithili Dictionary Vol.-
1 (COMPUTER DICTIONARY)
Gajendra Thakur, Nagendra Kumar
Jha, Panjekar Vidyanand Jha 2009 500
ISBN NO.978-81-907729-3-8

**** A Comprehensive
Conversation with the Multi-
Genre Creator and Young
Journalist Shri Gajendra
Thakur ji by the Young
Representative Very Long
Story Writer and Critic
Munnaji****

****Munnaji:**** Gajendra ji, Namaskar. Seeing your work among the youth, I have often felt delighted; for that reason, I wanted to have a detailed discussion with you on this. Gajendra ji, your most of your residence and education happened outside Mithila. The medium of higher education was English, then how did such an attachment to Mithila/Maithili develop?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** In childhood, in 1979-80, we did fourth and fifth grade from our village primary school. My father was an Executive Engineer in the Bihar Government; he passed away during his tenure. But this matter is older than that. At that time, my father was an Assistant Engineer, and the Ganga Bridge at Patna-Hajipur was being

constructed. Father was honest; those contractors and engineers threatened to crush him with a roller, threatened to kill the children. You see, he did not flee, but he sent us all to the village. Possibly, this one and a half years of village residence was the reason for my attachment to Maithili and Mithila. Later also, we used to go to the village twice a year with father, once during Holi and the second time during Durga Puja. We once heard from my father's mouth that in this life we are living in the city, but for the next seven births, I will not leave the village.

****Munnaji:**** When and how/from where did the inspiration for composition come for the first time? What was the first composition (written), and which was the first published composition (tell with genre) and where and when did it

get published?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** That is also a matter of 1979-80. At the village school, the responsibility for a children's drama was placed on our shoulders by the new master saheb Virabhadra ji and the master saheb from Barhara. Where would a drama book be found? So I wrote 'Daanvir Dadhichi'. This, with many corrections, was published in Kurukshetram Antarmanak in 2009 AD. In 2000 AD, when I created the Maithili Devanagari site on Yahoo Geocities, from then my manuscripts started being typed and appearing regularly on the internet. Later, Yahoo closed its Geocities, but the internet presence of Maithili I created on 5 July 2004 under the name "Bhalsarik Gaachh" still exists as the first Maithili presence. This same Bhalsarik Gaachh, from 1

January 2008, has been appearing regularly in the form of the fortnightly e-magazine Videha; now its 371 Videha issues and 36 Sadeha issues have come. As far as the matter of print magazines/dailies goes, compositions have been published in Bharati-Mandan, Samay Saal, Gharbahar, Antika, Aankur, Purvottar Maithil, Jahan Tahan, Mithila Dot Com (Janakpur), Parameshwar Kapadi ji's magazine (Dhuan-Dhaja, Janakpur), Mithila Samad, Mithila Darshan, etc. For Bharati-Mandan, we had sent compositions from Purnia in 2001-02 to Kedar Kanan / Taranand Jha "Tarun", which later got published. In that period, we were in our in-laws' place after an accident, on crutches for one and a half years (2001-02). Possibly, that period also gave me time and determined my direction.

****Munnaji:**** Doesn't composing in so many genres simultaneously create stress? What is the purpose of nurturing and publishing so many genres simultaneously?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** So many genres means how many genres? There are only two genres, prose and poetry. My story 'Shabdashastram' has many songs in it. The story 'Taskar' was completed after going into the details of Taskar Keshav described in the Panji. Now, if I do not transliterate the Panji from Mithilakshar to Devanagari, then Maithili love stories of the calibre of Laila-Majnu and Heer-Ranjha would not come into Maithili. There was a Maithili-English dictionary, but there was no English-Maithili dictionary; in the process of creating that, we

call blog as 'Jalavritta' and internet as 'Antarjal', so how would that happen? My science fiction on time-space displacement, and articles on internet and management, how could a SWOT analysis for Maithili be written in Maithili? So it is proven that my prose and poetry are indebted to each other; the transliteration/digitisation of my manuscripts and the creation of dictionaries also contributed to the distinctiveness of my prose and poetry. My work on Maithili-Sanskrit education helped me in the exploration of original Sanskrit stories and poetry, and because of that, we did not accept the mythological legend of "Daanvir Dadhichi" in which Dadhichi donates his bones, and we considered the Vedic story in which the Ashwini Kumaras attach a horse's head to him (Dadhichi), Indra cuts that neck, and then the Ashwini Kumaras

attach Dadhichi's real head, and from the bones of that cut horse's head, Indra's weapon is prepared, not from Dadhichi's bones. The original distinctiveness that came in the two song-compositions, Tvanchahanch (based on the original Sanskrit Mahabharata) and Asanjati Man (based on Ashvaghosha's Buddhacharita in Sanskrit), is not possible from studying secondary sources, and nor is the analysis of Vedic era themes like Durvakshata mantra, etc., possible without understanding the original meaning, contrary to secondary sources like Griffith's English translation. This also came into play in the criticism of Mayanand Mishra's Pratham Shail Putri Cha, Mantraputra, Purohit, and Stridhan. So my Sanskrit-Maithili education was useful here. The philosophical elements of original Vachaspati/Kumarila/Mandan's Bhamati and Brahmasiddhi came

into 'Shabdashastram'. So my education in English literature became the basis for my articles on the influence of English literature on Maithili literature. My original study of Rigvedic Sanskrit and Avesta was used in the article on Maithili's Ghazal shastra, and Haiku and Haibun could achieve distinctiveness from the basis of translating original Japanese poetics. The Braille version of Sahasrabadhane, contribution to the creation of Kaithi and Mithilakshar Unicode, was not possible without my computer expertise, and my course on 'Labour in Development' was indispensable for my children's poems based on child labour.

All these compositions together were first published in hardbound form under the name 'Kurukshetram Antarmanak' because I wrote it for all members of the family.

Infant/Children's literature is also in it because a small child does not read the composition themselves, but you read it to them, make them memorize poems, show them the ankita alphabet education, have them act in plays. If you are in the mood, read stories; if not, read poetry-criticism/ drama, play. If you don't have the inclination to read the Mahabharata/ Buddhacharita, read Tvanchahanch and Asanjati Man. If you feel like it, read a novel, and if not, read a long story-very long story. Later, these seven parts also came in paperback as seven parts. A thousand copies of the hardbound were sold individually.

****Munnaji:**** Doesn't publishing compositions of multiple genres simultaneously pose a threat to your own identity? By doing this, might it happen that critics are unable to

evaluate you properly?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** But that did not happen. Because I have no aversion to writing, wherever it may lead, and nor is there any stress in creating new writing. 'Kurukshetram Antarmanak' is a collection of all my works up to 2009 (excluding the Panji and Dictionaries which were published separately). This was written for the reader, not for the critic, not for those Maithili critics who do not know Mithilakshar and are computer illiterate; we understand that they cannot critique the articles on Panji and computer/management, nor should they. If they do not have knowledge of Rigvedic Sanskrit, then they cannot critique my related criticism, we understand that, and nor should they. But let them critique what they can; many critics have done so, like

Premashankar Singh, Shiv Kumar Jha, and Rajdeo Mandal. Letters in favour and against have also come the most. But the reactions of the readers have been delightful; in addition to print, thousands more downloads of all my books have been done by Maithili speakers spread worldwide. Without the support of any government literary institution, translations of my novel Sahasrabadhane have been done in English, Sanskrit, Tulu, Kannada, Marathi, and Konkani. People are reading this novel in Braille.

"Khirdamandon se kya puchhun ke meri ibtida kya hai

Ki main is fikr mein rehta hoon meri intiha kya hai"

(Iqbal)

(What should I ask the wise about what my beginning is, I remain in this worry about what my end is. -

Iqbal)

"Khudi ko kar buland itna, ke har
taqdeer se pehle

Khuda bande se khud pucche, bata
teri raza kya hai?"

(Iqbal)

(Take your selflessness to such a
level that before creating anyone's
destiny, God himself has to ask them,
tell me, what destiny do you wish
for? -Iqbal)

****Munnaji:**** Apart from being a
tireless creator and critic, you have
also become visible as a foundational
pillar of Maithili magazines. How did
the idea of starting "Videha
Fortnightly e-magazine" come
about? Where do you see yourself
and it today through its medium?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** Sending compositions to Maithili magazines, then after two years a number would appear, or not even appear. Guest editors got tired of asking for compositions; there are also examples of that. New creators remained discouraged. Videha came with regularity in publication; it did not have the problem of distribution, because it was on the internet. The border that existed between the Maithili speakers of India and Nepal, the country's border, did not exist for Videha. Videha became popular among Maithili speakers spread not only across India but across the world. The notions that there are no readers in Maithili, no good writers, no young writers, no Maithil Brahmin-Karn Kayastha writers, no upper-caste writers at all—Videha broke all these notions. Till today, the Videha e-magazine has been viewed 2,72,082 times from 1,571

places in 107 countries by 51,077 individuals through various ISPs (Google Analytics data, up to 2012). In Videha: Sadeha:1, there were 118 authors (ranging from 18 years to 88 years). Videha is the only international research journal of Maithili recognized by the Paris-based international organization. Videha started with all these objectives and achieved all its objectives. But even after so much has happened, I will say that this is only the beginning. Because of Videha, I met many people, good and bad, mostly good. Because of Videha, I got readers, I got affection. Because of Videha, there is a constant pressure, the pressure to compose and the pressure to connect creators.

****Munnaji:**** Did the Brahmin class misuse Maithili for their own benefit, or did they impoverish Maithili? The

entire Brahmin class, like a sinking boat, just sat idly, what was the reason for that, and to what extent did Maithili benefit or suffer from this?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** How is misuse of Maithili, or misuse of any language, possible? This is possible only when people's economic condition is such that they struggle for food, or the government forces another language into their education system; in India, Hindi was forced, and in Nepal, Nepali was forced. The Brahmin or Kayastha class were ahead in education (I am not comparing them with Brahmins or Kayasthas from other parts of the country - compared to them, these people are very backward.), meaning ahead of other castes in Mithila. So in literature too, these same people came forward. There was no Ram

Mohan Roy in Mithila who would fight for widows, nor was there a Gabriel García Márquez who would sell his car to write "One Hundred Years of Solitude" so that his family's expenses could run for a year with that money and he could write this novel in that period! But both these statements are not entirely true; many people sacrificed everything and devoted themselves to Maithili, but due to factionalism, they were not discussed. Many were dragged into controversies and then took the so-called path of decline. In the Panji, there are details of at least three great donors, one of whom donated everything three times in his life. In the Panji, there are details of hundreds of inter-caste marriages, and that too between Brahmins and Dalits. Taskar Keshav married the king's dedicated daughter, Lakshmishwar Singh could not do anything. But all this remained

unrecorded until two years ago. In the 1942 AD movement, Panchanan Jha and Puran Mandal together sacrificed their lives in Jhajharpur, but that was not recorded; in 2009 AD, Jagdish Prasad Mandal made that event the basis of his story 'Pachhtaba'. Among the entire Brahmin class, Jagdish Prasad Mandal / Rajdeo Mandal / Bechan Thakur / Mahendra Narayan Ram / Meghnath Prasad / Bilat Paswan "Vihangam", besides these, the writers who were there, most of those who knew tricks and manipulations were able to move ahead, and among Brahmins and Kayasthas too, for the most part, those who knew tricks and manipulations moved ahead; whom to blame? There were no readers; those who spent money from their pockets were made controversial, those who were talented were discouraged, and those who knew

tricks and manipulations moved ahead. The reason is also clear: there were no readers in Maithili, so this happened, and it is also true that due to all these reasons, readers did not increase, a chicken and egg problem. The politicians of the entire Brahmin class are more guilty; they come asking for votes, but after winning, they do not speak Maithili, saying, "We do not speak your language, stay away from us." Videha's advent happened keeping all these aspects in mind; the effect of the slow-poisoning given to Maithili has been removed.

****Munnaji:**** Maithili was specifically the original language of the entire Brahmin class. The Brahmins' original language was Sanskrit, but in colloquial speech, everyone's language was Maithili. But Brahmin people kept them all

completely away. You managed to connect them all? How?

****Gajendra**

Thakur:**

"Manushimihi Sanskritam" – this saying is of Hanuman ji, that he spoke with Sita Maiya in the language of her parental home, Manushi, in the Ashoka Vatika (Valmiki Ramayana - Sundarakanda). In Maithili, there are many words that are in Vedic Sanskrit but not in Classical Sanskrit; therefore, Maithils, specifically the Brahmin class, are closer to Vedic Sanskrit, while the educated Maithils (Brahmins and Kayasthas) are closer to Classical Sanskrit. But the literature residing in the people's throats is in the entire Brahmin class; Umesh Mandal has compiled such literature of 12-14 castes, and books by Mahendra Narayan Ram/ Vishweshwar Mishra/ Manipadma

have also been published. It is true that before the advent of Videha, there was a one-sided situation: ninety percent were Brahmin and ten percent were Kayastha writers. Others were negligible. Videha was able to generate trust among all, and included those people who kept getting connected to Videha over various periods and gave it strength. Initially, Vidyanand Jha, Nagendra Kumar Jha, Rashmi Rekha Sinha, Umesh Mandal, Shiv Kumar Jha and Manoj Kumar Karn, Jaya Verma and Rajiv Kumar Verma got connected to Videha. Despicable attempts were also made, at the behest of some trickster writers, to mentally harass me and the members of the editorial board, but this gave us all the opportunity to learn the art of getting out of trouble. But compared to the encouragers, these were in very small numbers, keep it at five percent. We connected people, and

they got connected; both are true. Our effort ended this discourse of lack: "We have done this big thing, this is not possible," etc., etc., etc. And in this discourse of lack, Brahmins-Kayasthas were certainly included, and the entire Brahmin-Kayastha writers and politicians were also included, and they are more guilty. If others come, our influence will decrease, meaning running away from competition; this had become the sentiment of both Brahmin-Kayastha and non-Brahmin-Kayastha writers, although there are exceptions to this as well.

****Munnaji:**** Yourself being from the Brahmin class, yet a creator who is distressed or distanced from the old Brahminism and Brahmanism, and who is keeping new and old creators of all castes and religions vibrant together on one platform,

what mentality or secret lies behind this?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** In the matric syllabus, we used to read that Maithili speakers of all castes are Maithils, but on the ground level, at Vidyapati festivals etc., this Maithil epithet mainly used to be limited to two castes. Meaning the difference between words and deeds. In our upbringing and education, there was no difference between words and deeds; that is probably the reason. Secondly, if competition increases, then your literature will become stronger; if more people come, then more good people will come. No one has dared to ask for my favour on the basis of caste or the name of relatives, at least those people who know my father and me. Nor have we ever spared any composition-thief on the basis of caste. And those

who have that tendency, people of all castes and religions should gather together so that we can all save ourselves from backstabbing. And as for the people of our mentality who are staying vibrant together on one platform, we would say that our work has given them confidence in us all—thanks to them all.

****Munnaji:**** Any specific activity or incident that increased your anger towards Brahmins or Brahminism and your attachment towards non-Brahmins?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** Where is the need for a single incident? In the shops of Darbhanga, apart from the matric syllabus guide, no Maithili book was available; from the mouth of one writer, a word of respect for another would never come out; if

someone, as a guest editor, stole your composition and you caught them, then they would not agree on that, rather they would pat the back of the guilty person. Who does not understand the difference between verbatim theft and an inspired or influenced composition, and in that matter, patting the back of the one who committed verbatim theft! After the advent of Videha, change has come in all this; who can deny this. Attachment to truth and opposition to injustice all come naturally; there is no need for any specific activity or incident, no need to take advantage of any incident.

****Munnaji:**** Despite being abused and slandered for keeping Maithili journalism away from being distant or for the pursuit of truth, how long will the firm resolve to remain steadfast on one stump continue to

be humiliated?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** In the dedication of Kurukshetram Antarmanak, we had written:

"Had seen the father taking the truth in a state of equanimity

Then had understood that

It was not that sacrifice was made

This is the path for those who live."

And reading this, many people in the village started crying. They all understood, but I can only tell you this: the future will decide this; what can I say exaggeratedly about myself.

****Munnaji:**** Some editors are bound by the fate of "you publish mine or write on me, and I will

publish yours." They publish only some selected people or remain entangled in nepotism. But you, apart from this, give space to everyone—what thought does this express?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** The problem in Maithili was that there were no readers, so it used to be like that. We all give space to everyone, so readers increased, and Maithili was saved from becoming extinct. And now other magazines have also started giving space to everyone—because the discourse of lack, like "there are no writers," "others do not write," "new people do not come into Maithili at all," all these myths have been demolished by Videha.

****Munnaji:**** Won't you too, under the mental encroachment of

Maithils, change your views and become just like that, as has been happening in Maithili journalism till today?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** How can the mental encroachment of Maithils happen on me? We do not run away from competition, from hard work. In Maithili journalism, the number of talented people was low, so such encroachment was natural. Why just Maithili, in all language journalism/university teaching, admission in language subjects happens with low marks, so such encroachment is more. But after the advent of Videha, the number of people from other disciplines like History, Geography, Computer Science, Chartered Accountancy, Doctors, etc., has increased in Maithili literature; talented people in literature also exist, and they have

also come forward. Even after our death, these 'Raktabeej' (demon seeds) will keep our objectives moving forward.

****Munnaji:**** At places, this discussion arises that you and Shruti Publication are spending a larger portion of your financial-mental energy on publishing particular individuals; what would you say about that?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** This has not happened in Videha till today. Despite the limited resources of my "Provident Fund and Arrear money" and mother's pension, whatever mental resources there are, like book design, site design, typing, are provided free of cost by the Videha editorial board. Any Maithili magazine or institution that has

contacted Videha for website creation, magazine registration, etc., and it has not been provided to them, has not happened. For Maithili books of Shruti Publication, we also provide technical assistance up to camera-ready copy. On our advice, eight books of Shri Jagdish Prasad Mandal ji and the late Radhakrishna Chaudhary ji's 'Mithila's History' were printed; all these books are available for free download on the Videha archive. Please read them all and decide for yourself whether they are worthy of publication based on quality or if the decision to publish them was made on the basis of particular individuals. Many of our suggestions were also not accepted by publishers; all institutions have limits of financial resources. The manuscripts of Shri Jagdish Prasad Mandal and the late Radhakrishna Chaudhary ji went to many patriarchs associated with

government Maithili institutions, but those people were busy getting their own books published; they also got them printed, otherwise they would have no customers/readers. But at least it should be that the number of buyers paying for print versions, along with thousands of downloads of quality-based books, will now make these Maithili government and non-government institutions change their views. Because now we are focused only on Videha, and publishers are also able to publish books in limited quantities, so if these people come forward, there are invaluable and many wonderful compositions/creators available in the Videha archive. We will do the work of preparing up to camera-ready copy for free.

****Munnaji:**** I would like to ask a question connected to a personal

aspect of your life: how do you manage family coordination in addition to most regular contact with your job, regularly being engaged in composition, and regular operation of the magazine?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** My wife, Preeti Thakur, supports me; she also remains engaged in illustrating Maithili picture stories. The children, Om and Aastha, are of calm nature; that is an additional advantage. I have the support of the editorial board members of Videha, residing in distant provinces and countries, who do so much hard work, and if I do less work than them all, then what kind of editor am I? If there is a fire in the heart for any subject, then everything coordinates itself.

****Munnaji:**** Despite doing so much

work, till now your evaluation (of both personality and work) has not been possible. Do you not feel affected by this?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** No, we do not agree with this. The e-mails and letters received by me, readers' appreciation letters, the success of my plan for the preservation of manuscripts, and my research in linguistics—all this has given me satisfaction. How is it possible for bad people to also call you good? We would not even want that. Evaluation of both personality and work happens in Maithili or other languages only after death.

"Man aiso nirmal bhayo jaise Ganga neer.

Peechhe peechhe Hari phiren kahat Kabir Kabir."

(Kabir)

(My mind has become as pure as the water of the Ganga. God follows behind, calling out "Kabir, Kabir." - Kabir)

****Munnaji:**** What is the level of criticism in Maithili, what is the true model of criticism, and where is that in Maithili?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** Maithili criticism faced real problems. First was the number of readers being almost zero, and second was the writer and critic being each other's relatives/friends. So in this situation, gossip-based criticism prevailed. But that is no longer the case. If the old-school critics have to save their existence and compete with critics endowed with demonic talent like

Durganand Mandal, Shiv Kumar Jha, Rajdeo Mandal, Dhirandra Kumar, and many others, then they will have to abandon writing criticism without reading, abandoning the praises and condemnations of opposite poles.

****Munnaji:**** Finally, where do you see your contemporary creative people standing? What would you say about their condition and direction?

****Gajendra Thakur:**** It is surprising where these people were hidden; fulfilling their social-family responsibilities, what they are all doing for Maithili is not possible in other languages; there are some exceptions, and those will always be there.

****Munnaji:**** Thank you very, very much for your independent thoughts and for giving so much time.

(From Videha Archive, this interview was originally published in the January-March, 2011 issue of Purvottar Maithil. Later, it was collected in Videha-Sadeha 33)

****Interview of Gajendra Thakur****

**** (Conducted by Ashish
Anchinhaar via email) ****

1) In the interview given by Munnaji, you have stated that no one could critique the Panji and your internet-related work, but for the presented book, articles have come for the Panji-related work as well, and along with that, evaluation of your internet-related work has also been done apart from this book. What is your comment on this change?

****Answer-**** Sociological study of the Panji has been done, interest has increased.

2) Luxurious humans destroyed the earth's environment; now award-winning writers are destroying the literary-cultural environment. What should be done to save both environments?

****Answer-**** A house made of cow dung does not last long; award-winning writers have dried up the mainstream; the local literary-cultural environment is only up to an oasis. The parallel stream has existed since always; the literary-cultural environment is not under the mainstream.

3) What effect does writing a lot of compositions have on the seriousness of writing? Gajendra Paswan writes a lot, therefore there

is no quality in his compositions, but Gajendra Jha writes a lot, meaning he is very active and energetic. In these two examples, which side are you on?

****Answer-**** In the dung-plastered mainstream, all such discussions keep happening.

4) In the early days of Videha, Dr. Ramdev Jha and his associates had dominance in the Sahitya Akademi. Due to Videha's active opposition, change occurred in the Akademi, and different people became Akademi representatives. But did the character of the Sahitya Akademi change? What is the difference between the earlier Akademi character and the current Akademi character?

****Answer-**** The limited circle of readers-writers will continue there in the same way; there is a flaw in the structure. There is not even one percent scope for improvement there because of that reason.

5) Writers impose all kinds of moral constraints on other professions, but take all freedoms for themselves. If a policeman or a government clerk-officer takes a bribe, the entire police and government servants are considered corrupt, but when a writer gives a book for review and the reviewer-critic does fawning criticism, then why is the entire writer class not considered bad? If a policeman or government clerk became corrupt due to a bribe, then why did the critic not become corrupt by writing fawning reviews?

****Answer-**** Ethics does not determine truth-untruth, or false-truth; it is about taking your own decision, making your own choice within the available choices. In the mainstream, whatever choices are available, you have to make a decision from among them.

6) Imagine if all awards were stopped, all assignments ended, all platforms, all institutions closed. In such a situation, would Maithili language and literature survive or not? If it would survive, then how much, and if it would not survive, then why?

****Answer-**** If preserved on CD, put on YouTube, awards, translations, assignments, monographs... Maithili

language and literature has not benefited from all these, nor would there be any difference if all these stopped. That is a different world; people have not understood what awards, translations, assignments, monographs are; they are things of the dung-plastered mainstream's house.

7) There is a class of Maithili writers who, on the pretext of doing religious compositions, separate themselves from their group, but when Mantreshwar Jha, who was a Collector, writes religious songs, then he remains the supreme leader of that group. There are many such examples. Does literature have opposition to religion, or specifically to a particular writer?

****Answer-**** Religion is a human's

psychologist; some people will need it for some time. If culture remains, then one has to oppose it too; during festivals, one has to separate peasant songs by looking at them from Kali songs. People become more fanatical than religious people then.

8) As a reader, when we look at Videha magazine, two periods are visible with many changes. For example, until 2014-15, there used to be compositions of many neglected writers, but after that, their number decreased. Similarly, Videha used to have many names of editorial assistants; now that is mostly absent. After 2015, many mainstream writers started cooperating with Videha. How did this change happen, and along with it, what profit or loss did Videha incur?

****Answer-**** Videha publishes 24 issues a year. In the initial phase of the internet, under the circumstances then, mainstream writers might have considered it a secondary medium, and not now. Videha never recognized any category of neglected writers. "Man ke hare har hai, man ke jeete jeet." (Defeat is of the defeated mind, victory is of the victorious mind). The reduction in the number of editorial assistants was done by myself, after some incidents of those names being targeted by mainstream institutions. The mainstream writers who come to Videha following the path of the parallel stream are respected.

9) What is the current state of Maithili criticism, and who are all in criticism now?

****Answer-**** In the mainstream, criticism is zero. In the parallel stream, you can see the criticism issue of Videha; there is its own critical theory here.

10) The credit for not bringing Dalit-neglected classes into literature in Maithili goes to their own classes. For example, Taranand Viyogi, Subhash Chandra Yadav, or Mahendra Narayan Ram, while being in the mainstream, could not give a single writer of their caste to Maithili, but they themselves level more accusations of being casteist on Maithili. How do you see this?

****Answer-**** "Man ke hare har hai, man ke jeete jeet." (Defeat is of the defeated mind, victory is of the

victorious mind). The mainstream has lost from the mind; our same indication is there from the house standing on cow dung.

11) What is the position of Maithili with respect to contemporary Indian literature?

****Answer-**** The mainstream presents Maithili along with the compositions of its creators alongside the literature of other languages, through articles, plays, novels, poetry, ghazals, etc. And by that account, Maithili's place among other literature is low. Yes, if you see the collection of the parallel stream, it is equivalent to other literature.

12) Has any incident happened in

your personal life as a reason for writing, due to which you have considered yourself ashamed or proud?

****Answer-**** No, I have kept my job, life, and literature all in one color, and there is equanimity in all three.

13) Where is the ghazal genre and ghazal criticism in contemporary Maithili literature? What is the future of this genre?

****Answer-**** According to the government and non-governmental institutional mainstream, among other literature, the place of Maithili ghazal/ghazal criticism is low. Yes, if you see from the parallel stream's perspective, it is equivalent to other

languages.

14) How satisfied are you with the current young litterateurs of Maithili?

****Answer-**** I see no difference between young and old, just like between those who write less and those who write more; both can be good or bad, their compositions can be good or bad. Youth can be discouraged; youth is a phase of life; there is no guarantee based on any stage of life.

15) What is the reason for the controversy regarding the numbering in the program named 'Sagar Raati Deep Jarae'? What is the reason that the counting of that

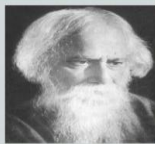
program held in Delhi does not happen?

****Answer:**** Many people spread many kinds of things, that the Sahitya Akademi sponsored it, etc., sponsorship etc. has happened before too. But the real thing is that the Akademi did or sponsored that program on Rabindranath Tagore in the 150th birth anniversary year of Rabindranath Tagore. And the Sahitya Akademi counts that story symposium in its programs, then how would one claim that there were two claimants for the same program? If the Sahitya Akademi had given funds to Malorang or any institution solely and only for 'Sagar Raati Deep Jarae' and that was mentioned in the Akademi, then I would have had no objection to its numbering, but the Akademi gives funds for Tagore In Maithili Theatre

and they say it's a story symposium, how is that possible? Sagar Raati Deep Jarai is a reading program of Maithili stories, so how would it be counted as a Rabindra Jayanti program. Only one 'Sagar Raati Deep Jarai' remains saved from the scourge of the Sahitya Akademi. The institution, in whose name they received funds, had to print it on the card under compulsion, and I am showing its photo. Seeing these cards, it also becomes clear that it was wrong on a moral level as well. For example, the subject named 'Katha Rabindra' meant that it would be translations of Rabindranath Tagore's stories or a discussion on his stories, whereas the basic condition of 'Sagar Raati Deep Jarai' is that the story should be unpublished and unpublicized. Understand similarly for Rabindra Kavita. In that session too, something else happened instead of

Rabindranath's poetry. Either the Akademi was cheated for funds, or the people from the Akademi at that time remained silent due to collusion.

हकार



maithili lok rang
mailorang

Presents
TAGORE IN MAITHILI THEATRE

Five days festival in DELHI

22nd – 26th March, 2012

All presentation in Maithili Language

एहि महत्त्वपूर्ण महोत्सवमे सपरिवार आमंत्रित छी,
हम सब अहाँक बाट ताकब.

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मैथिली लोकरंग / मैलोरंग रेपर्टरी
TAGORE IN MAITHILI THEATRE

22 - 26 मार्च, 2012

महोत्सव विवरण

22 मार्च, 2012 : रवीन्द्र नाट्य (डाकघर) -

समय : सायं 06.30 बजे
स्थान : मुक्तधारा, भाई वीरसिंह मार्ग, गोलमार्केट, दिल्ली
(आर.के.आश्रम मार्ग, मेट्रो स्टेशन)
प्रस्तुति : मिथिलांगन, दिल्ली

23 मार्च, 2012 : रवीन्द्र अर्पण (जल डमरू बाजे) -

समय : सायं 07.00 बजे
स्थान : लिटिल थिएटर ग्रुप (एल.टी.जी.), दिल्ली
(मंडी हाउस, मेट्रो स्टेशन)
प्रस्तुति : मैलोरंग रेपर्टरी, दिल्ली

24 मार्च, 2012 : कथा रवीन्द्र (सगर राति दीप जरय-76) -

समय : सायं 06.00 बजे - 06.00 बजे प्रातःकाल
स्थान : अग्रवाल धर्मशाला, मधुबन रोड, दिल्ली
(निर्माण विहार, मेट्रो स्टेशन)

25 मार्च, 2012 : रवीन्द्र काव्य (काव्य रचनापाठ) -

समय : सायं 06.30 बजे
स्थान : एम.एल.आर. एकेडमी ऑफ आर्ट, मधुबन रोड, दिल्ली
(निर्माण विहार, मेट्रो स्टेशन)

26 मार्च, 2012 : रवीन्द्र नाट्य (व्यवस्था) -

समय : सायं 06.30 बजे
स्थान : मुक्तधारा, भाई वीरसिंह मार्ग, गोलमार्केट, दिल्ली
(आर.के.आश्रम मार्ग, मेट्रो स्टेशन)
प्रस्तुति : पंचकोसी, सहरसा

26 मार्च, 2012 : रवीन्द्र नाट्य (काबुलीबाला) -

समय : सायं 07.30 बजे
स्थान : मुक्तधारा, भाई वीरसिंह मार्ग, गोलमार्केट, दिल्ली
(आर.के.आश्रम मार्ग, मेट्रो स्टेशन)
प्रस्तुति : मैलोरंग रेपर्टरी, दिल्ली

•

**"What town's son has
come to sell vermilion,**

oh

**What town's daughter
has bought vermilion,
hey..."**

****Introduction of
Gajendra Thakur and
Preeti Thakur****

Here, the introduction of Gajendra

Thakur and Preeti Thakur is being given, and this introduction is detailed. This might seem strange to the reader. But those who have read in the preface of my book "Maithili Ghazal ka Vyakaran evam Itihaas" will understand why we are doing this. My clear belief is that to reach a grand stature, a person has the support of many people, especially family. Therefore, when that person gets an opportunity to feel proud, all those people should be acknowledged. The photos are being given in the appendix at the end. So far, Wikipedia pages of Gajendra Thakur have been created in three languages, the links are as follows-

Maithili-

<https://mai.wikipedia.org/s/co>

English-

https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Gajendra_Thakur&oldid=1144739154

And in Arabic of Egypt-
[https://arz.wikipedia.org/w/index.p
hp?title=%D8%AC%D8%A7%DA%86
%D9%8A%D9%86%D8%AF%D8%B1
%D8%A7_%D8%AB%D8%A7%D9%83
%D9%88%D8%B1&oldid=2849105](https://arz.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=%D8%AC%D8%A7%DA%86%D9%8A%D9%86%D8%AF%D8%B1%D8%A7_%D8%AB%D8%A7%D9%83%D9%88%D8%B1&oldid=2849105)

****Picture- 1- Gajendra Thakur****

Date of Birth: 30 March 1971
(Bhagalpur)

Mother: Smt. Lakshmi Thakur
(Parental home - Haithi Bali,
Madhubani)

Father: Late Kripanand Thakur
(Mother's village - Raje, Madhubani)

Wife: Smt. Preeti Thakur (Wedding
day - 26 January 2000)

Son: Om Thakur

Daughter: Aastha Thakur

Village: Mehath, Jhajharpur,
Madhubani (Bihar)

Education: MBA (Finance), C.I.C.,
C.L.D., M.B.L., P.G.D.C.L.C.F.,
P.G.D.I.P.R.L., Kovida

Profession: In service of Government
of India

Other members of Gajendra Thakur
ji's family:

Grandfather: Abhay Narayan Jha

Grandmother: Phool Dai

Maternal Uncles: Ram Avatar Jha
and Devendra Jha (Village - Haithi
Bali, Madhubani)

Brother: Shri Kumar Jitendra

Sister-in-law: Smt. Sunita Thakur
(Parental home - Bhavanipur,
Madhubani)

Nephew: Vedant Thakur

Niece: Swastika Thakur

Sister: Smt. Nilima Chaudhary (In-laws' place - Rudrapur, Madhubani)

Brother-in-law: (Shri) Shrimohan Chaudhary

Sister: Madhulika Mishra

Brother-in-law: Ravi Mishra (Village - Satlakha, Madhubani)

Sister's children: Avya and Ridhan

Second sister: Tulika

Brother-in-law: Sarvesh Kumar Jha (Village - Haradi, Madhubani)

****Preeti Thakur ji's parental side-****

****Picture- 2- Preeti Thakur****

Birth: 3 June 1977 (Kishanganj)

Mother: Smt. Indira Jha

Father: Shri Sudhir Chandra Jha

Village Jageli, Bhaya-Taranagar,
Purnia.

Education: Graduate in Botany

Other members of family:

Paternal Grandfather: Gaurikant Jha

Paternal Grandmother: Varda Devi

Maternal Grandfather: Jaykrishna
Jha

Maternal Grandmother: Shashikala
Devi

Brother: Shashi Shekhar

Sister-in-law: Priyanka

Niece-Nephew: Ananya and Atharva

Brother: Ravi Bhushan

Sister-in-law: Rashmi Priya

Niece-Nephew: Aparna and
Vikramaditya

****Preeti Thakur's Literary World****

Original:

1. Gonu Jha Aaur Aan Maithili Chitrakatha - First Maithili Picture Story (Children's Literature), (2008)
2. Maithili Chitrakatha (Children's Literature), (2009)
3. Mithila's Folk Deities (Children's Literature), (2010)
4. Vidyapati's Purush Pariksha (Children's Literature), (2012)

Translation (Maithili):

1. Small and Big (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2002, Revised Edition 2022)

2. Look at Property-Wealth and Animals (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2003, Revised Edition 2022)

3. My Family (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2007, Revised Edition 2022)

4. Animals (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2016, Revised Edition 2022)

5. Book 13: 1... 2... 3... (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2018, Revised Edition 2022)

6. Sound of Instruments (Translation - Children's Picture Story, Children's Literature) (1st Edition 2019, Revised Edition 2022)

7. Race (Translation - Children's

Picture Story, Children's Literature),
(2022)

8. A B C D - Nature Alphabet Book
(Translation - Children's Picture
Story, Children's Literature) (2022)

9. Everyone Eats (Translation -
Children's Picture Story, Children's
Literature) (2022)

10. Bo Mew Bah (Translation -
Children's Picture Story, Children's
Literature), (2022)

11. Colors All (Translation -
Children's Picture Story, Children's
Literature), (2022)

Special Work:

Compiled, Scanned & Catalogued:
11000 PALM LEAF PANJI
INSCRIPTIONS (VOLUME I TO XXII)
Compiled, Scanned & Catalogued by
Preeti Thakur

1. Panji (11000 original Mithilakshar

Palm Leaf), 2007

****Gajendra Thakur's Literary
World****

In the book Kurukshetram Antarmanak, the books with serial numbers 1 to 7 given above were published as a single book, for convenience of publication and to keep the price low. If the reader wishes, they can consider it as one book, but we have given separate order.

Original (Maithili- Braille):

1. Sahasrabadhane_Brail-Maithili
(First Maithili Braille Book), (2009)

Original (Maithili):

Kurukshetram Antarmanak

Devanagari Version, Tirhuta Version, Braille Version

1. Galpa-Guccha (Very Long and Short Story Collection) (2009)
2. Bal Mandli/ Kishor Jagat (Children's Drama, Short Stories, Poems etc.) (Children's Literature), (2009)
3. Research-Essay-Criticism Part-1 (2009)
4. Sankarshan (Drama), (2009)
5. Sahasrabdi ka Chaupadpar (Poetry Collection), (2009)
6. Tvanchahanch and Asanjati Man (Two Song Compositions), (2009)
7. Sahasrabadhanee (Novel), (2009)
8. Mithila Ratna/ Mithila Painting/ Mithila's Festivals (Stories) and Mithila's Music (2009)

9. Learn Mithilakshar Script (2009, Second edition 2023)

10. Learn Braille through Mithilakshar Script (2009, Second edition 2023)

11. Learn International Phonetic Script through Mithilakshar Script (2009, Second edition 2023)

12. Learn Kaithi (2009, Second edition 2023)

13. Learn Newari (2009, Second edition 2023)

14. Learn Calligraphic Newari (Ranjana) (2009, Second edition 2023)

15. Learn Urdu Script (2009, Second edition 2023)

16. Learn Tibetan Script (2009, Second edition 2023)

17. Learn Japanese Script for Haiku

(2009, Second edition 2023)

18. Learn Brahmi (2009, Second edition 2023)

19. Learn Kharoshthi (2009, Second edition 2023)

20. Aksharamushtika (Children's Short Story Collection), (Children's Literature), (2010)

21. Sahasrashirsha (Novel), (2010)

22. Jalodip (Children's Drama Collection), (Children's Literature), (2012)

23. Baangak Bangaura (Children's Poetry Collection), (Children's Literature), (2012)

24. Narashansi (Song-Composition), (2012)

25. Bha Jaeb Chhu (Maithili's first climate-fiction play originally published in 2012), (Children's

Literature), (2012)

26. Jagdish Prasad Mandal - A Biography (2013)

Jagdish Prasad Mandal - A Biography
(Hindi translation by Rameshwar Prasad Mandal)

27. Research-Essay-Criticism Part Two (Kurukshetram Antarmanak-2), (2014)

28. Dhanghi Baat Banebaak Daam Agoobaar Pene Chhan (Rubai, Kata and Ghazal Collection), (2014)

29. Sahasrajit (Poetry Collection), (2014)

30. Machand (Drama), (2014)

31. Maithili Samikshashastra (2022)

Maithili Samikshashastra (Tirhuta)

32. Nit Naval Subhash Chandra Yadav (2022)

Nit Naval Subhash Chandra Yadav
(Mithilakshar)

33. Kamalak Bhagata, (Children's Literature), (2022)

34. Tarharime Pareelok (Children's Literature), (2022)

35. Besi Chhutti Kam School (Children's Literature), (2022)

36. Badad Karae Daun Ne Yau, (Children's Literature), (2022)

37. Bal Ghazal (Children's Literature), (2022)

38. Finish Line, (Children's Literature), (2022)

39. Maithili Samikshashastra (Part-2, Application), (2023)

40. Maithili Competition, (Children's Literature), (2023)

41. Research-Essay-Criticism, (Part-2,

Kurukshetram Antarmanak Khand-8), (Concise), (2023)

42. Nit Naval Dinesh Kumar Mishra (2023)

Nit Naval Dinesh Kumar Mishra (Mithilakshar)

Nit Naval Dinesh Kumar Mishra (Kaithi)

Nit Naval Dinesh Kumar Mishra (Newari)

Nit Naval Dinesh Kumar Mishra (IPA)

43. Dushan Panji- The Black Book (2023)

Dushan Panji- The Black Book (Mithilakshar)

44. Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal (Very Long, Short and Long Story Collection), (2023)

Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal
(Mithilakshar)

Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal
(Kaithi)

Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal
(Newari)

Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal (IPA)

Shabdashastram (Short Story
Collection)

45. Swapname Mijhar Hoit (2023)

46. Ganga Bridge (Drama), (2023)

47. Ulkamukh (Drama), (2023)

48. Learn Maithili Sign Language
(2023)

49. Maithili's Adikavi Vidyapati (Pre-
Jyotirishwar) (2023)

50. Nit Naval Sushil (2023)

Original (English):

1. Rajdeo Mandal- Maithili Writer (2022)

2. JAGDISH PRASAD MANDAL- Maithili Writer (2023)

Translation (English):

1. The_Science_of_Words (2014)

Translation (Maithili):

1. Telugu Stories and Odia, Telugu, Gujarati, Bhojpuri and Kashmiri Poetry (2009)

2. Telugu Stories and Odia, Telugu, Gujarati, Bhojpuri and Kashmiri Poetry (Mithilakshar)

3. Videha:Sadeha 27 (Prose and Poetry translated from other languages by Gajendra Thakur and Ravi Bhushan Pathak - from issues 1-350), (2022)

4. Maasai's Transformative Rebecca, (Children's Literature), (2022)

5. Listen, (Children's Literature), (2022)

6. Houses All, (Children's Literature), (2022)

7. One Good Day, (Children's Literature), (2022)

8. Let's Go, We Are Fine, Right! , (Children's Literature), (2022)

9. Have You Seen These Birds? (Children's Literature), (2022)

10. Toast (Children's Literature), (2022)

11. Big One! Small One! (Children's Literature), (2022)

12. Here We All Live (Children's Literature), (2022)

13. Princess of Bharat, (Children's Literature), (2022)

14. Ugh (Children's Literature),

(2022)

15. Quarrel-Quarrel Quarrelsome,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

16. Chunnu-Munnu's Bath,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

17. The Child Who Was Afraid of
Balloons (Children's Literature),
(2022)

18. Amazing Fibonacci Number
Series, (Children's Literature), (2022)

19. Haru (Children's Literature),
(2022)

20. Not Now, Not Now! (Children's
Literature), (2022)

21. Birthday Celebration Feast,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

22. Fat King Thin-Skinny Rooster,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

23. The Girl Who Couldn't Stop Her

Laughter (Children's Literature),
(2022)

24. English (Children's Literature),
(2022)

25. I Can Smell, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

26. Little Red-Bright String
(Children's Literature), (2022)

27. Do Good, Enjoy Good (Children's
Literature), (2022)

28. It's All This Cat's Fault! ,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

29. Choibha Mango! (Children's
Literature), (2022)

30. The Path of Our Neighborhood
(Children's Literature), (2022)

31. When Ikkadu Went to School,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

32. Fly Come Back Again Tada!,

(Children's Literature), (2022)

33. Grandma's Oppressive Machines,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

34. Ting Tong, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

35. Paws-Meow-Woof, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

36. A Rooster's Day, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

37. I Like It, (Children's Literature),
(2022)

38. Rita's First Day at New School,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

39. Laugh a Little, Won't You! ,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

40. Red Raincoat, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

41. Ghosts' Theater, (Children's
Literature), (2022)

42. Come, Let's Count Feet,
(Children's Literature), (2022)

43. Where is This Number 5?
(Children's Literature), (2022)

44. Princess of Bharat, (Wordless),
(Children's Literature), (2022)

45. Moo Project (Tirhuta Script),
(2023)

46. Moo Project (Devanagari Script),
(2023)

Maithili-English Talking Read-Aloud
Audio Books:

1.
<https://bloomlibrary.org/player/Wcf6zr5CoF> (Maasai's Transformative Rebecca), (Children's Literature), (2022)

2.
<https://bloomlibrary.org/player/p3s>

HdYBgIT (Let's Go, We Are Fine, Right!), (Children's Literature), (2022)

3.

<https://bloomlibrary.org/player/f19pSdhGMo> (One Good Day), (Children's Literature), (2022)

4.

<https://bloomlibrary.org/player/b2l5wesxCp> (Houses All), (Children's Literature), (2022)

5.

<https://bloomlibrary.org/player/dAzC0Fubt7> (Have You Seen These Birds?), (Children's Literature), (2022)

6. Parvat Upar Bhamara Je Satal on https://www.youtube.com/@videha_ejournal , (2022)

Editorship:

Videha Issues 1-376 and onwards,
Videha-Sadeha Issues 1-36

Joint Editorship:

Gajendra Thakur, Nagendra Kumar
Jha and Panjekar Vidyanand Jha:

11000 PALM LEAF PANJI
INSCRIPTIONS (VOLUME I TO XXII)
Compiled, Scanned & Catalogued by
Preeti Thakur

1. Genome Mapping (450 AD to 2009
AD)--Mithila's Panji Management
(2009)

2. Maithili-English Dictionary Vol. I
(2009)

3. Maithili-English Dictionary Vol. II
(2009)

4. English-Maithili Computer
Dictionary (2009)

5. Genealogical Mapping (450 AD to
2009 AD)—Mithila's Panji

Management - Part-2 (2012)

6. Videha English Maithili Dictionary,
(2012)

Gajendra Thakur and Ashish
Anchinhaar:

1. Maithili Ghazal: Aagaman aur
Prasthan Bindu (Criticism-Analysis-
Review of Ghazal), (2012)

2. Maithili's Representative Ghazals
(2017)

The free material provided by
Gajendra Thakur for NTA-UGC/
UPSC/ BPSC Maithili Optional etc. is
as follows-

Maithili Samikshashastra

Maithili Samikshashastra (Tirhuta)

Maithili Samikshashastra (Part-2,
Application)

Maithili Competition

[Place of Maithili in Indo-European Language Family/ Origin and development of Maithili language (Sanskrit, Prakrit, Avhatt, Maithili)]

(Criticism- Different Literary Forms in Modern Era/ test of critical ability of the candidates)

(Jyotirishwar, Vidyapati and Govinddas are in the syllabus, and Rasamay Kavi Chatur Chaturbhuj is a poet contemporary to Vidyapati. Before starting the criticism series here, the vocabulary of all four is being given along with synonyms for new words. With knowledge of new and old vocabulary, there will be fluency in the question-answers on Jyotirishwar, Vidyapati and Govinddas; along with that, as the vocabulary increases, the hesitation in writing question-answers in genuine Maithili will gradually

disappear, there will be flow in the writing, and expression of true emotions can happen.)

(Badrinath Jha Vocabulary and Mithila's Agriculture-Fish Vocabulary)

(Value Addition - Paper 1 - Society and Culture in Lorik's Gatha)

(Value Addition - Paper 2 - Vidyapati)

(Value Addition - Paper 2 - Poetry Criticism - Sample)

(Value Addition - Paper 1 - Folk Tale Dance Drama Music)

(Value Addition - Paper 2 - Yatri)

(Value Addition - Paper 2 - Maithili Ramayana)

(Value Addition - Paper 2 - Maithili Novel)

(Value Addition - Paper 1 - Word

Analysis)

(Origin and Development of Tirhuta Script)

Appendices-1-2-3 Appendices-4-5

(Relationship between Maithili and other Eastern languages (Bangla, Assamese and Odia) [U.P.S.C. Syllabus, Paper-1, Part-"A", Serial-5])

[Maithili and Hindi/ Bangla/ Bhojpuri/ Magahi/ Santhali - For the Maithili (Optional) subject of the Bihar Public Service Commission (B.P.S.C.) Civil Services Examination]

NTA_UGC_NET_Maithili_01- Gajendra Thakur

NTA_UGC_NET_Maithili_02- Gajendra Thakur

Test Series-1- Gajendra Thakur

Test Series-2- Gajendra Thakur

GS (Pre)

Topic 1 - Gajendra Thakur

Students of NTA-UGC/ UPSC/ BPSC can go to Gajendra Thakur ji's youtube channel, the link of which is

1)

<https://www.youtube.com/@videha-elearning>

2)

https://www.youtube.com/@videha_ejournal/videos

3)

<https://www.youtube.com/@ggajendra71/videos>

Special - Paper reading titled "Samanvay" at the Indian Language Festival organized by IEHC on 3 November 2012. Readers can see this paper reading and other Maithili participants' readings by going to the

third channel link.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qKkki28Haxg>

Special - Three Maithili stories of Gajendra Thakur ji have been screened at the Diorama International Film Festival (through English translation, translator being the author himself). You can see after logging in. The link is https://watch.diorama.in/story/the-science-of-words/?fbclid=IwAR3zmWoyXmiViBXa4T0WfSDXjrSjN61Ka5L_KmvLHd_c-H8AmUTmoVhX4hg

****Founder of various honors - Gajendra Thakur****

Gajendra Thakur established the Videha Samman, which is also known as the Parallel Sahitya

Akademi, Parallel Lalit Kala Akademi and Parallel Sangeet-Natak Akademi honors/awards. This is the first such honor where those sections were also honored whose talent was suppressed by the brokers of institutions and government. This list is very long, so readers can see it by going to this link of Videha - https://drive.google.com/file/d/1KVCDIKRLXihmEvYENLmX4YfELT3yl_RJ/view

In addition, he has also provided much assistance for the first honor for the Maithili ghazal genre, the "Ghazal Kamala-Kosi-Bagmati-Mahananda Samman". The link for information related to this honor is - https://anchinharakharkolkata.blogspot.com/p/blog-page_4.html

Hearing the name "Parallel Sahitya Akademi, Parallel Lalit Kala Akademi and Parallel Sangeet-Natak Akademi honors", the mainstream pontiffs of

Maithili used to be furious and still are, but understand it as Maithili's fortune that such a tradition started even earlier. The need for such parallel work even in the Hindi language was expressed by some writers of that language as well. I am giving a screenshot and link of a Facebook post made in 2015 by a Hindi writer (Devendra Arya) (photo sequence, left to right)-

https://m.facebook.com/story.php?story_fbid=pfbid0344bgsLbDw818X38MrdL9wt2SvhyrX6KmQsc1GqF6oKkKa2ZhF5Y6bwRJjZNtrtqLl&id=100002871986777&mibextid=2JQ9oc

****Appendix-1****

****Picture- 3- Late Kripanand Thakur****
****Picture- 4- Smt. Lakshmi Thakur****

****Picture- 5 & 6-** In the first photo from left - Swastika Thakur, Shri Kumar Jitendra, Smt. Sunita Thakur, Vedant Thakur. In the second photo from left - (Shri) Shrimohan Chaudhary, Smt. Nilima Chaudhary******

****Picture- 7 & 8-** In the first photo from left - Smt. Lakshmi Thakur, Om Thakur, Preeti Thakur and Aastha Thakur. In the second photo, back from left - Madhulika Mishra, Ravi Mishra, front from left - Ridhan and Avya******

****Picture-9 & 10** First photo from left - Tulika and Sarvesh Kumar Jha. Second photo Aastha Thakur******

****Picture- 11- Om Thakur****

****Picture- 12- Gajendra Thakur (in 2013)****

****Picture- 13 & 14 - Shri Sudhir Chandra Jha and Smt. Indira Jha****

****Picture- 15 & 16 - Gaurikant Jha and Varda Devi****

****Picture- 17 & 18 - Jaykrishna Jha and Shashikala Devi****

****Picture- 19 & 20 - Shashi Shekhar and Priyanka****

****Picture- 21 & 22 - Shashi Shekhar, Priyanka, Atharva and Ananya****

****Picture- 23 & 24 - Ravi Bhushan and Rashmi Priya****

****Picture- 25 & 26 - Aparna and Vikramaditya****

"Like a branch of the karmi tree, they will entwine, like a purrain plant, they will spread, hey..."

Sitting in the courtyard of Kripanand Thakur ji in Mehath village, whatever you all have read so far was just the preface. Now, from here, this couple of creators is stepping forward for the 22nd-century Maithili literary cradle, which is fully adorned and ready especially for them. This same cradle will witness new-new plans and projects. This

same cradle will witness the love for language and literature. This same cradle will witness promises, silently fulfilling promises. This same cradle will witness that foundation on which the 32nd-35th century Maithili will stand.....

"Kaushalya Rani and also Sumitra Rani wrote the Kohbar...

Made ripe betel nut and betel leaf into a khiliya..."

"On the banks of the river, a gardener's garden, in it a sandalwood tree, hey..."

"In the backyard of the house, a clove plant, cloves bloom at midnight, hey..."

"Who will cut with scissors, mother, the decorative border..."

Now, let us all step back. Let us all return. We will come again another time. We will all come again.

****Contributing Author
Introductions****

I am 'Anchinhaar' (unfamiliar), but the authors who have contributed to this book are not unfamiliar to the reader, so their special introduction has not been given. These names themselves are an introduction in themselves. Nevertheless, a reader of the PDF would have the convenience that if they click on any author's name, then that author's introduction, in whatever form we have found it (Wikipedia, books, magazines, other available introductions or Videha special issues, the author introduction section collected in Videha - the

photo given in Videha Ratna), would appear. But as said in the preface, this facility would not be available in print, so for this, we are apologizing to the readers of the print medium. Otherwise, print readers can be happy thinking that when these links don't work, then print and links will all become equal. If under an author's name there is one underline, that means one link has been given in it. But in whose name there are separate underlines, that means we have given more than one link in it. For example: In Siyaram Jha 'Saras', there is one link, therefore one underline is found; in Dr. Raman Jha, there are two links, therefore two separate underlines are found; but in Uday Narayan Singh 'Nachiketa', four separate underlines are found, meaning a total of four links have been given in it, which the reader of the online book can open and read by clicking

on them separately-

1. Siyaram Jha 'Saras' 2. Dr. Shefáliká Varma 3. Veena Thakur 4. Dr. Raman Jha 5. Shiv Kumar Jha 'Tillu' 6. Dhirandra Kumar 7. Durganand Mandal 8. Kalpana 9. Kirtinath Jha 10. Laldev Kamat 11. Binyanand Jha 12. Jagdish Chandra Thakur 'Anil' 13. Dr. Kailash Kumar Mishra 14. Bhavnath Jha 15. Bhimnath Jha 16. Dr. Shiv Kumar Mishra 17. Uday Narayan Singh "Nachiketa" 18. Pranav 19. Laxman Jha 'Sagar' 20. Shivshankar Srinivas 21. Rabindra Narayan Mishra 22. Dr. Dhanakar Thakur 23. Dr. Yoganand Jha 24. Ashok 25. Arvind Thakur 26. Rajdeo Mandal 27. Professor Premshankar Singh (now late) 28. Dr. Abha Jha 29. Acharya Ramanand Mandal 30. Ajit Kumar Jha 31. Mukesh Dutt 32. Munna Ji

****Editor's Introduction****

****Ashish Anchinhaar****

Founder and editor of the internet magazine (in blog form) "Anchinhaar Aakhar", centered on Maithili Ghazal and Sher-o-Shayari. Author of a total of 8 books, including Maithili Ghazal's Grammar and History and History of Maithili Web Journalism, and editor of 4 books. For a special introduction, you can go to the link <https://mai.wikipedia.org/s/5i>.

Email: ashish.anchinhar@gmail.com



प्रति कारण सेतु बान्धुल Redefining Maithili

साम्पादकः आशीष अनघिन्दार



प्रीति कारण सेतु बान्हल

Redefining Maithili

প্ৰীতি কাৰণ সেতু বান্হন

Redefining Maithili



सम्पादक परिचय
आशीष अनचिन्हार
मूल नाम - आशीष कुमार मिश्र
माता - श्रीमती गम्भीरा मिश्र
पिता - स्व. कृष्ण चंद्र मिश्र
गाम - भटरा घाट, बिस्फी, मधुबनी
जन्म - 4/12/1985



बर्ष 2008 में शुरू भेल मैथिली गजल एवं शेरों-शाहीपर केंद्रित इंटरनेट पत्रिका (ब्लाग रूपमें) "अनचिन्हार आखर" केर संस्थापक ओ संपादक।

प्रकाशित कृति -

- 1) अनचिन्हार आखर (गजल, रुबाइ ओ कता संग्रह)
- 2) मैथिली गजलक व्याकरण ओ इतिहास (ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)
- 3) मैथिली त्रेब पत्रकारिताक इतिहास (ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)
- 4) जंघाजोड़ी (गजल संग्रह, ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)
- 5) मैथिली गजलक Ready Reckoner (ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)
- 6) कुमारि इच्छा (गजल संग्रह, ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)
- 7) शब्द-अर्थ-शक्ति (स्वतंत्र रूपे मैथिली गजलक पहिला आलोचना/पोथी, ई भर्सन प्रकाशित)

8) संदर्भ सहित (गजल-आलोचना)

संपादित पोथी-

- 1) स्वतंत्रचेता (अरविन्द ठाकुर: व्यक्तित्व-कृतित्व, विदेहक अरविन्द ठाकुर विशेषांक केर संशोधित रूप)

श्री गजेन्द्र ठाकुरजीक संगे सह-संपादित पोथी

- 1) मैथिली गजल: आगमन ओ प्रस्थान बिंदु (संपादित रूपमें मैथिली गजल आलोचनाक पहिल पोथी), ई भर्सन प्रकाशित

- 2) मैथिलीक प्रतिनिधि गजल (1905सँ 2022 धरि), ई भर्सन प्रकाशित

सम्मान-

बर्ष 2014 लेल विदेह भाषा सम्मान (समानान्तर साहित्य अकादेमी सम्मान)सँ पोथी "अनचिन्हार आखर" (गजल संग्रह) लेल सम्मानित।

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<https://anchinharakharkolkata.blogspot.com/>